

Armarius

A saga manager for Ars Magica

The Walkthroughs

Seventeen guides to running an Ars Magica saga with Armarius, from a new magus to the house rules.

The master tome · Guides 1 to 17

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Making a Magus

From a Gifted child to a finished sheet: childhood, apprenticeship, the Gauntlet and a magus's lineage, with Adelheid of Flambeau and Leandro's new apprentice.

Guide 1 of 17

Making a magus is the bit of Ars Magica that scares new players off: Virtues and Flaws, seven points of Characteristics, four separate pots of experience and 120 levels of spells, each with its own limits. And that's just the quick way. If your troupe wants to play the years before the Gauntlet, there's a whole childhood and apprenticeship to live through as well.

Armarius does both. This guide follows two magi of Rabenstein, the covenant on the Swabian Alb where most of these guides are set. **Adelheid of Flambeau** is made the usual way, on the Creation Worksheet, straight out of her Gauntlet in Spring 1220. **Kaspar**, a miller's boy from the village under the crag, is made the long way: found by **Leandro of Bonisagus**, opened to the Arts, taught year by year, and sent to his own Gauntlet.

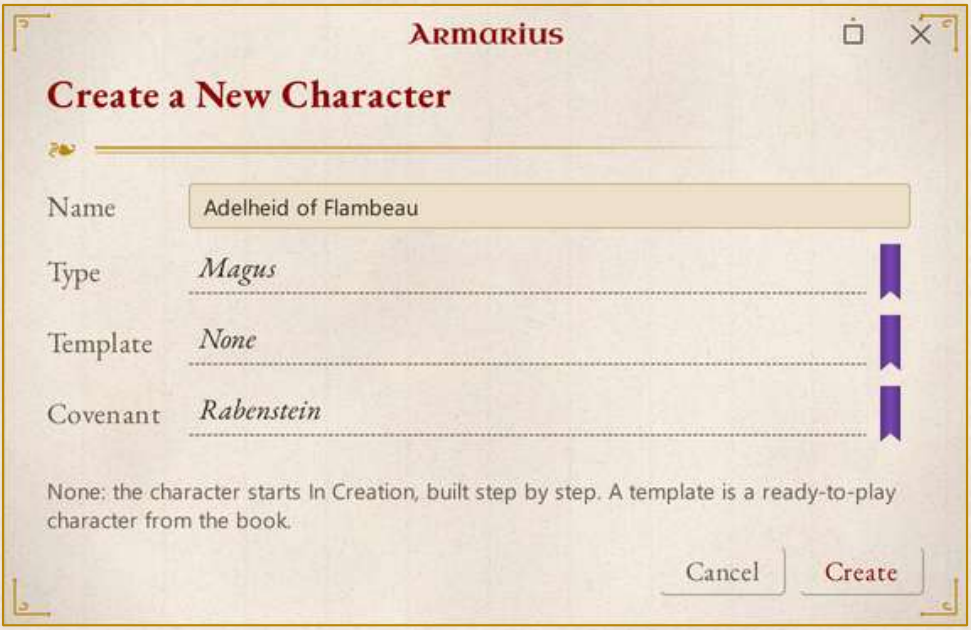
The rules come from the *Ars Magica Definitive Edition* (DE): Detailed Character Creation in chapter three (pp. 43-50), the Virtues and Flaws of chapter four, and Apprentices in chapter eight (pp. 269-272). The childhood and Gauntlet rules are from *Apprentices* (pp. 7-24, 58-61), and House Acclaim from *Houses of Hermes: True Lineages* (pp. 21-22) and *Houses of Hermes: Societates* (p. 31). Where a supplement and the Definitive Edition disagree, the Definitive Edition wins, and the guide says so.

The book's recipe · DE p. 44

1. Pick a concept. 2. Pick a House. 3. Virtues and Flaws: up to ten points of Flaws and the same of Virtues (Minor 1, Major 3). 4. Seven points of Characteristics. 5. Early childhood: 75 xp of native language and 45 more. 6. Later life: 15 xp a year. 7. Apprenticeship: 240 xp and 120 levels of spells. 8. Optional years after Gauntlet. Then personality, reputations, Confidence and equipment.

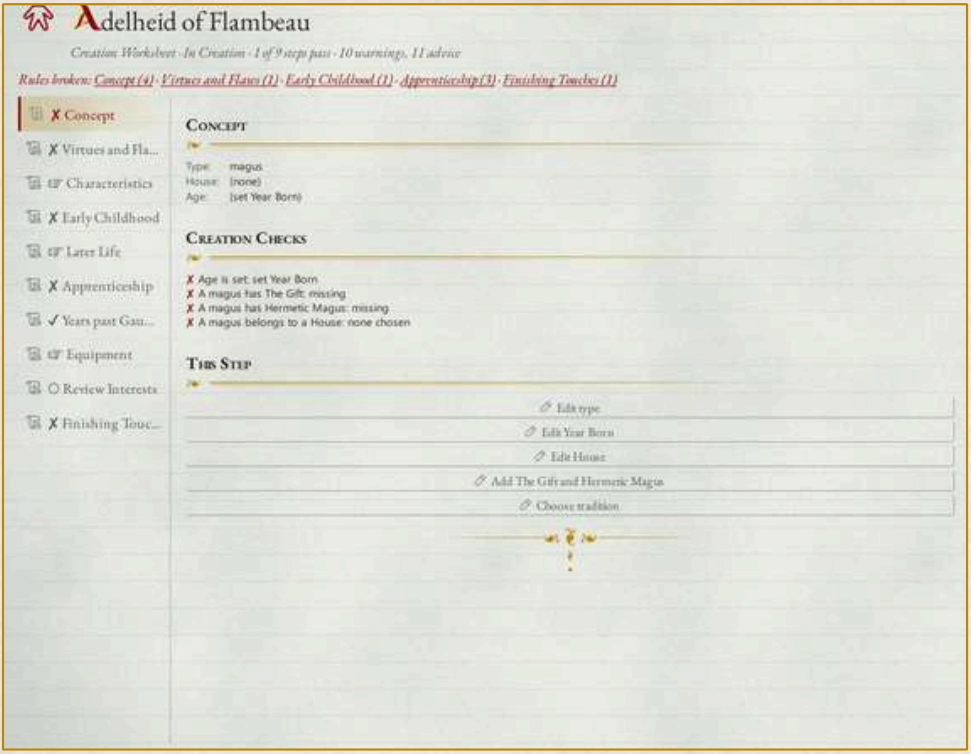
1. A new magus

On the covenant's page, open **People** and click the dotted **New Magus** card at the end of the Magi. Give her a name, leave Type at **Magus** and leave the **Template** at None. (The templates are the book's ready-made magi, one per House, if you'd rather skip all this and start playing.)



Create a New Character, in its own window: Name "Adelheid of Flambeau", Type Magus, Template None, Covenant Rabenstein. The line under the fields says what None means: the character starts In Creation, built step by step.

A new character starts **In Creation**: her page is drawn on drafting vellum, and the Creation Worksheet opens by itself. Down the left are the book's steps, each marked ✗ while a rule is broken, ☞ while there's advice, and ✓ once it all checks out. The red line across the top links every step with a broken rule, so you can jump straight to it.



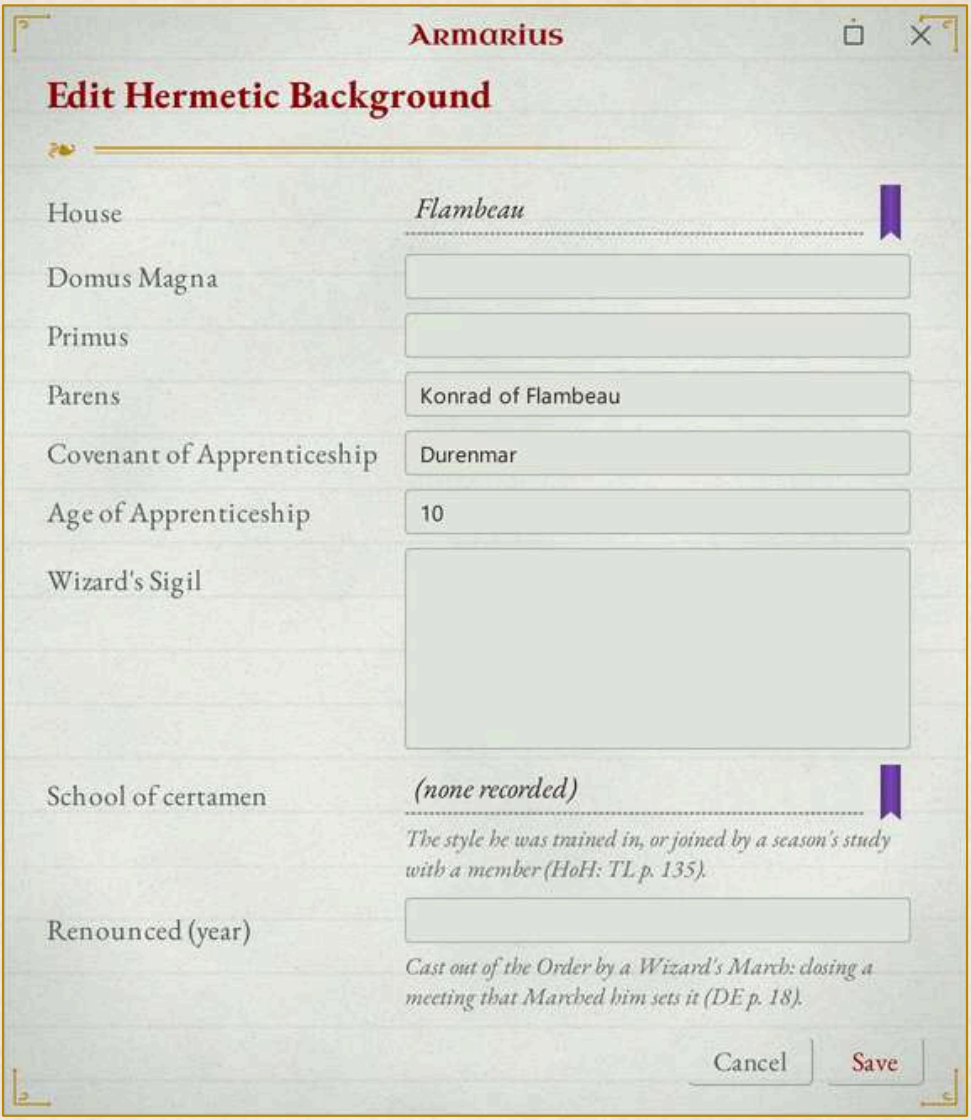
The worksheet straight after Create: Concept, Virtues and Flaws, Characteristics, Early Childhood, Later Life, Apprenticeship, Years past Gauntlet, Equipment, Review Interests and Finishing Touches down the rail, four rules broken on Concept alone because she has no age, no Gift and no House yet.

Checks never stop you editing. They only matter when you move her to In Play at the end.

2. Concept: who she is

First, **Edit Year Born** asks for her birth year: 1195, so she's 25. **Edit House** asks for her House and the rest of her Hermetic Background: Flambeau, her parens **Konrad of Flambeau**, Durenmar as the covenant of her apprenticeship, and ten as the age she started. Then **Add The Gift and Hermetic Magus** puts in the two free Virtues every magus has, and **Add the House Virtue** asks which of her House's gifts she takes.

> **The rule · DE pp. 45-46**
>
> Every magus has The Gift and the free Social Status Hermetic Magus. Each House gives a benefit at creation, on top of the normal allowance: a Flambeau gets Puissant Perdo or Puissant Ignem free.



Edit Hermetic Background, opened right under the step: House Flambeau, Parens Konrad of Flambeau, Covenant of Apprenticeship Durenmar, Age of Apprenticeship 10.

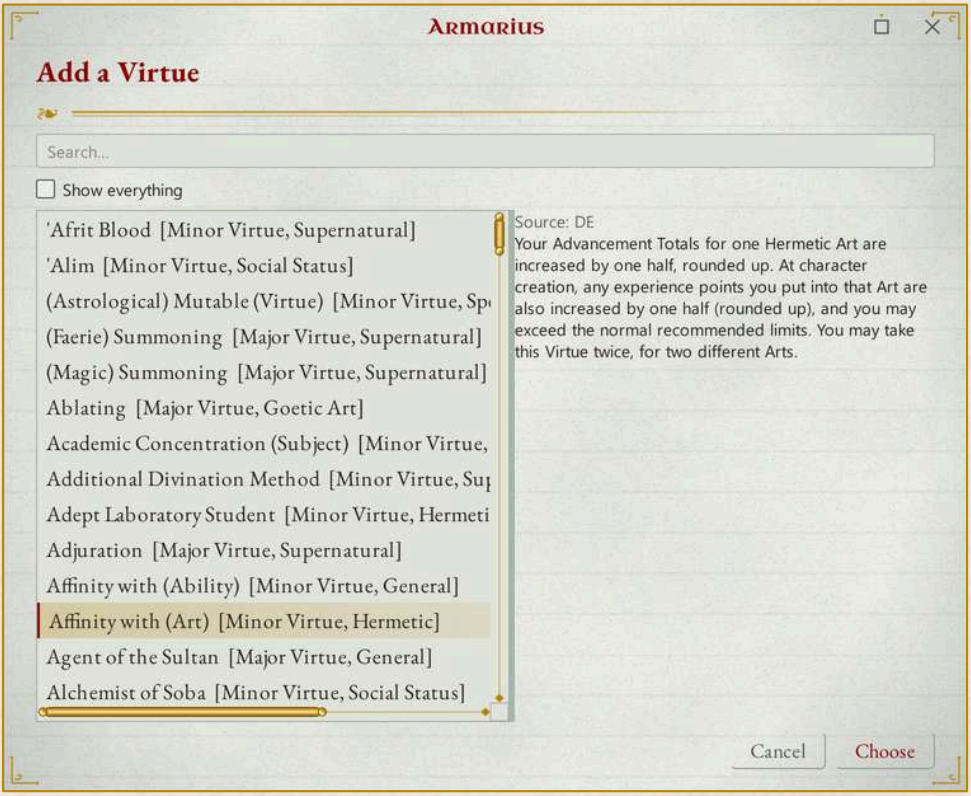


Add the House Virtue, titled "House Flambeau's free Virtue", offering Puissant Perdo and Puissant Ignem.

What happened. Concept goes to ✓: 25 years old, House Flambeau, with The Gift, Hermetic Magus and Puissant Ignem.

3. Virtues and Flaws

Here's where she gets interesting. **Add a Virtue** opens the whole list, with each one's rules beside it; type a few letters to find one. A Virtue that names something, like Affinity with (Art), asks which Art next. **Add a Flaw** does the same for Flaws.

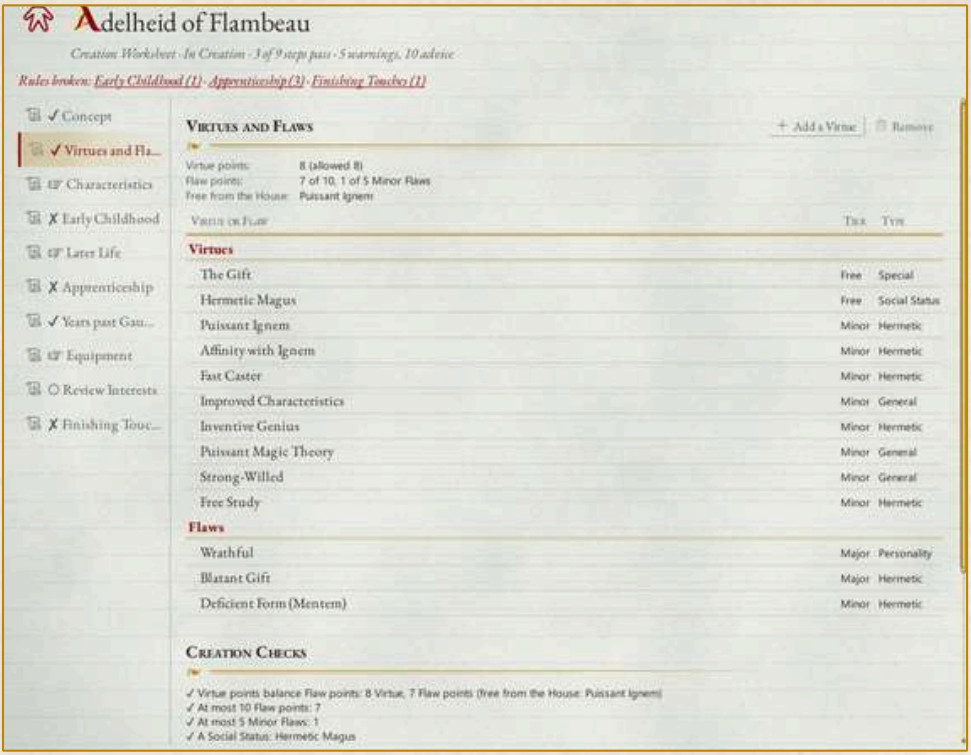


Add a Virtue, with Affinity with (Art) chosen and its rules shown on the right.

The rule · DE pp. 45, 61, 66

Up to ten points of Flaws, no more than five Minor ones, and the same number of points of Virtues. A magus should have at least one Hermetic Flaw, since no magus fits Hermetic theory perfectly. No more than one Story Flaw, one Major Personality Flaw, and two Personality Flaws in all.

Adelheid takes seven points of Flaws: she's **Wrathful** (Major, p. 154), she has the **Blatant Gift** (Major, p. 120), so ordinary folk find her frankly alarming, and she's **Deficient in Mentem** (p. 125). That pays for seven Minor Virtues: **Affinity with Ignem** (p. 69), **Fast Caster** (p. 80), **Free Study** (p. 82), **Improved Characteristics** (p. 86), **Inventive Genius** (p. 87), **Puissant Magic Theory** (p. 105) and **Strong-Willed** (p. 110).



Virtues and Flaws done. The checks count 8 Virtue points against 7 Flaw points and pass, because Puissant Ignem came free from the House.

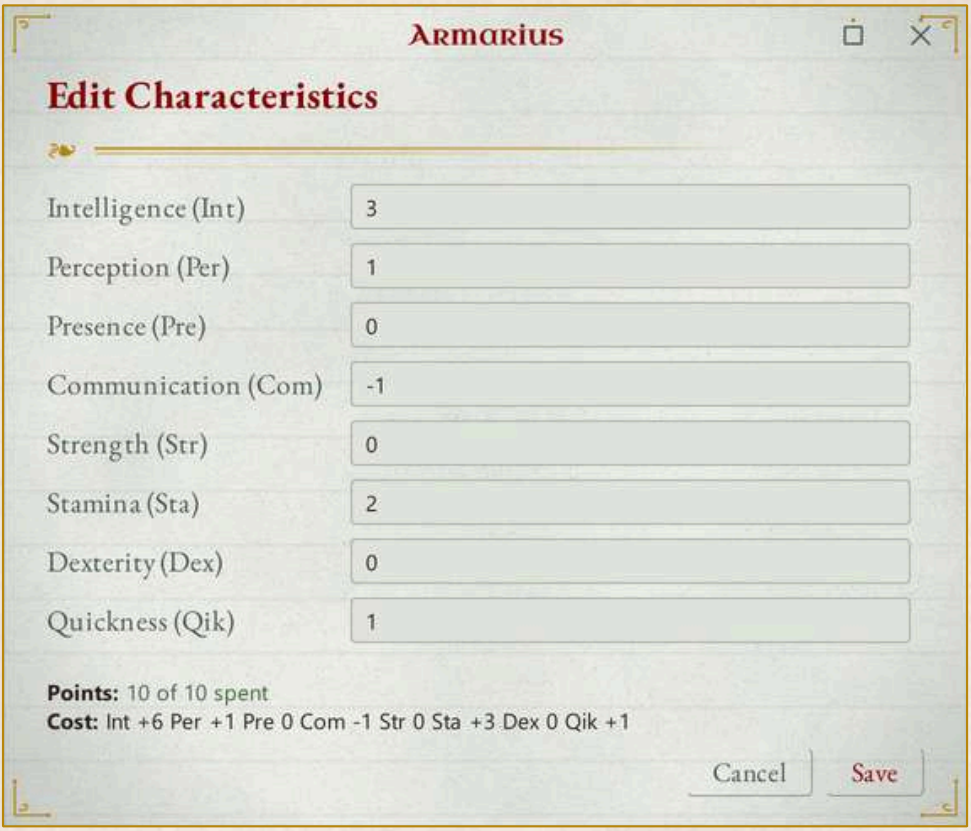
> **What happened.** Seven points each way, plus the free three. Every check on the step passes.

4. Characteristics

Click **Edit Characteristics** for the eight scores. The line under them keeps the cost as you type, so you can shuffle points around until the total comes out right. (For a character on the standard seven points, **Fill from an array** beside it spends them in one go: pick an array, then put each score where you want it. Adelheid's ten points are her own to place.)

> **The rule · DE p. 48**
>
> Seven points to spend: +1 costs 1, +2 costs 3, +3 costs 6. Going negative gives points back (-1 gives 1, -2 gives 3, -3 gives 6). Improved Characteristics adds three more points (p. 86).

Ten points, then. Intelligence +3 (6 points) because it runs the laboratory, Stamina +2 (3) because it runs spellcasting, Perception +1 and Quickness +1 (1 each), paid for by Communication -1. She won't be writing many books.



Edit Characteristics, with the line under the fields reading "Points: 10 of 10 spent" and the cost of each score.

What happened. 10 of 10 points spent, and the step goes to ✓.

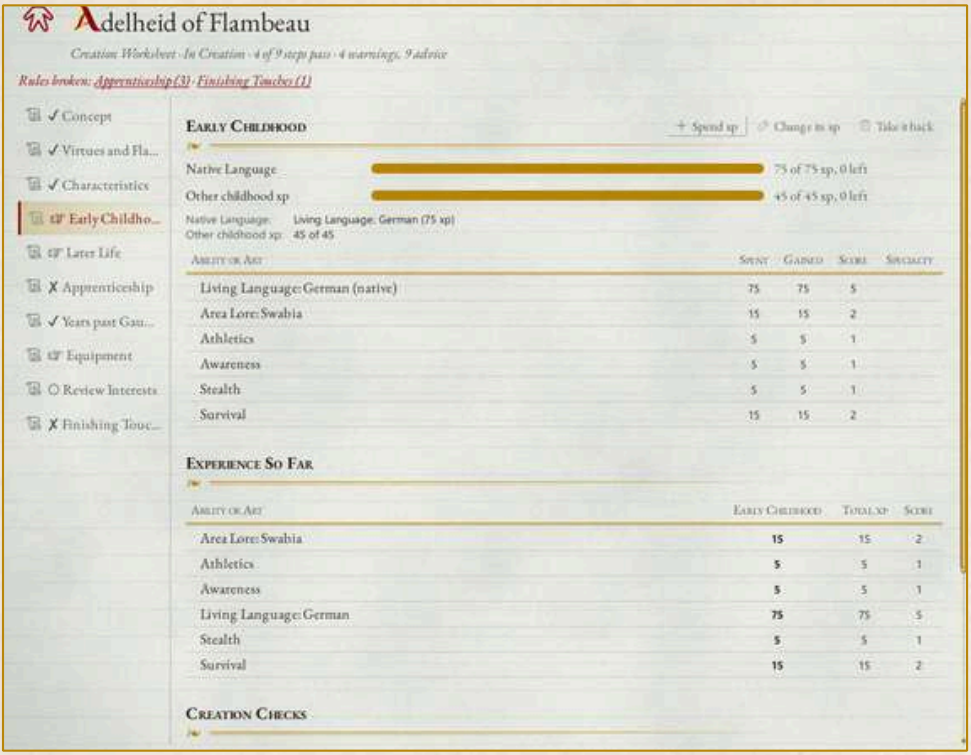
5. Childhood

Every magus was a child once, and the book gives her two pots of experience for it.

Early Childhood wants her native language first: click **Native Language** and choose German (75 xp, a score of 5). For the other 45 xp you can **Spend xp** yourself, or **Use a sample childhood**, the book's ready-made packages. Adelheid grew up running about the Swabian hills, so she gets the Exploring childhood, with Swabia as her Area Lore.

The rule · DE p. 48

75 xp of native language and 45 xp among Area Lore, Athletics, Awareness, Brawl, Charm, Folk Ken, Guile, another living language, Stealth, Survival and Swim. Exploring childhood: Area Lore 2, Athletics 1, Awareness 1, Stealth 1, Survival 2.

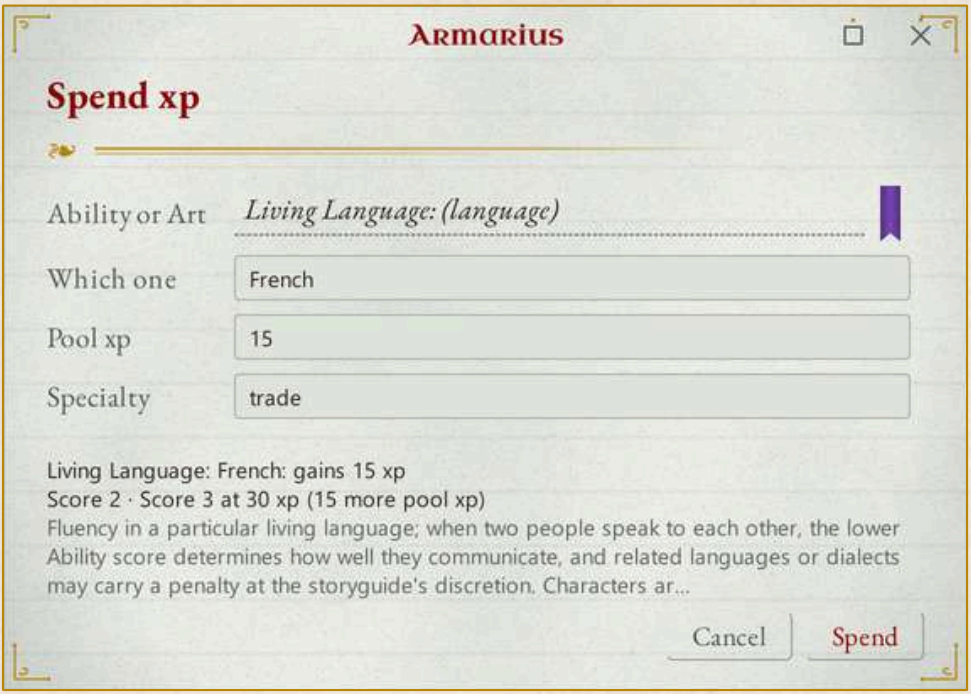


Use a sample childhood, with the Exploring childhood chosen; then the Early Childhood step with Area Lore: Swabia. Experience So Far keeps a running total of every step.

Later Life is the years between five and the start of her apprenticeship at ten, and the step works that out from her age of apprenticeship: five years at 15 xp is 75 xp. She can only spend it on General Abilities, since she has no Virtue opening the others yet.

The rule · DE p. 49

15 xp a year until apprenticeship, on Abilities the character's Virtues let her learn. Academic, Arcane, Martial and Supernatural Abilities each need a Virtue (a magus gets them in apprenticeship). Each Ability should have a specialty (p. 157).



Spend xp in Later Life: Living Language: French, 15 xp, specialty "trade". The line under it says what the xp buys: score 2, and score 3 at 30 xp.

What happened. 75 of 75 xp spent: French 2, Athletics 2, Awareness 2, Folk Ken 2, Brawl 1 and Concentration 2. Later Life goes to ✓. Early Childhood keeps a ☞: the sample childhood comes without specialties, and every step that spends xp reminds you of an Ability left without one. Give each its specialty in Spend xp's **Specialty** box when you like; advice never stops you.

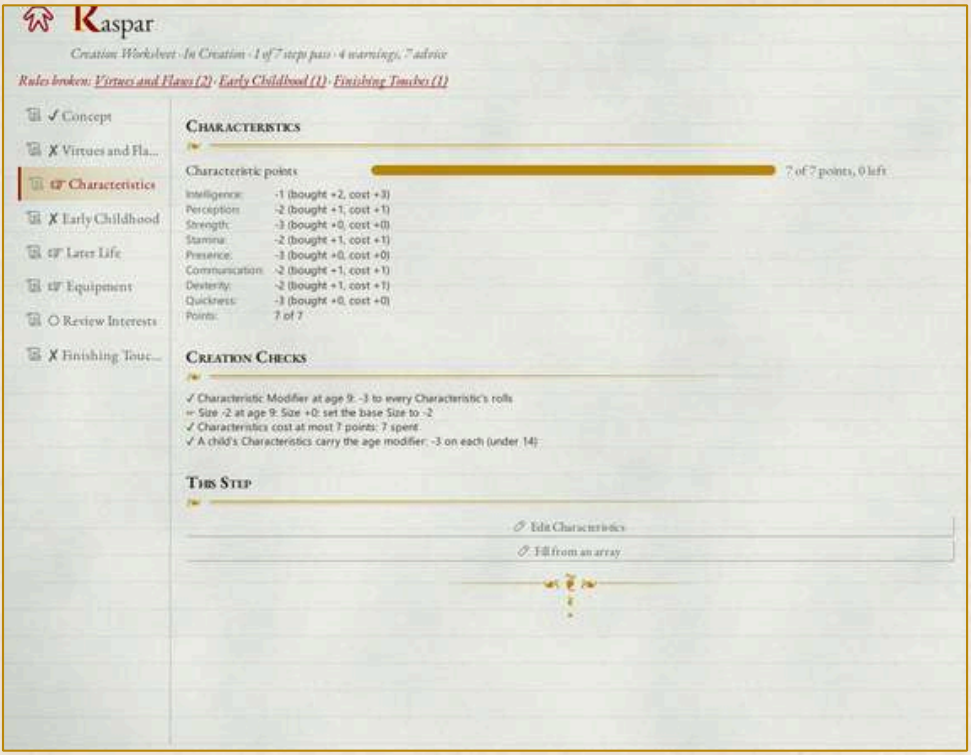
Playing a child instead

If your troupe would rather start younger, with *Apprentices* in play the same worksheet makes a child. Kaspar is nine when Leandro finds him (more on that in chapter 7), and the worksheet knows it from his Year Born.

The rule · Apprentices pp. 7-9, 13-14

Below 14, every Characteristic carries a modifier for age (-3 at 8 or 9) and Size is smaller (-2 at 8 or 9). A score of 0 is average for the age group, and the seven points are bought as usual. After five, a child gains 15 xp a year, and no Ability can be above 5. Virtues that grant experience are barred to a character made younger than 14.

On Characteristics you type the scores *with* the age modifier in them, and the step shows what was bought underneath. Kaspar's player buys Intelligence +2 and a +1 in Perception, Stamina, Communication and Dexterity:
so Intelligence goes in as -1 and the others as -2 (and -3 for the scores left at 0). The step reads "-1 (bought +2, cost +3)" and "7 of 7".



Kaspar's Characteristics step: each score with "(bought +n, cost +n)" beside it, Points 7 of 7, and the checks "Characteristic Modifier at age 9: -3 to every Characteristic's rolls" (✓) and "Size -2 at age 9: set the base Size to -2" (☞).

Later Life does the rest: "age 5 to 9 (now), 4 years at 15 xp = 60 xp", with the Ability cap at this age of 5. Kaspar was born with a touch of the Sight, so he also takes **Second Sight**, a Supernatural Ability many Gifted children have.

The app also keeps the **transitions of maturation** for you. At the end of a year, everyone turning 8, 15 or 21 gets a line in the season's results and a Diary entry: in the first season of that year they may swap Virtues and Flaws, Minor for Minor and Major for Major, and any Child Virtues or Flaws must be swapped by 21 (*Apprentices* pp. 14-15). You make the swap yourself on the Virtues & Flaws chapter.

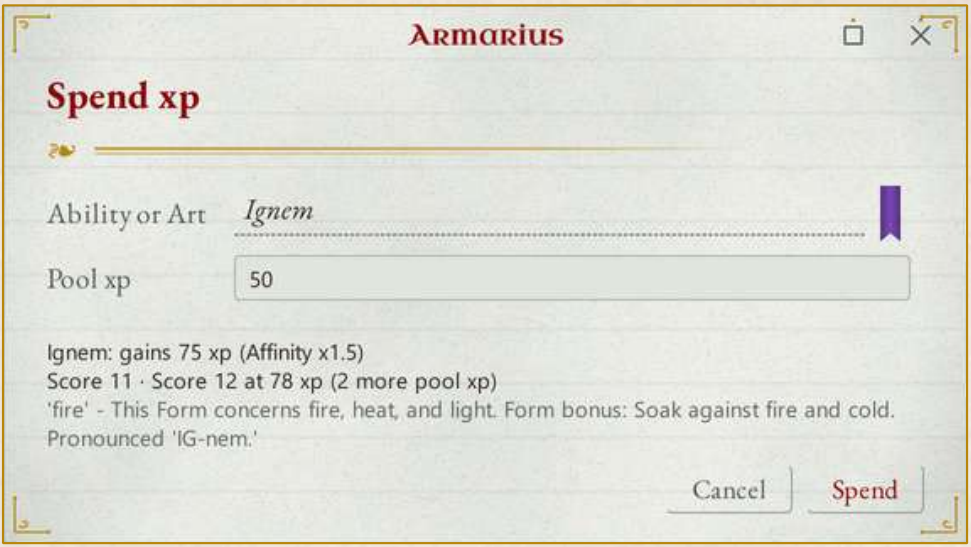
6. Apprenticeship

Back to Adelheid. Fifteen years with Konrad: 240 xp for Arts and any Abilities, and 120 levels of spells. This is the big one, so take it slowly.

The rule · DE pp. 49-50

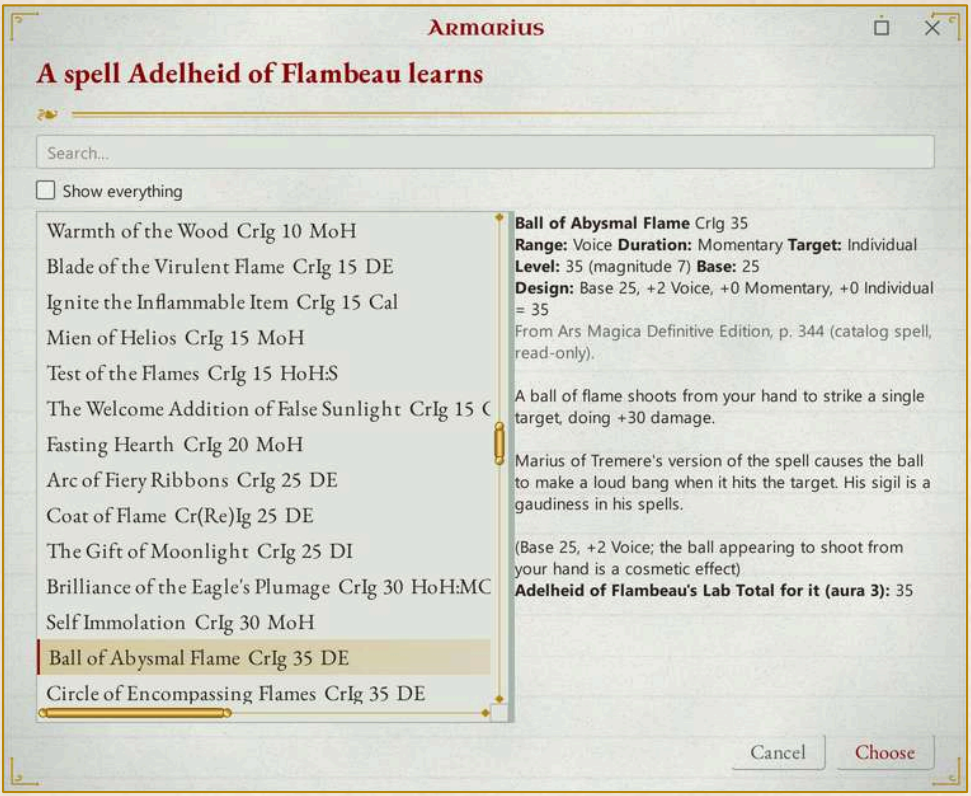
240 xp on Arts or Abilities (Arcane, Academic and Martial included) and 120 levels of spells. Every magus needs Parma Magica, Magic Theory and Latin at 1 at least; Latin 4 and Artes Liberales 1 to read the Order's books; Magic Theory 3 to set up a laboratory. A spell's level can't be higher than Technique + Form + Intelligence + Magic Theory + 3, counting any Virtues that would apply to a Lab Total.

Most of it goes on fire. 50 xp in Ignem becomes 75 with her Affinity (x1.5, p. 69), a score of 11, and Puissant Ignem adds 3 more whenever she uses it (p. 105). Creo gets 21 (score 6), then Rego, Perdo, Vim, Intellego and Corpus a bit each. The rest buys Latin 4, Magic Theory 3, Penetration 2 and a 1 in Parma Magica, Artes Liberales, Finesse and Order of Hermes Lore.



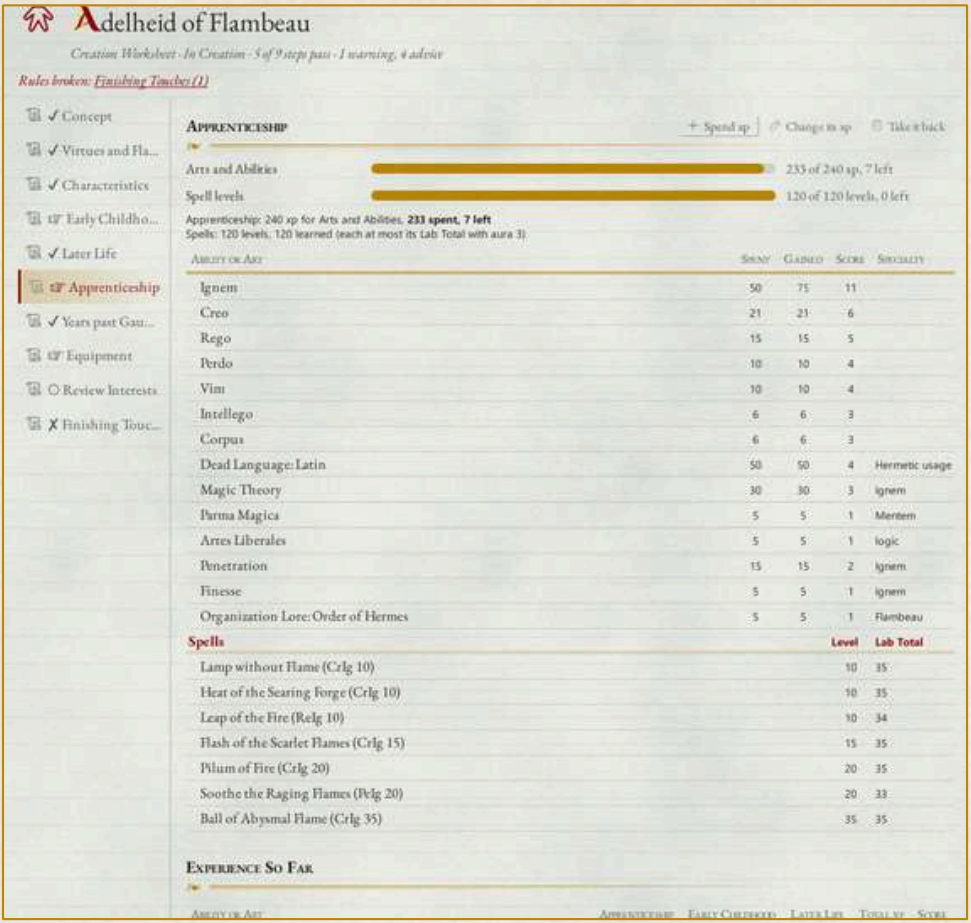
Spend xp in Apprenticeship: Ignem, 50 xp. The line shows the Affinity at work: "gains 75 xp (Affinity x1.5)", score 11.

Then **Learn a spell**, seven times. The list has every spell in the books the saga uses, and the checks test each one against her Lab Total with an aura of 3, just as the book says.



Learn a spell, with Ball of Abysmal Flame chosen: the classic Flambeau fireball.

Close: Ball of Abysmal Flame is level 35, and her Creo Ignem Lab Total is Creo 6 + Ignem 14 + Intelligence 3 + Magic Theory 5 (3 plus Puissant's 2) + 1 for her Magic Theory specialty in Ignem + aura 3 + Inventive Genius 3 = 35. Just enough, and only because of that specialty. The checks also say she has 7 xp left unspent, and 7 more in Creo takes it from 21 xp to 28, a score of 7, which gives her a point to spare.



Adelheid of Flambeau

Creation Worksheet · In Creation · 5 of 9 steps pass · 1 warning, 4 advice

Rules broken: Finishing Touches (1)

- ✓ Concept
- ✓ Virtues and Fla...
- ✓ Characteristics
- ☞ Early Childho...
- ✓ Later Life
- ☞ Apprenticeship
- ✓ Years past Gau...
- ☞ Equipment
- ○ Review Interests
- ✗ Finishing Touc...

Apprenticeship — + Spend xp | Change xp | Take it back

Arts and Abilities — 233 of 240 xp, 7 left

Spell levels — 120 of 120 levels, 0 left

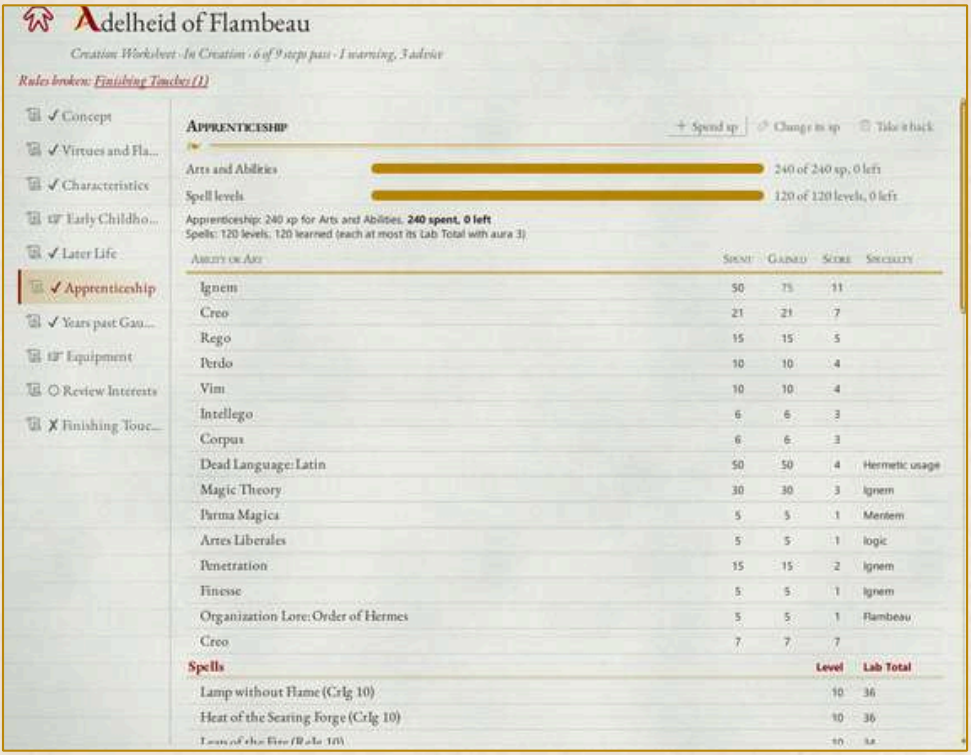
Apprenticeship: 240 xp for Arts and Abilities, **233 spent, 7 left**
Spells: 120 levels, 120 learned (each at most its Lab Total with aura 3)

Ability or Art	Spent	Gained	Score	Specialty
Ignem	50	75	11	
Creo	21	21	6	
Rego	15	15	5	
Perdo	10	10	4	
Vim	10	10	4	
Intellego	6	6	3	
Corpus	6	6	3	
Dead Language: Latin	50	50	4	Hermetic usage
Magic Theory	30	30	3	Ignem
Parma Magica	5	5	1	Mentem
Artes Liberales	5	5	1	logic
Penetration	15	15	2	Ignem
Finesse	5	5	1	Ignem
Organization Lore: Order of Hermes	5	5	1	Flambeau
Spells			**Level**	**Lab Total**
Lamp without Flame (CrIg 10)			10	35
Heat of the Searing Forge (CrIg 10)			10	35
Leap of the Fire (ReIg 10)			10	34
Flash of the Scarlet Flames (CrIg 15)			15	35
Pilum of Fire (CrIg 20)			20	35
Soothe the Raging Flames (PeIg 20)			20	33
Ball of Abysmal Flame (CrIg 35)			35	35

Experience So Far

Ability or Art | Apprenticeship | Early Childhood | Later Life | Total xp | Score

The Apprenticeship step with 233 of 240 xp spent, its spells listed with their levels and Lab Totals: Ball of Abysmal Flame at level 35 against a Lab Total of 35.



The same step after seven more xp in Creo: 240 of 240 xp, 120 of 120 spell levels, and every spell under its Lab Total.

What happened. Apprenticeship goes to ✓. Her spells are Lamp without Flame, Heat of the Searing Forge, Leap of the Fire (10 each), Flash of the Scarlet Flames (15), Pilum of Fire, Soothe the Raging Flames (20 each) and Ball of Abysmal Flame (35): 120 levels exactly.

The Apprenticeship step adds 60 xp and 30 spell levels for a Skilled Parens, and takes as much away for a Weak one. With *Apprentices* in play, the saga can also use that book's standard apprenticeship for a character made part way through: 19 xp a year for the first twelve years, then 6 xp and 40 spell levels a year for the last three (*Apprentices* p. 14).

7. Training an apprentice in play

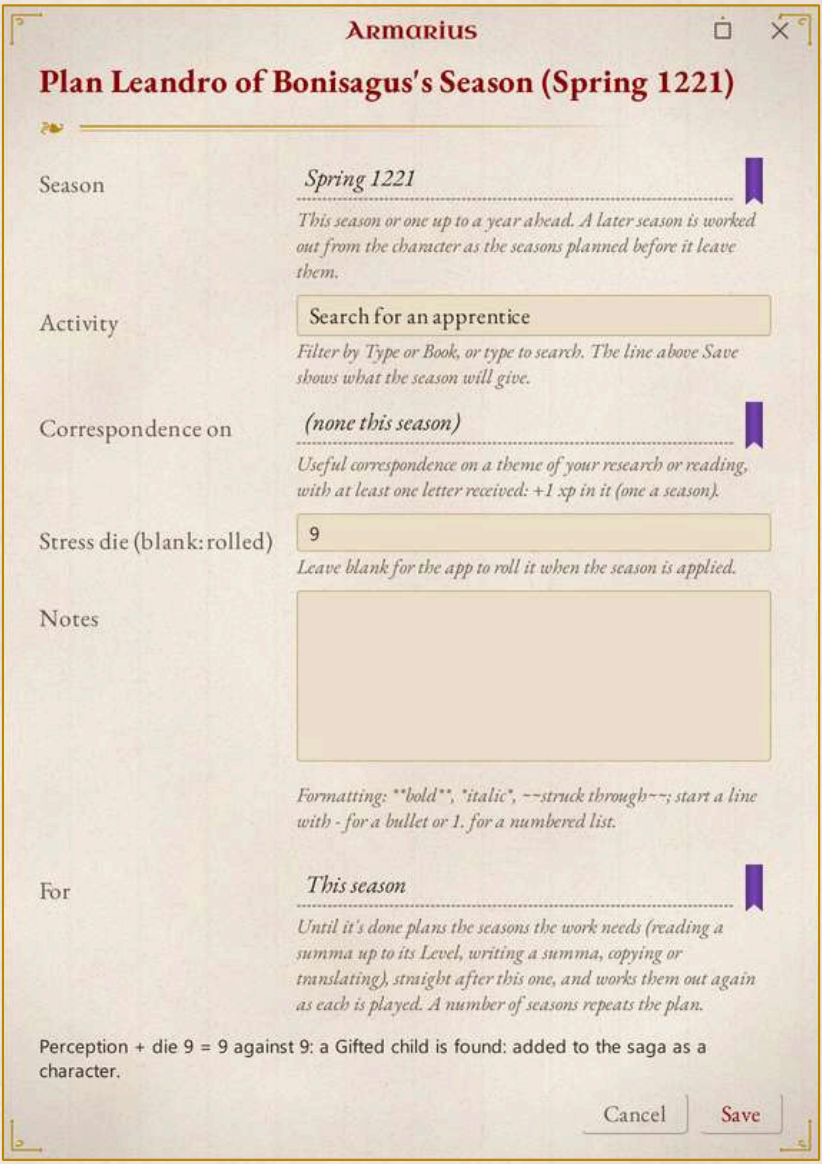
Now the long way round. In Spring 1221 Leandro, 46 and with a settled laboratory, decides it's time he passed on what he knows.

Finding one

Open Leandro's **Planning** chapter and click **Plan**. Under Activity, choose **Search for an apprentice** (it's in the Teaching & apprentices group). If the troupe would rather play the search as a story, do that; otherwise leave the die blank and the app rolls it when the season is applied, or type in the one you rolled at the table.

The rule · DE p. 269

For each season spent searching, roll a stress die + Perception. On 9 or more you find a potential apprentice. On a botch you think you've found one, but you've been duped by the child or by some power that swaps the child for its servant. An apprentice is normally at least seven, and rarely older than twenty.



Plan Leandro of Bonisagus's Season, Spring 1221: Activity "Search for an apprentice", die 9. The line at the foot reads "Perception + die 9 = 9 against 9: a Gifted child is found: added to the saga as a character."

Houses of Hermes: True Lineages (p. 22) says a magus Bonisagi adds his House Acclaim to this roll, and gives the target as 12. The Definitive Edition's 9 wins: the app keeps 9 and adds the Acclaim.

> **What happened.** Leandro's Diary has "Search for an apprentice: Perception + die 9 = 9 against 9: a Gifted child is found: added to the saga as a character." The child is on Rabenstein's People chapter as **A Gifted child found by Leandro of Bonisagus**: a Companion, In Creation, seven years old, with The Gift. He's Kaspar, the miller's boy: rename him, and on his worksheet set his Year Born to 1212 (he's nine) and build him as in "Playing a child instead" above, adding Second Sight.

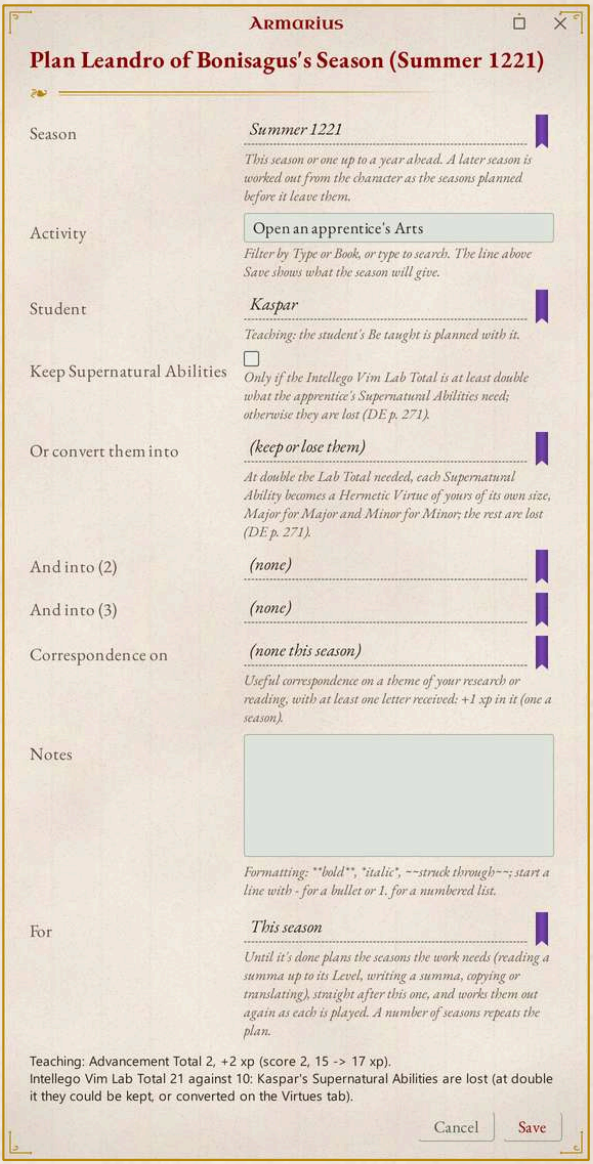
Opening the Arts

Kaspar isn't Leandro's apprentice until his Arts are opened, and that takes a season of Leandro's teaching. Plan Leandro's Summer 1221: choose **Open an apprentice's Arts** and pick Kaspar as the **Student**.

The rule · DE pp. 270-271

Opening the Arts takes a season of teaching and nothing else: the apprentice gains a score of 0 in all fifteen Arts. If the master has less than 5 in an Art, the apprentice gets a Deficiency in it, which most Tribunals treat as a Low Crime. A child who already has a Supernatural Ability needs the master's Intellego Vim Lab Total to reach five times its score (at least 10 for a Minor Virtue's Ability, 30 for a Major's). Reach it and the Ability is lost; reach double it and the master may keep it, or turn it into a Hermetic Virtue of the same size that he has.

Leandro has at least 5 in every Art, so no Deficiencies. Second Sight is a Minor Virtue's Ability at a score of 1, so he needs 10. His Intellego Vim Lab Total is Intelligence 3 + Intellego 5 + Vim 5 + Magic Theory 5 + aura 3 = 21.



Plan Leandro's Season, Summer 1221: Activity "Open an apprentice's Arts", Student Kaspar, Keep Supernatural Abilities unticked and "Or convert them into" left at "(keep or lose them)". The line at the foot reads "Teaching: Advancement Total 2, +2 xp (score 2, 15 -> 17 xp)." and "Intellego Vim Lab Total 21 against 10: Kaspar's Supernatural Abilities are lost (at double it they could be kept, or converted on the Virtues tab)."

21 is a point over double 10, so Leandro could keep the Sight or convert it. To keep it, tick **Keep Supernatural Abilities**. To convert it, choose in **Or convert them into** one of Leandro's own Hermetic Virtues of the same size, Minor for Minor: here his Affinity with Creo. Leandro lets it go.

Advance the season (click the **Advance Season** card at the foot of the chapters on the left, the one with the season's medallion), and the app applies it.

> **What happened.** Kaspar has a score of 0 in all fifteen Arts, and Second Sight is gone. The Diary adds "Leandro of Bonisagus claims Kaspar as his apprentice": Kaspar now has the free Social Status **Apprentice** (*Apprentices* p. 9), Leandro as his parens and House Bonisagus. Leandro gets 2 xp of Teaching for his trouble. Kaspar is still down as a Companion; with **Edit type** on his worksheet's Concept step, make him a Magus if you'd like his sheet to show the Hermetic chapters.

Year by year

From now on Leandro has to teach Kaspar at least one season a year, and Kaspar helps in the lab the rest of the time. For the teaching, plan Leandro's season as **Teach** (or Kaspar's as **Be taught**, with Leandro as the teacher: the app plans the other side for you). For the lab, plan Kaspar's season as **Assist in a laboratory**.

The rule · DE pp. 270, 272

The master must teach the apprentice personally for at least one season a year; the season that opens the Arts is the first. Arts and Hermetic Virtues can only be taught one to one. In seven Houses (Bonisagus, Guernicus, Mercere, Tremere, Flambeau, Jerbiton, Tytalus) the apprentice takes on his parens's free House Virtue after ten seasons of one-to-one work: being taught Arts, Arcane Abilities or spells, or helping in the lab.

The app counts those seasons for you. An apprentice is anyone not yet a magus whose Hermetic Background names a magus of the saga as Parens, as Kaspar's names Leandro since the Arts were opened. At the tenth season the House Virtue goes on Kaspar's sheet by itself, with a Diary entry. A parens with both of his House's choices (a Flambeau with Puissant Perdo and Puissant Ignem) gets a Diary note instead, to add the one he picks. The Mystery Cult Houses Initiate their Virtue rather than pass it on (see *The Mystery Cults*).

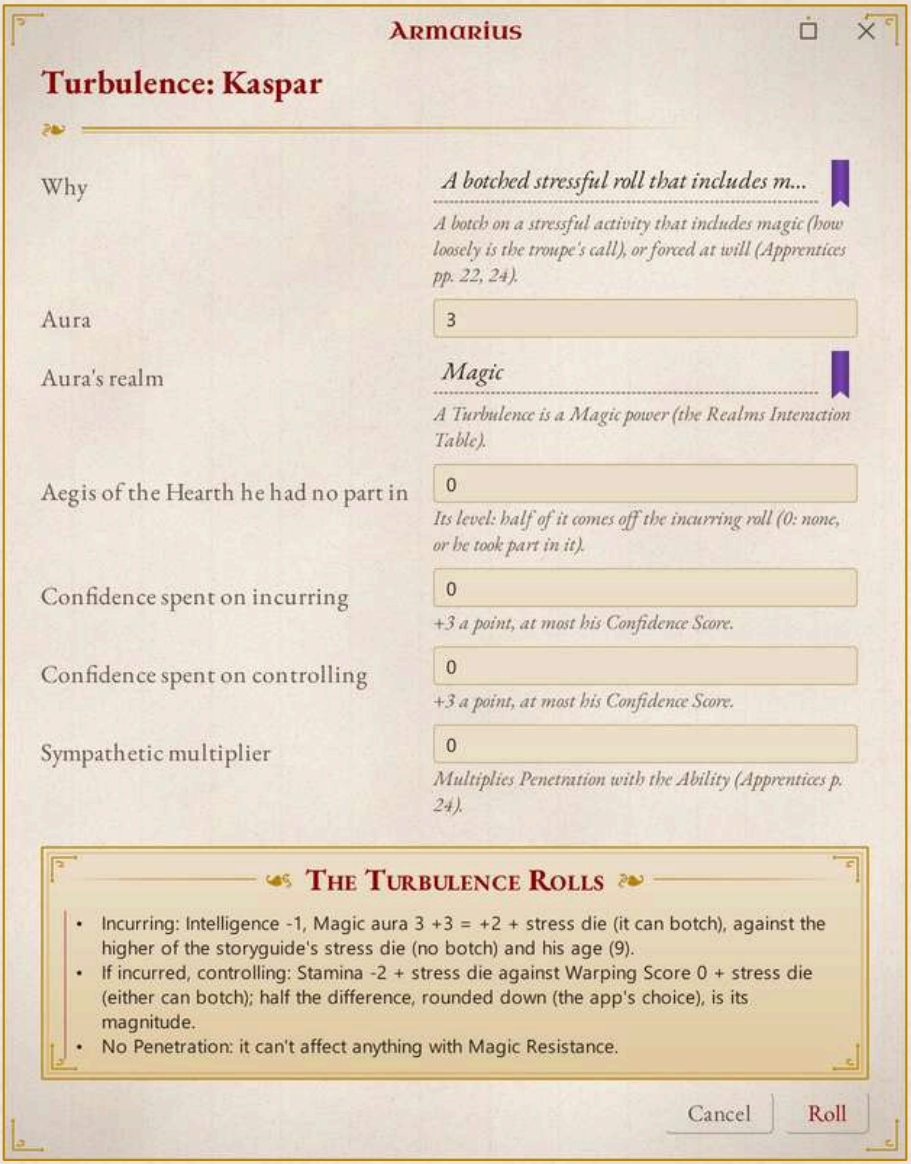
Teach a Hermetic Virtue is a season of its own: Communication + Teaching + 3 + 6 against 15 for a Minor Virtue or 21 for a Major, plus 3 for each Minor and 9 for each Major Hermetic Virtue the student already has. Teach a Hermetic Flaw along with it, one the teacher has, and it's +3 for a Minor Flaw or +9 for a Major; the student gets the Flaw too (DE p. 271).

Turbulence

A Gifted child's magic leaks. When Kaspar botches something that includes magic, or a stressful lab season he's helping with goes badly, check for a Turbulence. On his **Deeds** chapter, under Apprenticeship, click **Turbulence** (it's also under A Season's Work on **Planning**), say why it's being checked (a botch, or forced by spending a Confidence Point), and give the aura and its realm. The line at the foot spells out both rolls before you save.

The rule · Apprentices pp. 22-24

Incurring: Intelligence + stress die + the aura's modifier, against the higher of the storyguide's stress die (no botch) and the child's age. Controlling: Stamina + stress die against Warping Score + stress die. Half the difference is the effect's magnitude, in any Technique and Form; the player picks a controlled effect, the storyguide an uncontrolled one. It has no Penetration unless the child has the Ability. Half the level of an Aegis of the Hearth the child had no part in comes off the roll to incur it.



Turbulence: Kaspar. Why: "A botched stressful roll that includes magic", Aura 3, Magic. The foot spells out the incurring roll against "the higher of the storyguide's stress die (no botch) and his age (9)", then the controlling roll, and "No Penetration: it can't affect anything with Magic Resistance."

Roll rolls it and writes it in Kaspar's Diary. This time the die said no. The effect itself, when there is one, is the storyguide's to describe.

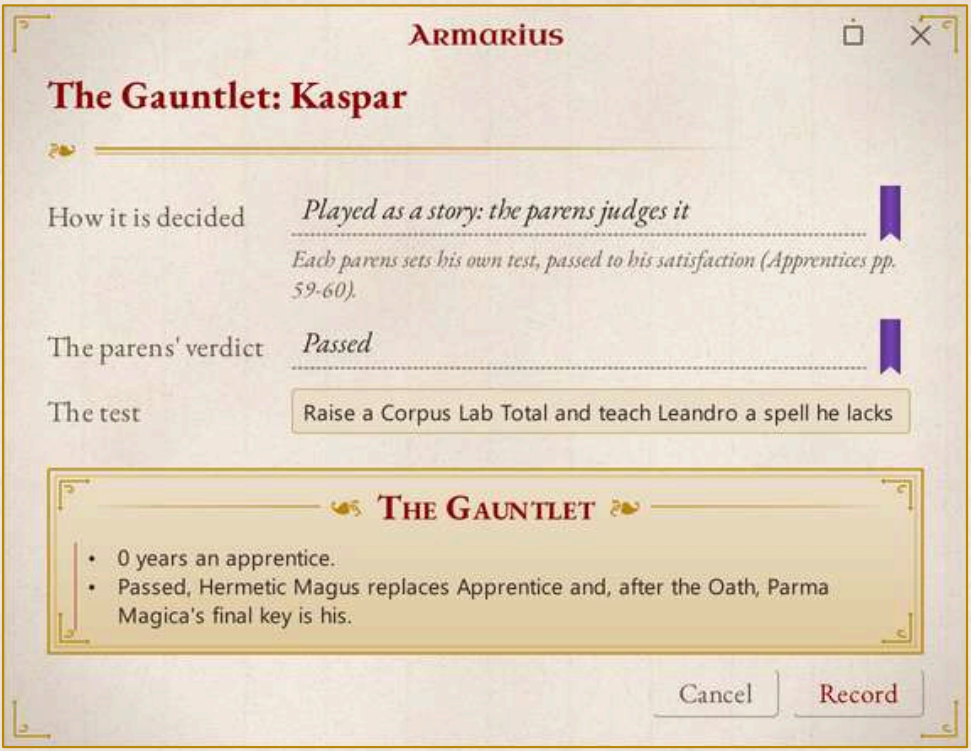
For a storyguide character's apprentice, the same form can also roll for losing the Gift after an uncontrolled Turbulence in the lab (*Apprentices* p. 59). For a player's apprentice that's never the dice's choice: if Kaspar's player wants him to fail, **Lose the Gift** sits beside Turbulence, and asks whether the Gift is lost for good or only suppressed.

8. The Gauntlet

Fifteen years on, Leandro thinks Kaspar is ready to stand as a magus in his own right. Open Kaspar's **Deeds** chapter and, under Apprenticeship, click **The Gauntlet**.

> **The rule · Apprentices pp. 59-61**
>
> The parens sets the test and judges it. Fail, and the apprentice spends another year before trying again; after three failures House Quaesitor sets one of its own. If you don't play it as a story, either pass it automatically once the seasons of study are served, or roll Intelligence + an Ability fitting the House + stress die against 9 (a botch means something dire). Keeping an apprentice more than 20 years is a Low Crime in many Tribunals. The final key of the Parma Magica is given only after the Oath.

The form asks **How it is decided**: played as a story (and then the parens's verdict), passed without a story, or rolled, with the **Ability tested** (Magic Theory for a Bonisagus). Name **The test** too, if you like: Leandro's was to raise a Corpus Lab Total and teach him a spell he lacks.



The Gauntlet: Kaspar. How it is decided: "Played as a story: the parens judges it", The parens' verdict: Passed, The test typed in. The foot reads "Passed, Hermetic Magus replaces Apprentice and, after the Oath, Parma Magica's final key is his."

Record writes the verdict in his Diary. Passed, Hermetic Magus replaces Apprentice, and Kaspar is a magus of House Bonisagus.

9. Lineage

A magus is never just himself: he's his parens's filius, his House's member, and his master's legacy. The sheet's **Hermetic Background**, on the Description chapter, keeps the lineage: House, Domus Magna, Primus, Parens, Covenant of Apprenticeship, Age of Apprenticeship and Wizard's Sigil.

> **The rule · DE pp. 270, 272**
>
> A magus claims an apprentice from the season he opens the Arts. No other magus may come between them, except a magus of House Bonisagus, who may claim any magus's apprentice at any time. A master may pass an apprentice to another magus if both agree. The apprentice learns the free House Virtue his parens knows; where the House has a choice, the parens chooses.

So Kaspar's House Virtue is Leandro's, and Kaspar's Hermetic Background names Leandro as Parens. Adelheid's names Konrad and Durenmar.

Below the Biographical Detail on the Description chapter, the **Lineage** section draws the line from those Parens: his parens and theirs, as far back as the saga knows them, and his filii and theirs below, an apprentice marked so. Leandro's shows Kaspar as his apprentice; Kaspar's shows Leandro above him.



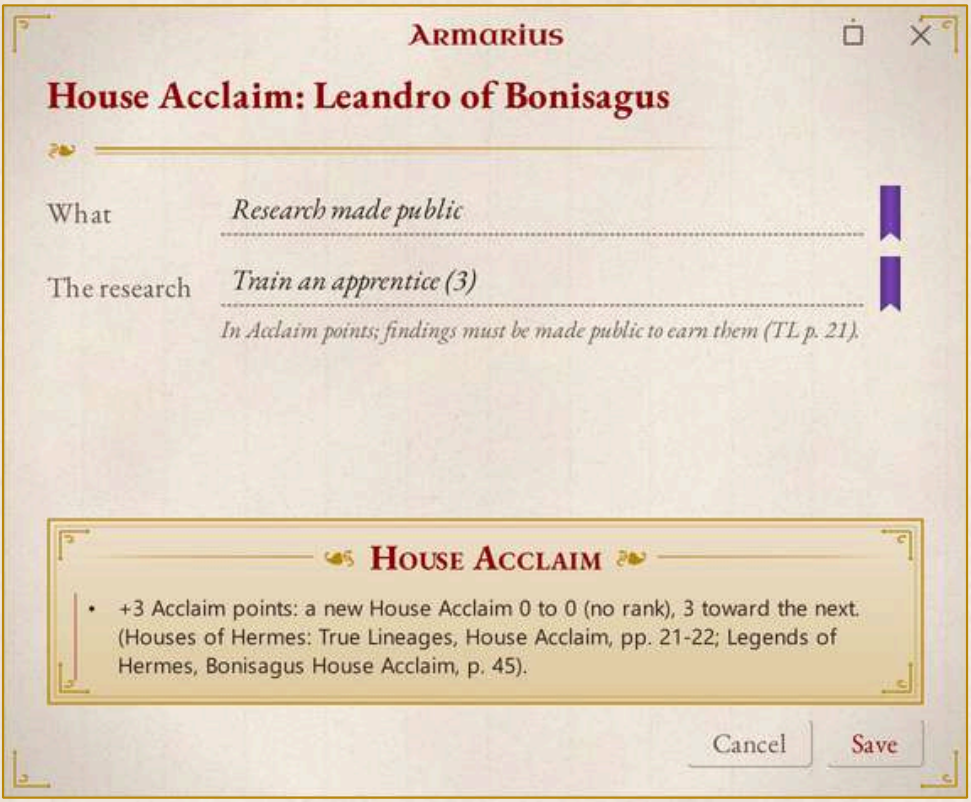
Leandro's Description chapter, the Lineage section: "Filii: Kaspar (apprentice)".

Two Houses also keep a reputation inside the House, called **House Acclaim**. A magus Bonisagi earns it by research made public (an Art summa is worth half its Level, an apprentice trained 3, a minor breakthrough 15) and climbs the House's four ranks with it; a Flambeau earns hers by deeds done before witnesses (an exceptional Gauntlet, played at the table, is worth 2 to 5).

The rule · True Lineages pp. 21-22; Societates p. 31

House Acclaim grows like an Ability: 5, 15, 30 and 50 points for 1 to 4 (the Bonisagus ranks boukoloi, daduchos, cannophori, dendrophori). A Bonisagus adds it to social rolls with his own House. A Flambeau's is a Hermetic Reputation known across the Order; it falls by a point a year without a new deed, and can't go below 0.

On the **Deeds** chapter, under Session & Reputation, click **House Acclaim** (it shows for a Bonisagus or a Flambeau). Choose what earned the points and the form works them out: for Leandro, **Research made public** and an apprentice trained, 3 points; for Adelheid, **A deed**, and an exceptional Gauntlet, if your troupe played it, is worth 2 to 5 to start her off. The first award starts House Acclaim, it rises as an Ability does, and each award goes in the Diary.

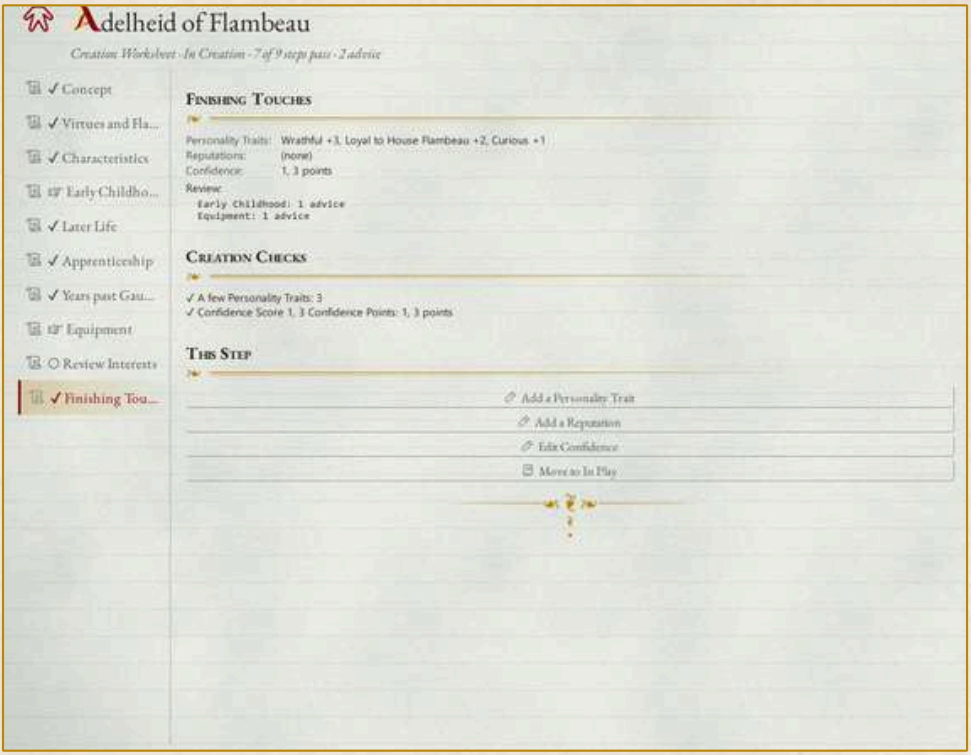


House Acclaim: Leandro of Bonisagus, Research made public, an apprentice trained (+3). The foot reads his House Acclaim and the points toward the next rank.

10. Finishing touches and the finished sheet

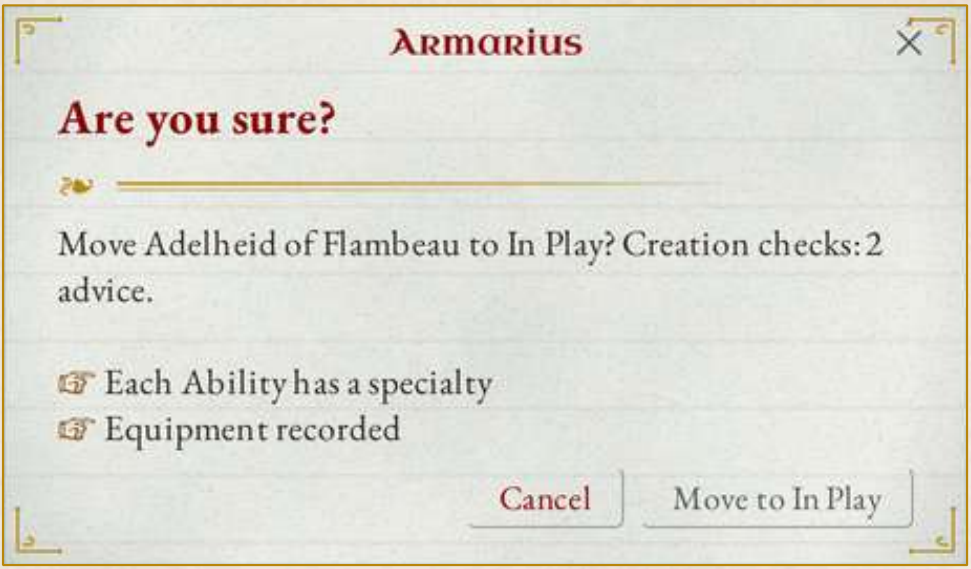
Back on Adelheid's worksheet. The **Years past Gauntlet** step is for older magi, 30 points a year, so a fresh one skips it. **Equipment** is the book's step 11: **Add an item** for each weapon, armour or tool she starts with, and they're kept on her Inventory chapter. It stays advice (☞) until something is recorded. **Review Interests** lists the kinds of deed the books in play offer; untick any she won't take up, and their actions stay off her sheet. The last step is personality: **Add a Personality Trait** a few times, from +3 to -3 (she's Wrathful +3, Loyal to House Flambeau +2 and Curious +1), **Add a Reputation** if she has any, and **Edit Confidence** for the standard Confidence 1 and 3 points.

> **The rule · DE p. 44**
>
> Pick a few Personality Traits from +3 to -3. Companions and magi start with a Confidence Score of 1 and 3 Confidence Points unless a Virtue or Flaw changes that.

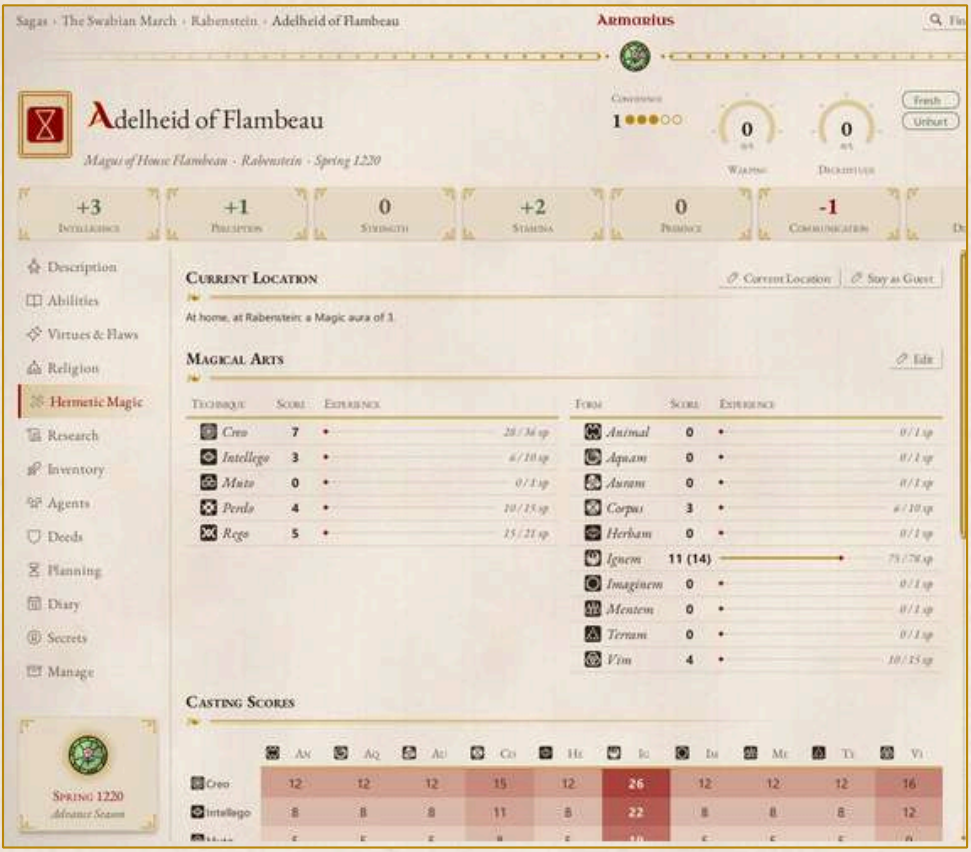


Finishing Touches, every step in the rail marked ✓, and the review at the foot saying every check passes.

Click **Move to In Play**. It asks once more, listing any check that doesn't pass and any advice left (a specialty or two left blank, if you skipped them, and no equipment recorded), and then the vellum turns to parchment.



Move to In Play: "Move Adelheid of Flambeau to In Play? Creation checks: 2 advice." with the advice left listed: "Each Ability has a specialty" and "Equipment recorded".



Adelheid's finished sheet on parchment, the Hermetic Magic chapter open: Ignem 11 (14 with Puissant), and a Creo Ignem casting score of 26.

> **What happened.** Adelheid of Flambeau is In Play, ready for her first season (that's the next guide, *A Year at Rabenstein*). The checks stop once a character is In Play; you can move her back to In Creation from the button in her header if you need to.

What you do by hand

- **The found child's details**: the app adds a seven-year-old with The Gift; give him his name, age and the rest on his worksheet.
- **The apprentice's type**: he stays a Companion until you change his type to Magus.

Where the rules come from

Ars Magica Definitive Edition: starting age and the creation summary (pp. 43-44); Houses and their benefits, Virtue and Flaw allowances (pp. 45-46); Personality and Story Flaws (p. 66); Characteristics and early childhood (p. 48); later life, apprenticeship and the advancement table (p. 49); after apprenticeship and the spell cap (p. 50); Virtues and Flaws (p. 61); Affinity with Art (p. 69); Fast Caster (p. 80); Free Study (p. 82); Improved Characteristics (p. 86); Inventive Genius (p. 87); Puissant Ability and Puissant Art (p. 105); Strong-Willed (p. 110); Blatant Gift (p. 120); Deficient Form (p. 125); Wrathful (p. 154); specialties (p. 157); equipment (p. 44); finding an apprentice (p. 269); training and opening the Arts (pp. 270-271); teaching Hermetic Virtues and the House Virtue (pp. 271-272).

Apprentices: the Aging Chart (p. 7); Characteristics, Virtues and Flaws for young characters and the Apprentice Social Status (pp. 8-9); Child Virtues and Flaws (pp. 11-12); Abilities for young characters and the standard apprenticeship (pp. 13-14, 16); transitions of maturation (pp. 14-15); Turbulence (pp. 22-24); failing an apprentice and losing the Gift (pp. 58-59); the Gauntlet and the Parma Magica's final key (pp. 59-61).

Houses of Hermes: True Lineages: House Acclaim in House Bonisagus and the apprentice search (pp. 21-22). *Houses of Hermes: Societates*: House Acclaim in House Flambeau (p. 31).



Armarius

A saga manager for Ars Magica

The Covenfolk

Grogs, companions, a Mythic Companion and a scholar from Paris: the people who keep Rabenstein running, and how loyal they are to its magi.

Guide 2 of 17

A covenant isn't just its magi. Someone has to bake the bread, mind the gate, carry the lantern into the cave and stand between the wizard and the bandits. In Ars Magica those people are the **grogs**, the covenant's soldiers, servants and craftsmen, and the **companions**, the knights, scholars, outlaws and cunning folk whose stories are as big as any magus's. Some companions are more than human: the **Mythic Companions**, with powers of their own.

This guide fills Rabenstein with people. You'll make **Martin the Woodward**, a grog who hunts for the covenant; **Ulrich the Bold**, its man-at-arms; **Old Wendel**, a faerie doctor who came south from Saxony; and **Magister Albrecht of Esslingen**, a scholar back from the schools of Paris. Then you'll see how the year treats a grog, how the covenant rewards and punishes its people, and how loyal they feel to the magi on the crag.

The rules come from the *Ars Magica Definitive Edition* (DE): character types and Virtues and Flaws in chapter three (pp. 45-47), Mythic Companions (pp. 55-57) and covenant Loyalty in chapter six (pp. 185-186). *Grogs* gives the yearly update (p. 67), rewards and punishments (pp. 23-25) and the grog templates (chapter seven). *Covenants* adds to Loyalty (pp. 36-41), and *Art & Academe* covers schools (pp. 79-82), disputation (pp. 103-105) and the ligatures of natural philosophy (pp. 68-69).

1. Who lives at Rabenstein

Open Rabenstein's page and choose **Covenfolk** in the rail. It's the covenant's household: the magi and companions (listed from their own sheets), then the specialists, craftspeople, turb, other covenfolk, horses, hounds and livestock. At the top sits **Loyalty**, its four figures in a row.



Rabenstein's Covenfolk chapter, Spring 1220. Loyalty's four figures: Base Loyalty -68, Modifiers +0, Loyalty Points -68, Prevailing -4, the line "-4: unhappy, kept in place by steady work and their own interest (Covenants p. 37)", and the Situational Modifiers ledger under it; Household's Staffing ledger below shows Teamsters 0 of 1 needed, "Shortfall of 1", and Servants 0 of 2, "Shortfall of 2".

The rule · DE pp. 185-186

Prevailing Loyalty is the average Loyal to Covenant of the covenfolk. Its base is the magi's Gifts averaged: an ordinary Gift -30, a Blatant Gift -105, a Gentle Gift or none 0. Living Conditions, equipment, wages, a pension and up to three specialists (turb captain, steward, chamberlain: each adds Presence + his Ability) change it, and the covenant gains 2 points a year of Familiarity, up to what the Gifts took away. The points are read on the Ability advancement table.

Rabenstein has two magi. Leandro's Gift is -30, and Adelheid's Blatant Gift is -105, so the base is -68 (their average, -67.5, rounded to the nearest), and the Prevailing Loyalty is -4: the covenfolk aren't happy, but it's steady work, as the line under the figures says, along with how many more points the next score needs. Everything else is up to you, and the Situational Modifiers ledger shows each modifier; click any line and the Inspector shows its working. Click **Edit** beside Loyalty for the equipment, the wages and a pension. Familiarity works itself out from the covenant's Year Founded, and newcomers water it down until they too grow used to the Gift, 2 points a year from the year they arrived.

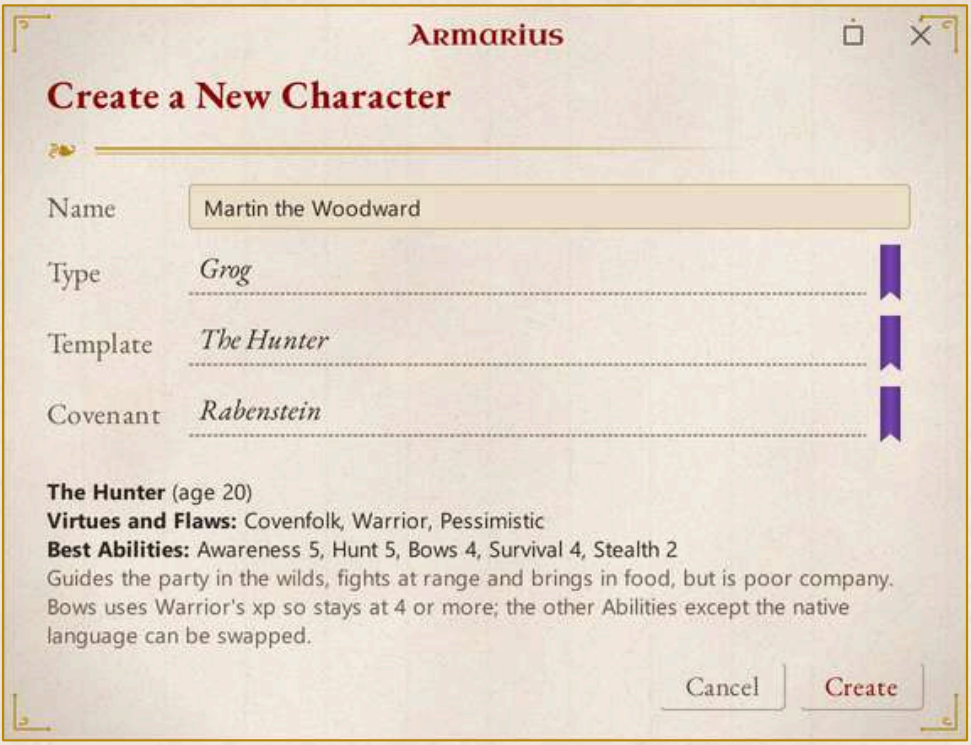
The Household's **Staffing** ledger counts the teamsters and servants the covenant needs for its size against those it has, and reads "Shortfall of 1" (or "Met") beside each. They don't need sheets: on **Other Covenfolk**, **Add** one entry for "the kitchen" with a Covenant Role of Servant and a Quantity of 2. In play, the form also asks the **Year arrived** (the saga's year, to start); clear it for people who've been there since the founding.

2. A grog: Martin the Woodward

On Rabenstein's **People** chapter, click the dotted **New Grog** card under Grogs. Name him, check Type is **Grog**, and look at the **Template** list. The first six are the Definitive Edition's ready-made grogs, which start In Play; with *Grogs* in play, the list also has that book's nineteen grog templates, marked "(Grogs)", the three animals, the quick recipe, and any other supplement's grogs, marked with their book.

> **The rule · DE pp. 32, 45**
>
> The Hunter is one of the book's grog templates (p. 32). Grogs may have up to three points of Flaws and as many of Virtues, all Minor. They may not have The Gift or a Story Flaw: those make a character central to stories, and that isn't a grog's job.

Martin is The Hunter. The line under the form describes the template before you commit: age 20, Covenfolk, Warrior and Pessimistic, and his best Abilities.



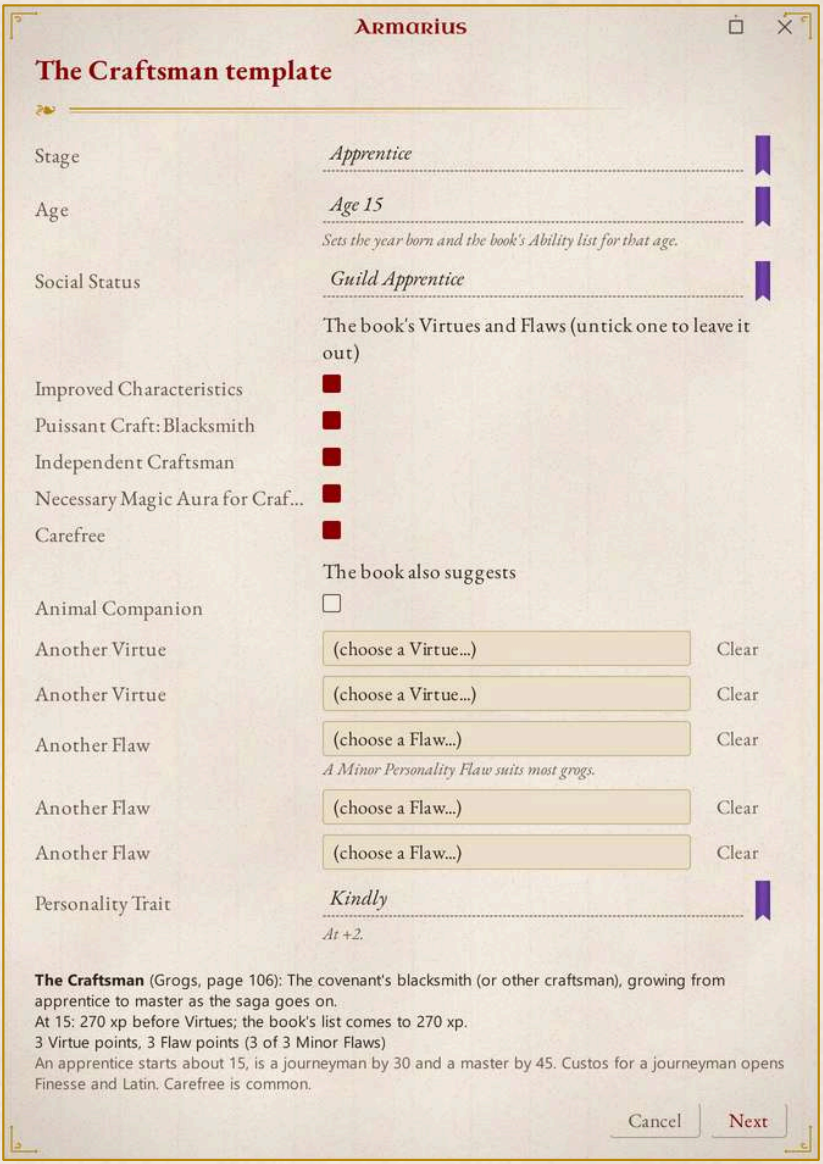
Create a New Character: Name "Martin the Woodward", Type Grog, Template The Hunter. The line above Create reads "The Hunter (age 20). Virtues and Flaws: Covenfolk, Warrior, Pessimistic. Best Abilities: Awareness 5, Hunt 5, Bows 4, Survival 4, Stealth 2".

Click **Create**. The template leaves two names to you: the **Area** of his Area Lore (the Swabian Alb) and his **Language** (German).

> **What happened.** Martin is made and In Play at once: Perception +3, Dexterity +2, Quickness +2; Awareness and Hunt at 5, Bows, Survival and Area Lore: Swabian Alb at 4; Brave +3, Pessimistic +3 and Loyal +1.

A Grogs template

The *Grogs* templates are guidance rather than finished characters, so they ask more of you. Try The Craftsman for the covenant's smith: after Create it asks which **Stage** (apprentice, or journeyman or master), the **Age** and **Social Status** that go with it, and ticks the book's Virtues and Flaws, any of which you can untick. You can add another Virtue or Flaw of your own, and pick his Personality Trait. The line at the foot keeps score: "At 15: 270 xp before Virtues; the book's list comes to 270 xp. 3 Virtue points, 3 Flaw points (3 of 3 Minor Flaws)".



The Craftsman template: Stage Apprentice, Age 15, Social Status Guild Apprentice, the book's Virtues and Flaws ticked (Improved Characteristics, Puissant Craft: Blacksmith, Independent Craftsman, Necessary Magic Aura for Craft, Carefree), Another Virtue and Another Flaw, Personality Trait Kindly.

Next refuses anything a grog can't take. The grog then starts In Creation, with the book's Abilities on his Creation Worksheet as xp, and the worksheet checks the result as it did for Adelheid in *Making a Magus*.

Where he belongs

A new grog joins the covenant's household at once: on **Covenfolk**, Martin is under **Turb**, so he counts among the inhabitants (and the yearly costs in *Founding and Keeping a Covenant*). A grog who does something else belongs on another list: Delete him from the Turb and, under **Specialists** or **Craftspeople**, click **Add**, which offers the covenant's grogs who aren't on any list.

3. A grog's year

Grogs aren't planned season by season like magi. Once a year, in Winter, each one gets an update that sums up what the year taught him.

> **The rule · Grogs p. 67**
>
> A grog gains 15 xp a year: a vocational season (7 xp, or the teacher's Source Quality), a season of practice (4 xp) and two of exposure (2 xp each). Story experience is added as soon as it's earned, and each award of it takes the place of one of the year's seasons, in this order: exposure, vocational, practice, exposure.

Martin went into the woods of the high Alb with Adelheid this spring. When a story ends, open his **Planning** chapter and click **Story Experience**. Name the story and give up to three Abilities it used, with the experience each gains.

The rule · DE p. 376; Grogs p. 67

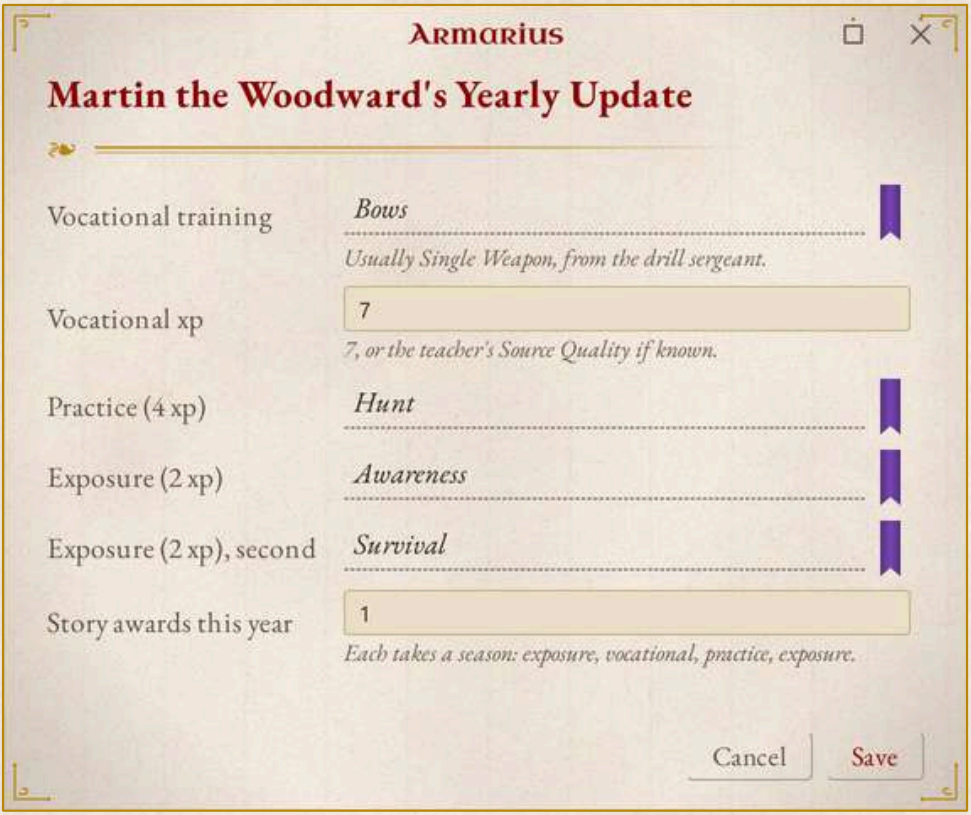
A story gives 5 to 10 experience, as an Adventure's Source Quality, at most 5 to any one Ability. A grog gains it at once, and the year's update loses a season for it.



Story Experience: Martin the Woodward. The story "The woods of the high Alb"; Hunt 3, Survival 2, Awareness 2.

What happened. His Diary reads "Story experience: The woods of the high Alb: Martin the Woodward gains Hunt +3, Survival +2, Awareness +2. 1 story award this year: the Winter update loses a season for each."

Then, on the same chapter, click **Yearly Update**. Choose the **Vocational training** Ability and its xp (Bows, 7: the turb's archery practice), the **Practice** Ability (Hunt) and the two **Exposure** Abilities (Awareness and Survival). **Story awards this year** already counts the story; change it only to correct it.



Martin the Woodward's Yearly Update: Vocational training Bows, Vocational xp 7, Practice Hunt, Exposure Awareness, second Exposure Survival, Story awards this year 1.

The update can be changed any time before Winter is advanced. Martin's This Season shows what it will give, and the covenant's **Seasons** chapter lists him under Grogs as "yearly".

> **What happened.** At the end of Winter 1220 Martin's Diary reads "Yearly update: Bows +7, Hunt +4, Survival +2". His story took the first exposure season, so Awareness gets nothing from the update: it had its 2 xp from the story.

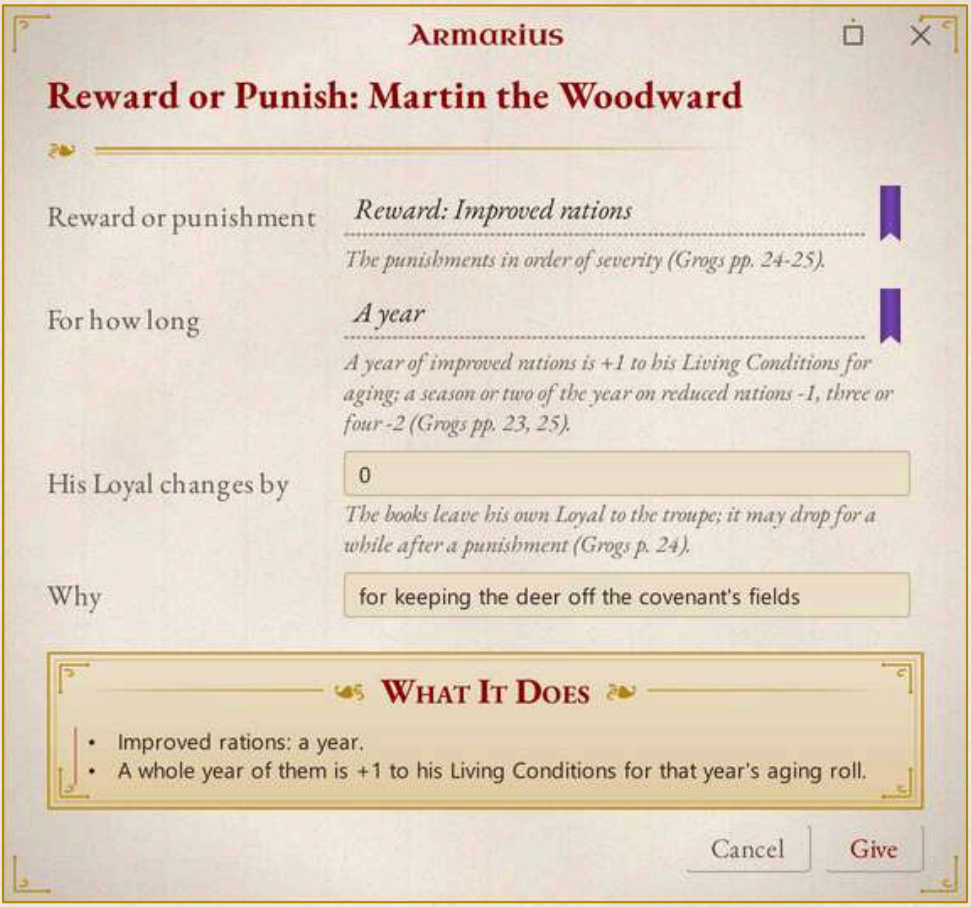
Martin also turns 21 that year, and with *Apprentices* in play the Diary notes a transition of maturation: he may swap a Virtue or Flaw for another of the same size in the first season of 1221 (*Apprentices* pp. 14-15).

4. Rewards, punishments and a pension

A good grog gets better rations, a bad one the rod. On Martin's **Deeds** chapter, under Covenfolk, click **Reward or Punish**.

> **The rule · Grogs pp. 23-25; Covenants pp. 38-39**
>
> Rewards (better rations, pay and a half, better equipment, promotion) are usually set by the turb captain, steward or chamberlain and announced before the turb. A year of better rations is worth a point of Living Conditions on his aging roll. Punishments run from a single blow with the rod to dismissal. One handed out fairly by the turb captain, steward or chamberlain costs no Loyalty; one a magus orders does, by how harsh it is.

Choose what it is and for how long, who orders it, and whether it's just. The inspector, **What It Does**, says what happens before you click **Give**. A punishment ordered by a magus asks what it **Counts as** (a public humiliation is -3 Loyalty points, a brutal punishment -12) and goes into the covenant's Diary as a Loyalty event.



Reward or Punish: Martin the Woodward, with "Reward: Improved rations" for "A year", ordered by the turb captain. The foot reads "A whole year of them is +1 to his Living Conditions for that year's aging roll."

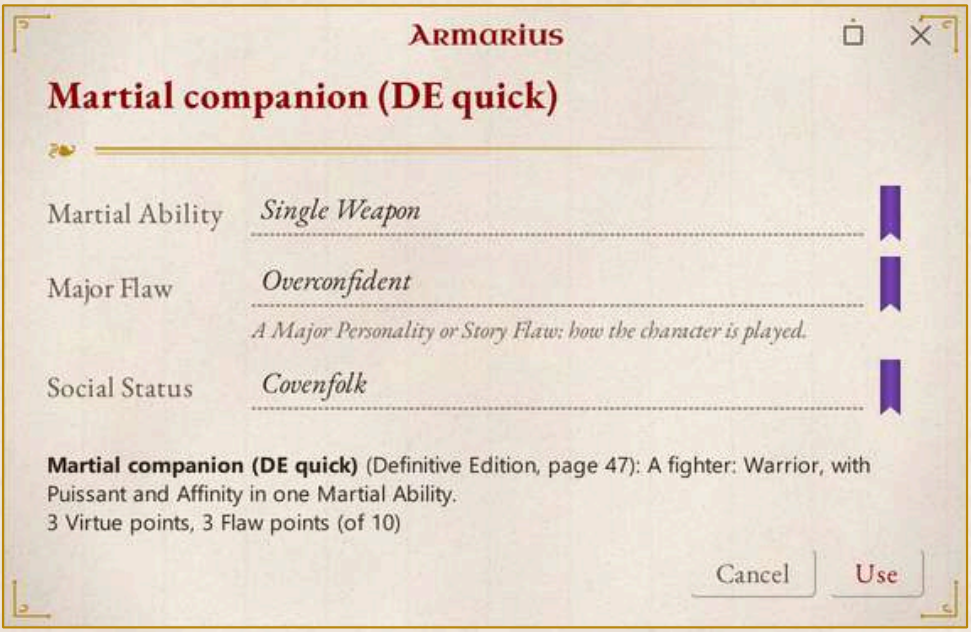
When a grog is too old to draw a bow, **Pension** beside it opens **Retire**: he retires on a pension of half Wages for life (DE p. 186), or pays rent for his lodging instead and is fed free. A covenant that grants pensions to all its retirees gains +10 Loyalty: tick **Grants pensions** on the same form (or set it with **Edit** beside Loyalty on the Covenfolk chapter). *Grogs* (p. 26) allows a half to three-quarters of his pay; the Definitive Edition's half is the one the app uses.

5. A companion: Ulrich the Bold

Companions are the player characters who aren't magi: knights, scholars, wise women. They get the full ten points of Flaws, and Virtues to match.

> **The rule · DE pp. 45, 47**
>
> Companions may have up to ten points of Flaws and as many of Virtues (Major 3, Minor 1); without The Gift they can't take Hermetic Virtues or Flaws. For a quick start: every companion takes a Major Personality or Story Flaw and Covenfolk. A martial companion takes Warrior, and Puissant and Affinity in the same Martial Ability.

Make Ulrich with the **New Companion** card, Type **Companion**, Template **Martial companion (DE quick)**. After Create, the recipe asks for its **Martial Ability** (Single Weapon), the **Major Flaw** (Overconfident: he isn't called the Bold for nothing) and his **Social Status** (Covenfolk).



Martial companion (DE quick): Martial Ability Single Weapon, Major Flaw Overconfident, Social Status Covenfolk. The foot reads "3 Virtue points, 3 Flaw points (of 10)".

> **What happened.** Ulrich starts In Creation with Covenfolk, Warrior, Puissant Single Weapon, Affinity with Single Weapon and Overconfident. The recipe is only the Virtues and Flaws: his Characteristics, childhood and later life go on his worksheet, just as for Adelheid, and he has seven more points of Flaws to spend if he wants them. The worksheet is the one from *Making a Magus*, without the apprenticeship.

The companion list has more ready-made people too: the Definitive Edition's Knight, Priest, Rogue, Witch and Female Scholar (In Play at once), the supplements' companions marked with their book (the Mystic Nun, the Byzantine Priest, a Lady of the Manor), and every *Grogs* template "as a companion", which needs a Story Flaw added.

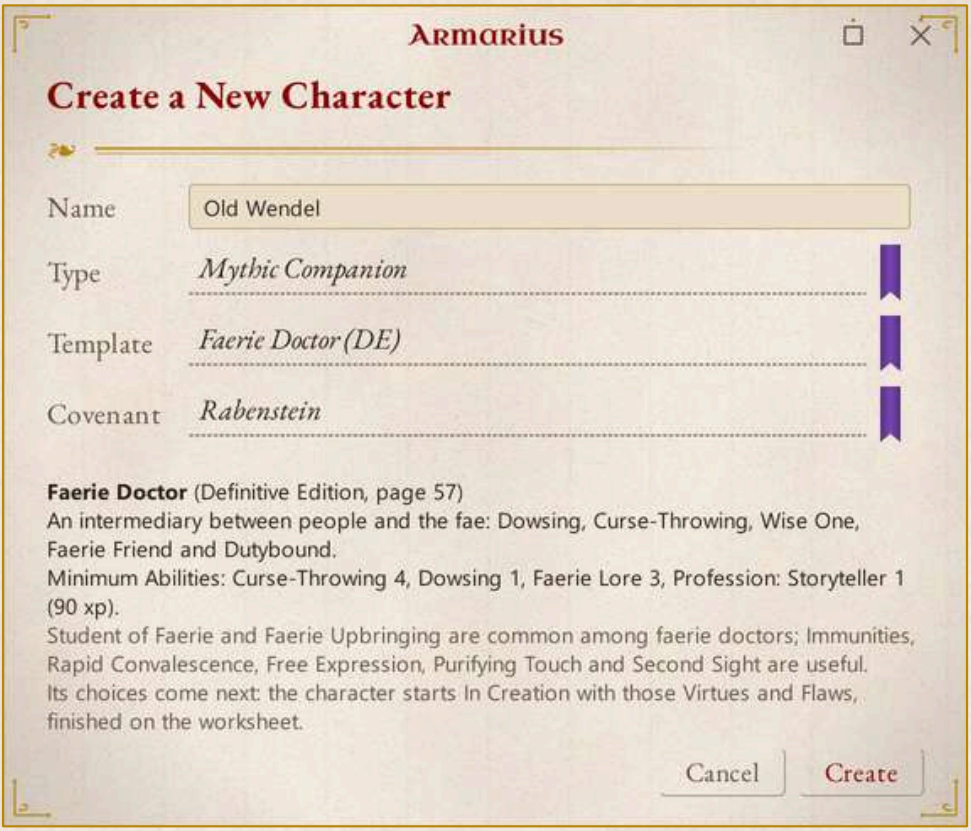
6. A Mythic Companion: Old Wendel

Some companions carry a piece of another realm in them. Old Wendel came down from Saxony with his faerie friend, a hare that talks, and the villagers under Rabenstein go to him for their curses and their lost cows.

The rule · DE pp. 55-57

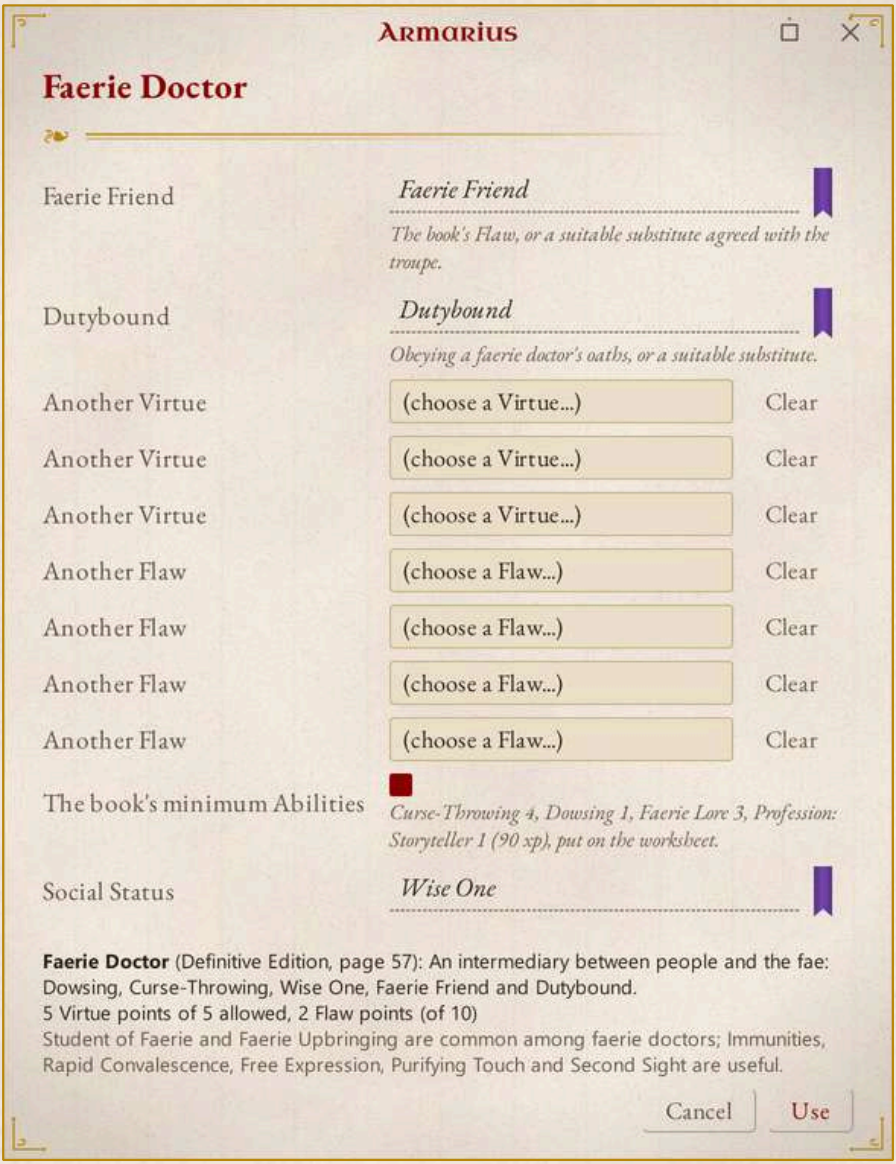
A Mythic Companion takes a free Virtue naming what he is, and a free Minor Virtue; each point of Flaws (up to ten) buys two points of Virtues. Each kind requires certain Virtues and Flaws, and about 90 xp of minimum Abilities.
A Faerie Doctor must have Faerie Doctor, Dowsing (free with it), Wise One and Curse-Throwing, and the Flaws Faerie Friend and Dutybound, or substitutes the troupe agrees; at least Curse-Throwing 4, Dowsing 1, Faerie Lore 3 and Profession: Storyteller 1.

Make him from the **New Companion** card with Type **Mythic Companion** and the **Faerie Doctor (DE)** template. The line under the form says what the template brings and suggests a few Virtues faerie doctors often have.



Create a New Character, Type Mythic Companion, Template Faerie Doctor (DE). The line reads "An intermediary between people and the fae: Dowsing, Curse-Throwing, Wise One, Faerie Friend and Dutybound. Minimum Abilities: Curse-Throwing 4, Dowsing 1, Faerie Lore 3, Profession: Storyteller 1 (90 xp)."

The next form lets you swap either required Flaw for another, add up to three Virtues and four Flaws of your own, and keeps **The book's minimum Abilities** ticked so they go straight onto his worksheet. Its foot keeps the sum: "5 Virtue points of 5 allowed, 2 Flaw points (of 10)".



Faerie Doctor: Faerie Friend and Dutybound chosen, Another Virtue and Another Flaw empty, The book's minimum Abilities ticked, Social Status Wise One.

> **What happened.** Old Wendel starts In Creation with Wise One, Faerie Doctor, Dowsing, Curse-Throwing, Faerie Friend and Dutybound, and Curse-Throwing 50 xp, Dowsing 5, Faerie Lore 30 and Profession: Storyteller 5 already on his worksheet. Give him a few more Flaws and the Virtues they pay for (Second Sight would suit him), then finish him on the worksheet.

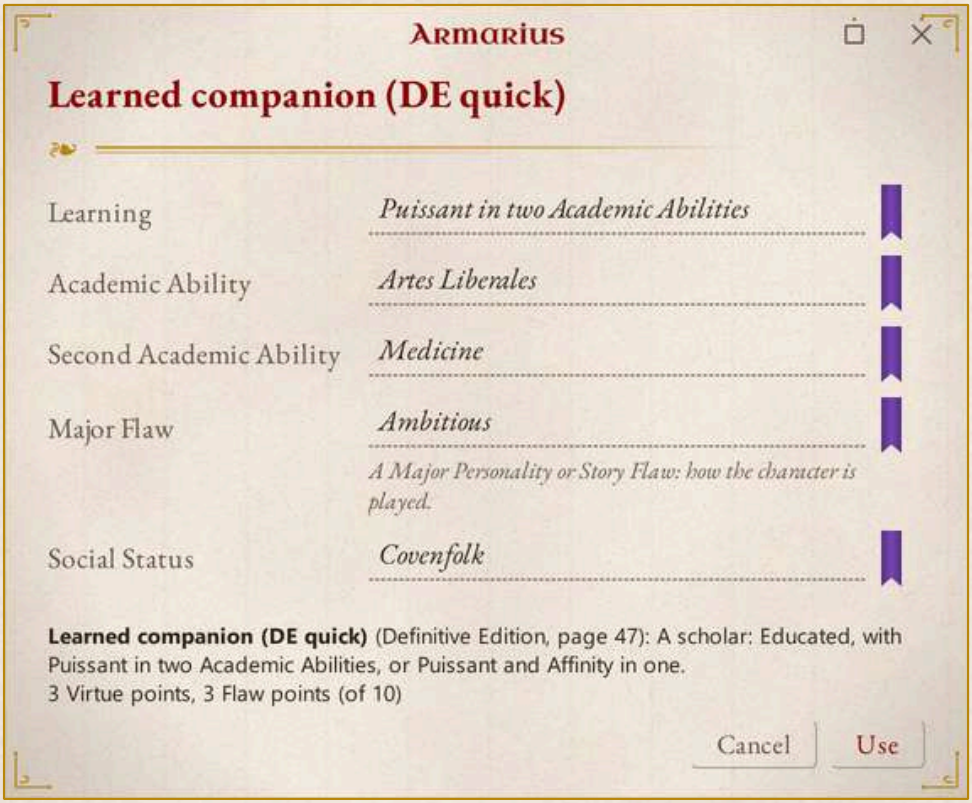
The other Mythic Companions work the same way: the Definitive Edition's Devil Child, Nephilim and Spirit Votary, and the supplements' Zahid, Perfectus, Kabbalist, Diabolist, Summoner, Blood of Heroes, Maestro, Dragon-born and Varcolac.

7. A scholar: Magister Albrecht of Esslingen

Albrecht spent ten years at Paris and came home with a master's ring, a head full of Aristotle, and no benefice. Rabenstein feeds him; he teaches the covenfolk's children their letters and argues with Leandro over dinner.

Making him

Use **Learned companion (DE quick)**: Educated, with either Puissant in two Academic Abilities or Puissant and Affinity in one. Albrecht takes Puissant Artes Liberales and Puissant Medicine, and his Major Flaw is Ambitious: he wants a chair at a cathedral school.



Learned companion (DE quick): Learning "Puissant in two Academic Abilities", Artes Liberales and Medicine, Major Flaw Ambitious, Social Status Covenfolk. The foot reads "3 Virtue points, 3 Flaw points (of 10)".

The rule · Art & Academe p. 79

Every school limits how high a starting character's Academic Abilities can be: a rural parish school teaches Artes Liberales and Latin to 2, a cathedral school Artes Liberales, Latin and Theology to 6 and Canon Law and Philosophiae to 3, a private tutor anything to 6. Minor subjects are taught to half the limit, rounded up. Attending any of them needs Educated.

The quick recipe gives him Educated with no school yet. On his worksheet's Virtues and Flaws step, edit Educated and choose its **School** (a cathedral school, for Paris's own): from then on his worksheet caps his Academic Abilities at the school's limits, as well as by his age (DE p. 48).

A seat at the council

Rabenstein's magi give Albrecht a full vote on the covenant's council. On **Covenfolk**, edit his entry under **Companions** and tick **On the council, with a full vote**.

The rule · Covenants p. 38

Base Loyalty averages the council's Gifts: each magus's, and an unGifted member with an equal vote counts 0. A token seat doesn't count.

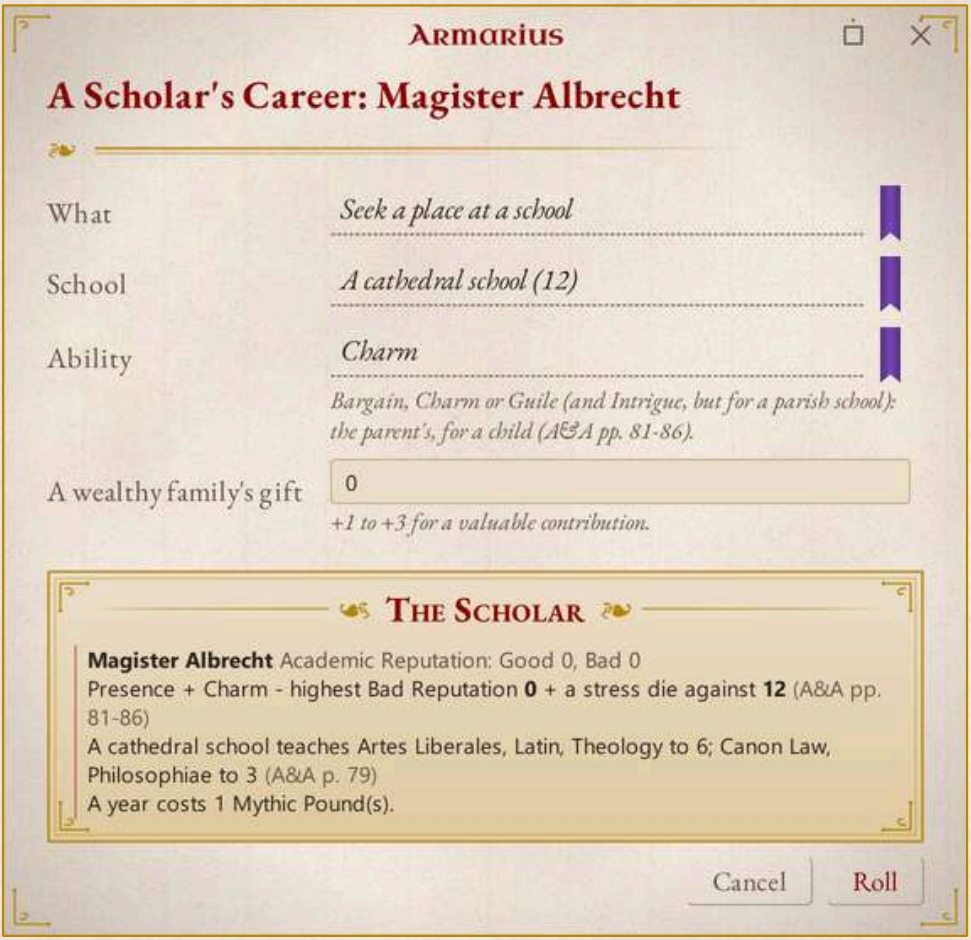
> **What happened.** The base averages three now: (-30 - 105 + 0) / 3 = -45, and when you click his entry the Inspector says "Council: a full vote (counts 0 in Base Loyalty)".

A scholar's career

With *Art & Academe* in play, a scholar's Planning chapter has **A Scholar's Career**, under A Season's Work. **Seek a place at a school** rolls the entry: the parent's (or his own) Presence + Bargain, Charm or Guile against the school's Ease Factor, with the highest Bad Reputation taken off for a cathedral school. The inspector says what that school teaches, to what score, and what a year costs.

The rule · Art & Academe pp. 81-82

Getting into a parish school: Presence + Bargain, Charm or Guile + stress die against 6 (rural) or 9 (urban). A cathedral school: Presence + Bargain, Charm, Guile or Intrigue + stress die - highest Bad Reputation against 12. A rich family's gift may add +1 to +3. Fail, and try again next year; botch, and that teacher never takes you.



A Scholar's Career: "Seek a place at a school", School "A cathedral school (12)", Ability Charm. The foot spells out the roll against 12, what a cathedral school teaches (Artes Liberales, Latin, Theology to 6; Canon Law, Philosophiae to 3), and that a year costs 1 Mythic Pound.

A deed for the Academic Reputation keeps the other half of a scholar's life: writing a tractatus, a gloss, a teaching post or a lost benefice each moves his Good or Bad Academic Reputation by an experience point (*Art & Academe* p. 103).

Disputation

When Albrecht and Leandro argue over whether the stars move the humours, it can be a proper disputatio. On Albrecht's Deeds chapter, under Scholarly, **Disputatio** picks the other disputer, who states first, the **Subject** (Artes Liberales, Philosophiae, Theology or Canon Law), the kind, and the judge's number of questions. The line above **Dispute** shows each side's totals before the dice.

The rule · Art & Academe p. 104

Attack: Communication + Ability + stress die. Defence: Perception + Ability + stress die. If the attack wins, Weakening is Intelligence + the margin, against Resistance: Presence + the highest positive Academic Reputation. Each statement that gets through costs the other side symbolic Fatigue levels; five lose the disputatio.

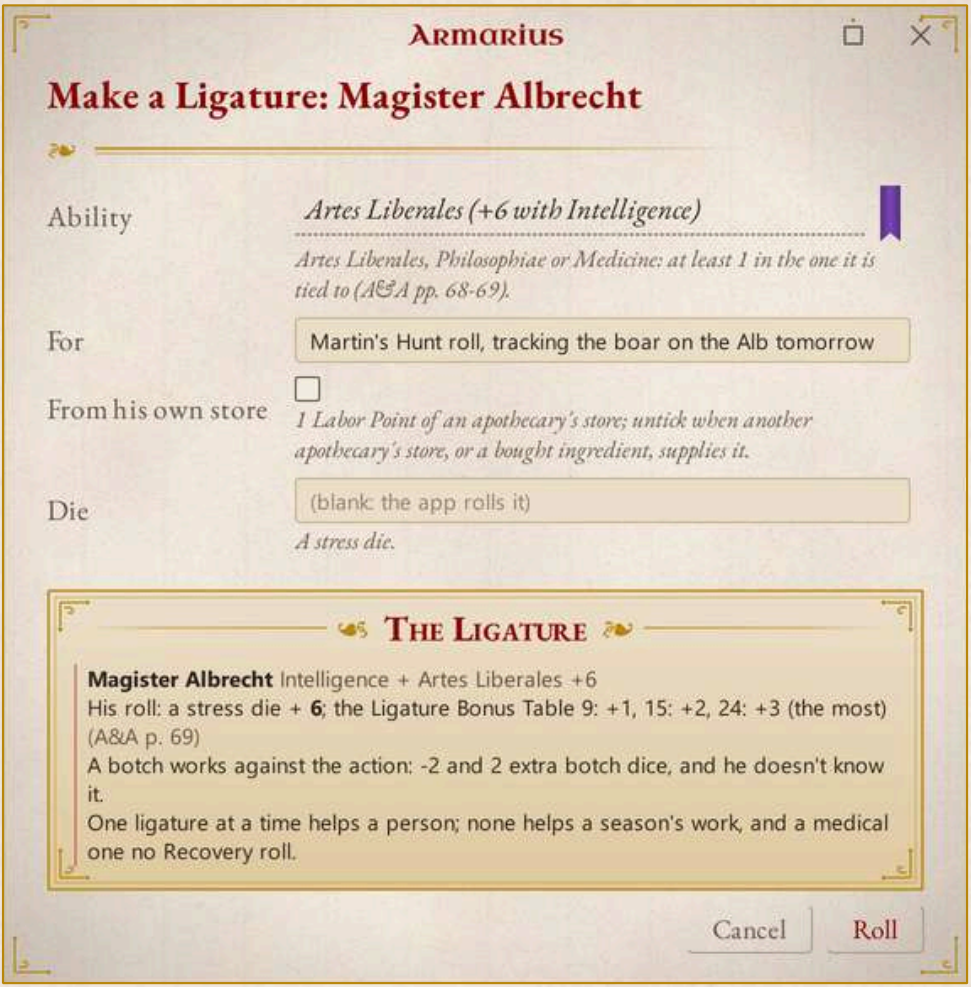
Dispute rolls every exchange; **Keep** writes it in both men's Diaries, with any real Fatigue it cost them.

Natural philosophy

A scholar needs no Gift to bend the world a little. **Make a Ligature**, beside it on the Deeds chapter, is a charm for one roll: a little bag of herbs, stones and parchment made for one person, one action and one six-hour window.

The rule · Art & Academe pp. 68-69

Anyone with Artes Liberales, Philosophiae or Medicine can make one, tied to that Ability: Intelligence + the Ability + stress die. 9 gives +1 to the action, 15 +2, 24 +3 (the most). A botch works against the action (-2 and two more botch dice), and the maker doesn't know. One ligature at a time, never for a season's work, and a medical one never helps a Recovery roll. Each takes a Labor Point from an apothecary's store.



Make a Ligature: Ability Artes Liberales, "For" typed in, From his own store unticked. The foot reads "His roll: a stress die + 6; the Ligature Bonus Table 9: +1, 15: +2, 24: +3 (the most)" and warns what a botch does.

The bigger works of natural philosophy, the formulae (astrological inceptions, alchemical reagents and medical theriacs), are learned and made in seasons: they're in *The Hidden Arts*.

What you do by hand

- **A grog's place**: a new grog joins the Turb; move one who isn't a soldier to his own list.
- **Swapping a Virtue or Flaw** at a transition of maturation, on the Virtues & Flaws chapter.

Where the rules come from

Ars Magica Definitive Edition: The Hunter (p. 32); Virtues and Flaws by character type (p. 45); Quick and Easy Virtues and Flaws (p. 47); Abilities by age and early childhood (p. 48); Mythic Companions (p. 55); the Faerie Doctor (pp. 56-57); Covenant Loyalty, the Gift modifiers, specialists, Familiarity and pensions (pp. 185-186).

Grogs: free time, rewards and punishments (pp. 23-25); pensions (p. 26); updating grogs and story experience (p. 67); grog templates, The Craftsman (chapter seven, p. 106). *Covenants*: Loyalty and punishments (pp. 36-41).

Art & Academe: ligatures (pp. 68-69); the limits of education (p. 79); parish and cathedral schools (pp. 81-82); Academic Reputation (p. 103); disputatio (pp. 103-105). *Apprentices*: transitions of maturation (pp. 14-15).



Armarius

A saga manager for Ars Magica

A Year at Rabenstein

Seasons, books and vis, a Longevity Ritual and the winter aging roll, and what happened when Adelheid of Flambeau botched a fireball in a faerie wood.

Guide 3 of 17

Ars Magica runs on seasons. Between stories, every magus spends each season on one thing: reading, studying vis, being taught, writing, working in the lab. Keeping track of who did what, who learned how much, and whose turn it is to roll for old age is exactly the sort of bookkeeping Armarius is good at.

This guide follows Rabenstein through a year, Spring 1220 to Spring 1221, with its two magi: young **Adelheid of Flambeau**, fresh from her Gauntlet (you made her in *Making a Magus*), and **Leandro of Bonisagus**, 45 and starting to feel it. Then it looks at the books magi write and copy, where vis comes from, and the slow tide of Warping, ending with Adelheid's first trip into Wizard's Twilight in Spring 1223.

The rules are the *Ars Magica Definitive Edition*'s (DE) chapter ten, Long-Term Events (pp. 375-392), with the Longevity Ritual and vis extraction from chapter eight (pp. 250, 261), Wizard's Twilight from chapter seven (pp. 228-230), and Living Conditions from chapter six (p. 190). *Covenants* suggests how much vis a source should give (p. 72).

The rule · DE pp. 375-376

Each season a character gains experience from one source: a book, a teacher, vis, practice, an adventure. The source has a Source Quality; Virtues and Flaws can change it into the Advancement Total, and that's the experience gained. A season with nothing better gives Exposure: 2 xp. Magi have four genuinely free seasons a year, and lab work takes a whole one.

1. Before we start: the covenant's Living Conditions

One number matters at the end of the year: the covenant's Living Conditions. Rabenstein is a Spring covenant, and with **Living Conditions (Magi)** and **(Mundane)** left blank on **Edit**, the app takes them from the covenant's season: +1 for its magi, 0 for everyone else. Type a number only to set it yourself.

The rule · DE pp. 190, 391

A covenant's Living Conditions modifier depends on its season and who you are: in a Spring or Winter covenant a magus gets +1 and everyone else 0; in Summer or Autumn, +2 and +1. It's taken off every aging roll.



Rabenstein's Covenfolk chapter: the Situational Modifiers ledger, Living Conditions "+0 (Spring) (+0)" for the covenfolk, and in the header Living (Magi) "+1 (Spring)" and Living (Mundane) "+0 (Spring)".

The figures on the covenant's header say where they came from: "+1 (Spring)" is the season's own.

2. Who's doing what: the covenant's Seasons

Open the covenant's **Seasons** chapter. It's the planning board: every magus and companion, this season and the three after, and whether they've got anything planned. Grogs show "yearly" (their update is in *The Covenfolk*). Right now nobody has a plan.

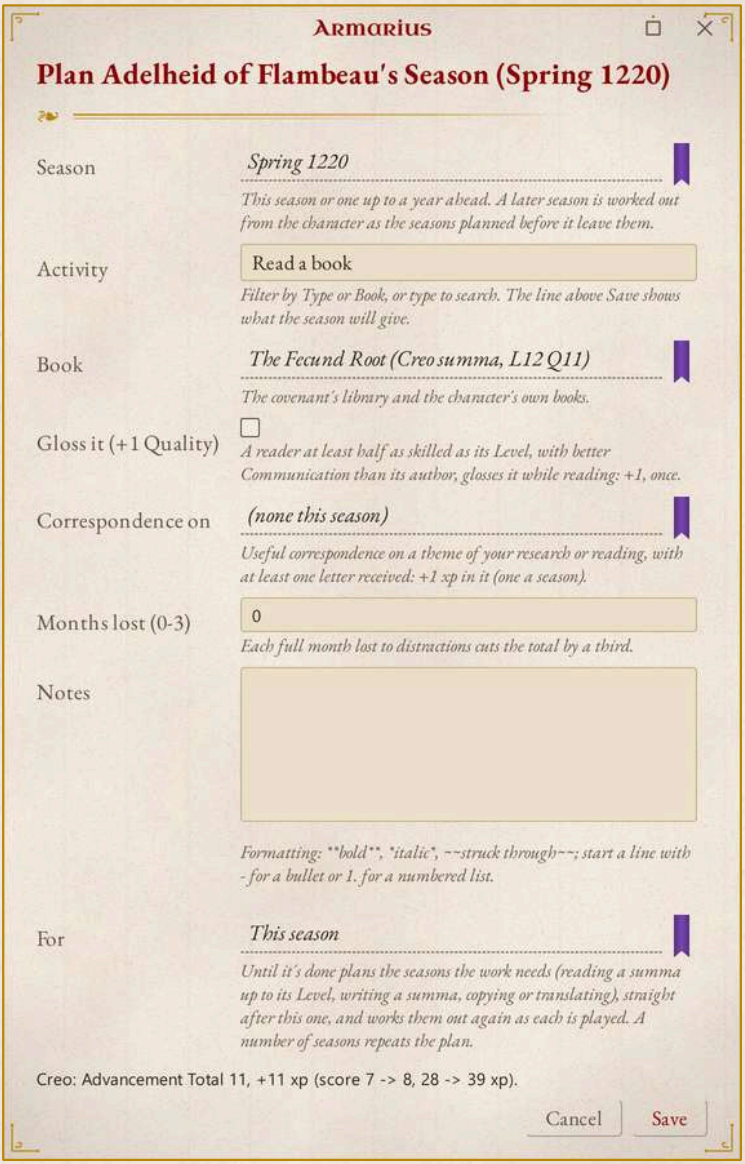


Rabenstein's Seasons chapter, Spring 1220: two magi, "nothing" in every column, this season's in the warning colour.

3. Spring: Adelheid reads a book

Rabenstein's library has *The Fecund Root*, a Creo summa of Level 12 and Quality 11. Open Adelheid's sheet, go to **Planning**, and click **Plan**. Choose **Read a book**, pick the book, and the line at the foot of the form tells you what she'll get before you save.

> **The rule · DE pp. 378-379**
>
> A summa has a Level and a Quality. Reading it for a season gives its Quality in xp, but never takes the reader past its Level. You need Latin 4 and Artes Liberales to read the Order's books.



Plan Season, opened under This Season: Read a book, The Fecund Root. The foot of the form reads "Creo: Advancement Total 11, +11 xp (score 7 -> 8, 28 -> 39 xp)".

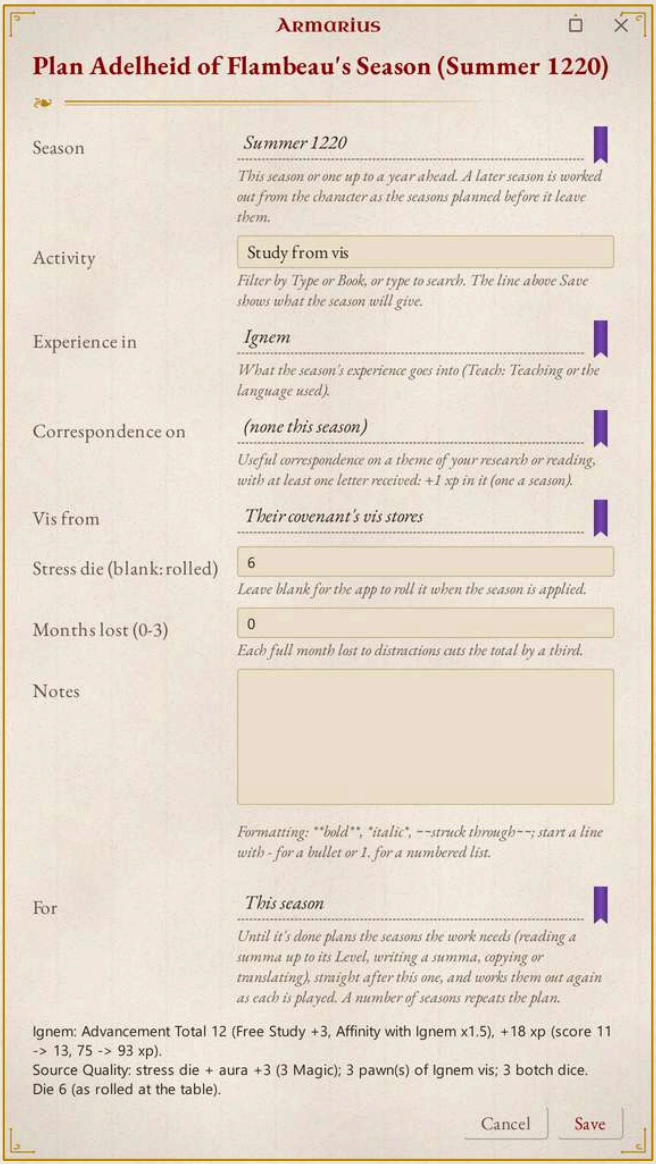
What happened. Planned: Creo +11 xp, from 28 to 39, a score of 8.

4. Summer, Autumn and Winter

You don't have to wait for Summer to plan Summer. The form's **Season** box takes this season or any of the three after it, and Seasons Ahead lists them. Adelheid's year goes like this.

Summer: Study from vis. Rabenstein has a few pawns of Ignem vis in its stores, and Adelheid gets three of them. Choose **Study from vis**, Ignem, and **Vis from** her covenant's vis stores. We rolled the stress die at the table (a 6) and typed it in; leave it blank and the app rolls it when the season is applied.

> **The rule · DE pp. 69, 82, 378**
>
> Studying raw vis costs a pawn for every five points (or part) of the Art: Ignem 11 needs 3 pawns. Source Quality is a stress die + the aura, with a botch die per pawn. Free Study adds 3 to it, and Affinity with Ignem multiplies the result by one and a half.

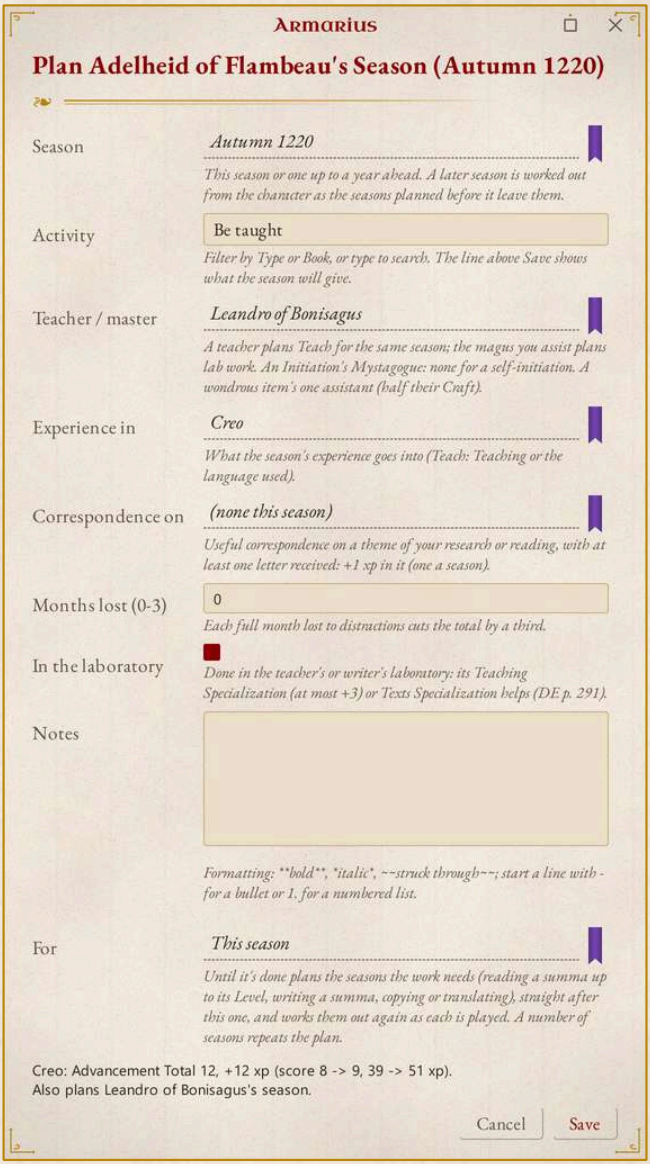


Plan Season: Study from vis, Ignem, die 6. The foot reads "Ignem: Advancement Total 12 (Free Study +3, Affinity x1.5), +18 xp (score 11 -> 13)", then "Source Quality: stress die + aura +3; 3 pawns of Ignem vis; 3 botch dice".

Autumn: Be taught. Leandro agrees to teach her Creo. Choose **Be taught** and pick him as the teacher, and the app plans his season too: he's down for **Teach**, and clearing either plan clears both.

The rule · DE p. 378

Teaching's Source Quality is the teacher's Communication + Teaching + 3, +6 with a single student. The student can't go past the teacher's own score. Leandro has Communication +1 and Teaching 2, so 1 + 2 + 3 + 6 = 12.

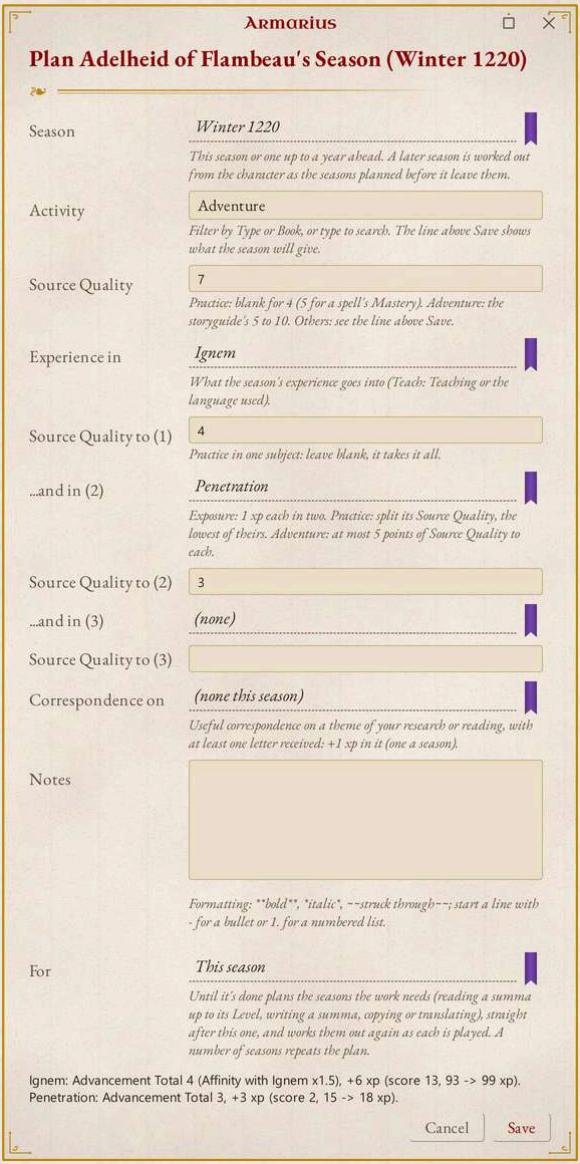


Plan Season: Be taught, by Leandro of Bonisagus, in Creo. The foot says it also plans Leandro of Bonisagus's season.

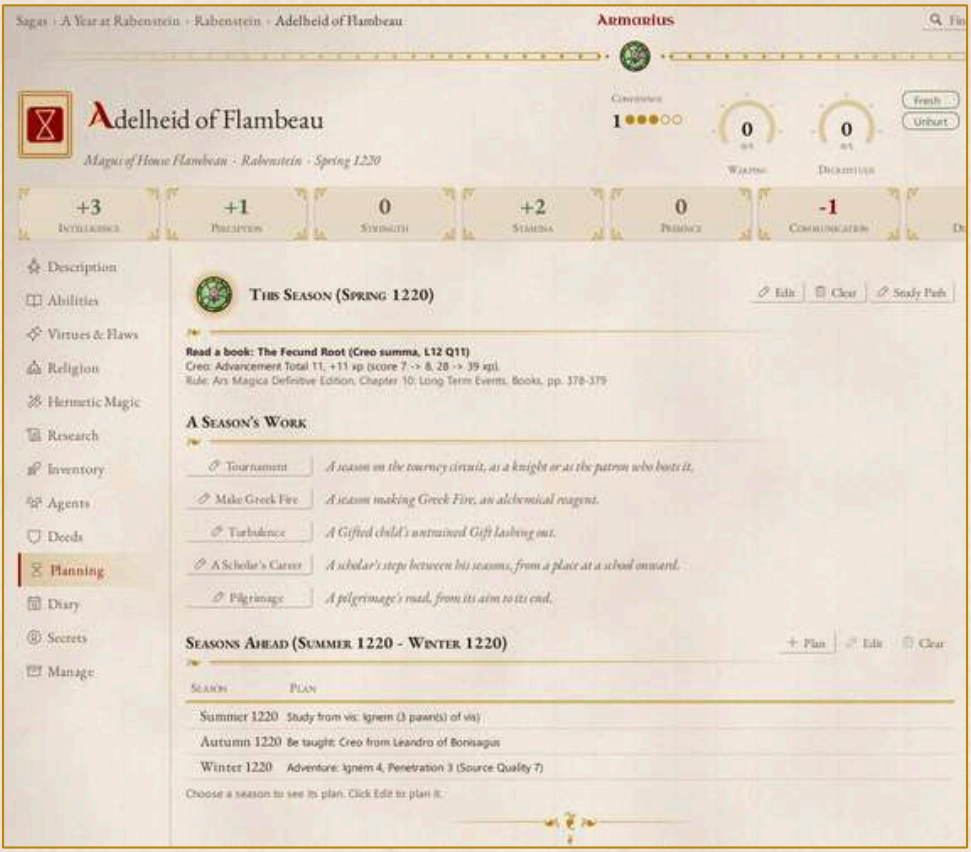
Winter: an adventure. The troupe has a story planned for the winter, and the storyguide reckons it's worth a Source Quality of 7. Adelheid puts 4 of it into Ignem and 3 into Penetration.

The rule · DE pp. 376-377

An adventure takes the whole season and gives the Source Quality the storyguide sets (5 to 10), split among Abilities used during it, and Arts used on stage, with at most 5 to any one.



Plan Season: Adventure, Source Quality 7, Ignem 4 and Penetration 3. The foot reads "Ignem: Advancement Total 4 (Affinity x1.5), +6 xp" and "Penetration: Advancement Total 3, +3 xp".



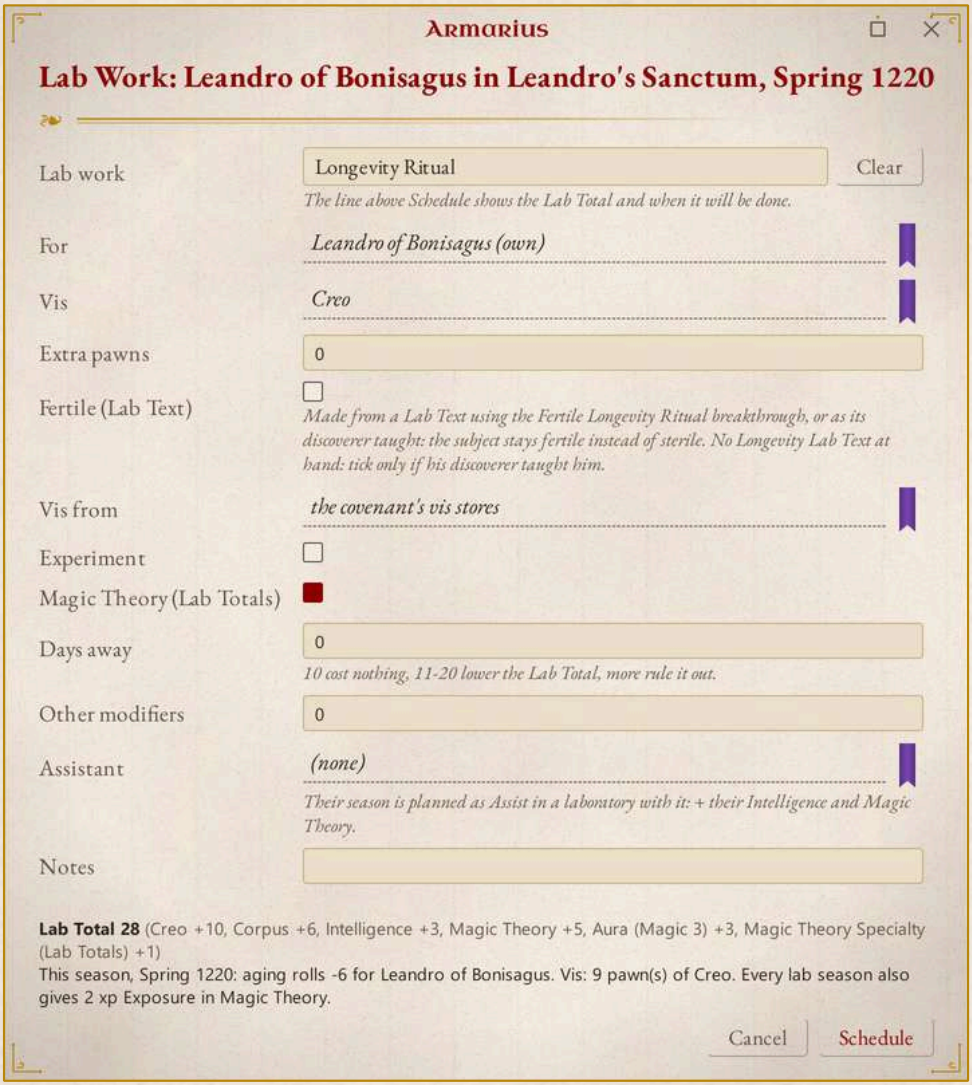
Adelheid's Planning chapter: This Season and the three Seasons Ahead, all four filled in.

5. Leandro's Longevity Ritual

Leandro is 45, and he'd quite like to be 90 one day. Lab work is planned in the laboratory, not on the sheet: open **Leandro's Sanctum**, go to **Seasons**, click Spring 1220 in the Planning list and click **Plan**. Choose **Longevity Ritual**, who it's for (himself), and which vis pays.

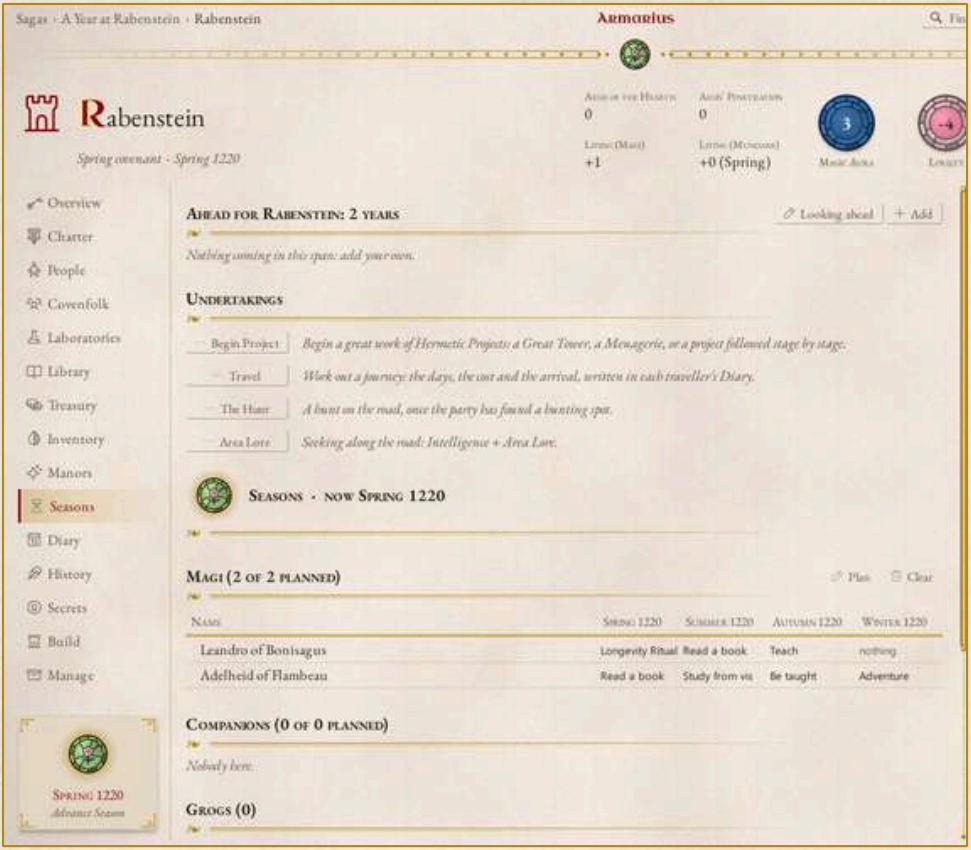
The rule · DE p. 261

A Longevity Ritual takes a season. It gives -1 to aging rolls for every five points (or part) of the Creo Corpus Lab Total, and costs a pawn of Creo, Corpus or Vim vis for every five years of age, rounded up. It lasts until the magus suffers an aging crisis.



Lab Work: Longevity Ritual. The line at the foot works out the Lab Total piece by piece: "Lab Total 28 (Creo +10, Corpus +6, Intelligence +3, Magic Theory +5, Aura (Magic 3) +3, Magic Theory Specialty (Lab Totals) +1). This season, Spring 1220: aging rolls -6 for Leandro of Bonisagus. Vis: 9 pawns of Creo."

Creo 10 + Corpus 6 + Intelligence 3 + Magic Theory 5 + aura 3, plus 1 for his Magic Theory specialty in Lab Totals, makes 28: -6 to his aging rolls. At 45 it costs 9 pawns of Creo vis. In Summer he reads the covenant's Magic Theory summa, and in Autumn he's teaching Adelheid. Winter we leave empty, to see what happens.



The covenant's Seasons again: both magi planned for the year, Leandro except Winter.

6. Advance Season

When the troupe has played out Spring's stories, click the **Advance Season** card at the foot of the chapters on the left (the season's medallion, **Spring 1220**, with "Advance Season" under it). The app says what will be applied and asks once. It takes a backup of the saga first, so a mistake is never more than a copy away: if you advance by mistake, **Undo Last Season**, beside Set Date on the saga's Seasons chapter, puts the whole saga back as it was.



Advance Time: "Advance the saga from Spring 1220 to Summer 1220? 2 planned season(s) will be applied.", and under it "Advanced by mistake? Undo Last Season (beside Set Date) puts the whole saga back as it was".

Then the saga's Seasons page opens on **Just played**: one line per person with what they did and what it gave. Each character's Diary gets an entry too.



Spring 1220, just played: Adelheid's reading and Leandro's Longevity Ritual.

> **What happened.** Spring: Adelheid reads *The Fecund Root*, Creo 7 to 8. Leandro's ritual takes 9 pawns of Creo vis from the stores, and he gets 2 xp of Magic Theory for the lab work (p. 376).

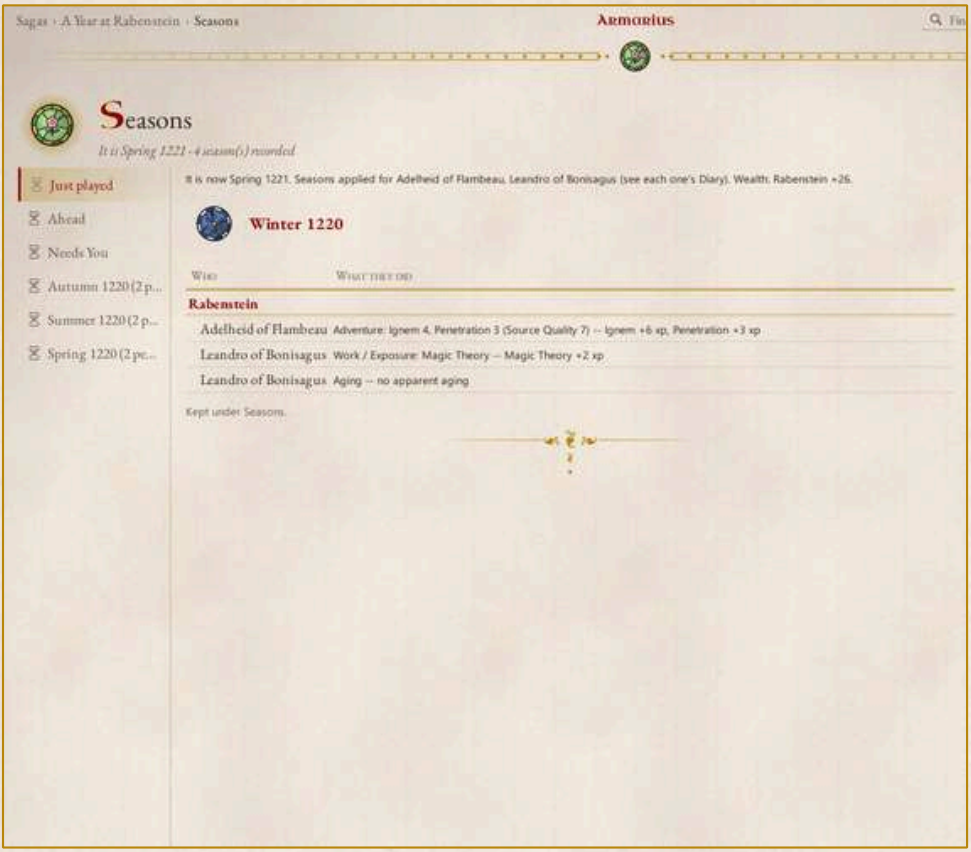
We did the same three more times. Summer: Adelheid's vis study gives 18 xp and Ignem goes from 11 to 13; Leandro reads Magic Theory (+6). Autumn: Leandro teaches her Creo for 12 xp, and she reaches Creo 9; he gets 2 xp in Teaching for his trouble. Winter: her adventure gives Ignem 6 xp (4 points of Source Quality, with her Affinity) and Penetration 3.

7. Winter: the end of the year

Advancing Winter closes the year. Leandro has nothing planned, so he gets the saga's default for an empty season, Work / Exposure: 2 xp in Magic Theory. Then come the year's own jobs: Warping, aging, each covenant's vis harvests and books, and the covenant's surplus added to its Wealth.

The rule · DE pp. 390-392

A character starts making aging rolls in the Winter after turning 35. Aging Total = stress die (no botch) + age/10, rounded up - Living Conditions - Longevity Ritual. 2 or less: no apparent aging. 3 or more: a year older. 10 to 12: an Aging Point in any Characteristic, and 13 or 22+ a crisis. A Longevity Ritual is a continuing magical effect, so it gives one Warping Point a year.

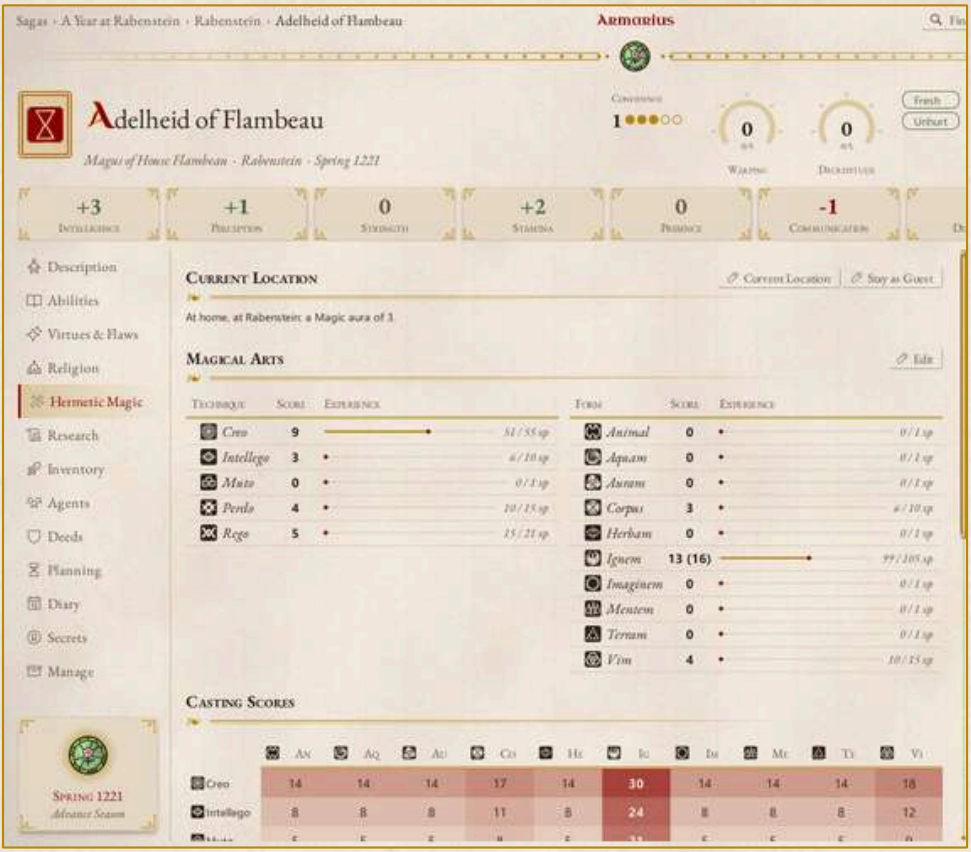


Winter 1220, just played: Adelheid's adventure, Leandro's default season and his aging roll.

> **What happened.** Leandro's Aging Total is the die's 2 + 5 for his age - 1 Living Conditions - 6 Longevity Ritual = 0: no apparent aging. He gains a Warping Point from the ritual. His Diary has the lot.



Leandro's Diary chapter: the year as a calendar, and each season's entry.



Adelheid's Hermetic Magic chapter a year on: Creo 9 and Ignem 13 (16 with Puissant Ignem).

A year gone at Rabenstein. Adelheid has Creo 9 (51 xp) and Ignem 13 (99 xp), and Penetration 18 xp. Leandro is no older to look at, and the saga's Seasons page keeps each season's results to browse later.

When the dice are unkind

One day Leandro's roll will come up 10 or more. An Aging Point "in any Characteristic", or the points a crisis brings, are the player's to place, so the Aging section (on his **Description** chapter) lists them until you do. Click **Place Aging Points** beside it to choose where each goes, one choice a point, offered first in the Characteristic the roll suggests; or Advance Season asks before it plays the next season (Cancel leaves the date where it is).

The rule · DE p. 392

Every Aging Point counts toward Decrepitude, which rises like an Ability; once a Characteristic has more Aging Points than its score, it drops by one. A crisis: raise Decrepitude first, then roll a simple die + age/10 + Decrepitude on the Crisis Table. A crisis ends a Longevity Ritual, and takes the rest of the season to recover from. Decrepitude 4 is extremely frail; 5 is bedridden and dying.

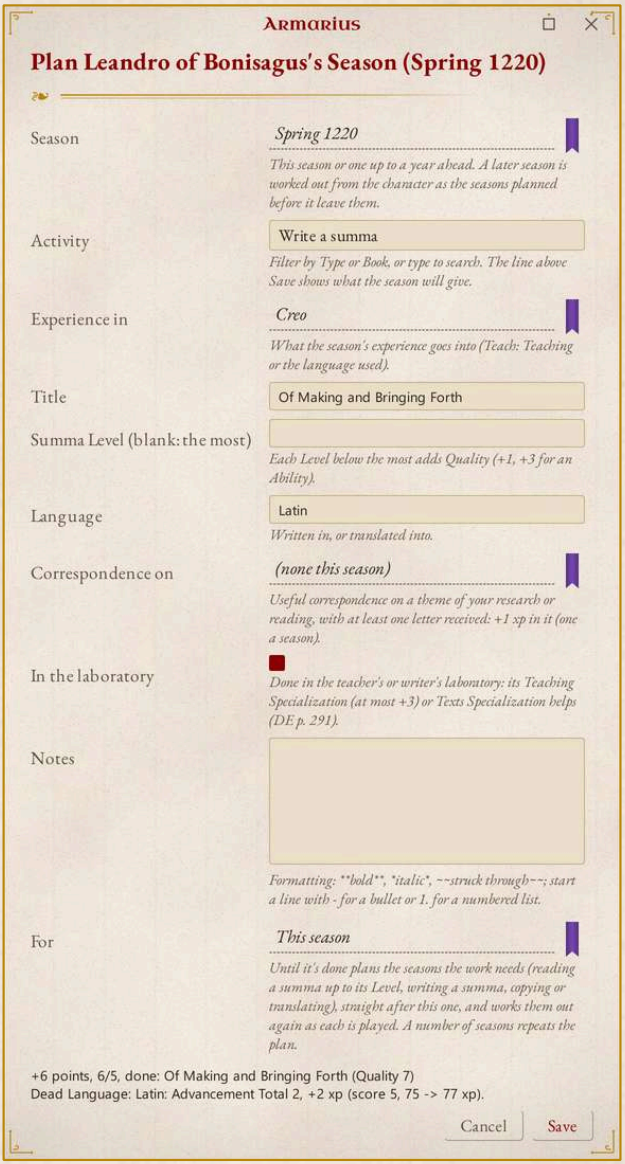
The app rolls the crisis with the Decrepitude the points bring, writes it all in the Diary, and warns on the Aging section at Decrepitude 4 and 5.

8. Books: writing and copying

Reading is the quickest way to learn, so the Order prizes its books, and a magus with something to say writes one. Leandro has one in him: a Creo summa of his own, which the forms here plan for the year we just played.

> **The rule · DE pp. 379-380**
>
> To write a book you need 5 in an Art (or 2 in an Ability) and 5 in the language. A summa's Level is up to half the author's score; its Quality is Communication + 6, +1 for every Level below the most (+3 for an Ability), but the bonus can't be more than the base Quality. Each season adds Communication + the language's score in points, and the summa is done when they reach the Level (five times the Level for an Ability). A tractatus takes one season, Quality Communication + 6, and an author may write only a fifth of his Art score (or half his Ability score) in tractatus on it, rounded up.

On Leandro's **Planning** chapter, click **Plan** and choose **Write a summa**. Choose Creo under **Experience in**, give it a **Title** (*Of Making and Bringing Forth*), and leave the **Summa Level** blank for the most he can manage. The line at the foot says how far a season gets him.



Plan Season: Write a summa, Creo, Title "Of Making and Bringing Forth". The foot reads "+6 points, 6/5, done: Of Making and Bringing Forth (Quality 7)", and the season's Exposure, 2 xp in Latin.

Creo 10 allows Level 5, and Communication 1 + Latin 5 is 6 points a season, so it's done in one. He could have written a Level 3 summa of Quality 9 instead, by typing the Level. In Summer he writes a tractatus, *On the Seed and the Flame*, with **Write a tractatus**: Quality 7, and one of the two Creo tractatus his score allows.

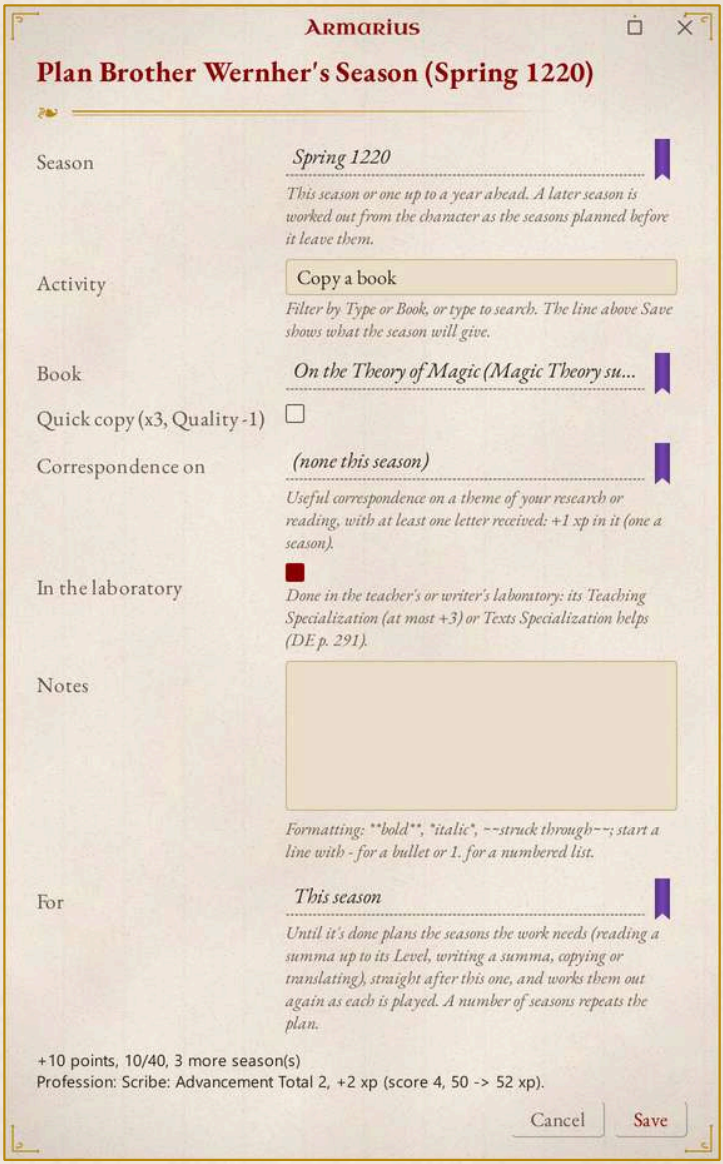
> **What happened.** At the end of each season the new book is on the shelf, Leandro's own until he gives it to the covenant (change its Owner on the Library chapter), and the Diary records it.

A library grows. With *Transforming Mythic Europe*'s **Rules for a Large Library** switched on (its card is under Optional Rules on the saga's **Saga Settings** chapter), **Read a book** also offers "the library" on a subject: its best summa sets the Level and Quality, and each other book near them adds to them (*Transforming Mythic Europe* p. 105). Rabenstein's shelf is too small to need it yet.

Copying a book is a season's work too. (A grog can copy as well: **Plan Copying** on his Planning chapter takes a season of his year for it.) Brother Wernher, a scribe with Profession: Scribe 4, makes Rabenstein a second copy of its Magic Theory summa (Level 8) with **Copy a book**: carefully, 6 + 4 = 10 points a season against five times the Level, 40, so four seasons. Tick **Quick copy** for three times the speed and a copy one Quality lower.

The rule · DE p. 380

Copying carefully: a tractatus a season, or 6 + Profession: Scribe points a season toward a summa (its Level for an Art, five times its Level for an Ability).
The copy has the original's Quality. Quickly: three times as fast, one Quality lower. A book on the Arts copied by someone without Magic Theory is corrupted.



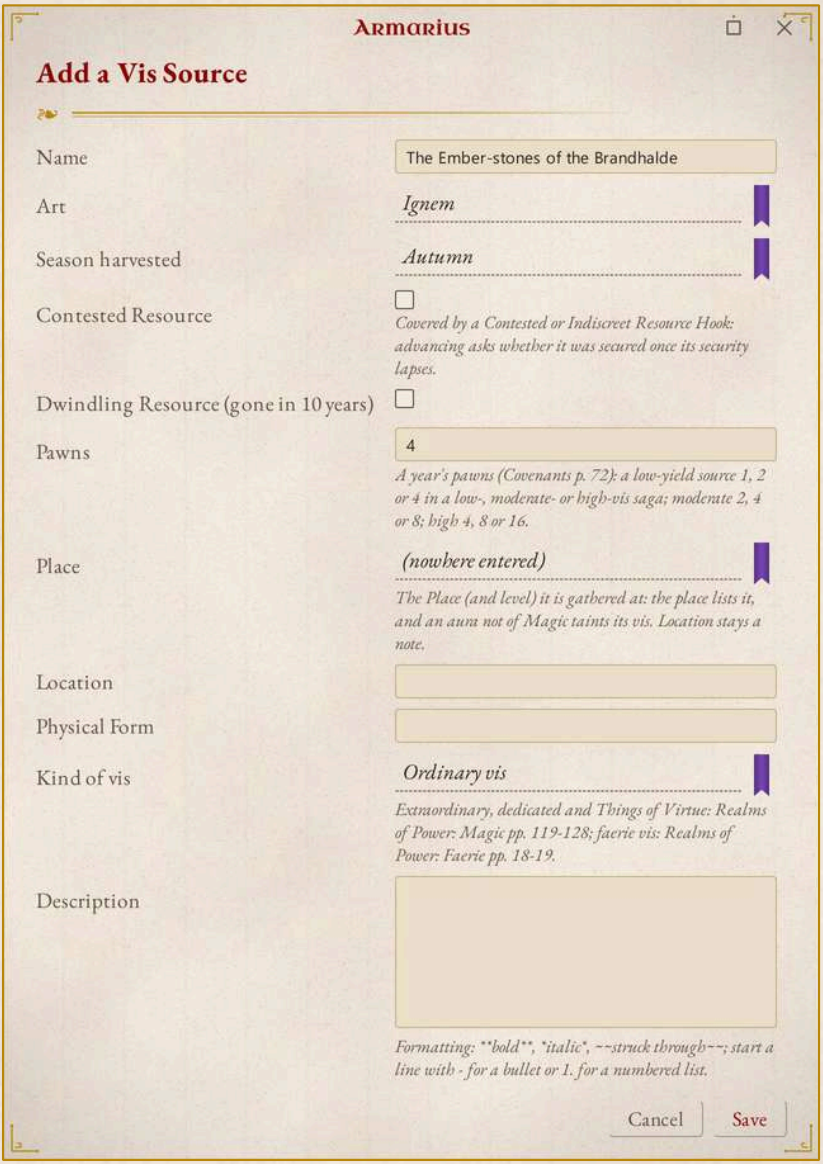
Plan Season for Brother Wernher: Copy a book, On the Theory of Magic (Magic Theory summa, L8 Q6). The foot shows the points this season against 40 and the seasons still to go.

9. Vis: sources, harvests and extraction

Vis is raw magic made solid: a fire-stone, a dew, a feather. Magi spend it on study, Rituals, enchanting and Longevity Rituals, and a covenant lives by its sources.

Rabenstein's grogs have found the **Ember-stones of the Brandhalde**, a burnt hillside where stones glow red each autumn. On the covenant's **Inventory** chapter, under **Vis Sources**, click **Add**: name it, its Art (Ignem), the **Season harvested** (Autumn) and its **Pawns** (4). If the Brandhalde is a Place in the saga's Region, choose it under **Place**: the place then lists the source, and vis from an aura that isn't Magic's comes out tainted by that realm. We leave it at "(nowhere entered)".

> **The rule · Covenants p. 72**
>
> How much a source gives is the troupe's choice: a low-yield source 1, 2 or 4 pawns a year in a low-, moderate- or high-vis saga, a moderate one 2, 4 or 8, a high-yield one, about a magus's year of vis, 4, 8 or 16. Most sources yield one Art only.



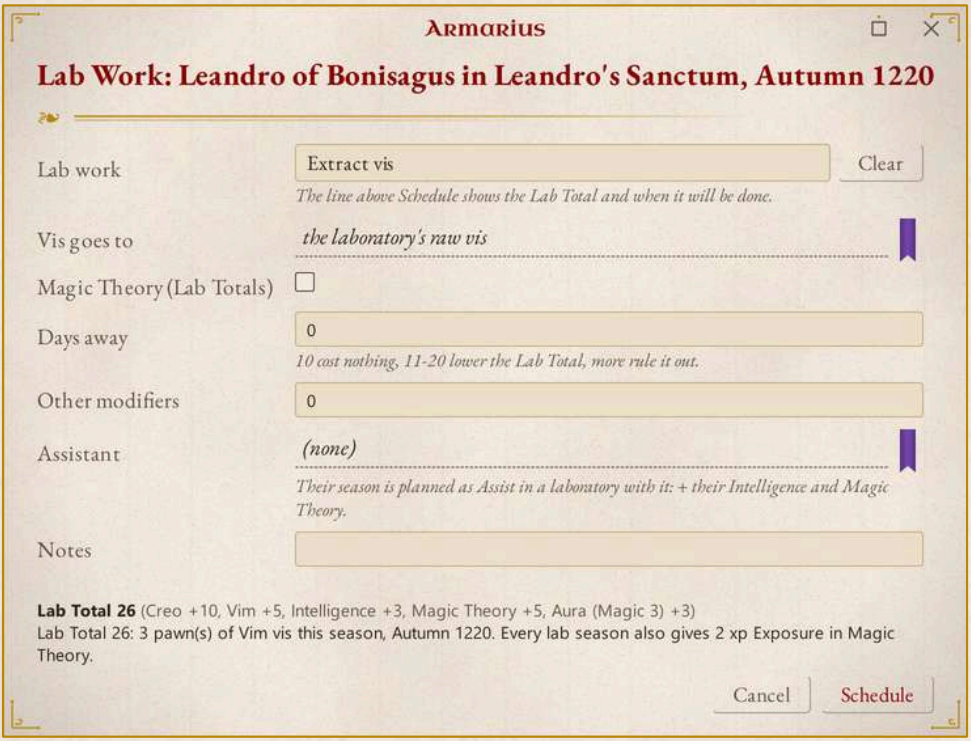
Add a Vis Source: "The Ember-stones of the Brandhalde", Art Ignem, Season harvested Autumn, 4 Pawns, Place "(nowhere entered)", Kind of vis "Ordinary vis".

> **What happened.** When Autumn is advanced, Rabenstein's Diary reads "Vis harvested: The Ember-stones of the Brandhalde. 4 pawns of Ignem vis into the vis stores", and the Raw Vis Stores go up by 4. A source marked **Contested** asks whether it was secured each year, and one marked **Dwindling** loses a tenth of its yield each year until it's gone. **Give**, beside a store, sends pawns to a laboratory, a magus or another covenant.

Short of vis? A magus can draw Vim vis out of the aura itself. In Leandro's Sanctum, plan a season of **Extract vis**.

The rule · DE p. 250

A season extracting vis gives a pawn of Vim vis for every ten points (or part) of the Creo Vim Lab Total. Vis can only be extracted in a Magic aura.



Lab Work: Extract vis. The foot reads "Lab Total 26 (Creo +10, Vim +5, Intelligence +3, Magic Theory +5, Aura (Magic 3) +3). Lab Total 26: 3 pawns of Vim vis this season, Autumn 1220."

What happened. Three pawns of Vim vis land in Leandro's Sanctum's own stores (its **Stores** chapter), and he gets his 2 xp of Magic Theory.

10. Warping and Wizard's Twilight

Magic leaves marks. Every magus slowly gathers Warping from the supernatural forces around her, and a sudden dose of it can tip her into Wizard's Twilight: a trip out of the world that might last a moment or seven years, and that changes her when she comes back.

The rule · DE pp. 389-391

A Warping Score grows like an Ability, from Warping Points: 5 points for a score of 1, 15 for 2, 30 for 3. Points come from four places: living in an aura of 6 or more (not one of your own realm), a powerful effect made by someone else and not designed for you, any constant effect on you (a Longevity Ritual is one point a year), and botching a supernatural roll: a point per zero on the botch dice.

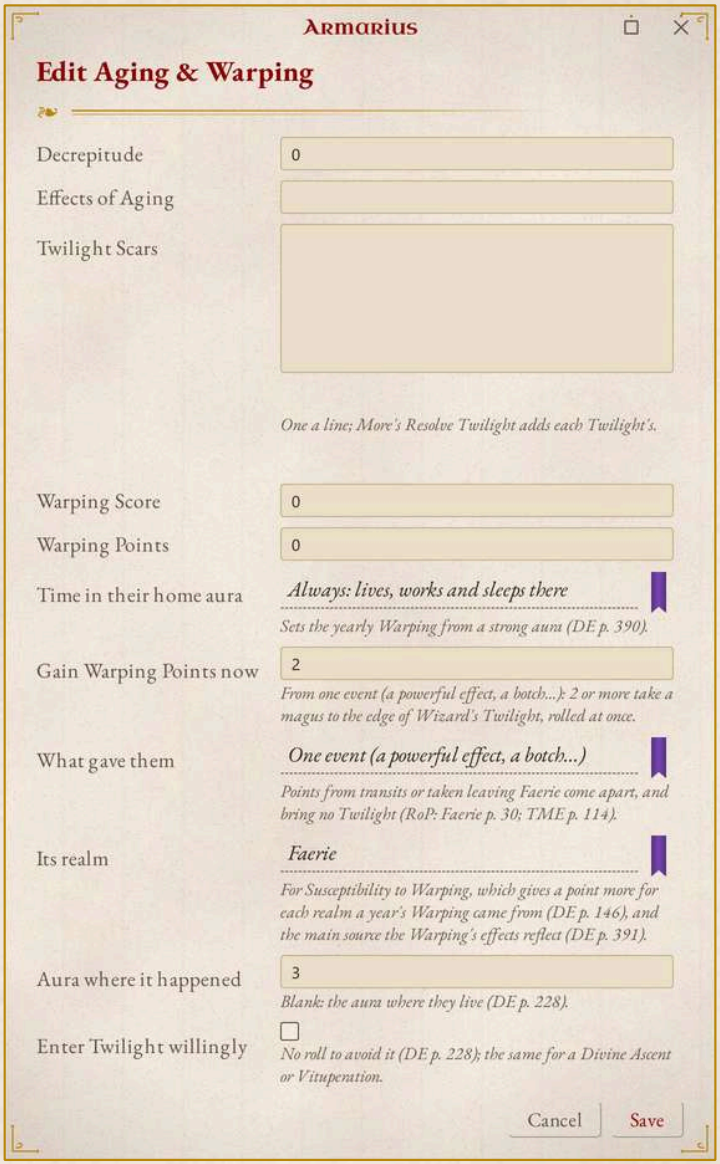
Armarius keeps the steady sources by itself. Each Winter it adds a Longevity Ritual's point (Leandro's, above) and the points from living in a strong aura of another realm, and the Warping dial in a character's header fills up towards the next score. The sudden kind, a botch, you tell it about yourself.

A botch in the wood

Spring 1223. Adelheid and two grogs corner the bandits who've been robbing the covenant's carters, in a faerie wood with an aura of 3. She throws a *Ball of Abysmal Flame* and the dice come up zero, with two zeros on the botch dice. Bad news for the oak tree behind the bandit chief, and two Warping Points for Adelheid.

> **The rule · DE p. 228**
>
> Gaining two or more Warping Points from one event takes a magus to the edge of Twilight. Add the points first, then roll to avoid it: Stamina + Concentration + Vim Form Bonus + stress die against Warping Score + points gained + Enigmatic Wisdom + the local aura + a stress die. Succeed and she spends two minutes getting her magic back under control. Fail and she's in Twilight. She can also choose to go in without a roll.

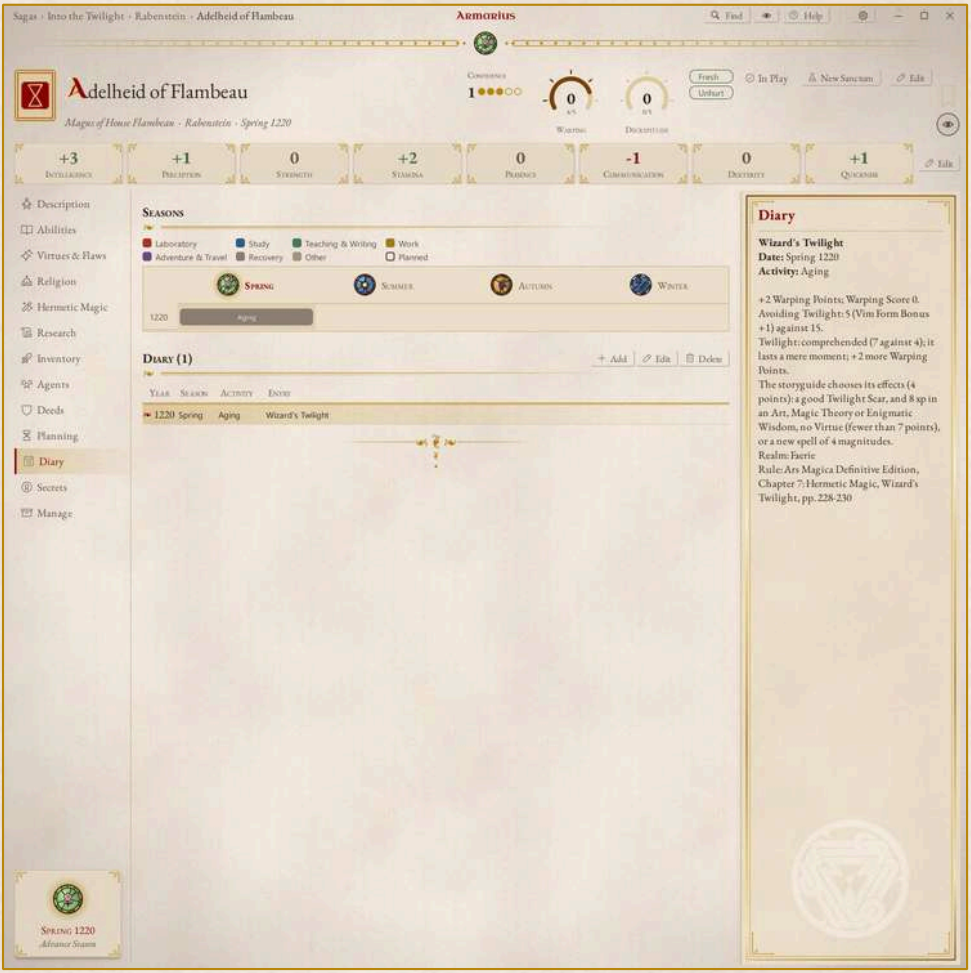
On Adelheid's **Description** chapter, click **Edit** on the Aging section. Type 2 in **Gain Warping Points now**, say which realm they came from (Faerie), and the **Aura** where it happened (3). Leave **Enter Twilight willingly** unticked so she tries to avoid it. Save, and the app rolls it all straight away.



Edit Aging & Warping: two Warping Points from a faerie wood, aura 3.

What the dice said

The app writes the whole episode into Adelheid's Diary, roll by roll.



Adelheid's Diary chapter, with the Wizard's Twilight entry open in the inspector.

Avoiding it: Stamina +2, Concentration 2, Vim Form Bonus +1 (Vim 4, a fifth rounded up) and a 0 on her die make 5. Against her Warping Score of 0, the 2 points, the aura's 3 and the storyguide's 10 make 15. She's in.

The rule · DE pp. 228-229

Comprehending it: Intelligence + Enigmatic Wisdom + stress die against Warping Score + stress die, with a botch die for each point that triggered it, plus one. Fail, and she's gone for the base time of her Warping Score (Score 1 two minutes, 4 a day, 5 a moon, 7 a year, 10 Final Twilight); succeed, and each point she wins by makes it a step shorter. Either way she gains a simple die more Warping Points.

Comprehending it: Intelligence +3 and a 4 make 7, against 0 + 4.
She understands it, and at a Warping Score of 0 the whole thing lasts a mere moment: to the grogs, she flickers, and is back. The simple die adds 2 more Warping Points, 4 in all.

What happened. Adelheid comprehended her Twilight. She has 4 Warping Points (4 of the 5 she needs for a Warping Score of 1, as the dial in her header shows) and a good experience to show for it.

Choosing what it did to her

The rule · DE pp. 229-230

A comprehended Twilight leaves a good Twilight Scar, something small and magical, and the storyguide picks one of: twice the Warping Points gained in xp in an Art, Magic Theory or Enigmatic Wisdom; a Hermetic or Supernatural Virtue (from 7 points); or a new spell of that many magnitudes. A failed one leaves a bad scar and takes the same away.

The Diary already sizes the choice: 4 points, so 8 xp or a spell of 4 magnitudes, and no Virtue. Our storyguide gave Adelheid 8 xp in Ignem, and a scar to match: tiny embers drift up from wherever she's just stepped.

Click **Resolve Twilight**, beside the Aging section. Tick **Comprehended**, type the **Warping Points gained** (4), choose the **Effect**, Experience, in Ignem, and type the **Twilight Scar**: "Tiny embers drift up from wherever she's just stepped." The xp goes on her Arts, the scar joins the section's scars, and the whole goes in the Diary.



Resolve Twilight: Adelheid of Flambeau, Comprehended, Warping Points gained 4, Effect Experience in Ignem (8 xp), and the Twilight Scar of drifting embers.

What happened. Ignem 14, a Twilight Scar of drifting embers, and 4 Warping Points towards her first point of Warping Score. Not bad for a botch.

What you do by hand

- **Twilight's effects** (DE pp. 229-230) are chosen by the storyguide; Resolve Twilight applies the choice.
- **Botches**: the app doesn't roll spellcasting at the table, so Warping from a botched spell (a point for each zero on the botch dice, DE p. 227) is typed on the Aging form.

Where the rules come from

Ars Magica Definitive Edition: Affinity with Art (p. 69); Free Study (p. 82); covenant Living Conditions (p. 190); Wizard's Twilight: botches, entering, avoiding and comprehending it, and the time table (p. 228); during Twilight and its good effects (p. 229); its other effects (p. 230); vis extraction (p. 250); Longevity Rituals (p. 261); experience, Source Quality and Advancement Totals (pp. 375-376); seasons, Exposure and lab work's Exposure (p. 376); Adventure (pp. 376-377); Teaching and Vis study (p. 378); Books and reading (pp. 378-379); writing summae and tractatus (pp. 379-380); copying books (p. 380); Warping Score, points and sources (pp. 389-390); Warping from a Longevity Ritual (p. 390); aging, Living Conditions and the aging table (pp. 391-392); Decrepitude and crises (p. 392).

Covenants: vis source yields (p. 72). *Transforming Mythic Europe*: a large library (p. 105).



Armarius

A saga manager for Ars Magica

The Laboratory

Lab Totals, spells learned and invented, Mastery, experiments that go bang, the long road to a breakthrough, and the Arcane Connection on the shelf.

Guide 4 of 17

Every magus's power is made in the laboratory. It's where spells are learned and invented, where items are enchanted and familiars bound, and where the bold, or the foolish, push Hermetic theory past what Bonisagus wrote down. Nearly all of it runs on one number, the Lab Total, and Armarius works it out for you, term by term, before you commit a season to anything.

This guide follows **Adelheid of Flambeau** in her own laboratory, **The Ember Cell** at Rabenstein, from Summer 1222. She learns two spells from her old master's Lab Texts, invents one of her own, masters a favourite, experiments, and sets out to find a whole new way of throwing fire.

The rules are the *Ars Magica Definitive Edition*'s (DE) chapter eight: the Lab Total (p. 249), inventing spells (pp. 251-252), similar spells (p. 260), Laboratory Texts (p. 262), Arcane Connections (p. 250), Arcane Experimentation and Arcane Discovery (pp. 274-279); Spell Mastery from chapter seven (pp. 225-226); and the Magical Focus Virtues from chapter four (pp. 94, 98).

The rule · DE p. 249

Almost everything in the lab runs on one number. Lab Total = Technique + Form + Intelligence + Magic Theory + aura, plus whatever Virtues, specialties and the job itself add.

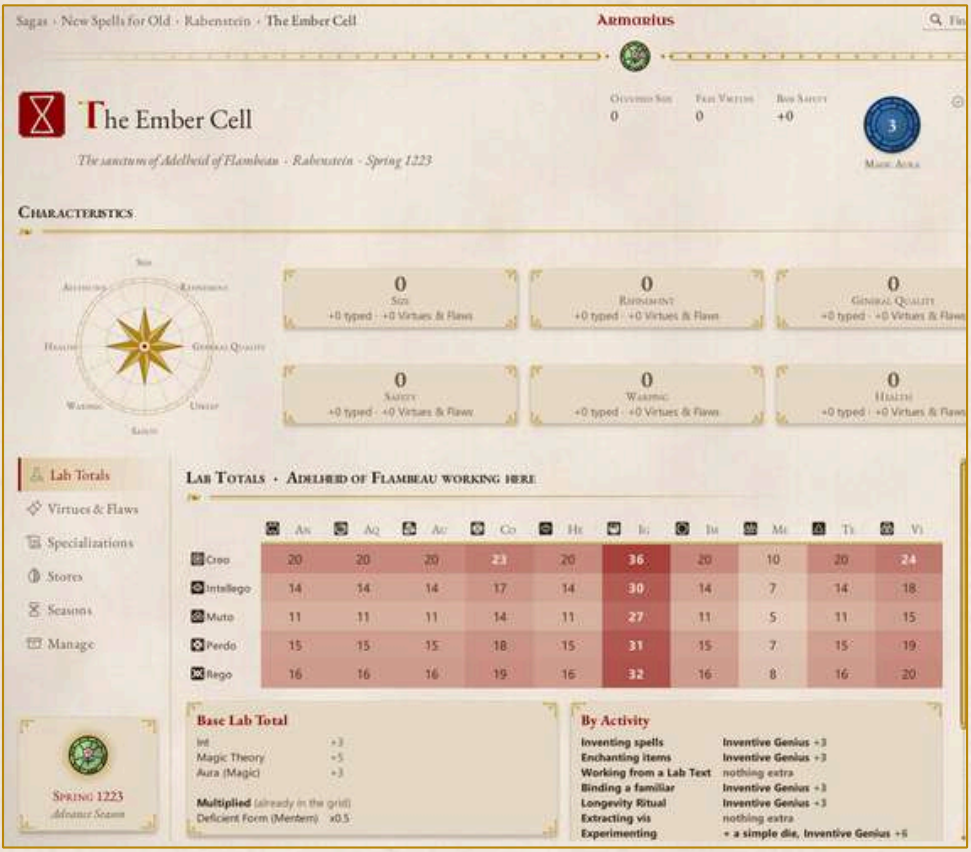
1. The Ember Cell and its Lab Totals

Open Rabenstein's page, choose **Laboratories**, and click **The Ember Cell**. A laboratory has its own page: its eight Characteristics under the header, as a compass and a card each (Size, Refinement, General Quality, Upkeep, Safety, Warping, Health and Aesthetics), and chapters for its Lab Totals, Virtues & Flaws, Specializations, Stores, Seasons (its planning and its Diary) and Manage.

Choose **Lab Totals** in the rail. It's the owner working here, laid bare: the **Base Lab Total** every activity shares (Intelligence, Magic Theory, the aura, the lab's General Quality), anything **Multiplied** (Adelheid's Deficient Mentem halves that Form, already in the grid), and **By Activity**, what each kind of work adds. Inventive Genius shows +3 for inventing spells, enchanting, binding a familiar and Longevity Rituals, nothing for working from a Lab Text, and +6 when experimenting. At the foot are the results it works out: a Longevity Ritual's aging modifier, the pawns a season of vis extraction would give, and the most vis and the largest shape and material bonus her Magic Theory allows.

The rule · DE pp. 87, 250

Inventive Genius: +3 to the Lab Total when not using a Lab Text or being taught, +6 when experimenting. A magus can use at most twice his Magic Theory in pawns of vis in a season.

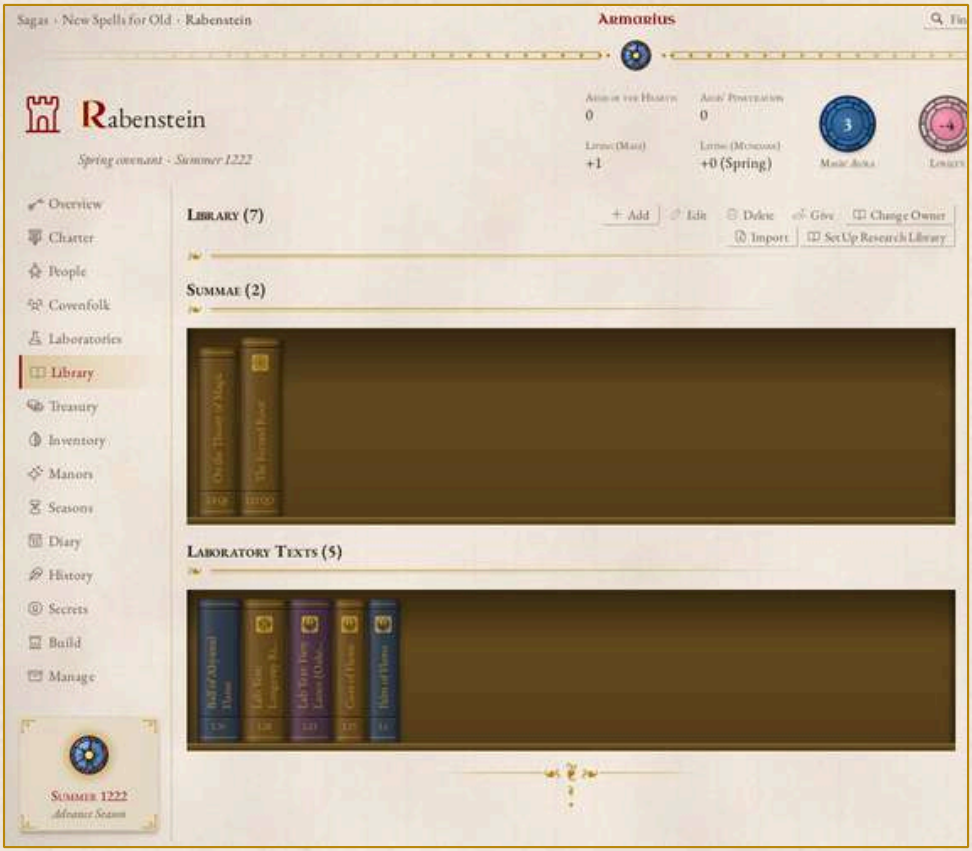


The Ember Cell's Lab Totals chapter: Base Lab Total (Int +3, Magic Theory +5, Aura (Magic) +3), "Deficient Form (Mentem) x0.5" under Multiplied, and By Activity listing Inventive Genius +3 for inventing, enchanting, familiars and Longevity Rituals, "nothing extra" from a Lab Text, and "+ a simple die, Inventive Genius +6" for experimenting; the results at the foot read "Creo Corpus 26: aging rolls -6", "Creo Vim 24: 3 pawns a season", "up to 10 pawns" and "bonuses up to +5".

Compare totals here before you plan anything; it saves a lot of opening and closing forms.

2. What's on the shelves

Rabenstein's **Library** chapter shows the covenant's books as shelves: summae, tractatus and Lab Texts. Two of the Lab Texts are fire spells written by Adelheid's old master, Konrad of Flambeau: *Coat of Flame* (Cr(Re)Ig 25) and *Palm of Flame* (CrIg 5).



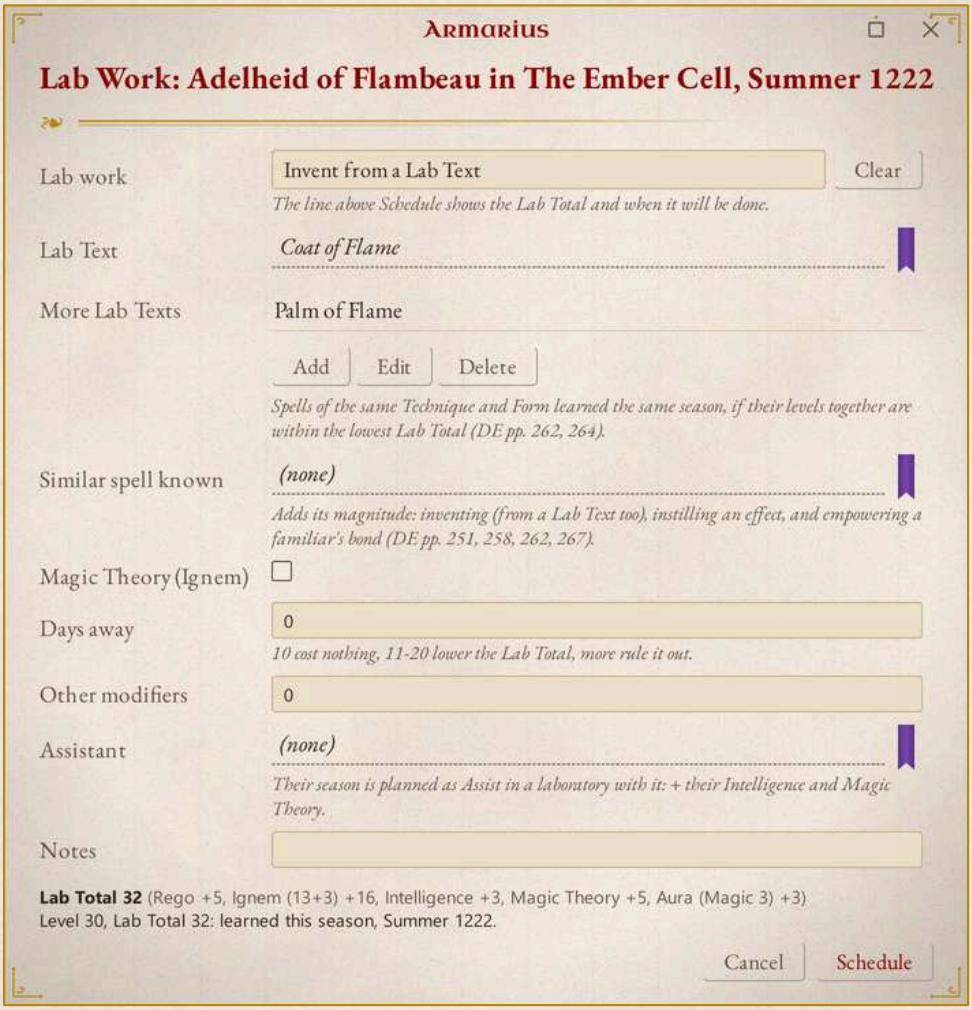
Rabenstein's Library: its summae standing as tall as their levels, and its Laboratory Texts as a second shelf.

3. Summer: two spells from Lab Texts

In The Ember Cell's **Seasons** chapter, click Summer 1222 in the Planning list and **Plan**. Choose **Invent from a Lab Text**, pick *Coat of Flame*, and add *Palm of Flame* under **More Lab Texts**.

The rule · DE pp. 262, 311

With a Lab Text, a magus learns the spell in one season if her Lab Total is at least its level. She can learn several at once if they share a Technique and Form and their levels add up to no more than her Lab Total. A spell's requisites count in the Lab Total too, and the lower Art is the one that counts.



Lab Work: Invent from a Lab Text, with Palm of Flame added under More Lab Texts. The foot reads "Lab Total 32 (Rego +5, Ignem (13+3) +16, Intelligence +3, Magic Theory +5, Aura (Magic 3) +3). Level 30, Lab Total 32: learned this season, Summer 1222."

Coat of Flame has a Rego requisite, so her Lab Total uses Rego 5 instead of Creo 9: Rego 5 + Ignem 16 + Intelligence 3 + Magic Theory 5 + aura 3 = 32. The two spells come to 25 + 5 = 30, so both fit in one season. (Inventive Genius doesn't help: it's only for work without a text.)

> **What happened.** At the end of Summer she knows *Coat of Flame* and *Palm of Flame*.

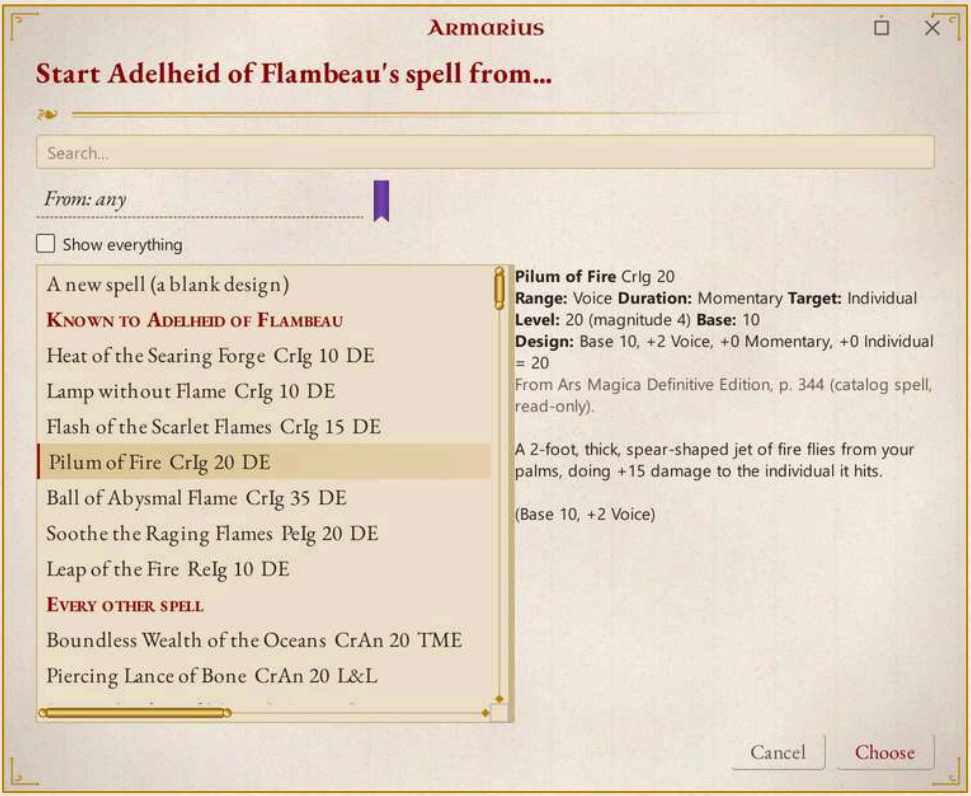
A magus can also learn spells from a teacher instead of a text: choose **Learn spells from a teacher**, the teacher (who must know them and spend his season teaching), and the **Spells taught**. The spells may be of any Arts, each within the teacher's Lab Totals and her own.

4. A spell of her own

Pilum of Fire is a fine spell, but only reaches as far as her voice. Adelheid wants one that hits anything she can see. Click **New Spell** in the Seasons chapter: it first asks what to **Start from**, with the spells she knows at the top, then every spell in the books in play, or a blank design.

The rule · DE pp. 251, 303

A new spell can copy one from the book, vary one, or be made up from the guidelines. To vary one, change its Range, Duration or Target and work out the new level from the guidelines: Pilum of Fire is base 10 +2 for Voice; Sight is +3, so the new spell is level 25.

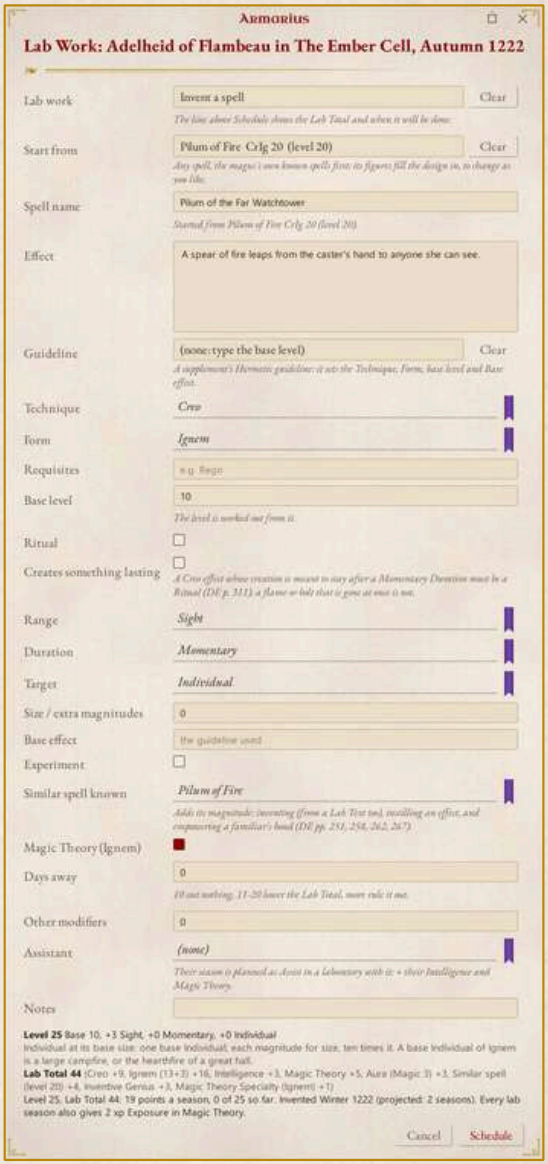


Start Adelheid of Flambeau's spell from...: "A new spell (a blank design)" first, then her own spells (Heat of the Searing Forge, Lamp without Flame, Flash of the Scarlet Flames, Pilum of Fire...), then every spell in the books in play, each with its Arts, level and book.

The form copies *Pilum of Fire*'s design. Change the **Spell name** and the **Range**, and the level follows. Then pick *Pilum of Fire* as the **Similar spell known**, and tick her Magic Theory specialty, Ignem, since it applies. Leave **Creates something lasting** unticked: a bolt of fire that's gone the moment it strikes leaves nothing behind (DE p. 344). Tick it only for a Creo spell meant to leave its creation standing once a Momentary Duration ends, such as a wall or a meal, and the form then reminds you that such a spell must be a Ritual (DE p. 311).

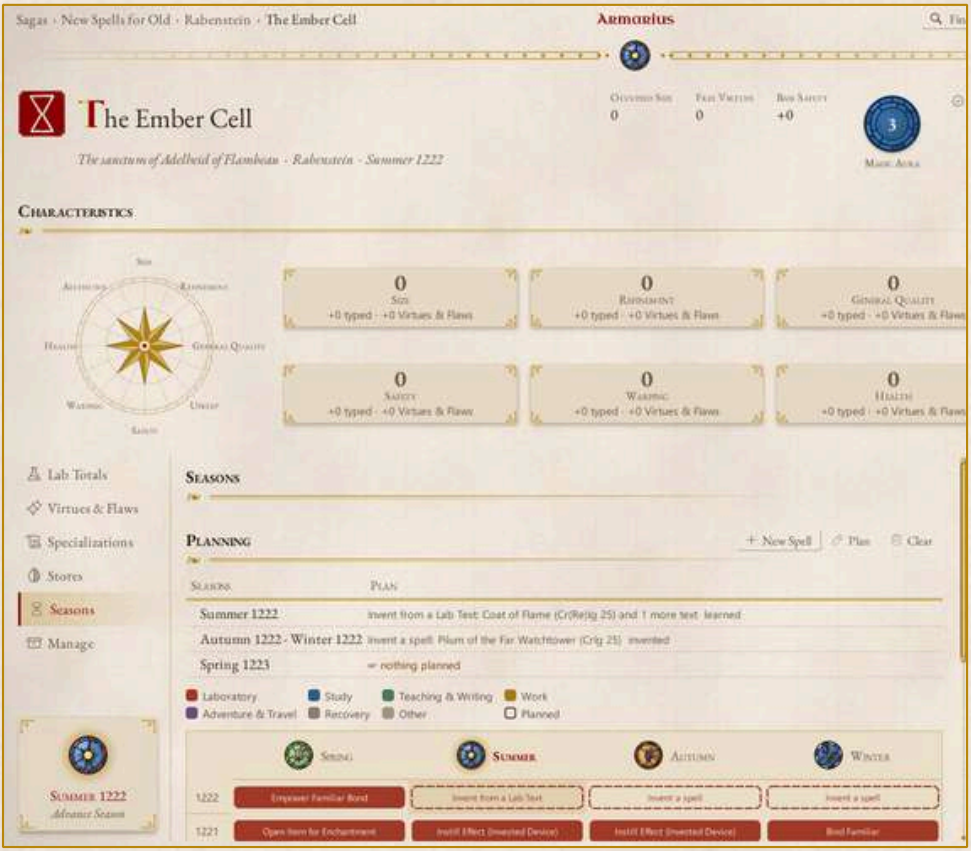
The rule · DE pp. 87, 157, 251, 260

Inventing a spell: for each point the Lab Total beats the level, bank a point a season; done when the bank reaches the level. Add the magnitude of the best similar spell she knows (same effect at another Range, Duration or Target), +1 for a specialty that applies, and Inventive Genius +3 when she works without a text.



Lab Work: Invent a spell, started from Pilum of Fire, Spell name "Pilum of the Far Watchtower", Range Sight. The foot reads "Level 25, Base 10, +3 Sight", then "Lab Total 44 (Creo +9, Ignem (13+3) +16, Intelligence +3, Magic Theory +5, Aura +3, Similar spell (level 20) +4, Inventive Genius +3, Magic Theory Specialty (Ignem) +1). Level 25, Lab Total 44: 19 points a season, 0 of 25 so far. Invented Winter 1222 (projected: 2 seasons)."

Creo 9 + Ignem 16 + Intelligence 3 + Magic Theory 5 + aura 3 + similar spell 4 + Inventive Genius 3 + specialty 1 = 44. That beats 25 by 19 a season, so it takes two: Autumn and Winter. **Schedule** it, and the app plans Winter too.



The Ember Cell's Planning: the Lab Texts in Summer, the new spell spanning Autumn to Winter.

5. Two seasons later

Advance Season through Autumn and Winter. Each time a lab season is applied, the app asks about **Interruptions**: days away from the laboratory, or the whole season lost. Leave them at nothing. After Autumn the spell is 19 of 25; after Winter it's done.

> **What happened.** Adelheid knows *Pilum of the Far Watchtower* (CrIg 25, Sight). Inventing it wrote a Lab Text in The Ember Cell, so anyone at Rabenstein can learn it in a season from now on (once they can read her notes: a magus's own Lab Texts are written raw), and each season in the lab gave her 2 xp of Magic Theory.

Rego	10	10	10	13	10	26	10	10	10	14

Certamen: Initiative +2, Attack Presence +0 + Art, Defence Perception +1 + the other Art, Weakening +5 + advantage, Resistance +3.

Known Spells (10) — + Add · Edit · Delete · Share Spell

Filter spells...

Spell	Arts	Level	Range	Duration	Target	Mastery	Shared
Ball of Abysmal Flame	CrIg	35	Voice	Momentary	Individual		
Pilum of the Far Watchtower	CrIg	25	Sight	Momentary	Individual		Not yet
Coat of Flame	Cr(Re)Ig	25	Voice	Diameter	Individual		
Soothe the Raging Flames	PeIg	20	Voice	Momentary	Individual		
Pilum of Fire	CrIg	20	Voice	Momentary	Individual		
Flash of the Scarlet Flames	CrIg	15	Voice	Momentary	Individual		
Leap of the Fire	ReIg	10	Voice	Momentary	Individual		
Lamp without Flame	CrIg	10	Touch	Concentration	Individual		

Her Known Spells, Spring 1223: Coat of Flame, Palm of Flame and Pilum of the Far Watchtower among them.

To share it, plan **Rewrite Lab Texts for general use** on her own sheet (Latin x 20 levels a season), or let another magus **Decode another magus's Lab Texts** in his own lab.

6. Mastering a spell

Pilum of Fire is the spell Adelheid casts in every fight, and she'd like to cast it faster and harder. Every spell has its own Mastery Ability, which grows like any other.

> **The rule · DE pp. 225-226**
>
> A magus adds her Mastery score in a spell to its Casting Score, and takes it off the botch dice; a mastered spell cast while relaxed has no botch dice at all. For each point of the score she picks one special ability for that spell: Fast Casting, Quick Casting, Penetration, Quiet or Still Casting, Multiple Casting, Magic Resistance against it, and more. Mastery is learned like an Ability: practice, books on the spell, a teacher.

On her **Planning** chapter, plan a season of **Practice** and choose **Mastery: Pilum of Fire** under Experience in. The list of Abilities in every study activity has a Mastery line for each spell she knows. Five xp gives Mastery 1.

Then, on her **Hermetic Magic** chapter, click *Pilum of Fire* in Known Spells and **Edit** it. The form keeps the spell's Mastery score and xp and its special abilities: she takes **Penetration**, which adds her Mastery score to her Penetration with it. The casting lines on the chapter read the special abilities by name.

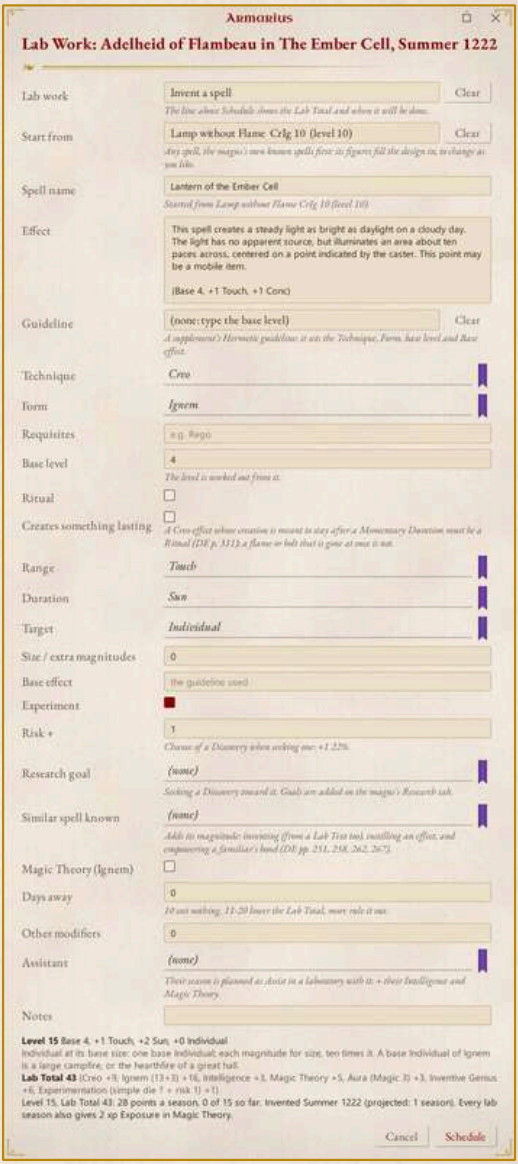
7. Experimenting

The safe way works, but it's slow. A magus who experiments adds a die to her Lab Total and takes her chances on the Extraordinary Results Chart.

The rule · DE pp. 274-276

You can experiment when inventing a spell, enchanting, binding a familiar or investigating an item, but never with a Lab Text. Add a simple die to the Lab Total, and optionally a risk modifier of +1 to +3, which is added to the chart roll too and adds as many botch dice. Each season, roll a stress die on the Extraordinary Results Chart: botch, a Disaster; 0-4 nothing odd; 5-6 a side effect; 7 no benefit (lose the die); 8 complete failure (the season is wasted); 9 a special result or story; 10 a Discovery; 11 a modified effect; 12+ roll twice more.

Adelheid wants a lantern that burns from dawn to dusk: *Lamp without Flame* at Sun duration. Click **New Spell**, start from *Lamp without Flame*, rename it *Lantern of the Ember Cell* and set Duration to **Sun**. Then tick **Experiment** and set **Risk +** to 1.



Lab Work: Invent a spell, "Lantern of the Ember Cell", Duration Sun, Experiment ticked, Risk + 1. The foot reads "Level 15", then "Lab Total 43 (Creo +9, Ignem (13+3) +16, Intelligence +3, Magic Theory +5, Aura +3, Inventive Genius +6, Experimentation (simple die ? + risk 1) +1). Level 15, Lab Total 43: 28 points a season."

The die is rolled when the season is advanced, and so is the chart. Anything that needs the storyguide's word, like what a side effect actually is, is asked in Advance Season's **Experiment Results** step; the rest the app applies and writes in the Diary. A Disaster's Warping, wounds and lab Flaws, a creation destroyed, a Discovery's xp: all done for you.

> **What happened.** Our Lantern came out with a side effect, and the storyguide rolled a fatal flaw: it lights up her face as well, so she can't sneak anywhere with it. The spell keeps it "warts and all": it's listed under the spell as an experimental effect, on her copy and on anyone's learned from its Lab Text. If you leave a side effect's description blank in Experiment Results, Edit the spell later and use **Experimental effects** to describe it.

A flawed spell can be invented again in a later season, with her Magic Theory added a second time to the Lab Total (DE p. 274). Plan it as a normal invention and type the Magic Theory she experimented with in **Recreating a flawed experiment: Magic Theory then**: it's added to the Lab Total again.

8. Original research and breakthroughs

Adelheid has an idea. A Flambeau's fire only reaches what she can see; but what if a spell could follow a thread of flame back to an Arcane Connection? That's not a new spell, it's a new piece of Hermetic theory: a Breakthrough.

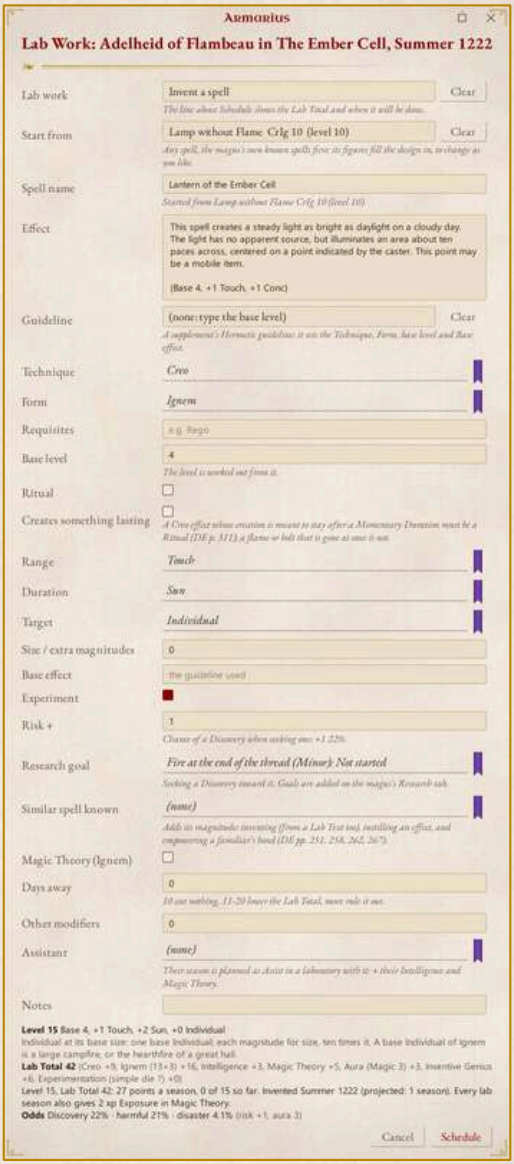
> **The rule · DE pp. 277-279**
>
> A Minor Breakthrough (a new Range, Duration or Target) needs about 30 breakthrough points, a Major one about 45, a Hermetic one, breaking a Limit of Magic, about 60; the troupe agrees the goal first. You seek it by experimenting on a spell or enchantment, hoping for a Discovery on the chart. The risk modifier isn't added to the Lab Total but used to move the chart roll up or down, +1 for every 5 points of Magic Theory (at most +3). A Discovery must then be stabilized by repeating the experiment exactly; any result but a harmful one stabilizes it, adds its magnitude in breakthrough points, and gives Warping Points equal to its magnitude less a simple die. Each spell gives one Discovery at most.

On her sheet, choose **Research** in the rail and click **Add** under Research Goals. Name the goal (*Fire at the end of the thread*), choose **Breakthrough**: Minor (30 points), and what **Reaching it grants**: a new Range, Duration or Target, here a range that follows a fire-linked Arcane Connection. **Keep the target secret** if your storyguide wants to hide the exact number, as the book suggests. The **Integration** list fills in the goals the supplements name (Ancient Magic, Hedge Magic, True Lineages) if you'd rather take one of those.



Add Research Goal: Goal "Fire at the end of the thread", Breakthrough Minor (30 points), Reaching it grants "A new Range, Duration or Target".

Now plan the Lantern again, Experiment ticked, and choose the goal under **Research goal**. The risk drops off the Lab Total, and the line at the foot adds the odds.



Lab Work: the same Lantern with Research goal "Fire at the end of the thread (Minor): Not started". The foot reads "Lab Total 42 (... Inventive Genius +6, Experimentation (simple die ?) +0)" and "Odds: Discovery 22% · harmful 21% · disaster 4.1%".

If the roll comes within the risk of 10, Advance Season asks whether to move it there: take it, and the Discovery comes *as well as* the roll's own result. Once there's a Discovery, plan **Stabilize a Discovery**: it repeats the experiment's Lab Total, seasons, vis, risk and move. The **Research** chapter keeps every season in its Research Log with its roll drawn on the chart, and each goal as a card with the road to it drawn underneath: goal agreed, seek, discovery, stabilize, breakthrough.

> **What happened.** This season the chart said side effect, not Discovery: the Research Log has its first line, "6: a side effect (fatal flaw)", and the goal reads 0 of 30, seeking. *Lantern of the Ember Cell* has given its one chance; next time she'll need a different spell to experiment with.

Seek an insight (a season studying a hedge wizard's text, relic or teacher) is the other road: Intelligence + Magic Theory + a stress die against 18, +3 with Inventive Genius.

9. A Magical Focus

Adelheid has no Magical Focus, but plenty of magi do, and it's one of the biggest numbers in the game, so it's worth seeing how the app handles one.

The rule · DE pp. 94, 98-99

A Major Magical Focus covers an area smaller than an Art (weather, necromancy, birds); a Minor one something slightly narrower than one Technique and Form (healing, self-transformation). Within it, add the lowest applicable Art twice when casting or working out a Lab Total. A magus can have only one Magical Focus.

When a magus has one, record **The Arts it spans** on the Virtue (Edit it on Virtues & Flaws). The lab work form then applies the focus **By its Arts**: any work whose Technique and Form, or a requisite, fall inside them counts, and the lower Art counted again may be a requisite's (DE p. 94). For a focus narrower than its Arts, such as birds within Animal, choose otherwise on the form: whether a bird is involved is the troupe's call.

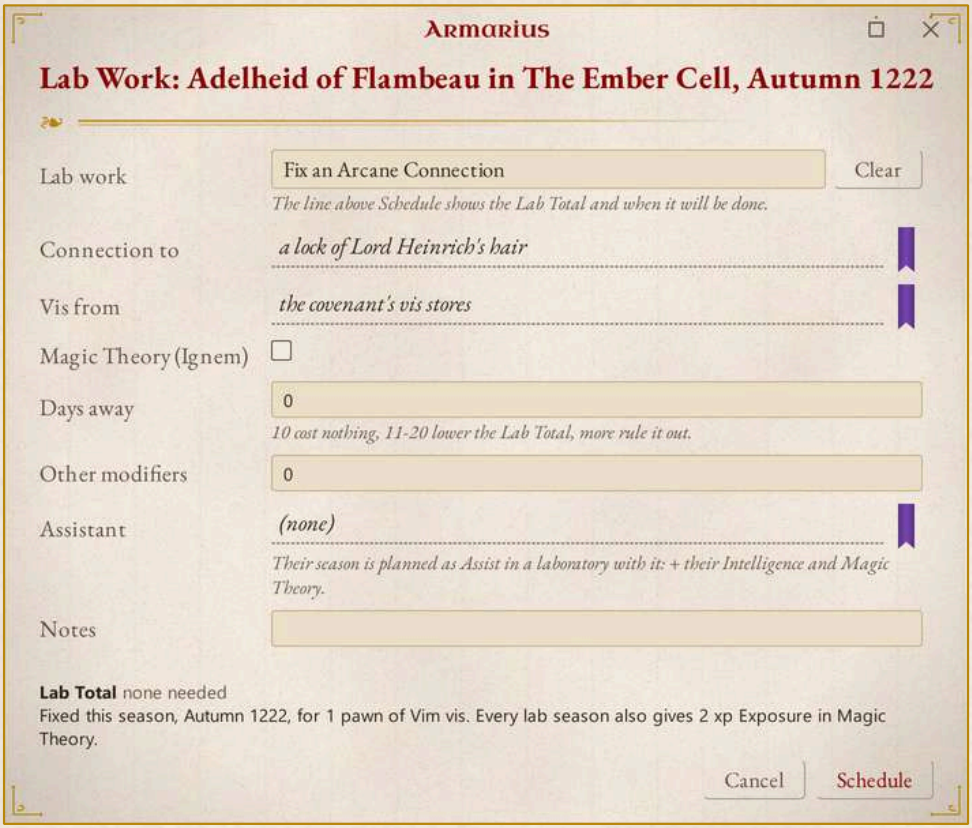
10. Arcane Connections

A lock of hair, a drop of blood, a stone from a man's hearth: an Arcane Connection lets a spell reach him wherever he is. Most fade within weeks, unless a magus fixes them.

The rule · DE pp. 219, 250

A magus with an active Arcane Connection can make it permanent with a season of laboratory work and a pawn of Vim vis. The connection must be active at the start of the season. It isn't based on a Lab Total.

Sir Aimery's men brought back a lock of Lord Heinrich of Falkenstein's hair after a quarrel at the ford. In The Ember Cell's **Stores** chapter, under **Arcane Connections**, click **Add**: say what it connects to and how long it lasts. Then plan a season of **Fix an Arcane Connection**, choose the connection, and say where the pawn of Vim comes from under **Vis from**.



Lab Work: Fix an Arcane Connection, Connection to "a lock of Lord Heinrich's hair", Vis from the covenant's vis stores.

If the store you choose has no Vim, the form says so in red ("Fixing an Arcane Connection takes 1 pawn of Vim vis; the laboratory's raw vis has none") and won't schedule it until you pick another.

> **What happened.** When the season is applied, the pawn of Vim is spent and the connection is marked fixed: it'll be there, on the shelf, when Rabenstein needs it. (In *War*, it does.)

What you do by hand

- **What counts as similar** (DE p. 260) is the troupe's call: the app takes the spell you choose and adds its magnitude.
- **A narrow Magical Focus**: when a focus covers less than its Arts, say on the form whether each piece of work falls inside it.
- **What a side effect or special result is**: the storyguide describes it in Experiment Results, or later on the spell.

Where the rules come from

Ars Magica Definitive Edition: Major Magical Focus (p. 94); Ritual spells (p. 311); Pilum of Fire (p. 344); Minor Magical Focus (p. 98); Inventive Genius (p. 87); specialties (p. 157); Arcane Connections (p. 219); Spell Mastery and its special abilities (pp. 225-226); the basic Lab Total (p. 249); vis limits and fixing Arcane Connections (p. 250); inventing spells (pp. 251-252); similar spells (p. 260); Laboratory Texts (p. 262); Arcane Experimentation and the Extraordinary Results Chart (pp. 274-276); Arcane Discovery, breakthroughs and stabilizing (pp. 277-279); changing Range, Duration and Target (p. 303); requisites (p. 311); Pilum of Fire (p. 344).



Armarius

A saga manager for Ars Magica

Enchantments

An oak wand that throws fire, the wand made Adelheid's talisman, and a fire-feathered falcon bound by three cords.

Guide 5 of 17

Sooner or later every magus wants an enchanted item. And sooner or later most of them want a friend: a magical beast bound to them for life. Both are lab work, both run on the same rules for putting magic into things, and both are fiddly by the book, with capacities, effect levels, uses per day, cords, Lab Totals and vis. That's where Armarius earns its keep.

This guide follows **Adelheid of Flambeau** through her first enchantments at Rabenstein, 1221 to 1223. She makes the obvious thing for a Flambeau, a wand that throws fire, then makes it her talisman, and binds **Scintilla**, a falcon whose feathers glow like embers, as her familiar.

The rules are the *Ars Magica Definitive Edition*'s (DE) chapter eight: Enchanting (pp. 253-260), Talisman Attunement (pp. 259-260), Familiars (pp. 265-268), and the Shape and Material Bonuses table (p. 285).

Three kinds of item · DE p. 253

An Invested Device is opened for enchantment with Vim vis first, and can then hold several effects. A Lesser Enchantment needs no opening but takes one effect, made in one season with a Lab Total at least twice its level. A Charged Item costs no vis but runs out. Adelheid goes for the real thing: an invested device.

1. Her own laboratory

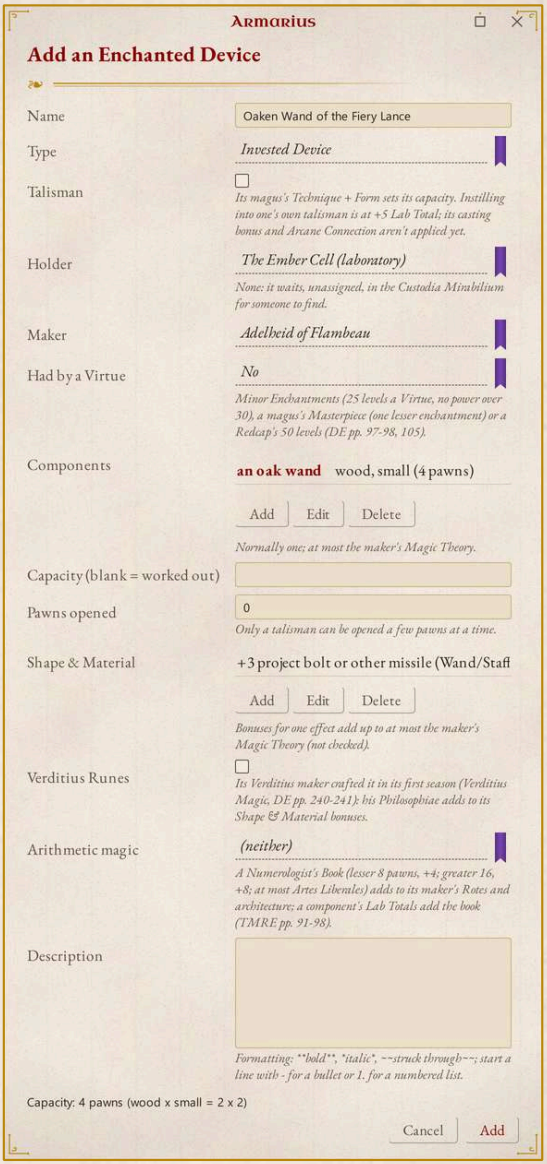
Lab work happens in a laboratory, and since the Spring Adelheid has one of her own: **The Ember Cell**, a plain new lab at Rabenstein (aura 3). Everything below is on its page. Its **Stores** chapter keeps its raw vis, Lab Texts and Enchanted Devices; its **Seasons** chapter is where lab work gets planned. (*The Laboratory* has the rest of a lab's page.)

2. The wand

First the object itself. In Stores, under **Enchanted Devices**, click **Add**. Name it, say it's an **Invested Device** and who made it, then add a component (what it's made of and how big) and any Shape & Material bonus it gives. The app works out how much vis it holds.

The rule · DE pp. 253-255, 285

Opening an invested device costs pawns of Vim vis equal to its material x size: wood is 2, a small thing (a wand, a dagger) x2, so an oak wand takes 4 pawns, and it can then hold 4 pawns' worth of effects. A wand or staff gives +3 to projecting a bolt or missile, and any shape and material bonus is capped at your Magic Theory.



Add an Enchanted Device: "Oaken Wand of the Fiery Lance", Invested Device, made by Adelheid of Flambeau, one component "an oak wand", wood, small, and a Shape & Material bonus of +3 to "project bolt or other missile". The line at the foot reads "Capacity: 4 pawns (wood x small = 2 x 2)".

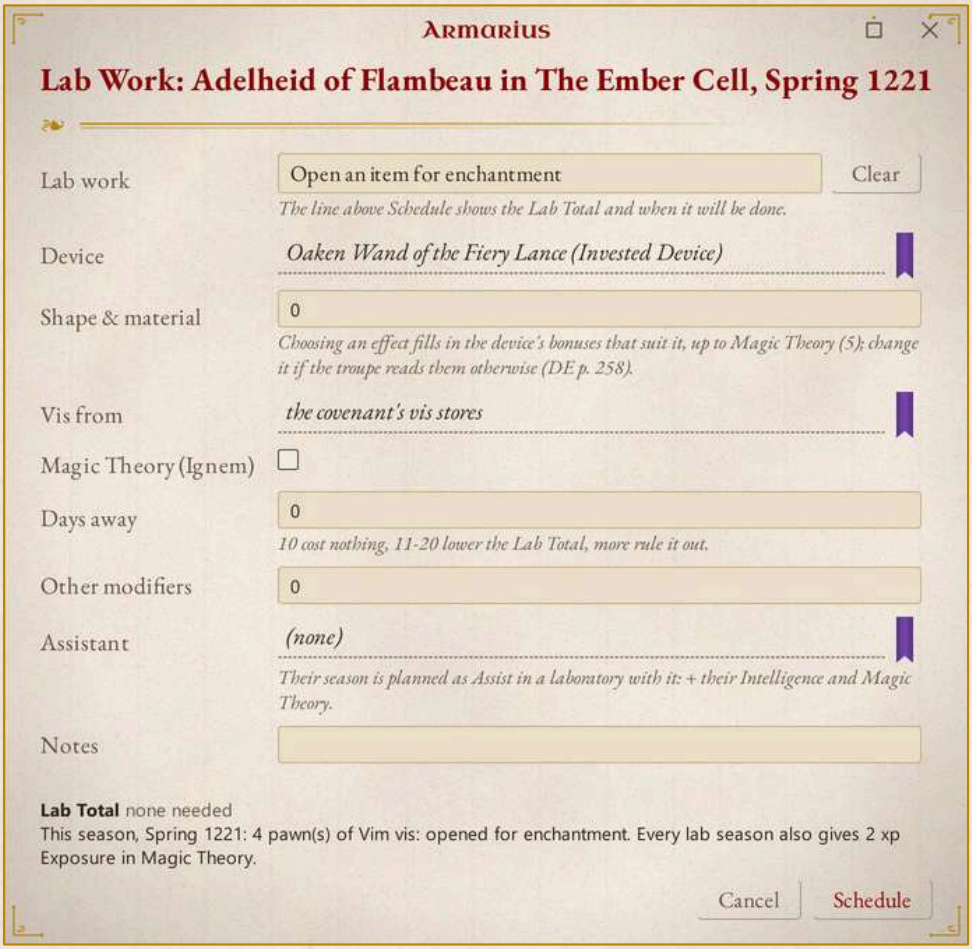


The Ember Cell's Stores, Spring 1221: the Oaken Wand of the Fiery Lance in Enchanted Devices, "Invested, Opening 0/4, 0 effects", not yet opened.

3. Spring 1221: opening it

Open the laboratory's **Seasons** chapter, click Spring 1221 in the Planning list and click **Plan**. Choose **Open an item for enchantment**, the wand, and whose vis pays: here, Rabenstein's stores.

> **The rule · DE pp. 250, 254**
>
> Opening takes a season and the Vim vis, and needs no Lab Total. A magus can't handle more than twice his Magic Theory in pawns of vis in one season.



Lab Work: Adelheid of Flambeau in The Ember Cell, Spring 1221: Open an item for enchantment, the Oaken Wand, vis from the covenant's vis stores. The foot reads "Lab Total none needed. This season, Spring 1221: 4 pawn(s) of Vim vis: opened for enchantment. Every lab season also gives 2 xp Exposure in Magic Theory."

Click **Schedule**, then click the **Advance Season** card at the foot of the chapters when Spring's stories are done. The vis comes out of the covenant's stores, Adelheid gets her 2 xp of Magic Theory for the lab season, and the wand shows as opened.

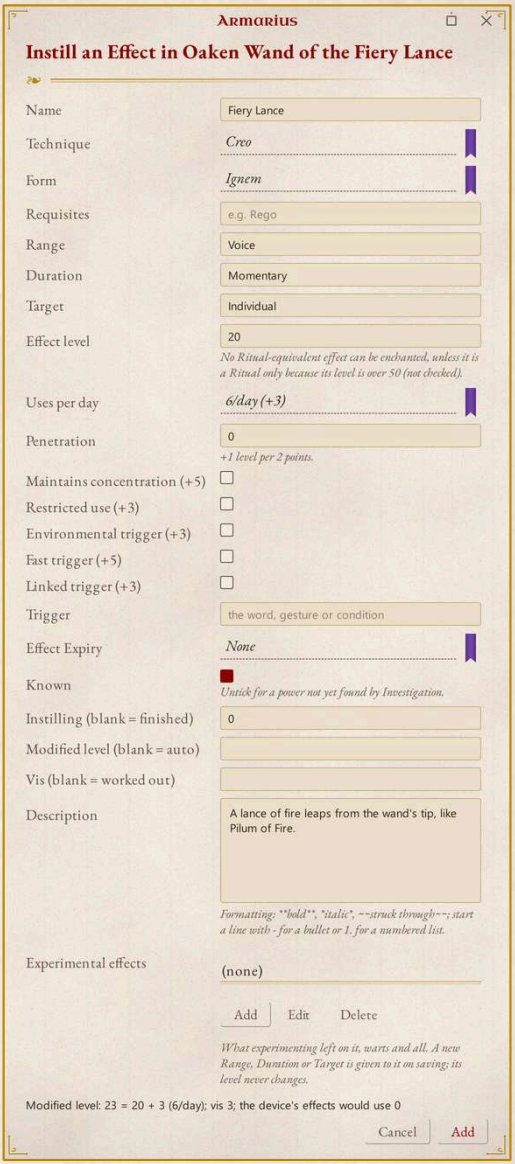
What happened. The Oaken Wand of the Fiery Lance is open: room for 4 pawns of effects.

4. Designing the effect

Click the wand's row and **Instill**. This is the effect's design, worked out like a spell: Arts, Range, Duration, Target and level, plus what only devices have, like uses per day and triggers. Set **Instilling** to 0 so the app knows it's still to be made.

The rule · DE pp. 256-258

An effect is designed like a spell (Adelheid copies Pilum of Fire, CrIg 20: base 10, +2 Voice, p. 344). Then add its options: uses per day (1 is free, 2 +1, 3 +2, 6 +3, 12 +4, 24 +5, unlimited +10), Penetration (+2 for each level added), concentration (+5), triggers (environmental +3, linked +3, fast +5). Each 10 levels or part of the result costs a pawn of vis of its Technique or Form.



Instill an Effect in Oaken Wand of the Fiery Lance: Fiery Lance, Creo Ignem, Voice, Momentary, Individual, Effect level 20, 6/day (+3), Instilling 0. The line at the foot reads "Modified level: 23 = 20 + 3 (6/day); vis 3; the device's effects would use 0".

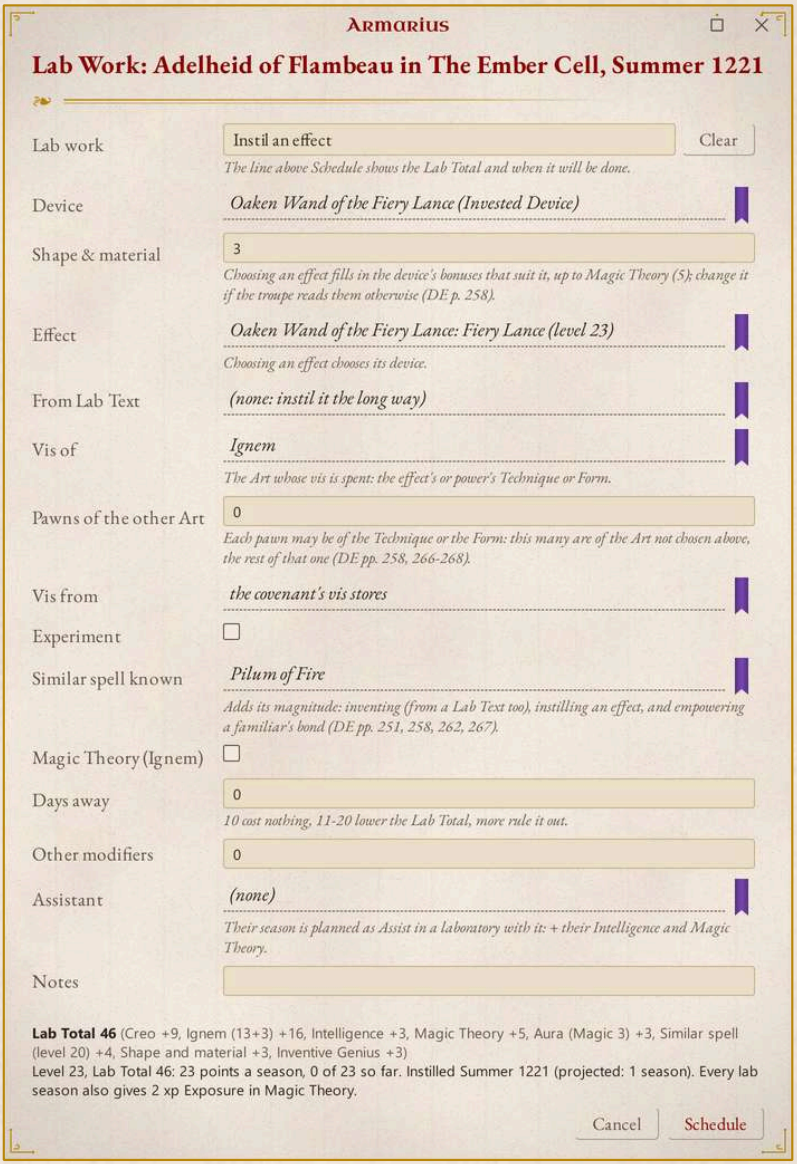
What happened. Modified level 23 (20, +3 for six uses a day): 3 pawns of vis, which fits in the wand's 4.

5. Summer: instilling it

Back in Seasons, plan Summer 1221: **Instil an effect**, choose the Fiery Lance, and pick the vis. You needn't wait for Spring to be played: a season ahead is checked against the wand as the Spring's opening will leave it. Choosing the effect fills in **Shape & material** with the wand's bonuses that suit it, here its +3 to project a bolt (up to her Magic Theory; change it if your troupe reads the bonuses otherwise). Pick *Pilum of Fire* as the **Similar spell known**. The line at the foot adds up the Lab Total and says how long it'll take.

The rule · DE p. 258

Lab Total = Technique + Form + Intelligence + Magic Theory + aura, plus shape and material, +1 for each effect already in the device sharing an Art, and the magnitude of a similar spell you know. Each season you bank the amount by which the Lab Total beats the modified level; when the bank reaches the level, it's done. The vis is paid in the first season.



Lab Work: Instil an effect. The foot reads "Lab Total 46 (Creo +9, Ignem (13+3) +16, Intelligence +3, Magic Theory +5, Aura (Magic 3) +3, Similar spell (level 20) +4, Shape and material +3, Inventive Genius +3). Level 23, Lab Total 46: 23 points a season, 0 of 23 so far. Instilled Summer 1221 (projected: 1 season). Every lab season also gives 2 xp Exposure in Magic Theory."

Creo 9 + Ignem 16 (13 and Puissant's 3) + Intelligence 3 + Magic Theory 5 + aura 3 + *Pilum of Fire*'s 4 magnitudes + the wand's 3 + Inventive Genius 3 (p. 87) = 46. That beats 23 by 23, enough in a single season.

Advance Season. The app asks if anything interrupted the work (days away from the lab cost points).

> **What happened.** At the end of Summer the Fiery Lance is instilled: 23 points banked against 23. The wand holds 3 of its 4 pawns, and a Lab Text of the effect appears in the lab's Stores, so it can be made again more easily.



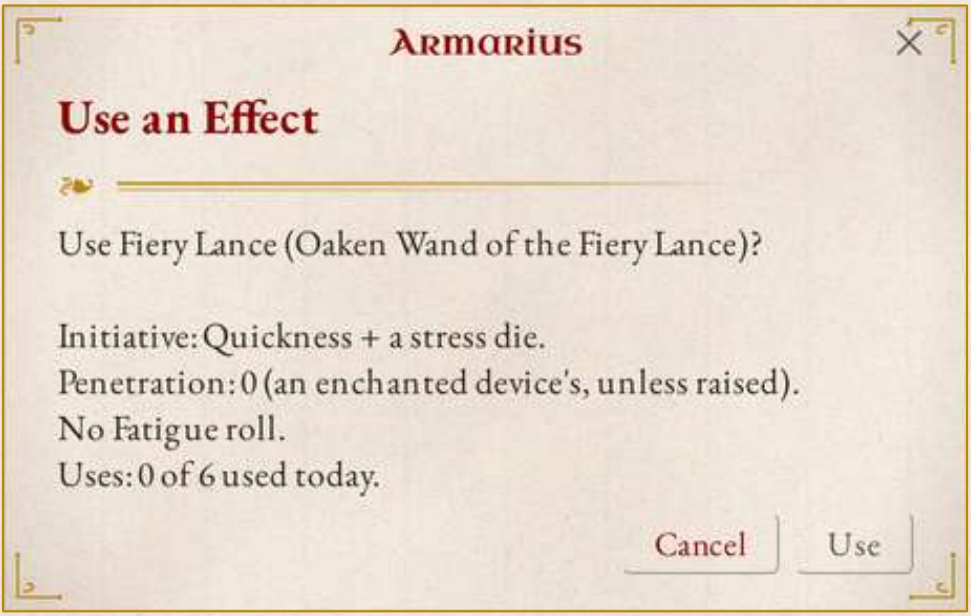
The Ember Cell's Stores in Winter 1221: the wand "Invested, Opened 4/4, 1 effect" with Fiery Lance (CrIg 20, 6/day) under it, and the Lab Text "Fiery Lance (Oaken Wand of the Fiery Lance)", level 23, by Adelheid of Flambeau.

6. Using the wand

Click the effect and **Use**, and the app reminds you how it works at the table: its Initiative, its Penetration, and how many uses are left today.

The rule · DE p. 259

A device's effect goes off at Quickness + a stress die for Initiative, has Penetration 0 unless levels were added for it, and costs no Fatigue. Its range is measured from the device. Advancing the season gives every device its uses back.



Use an Effect: "Use Fiery Lance (Oaken Wand of the Fiery Lance)?", Initiative: Quickness + a stress die, Penetration 0 (an enchanted device's, unless raised), no Fatigue roll, and "Uses: 0 of 6 used today."

> **What happened.** Adelheid has a wand that throws a *Pilum of Fire* six times a day, made in two seasons with 4 pawns of Vim and 3 of Ignem. It has a pawn of room left for another effect.

Lesser enchantments and **charged items** are made the same way, from the same Add: choose the type, then plan **Make a lesser enchantment** or **Make a charged item** in the lab. A lesser enchantment needs no opening but its Lab Total must be twice the effect's level; charged items cost no vis and run out (**Use Charge** counts them down). **Investigate an enchanted item** finds another magus's powers, weakest first, with your Intellego Vim Lab Total and a stress die each try (DE p. 260).

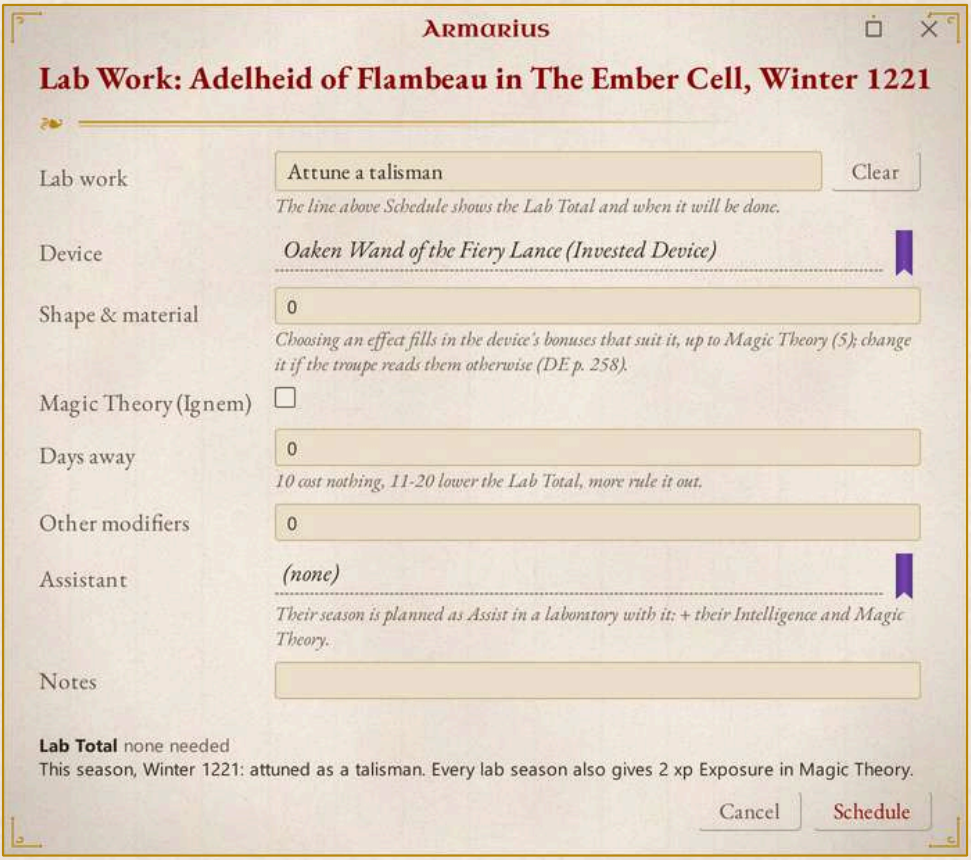
7. The wand becomes her talisman

A talisman is a magus's own item, so bound to her that it's part of her. Adelheid made the wand from start to finish herself, so it qualifies.

The rule · DE pp. 259-260

You can attune only an item you prepared yourself, with no effects instilled by anyone else; it takes a season, whatever the Lab Total, and you can have only one talisman at a time. While you touch it, it's part of you (Personal range reaches it, your Magic Resistance covers it), and it's always an Arcane Connection to you. Its capacity becomes your highest Technique + highest Form, and it can be opened a little at a time. You get +5 to Lab Totals instilling it, and nobody else can. Each time you open it or instill an effect, you may add one attunement from the Shape and Material table, which adds its bonus to your Casting Scores while you touch it; only the highest applies.

Plan **Attune a talisman** in The Ember Cell, with the wand. It needs no Lab Total; the foot says "attuned as a talisman". If the wand had an effect someone else instilled, or another magus had prepared it, the form would refuse.



Lab Work: Attune a talisman, the Oaken Wand of the Fiery Lance (Invested Device). The foot reads "Lab Total none needed. This season, Winter 1221: attuned as a talisman. Every lab season also gives 2 xp Exposure in Magic Theory."

> **What happened.** The wand is Adelheid's talisman, listed first among her devices and named on her Hermetic Magic chapter. Its capacity is now her highest Technique and Form, Creo 9 + Ignem 13 = 22 pawns, of which 4 are open; plan **Open an item for enchantment** again to open more, a pawn or a few at a time. Instilling it from now on adds +5 to her Lab Total.

Its attunements come with the work. On any season that opens the talisman further or instills an effect in it, the plan offers **Attune the talisman to**: choose one of the Shape & Material bonuses it doesn't have yet, and when the season is played it joins the wand's attunements, dated. Adelheid takes the wand's own "+3 to project a bolt or missile" when she next opens it. Her casting lines on the Hermetic Magic chapter list a talisman's attunements, best first.

8. Scintilla: finding the falcon

A familiar is a magus's best friend: a magical beast bound to her by three mystical cords, which shares her long life and lends her its strengths. Adelheid met hers on the Swabian Alb in the autumn of 1221.

This part is all story. The animal has to have magic in it (a Magic Might), and it has to like the magus as much as she likes it: no charms, no coercion. Play it at the table; the app comes in once the falcon has said yes.

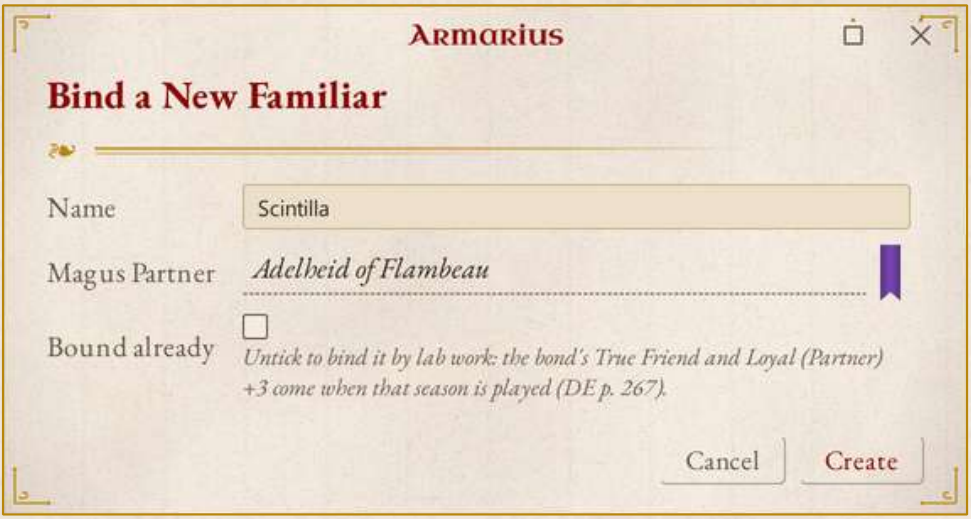
The rule · DE pp. 265-266

A familiar must have inherent magic, and must trust the magus freely. The bond is made with a Technique and a Form that fit the animal or its powers: a falcon's keen eyes suit Intellego, which fits animals with sharp senses, its glowing plumage Ignem, which fits shining creatures, and any bird Auram.

On Adelheid's sheet, the **Description** chapter has a dotted **Bind Familiar** card in its Familiar section. Click it, name the familiar, untick **Bound already** (that's for a familiar bound before play) and **Create**: Adelheid will bind her in the laboratory.



Adelheid's Description chapter: the dotted Bind Familiar card ("Bind one: the familiar is shown here.") in its Familiar section, under her Hermetic Background.



Bind a New Familiar: Scintilla, with Adelheid of Flambeau as Magus Partner and Bound already unticked.

9. Describing Scintilla

Scintilla gets a page of her own. Click **Edit** in her header for her species, Magic Might and Size, which the binding needs, and Characteristics for the rest. We started from the Bestiary's falcon (DE p. 432) and gave her a Magic Might of 10.



Scintilla's page, Identity & Cords: Size -3, Base Soak 2, Magic Might 10, a falcon's Characteristics (Perception +3, Strength -6, Quickness +6), no binding yet, and the three cords still at +0.

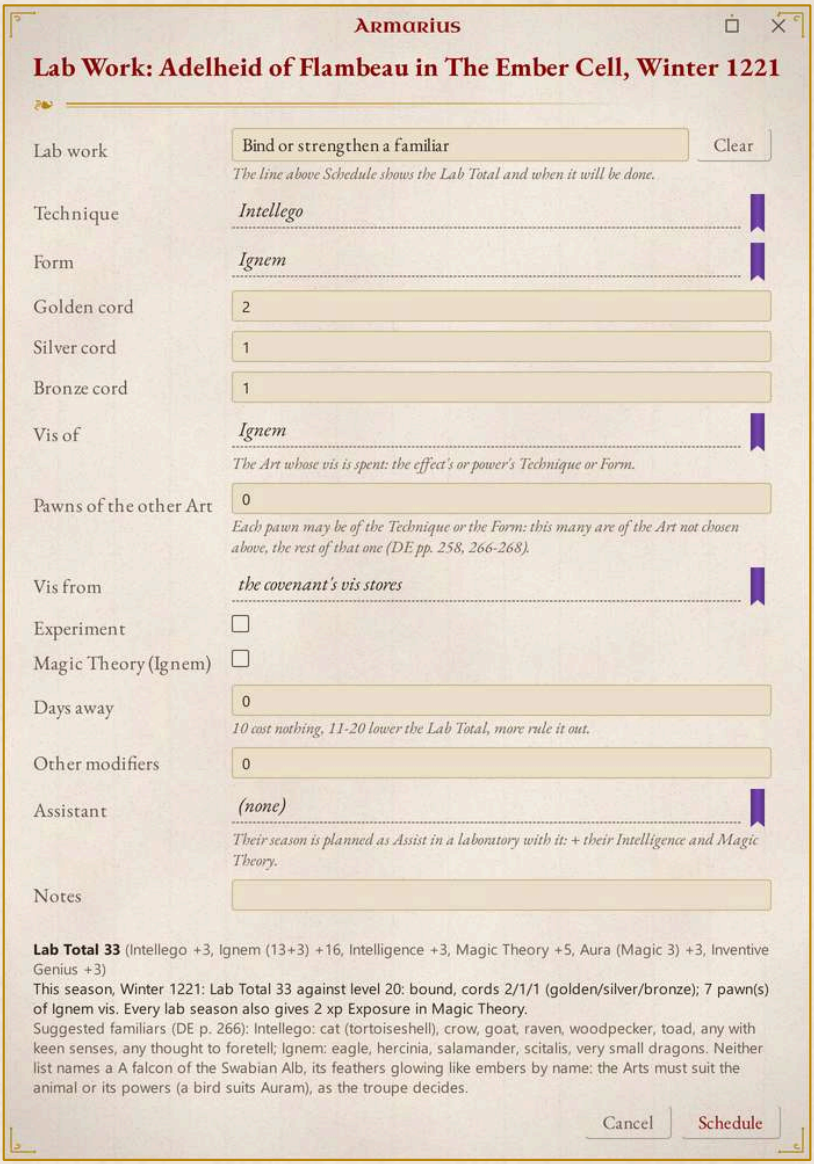
10. Planning the binding

Binding is a season of lab work. Open The Ember Cell's **Seasons** chapter, click Winter 1221 and **Plan**, and choose **Bind or strengthen a familiar**. Pick the Technique and Form, and the three cords you want.

The rule · DE pp. 266-267

Lab Total = any fitting Technique + any fitting Form + Intelligence + Magic Theory + aura. The binding's level is 25 + Magic Might + 5 x Size, and the Lab Total must reach it. The Lab Total also buys the three cords, 0 to +5 each, at 5, 15, 30, 50 and 75 points. The vis is one pawn per five points of Lab Total, of the Technique or Form used.

Scintilla's level is 25 + 10 - 15 = 20. Adelheid's best Lab Total would be Creo Ignem, 39, but Creo is for builders and rejuvenators, not falcons, so she binds her with Intellego Ignem: Intellego 3 + Ignem 16 + Intelligence 3 + Magic Theory 5 + aura 3 + Inventive Genius 3 = 33. That's enough for a Golden Cord of +2 (15 points), Silver +1 (5) and Bronze +1 (5): 25 of her 33.



Lab Work, Winter 1221: Bind or strengthen a familiar, Intellego and Ignem, cords 2, 1 and 1, Ignem vis from the covenant's vis stores. The foot reads "Lab Total 33 (Intellego +3, Ignem (13+3) +16, Intelligence +3, Magic Theory +5, Aura (Magic 3) +3, Inventive Genius +3). This season, Winter 1221: Lab Total 33 against level 20: bound, cords 2/1/1 (golden/silver/bronze); 7 pawn(s) of Ignem vis. Every lab season also gives 2 xp Exposure in Magic Theory.", then lists the familiars the book suggests for Intellego and Ignem.

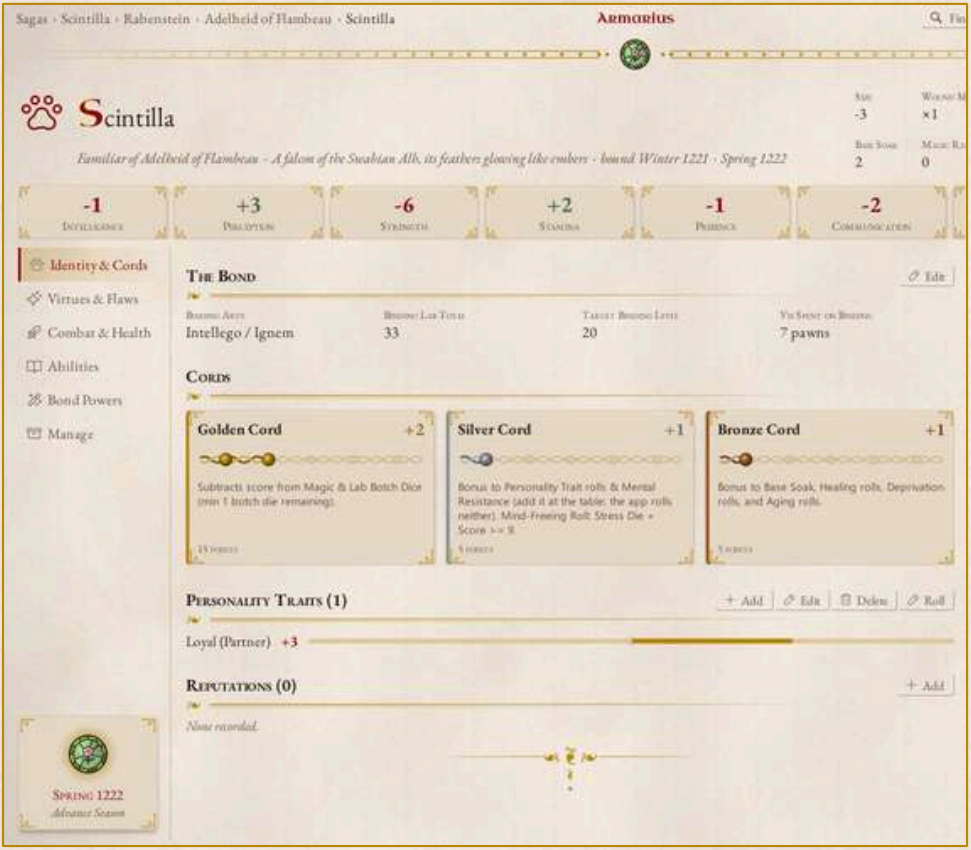
The three cords · DE p. 267

Golden: fewer botch dice with magic. Silver: a bonus to Personality rolls and to resisting mental influence, and the familiar can try to free a magus whose mind is taken. Bronze: a bonus to Soak, healing, deprivation and aging rolls.

What happened. Seven pawns of Ignem from the covenant's stores.
Her Magic Theory counts as 5 with Puissant Magic Theory, so she can handle up to ten pawns in a season (DE p. 250).

11. Bound

Advance Season, and the binding's done. Scintilla's **Identity & Cords** chapter shows the bond: the Arts, the Lab Total, the level, the vis and the three cords, each with what it does at the table.



Scintilla's Identity & Cords, bound Winter 1221: Intellego / Ignem, Lab Total 33, target level 20, 7 pawns, her cords at +2, +1 and +1 (15, 5 and 5 points), and Loyal (Partner) +3.

The rule · DE p. 267

Binding gives both partners the Minor Virtue True Friend and Loyal (Partner) +3. The familiar won't die of old age while the magus lives, gains human intelligence if it lacked it, shares her languages, and each is an Arcane Connection to the other.

What happened. Scintilla is Adelheid's familiar. The binding season gave both True Friend and Loyal (Partner) +3, and Adelheid's Description chapter shows Scintilla's card where Bind Familiar used to be.

The cords work for her from now on. The Bronze Cord is added to her aging and recovery rolls. The Golden Cord takes as many dice off the botch dice of her casting, never to none. The Silver Cord is added when she rolls with **Roll**, beside her Personality Traits (and Scintilla's): a Personality Trait roll, resisting mental influence, or Scintilla freeing her mind when it's overcome, a stress die + the Silver Cord against 9, one try a day.



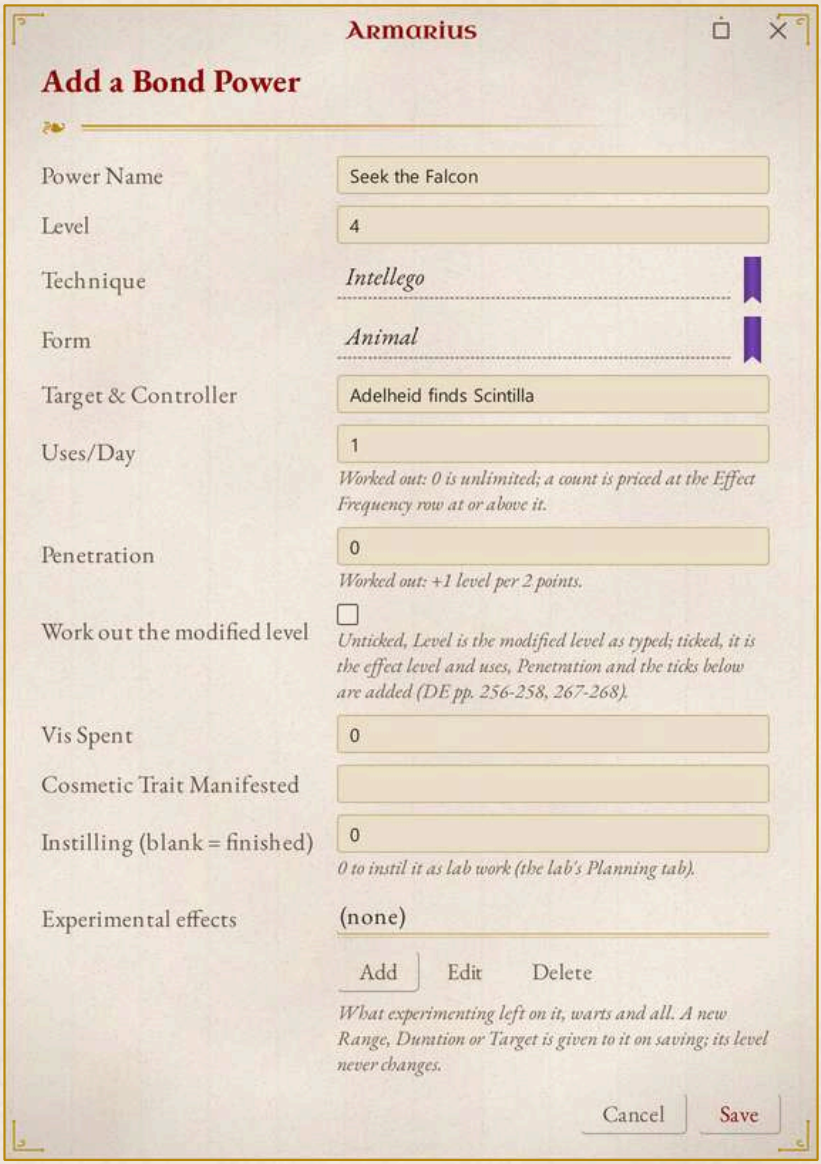
Adelheid's Familiar section now: Scintilla's card, "Magic Might 10 · 1 Bond Powers", and Loyal (Partner) +3 among her Personality Traits.

12. A power for the bond

The bond can hold powers, instilled much like an effect in an enchanted device. A simple first one: *Seek the Falcon*, so Adelheid always knows where Scintilla is. In Scintilla's **Bond Powers** chapter, click **Add** and type it in with Instilling at 0.

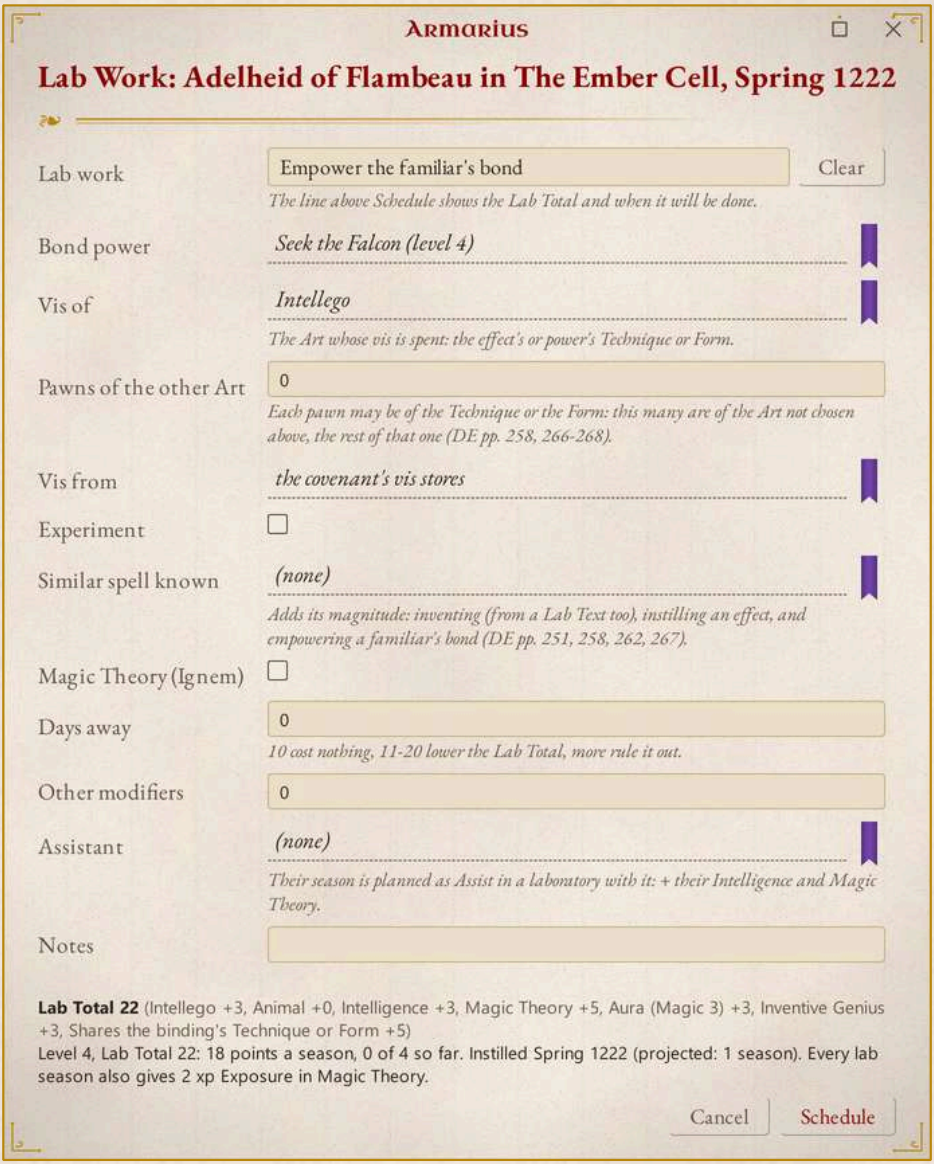
The rule · DE pp. 267-268

Bond powers follow the rules for instilling an effect, but there's no limit to how many, they only affect the magus or the familiar, and the Lab Total gets +5 if the power shares the binding's Technique or Form (+10 if both). The book's own example, finding the partner, is Intellego Animal: base 3, +1 magnitude for Touch, level 4. Vis is a pawn per 10 levels.



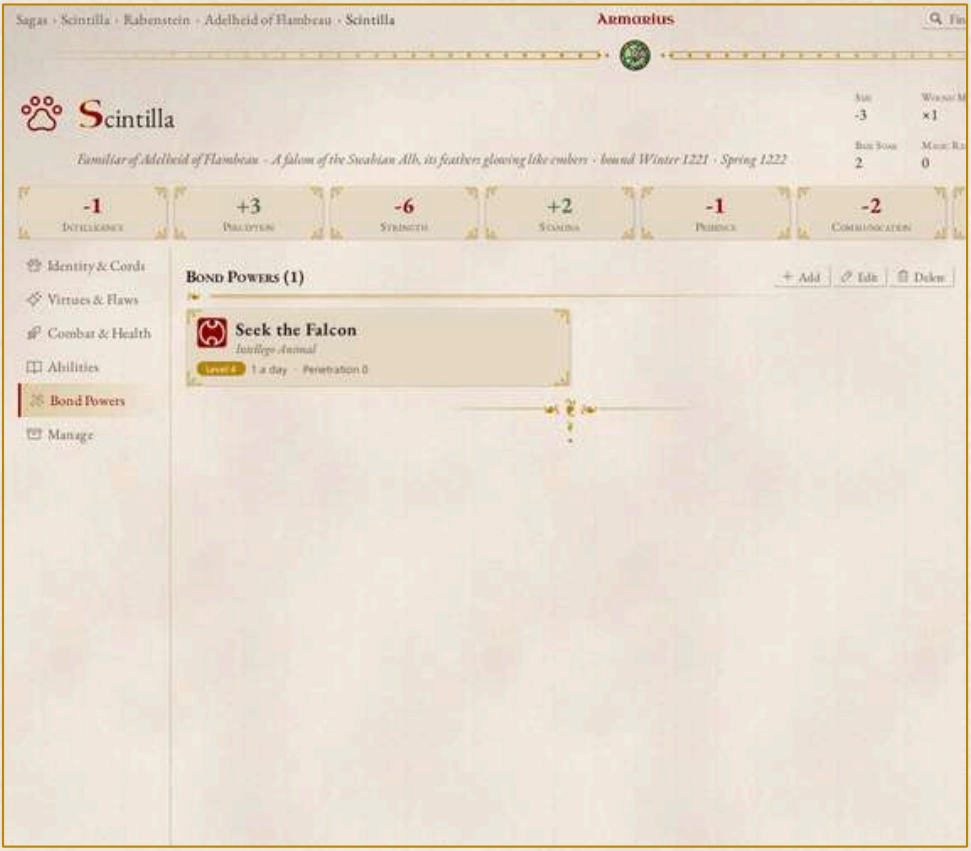
Add a Bond Power: Seek the Falcon, level 4, Intellego Animal, "Adelheid finds Scintilla", once a day, Instilling 0.

Then plan it in the lab: **Empower the familiar's bond**, the power, and its vis. Intellego 3 + Animal 0 + Intelligence 3 + Magic Theory 5 + aura 3 + Inventive Genius 3 + 5 for sharing the binding's Intellego = 22: one season, and a pawn of Intellego.



Lab Work, Spring 1222: Empower the familiar's bond, Seek the Falcon (level 4), Intellego vis. The foot reads "Lab Total 22 (Intellego +3, Animal +0, Intelligence +3, Magic Theory +5, Aura (Magic 3) +3, Inventive Genius +3, Shares the binding's Technique or Form +5). Level 4, Lab Total 22: 18 points a season, 0 of 4 so far. Instilled Spring 1222 (projected: 1 season). Every lab season also gives 2 xp Exposure in Magic Theory."

What happened. *Seek the Falcon* is in the bond. Advancing Spring 1222 instilled it in one season, and like every bond power it causes no Warping (p. 268).



Spring 1222, played: Seek the Falcon in Scintilla's Bond Powers, Intellego Animal, Level 4, 1 a day, Penetration 0.

What you do by hand

- **Which bonuses suit an effect**: the app fills Shape & material from the bonuses whose words match the effect; change it when your troupe reads them otherwise.
- **Which Arts fit a familiar** (DE p. 266) is the troupe's call: the app will bind with any Technique and Form you choose.

Where the rules come from

Ars Magica Definitive Edition: Inventive Genius (p. 87); the vis limit (p. 250); types of enchanted item and the enchantment summary (p. 253); preparation for enchantment (p. 254); material and size (p. 255); designing effects and effect frequency (p. 256); effect modifications (p. 257); instilling the effect (p. 258); using devices and Talisman Attunement (p. 259); attunements, investigating enchantments and similar spells (p. 260); finding and befriending a familiar (p. 265); the initial bond, fitting Arts and suggested familiars (p. 266); the three cords, the bound familiar and empowering the bond (p. 267); bond powers and the example powers (p. 268); Shape and Material Bonuses (p. 285); Pilum of Fire (p. 344); the falcon (p. 432).



Armarius

A saga manager for Ars Magica

The Mystery Cults

Hephaestina of Verditius learns the Elder Runes from old Ottokar, a Verditius finds his Hubris, and a tour of the other Mysteries: the four Houses, the hedge traditions, and Leandro's rooster that lays vis.

Guide 6 of 17

Some magic isn't learned from books: it's revealed, in a rite, by someone who already has it. That's a Mystery. The Houses of Bjornaer, Criamon, Merinita and Verditius are built around them, hedge wizards pass on their powers the same way, and a few lineages keep secrets that no library holds.

Rabenstein has two Verditius magi: **Hephaestina**, out of her Gauntlet in 1222, and old **Ottokar**, who knows the House's Verditius Elder Runes and has agreed to pass them on in Spring 1223. This guide follows that Initiation from the Script to the new Virtue, then looks at what the app offers the other Houses, the hedge traditions, and *Legends of Hermes*' art of growing vis, which **Leandro of Bonisagus** learns from a sept of House Bjornaer.

The rules are the *Ars Magica Definitive Edition*'s (DE) Mystery Initiation (pp. 387-389) and House Verditius's Hubris (pp. 241-242); *Houses of Hermes: Mystery Cults* (HoH:MC) for the four Houses' Mysteries, the Elder Runes and their Script (pp. 117-128); *Hedge Magic, Revised Edition* for hedge Initiations (pp. 13-14); and *Legends of Hermes* for Hermetic Viresculture (pp. 72-74). Where they differ, the Definitive Edition wins.

1. What an Initiation needs

The rule · DE pp. 387-388

The Mystagogue makes the Initiation Total: Presence + the cult's Lore + Script bonus. There's no die: if it reaches the Target Level, it works. The Target is 15 for a Minor Virtue the Mystagogue has (21 for a Major), or 18 and 30 if he doesn't. A Script's bonus is the sum of its parts: a special place at a special time, Quests, the Initiate's or Mystagogue's time, a sacrifice, and an Ordeal (+3 for a Minor Flaw, +6 for a Minor Flaw raised to Major, +9 for a Major Flaw). Each Ordeal makes the Initiate's next three Initiations easier.

House Verditius adds its own rules on top of the general ones: what a Verditius must know before he can be initiated, and what his first Inner Mystery costs him. The app knows them.

The rule · HoH:MC pp. 117-118, 120

A Verditius needs Verditius Cult Lore 3 to be Initiated into a Minor Inner Mystery, and 5 for a Major one. His first Inner Mystery always comes with an Ordeal that gives him the Minor Flaw Hubris. The House's own Script parts include +3 for a journey to one of its sacred places, +3 or +6 for sacrificing an enchanted item (+6 for a greater one, or a talisman), and +3 for the Minor Flaw an Ordeal gives.

So Hephaestina spent her first year at Rabenstein being taught the House's lore by Ottokar (a season of **Be taught** in Mystery Cult Lore: Verditius, the app's name for the book's Verditius Cult Lore), until her score reached 3.

The Script · HoH:MC p. 128

The Elder Runes are a Minor Virtue, so the Target is 15. Their Script is worth +9: the Initiate and Mystagogue travel to Durenmar in the Black Forest, a season's journey (+3), and on the winter solstice the Initiate burns one of her own greater enchanted items in Verditius's forge (+6).

Ottokar has Presence +1 and Mystery Cult Lore: Verditius 4. With the Script alone that's 1 + 4 + 9 = 14, one short. But this is Hephaestina's first Inner Mystery, so she also suffers the Hubris Ordeal, a Minor Flaw: +3 (DE p. 388), for 17.

2. Planning the Initiation

The Initiation is the Initiate's season. On Hephaestina's **Planning** chapter, click **Plan** and choose **Undergo an Initiation**. Pick Ottokar as the **Teacher / master**, and choose the **Virtue initiated** (Verditius Elder Runes) from the list.

The **Hedge Script** list holds the printed Scripts of every cult someone in the saga belongs to, House Verditius's among them: "House Verditius (Mystery Cult): Verditius Elder Runes (Ease 15, +9)". Choose it: it fills in the book's Script and lists its parts at the foot of the form, and the app adds the first Inner Mystery's Hubris Ordeal itself. The line at the foot does the sum.

The Script burns one of her own greater enchanted items. Under **Sacrificed**, choose it from her devices: it's made when the rite is carried out, and the device is gone from her sheet.



Plan Hephaestina of Verditius's Season (Spring 1223): Undergo an Initiation, Teacher / master Ottokar of Verditius, Virtue initiated Verditius Elder Runes (Minor), Ordeal (none), Hedge Script "House Verditius (Mystery Cult): Verdit...", Sacrificed her Bronze Brazier of the Steady Flame. The foot reads "The Script's components: The journey to Durenmar (a season) +3, A greater enchanted item burned in Verditius's forge +6 = +9", "The Hubris Ordeal of a first Inner Mystery adds +3 (HoH:MC p. 117)", that the Ordeal gives the Flaw Hubris and sets the Hubris Personality Trait to 1, that a Minor Inner Mystery gives 1 experience toward Hubris, and

If her Lore were short of 3, the form would say so in red and refuse: "Hephaestina of Verditius needs Verditius Cult Lore 3 to be Initiated into a Minor Inner Mystery".

Ordeal is where a Script's Flaw goes: **Gains a Flaw**, **Loses a Virtue** or **Raises a Minor Flaw to Major**. The Hubris of a first Inner Mystery is added by the app, so leave it blank here.

3. The solstice

Advance Season. The app works out the Initiation, burns the device, adds the Virtue and the Ordeal's Flaw, and writes it all in Hephaestina's Diary.



Hephaestina's Diary, Summer 1223: the Spring 1223 entry "Undergo an Initiation", open in the side panel, with the Hubris Ordeal's +3, the Flaw Hubris and the trait at 1, the experience toward Hubris, and the Initiation Total against 15: initiated.

What happened. Initiation Total 17 against 15: initiated. Hephaestina has the Verditius Elder Runes as a Minor Mystery Virtue, the Minor Flaw Hubris, and the Hubris Personality Trait at 1, with 1 experience toward the next point. The Ordeal will take 3 off the Target of her next Initiation, 2 off the one after, and 1 off the third.



Hephaestina's Virtues & Flaws: The Gift, Hermetic Magus and Verditius Magic, then Verditius Elder Runes (Minor, Mystery), and Hubris (Minor Flaw, Personality: "Hubris Personality Trait 1 that grows by xp").

What the runes do · HoH:MC pp. 127-128

When she opens a device for enchantment she may inscribe up to two elder runes, one for the Technique and one for the Form. Each adds 5 to the effect's level but doubles that Art for enchanting it, like a Magical Focus, and costs a pawn of that Art's vis. A rune on a wand of its own tree adds +2 more.

Hubris

The rule · DE pp. 241-242; HoH:MC pp. 119-120

Hubris grows like an Ability. A Verditius gains experience in it for selling enchanted items (1 for a lesser device, 3 for a greater, 6 for an attuned item), for winning at the Contest, for each new Inner Mystery (1 Minor, 3 Major) and for vendettas, and adds his Hubris to Lab Totals for a talisman, casting tools, magical animals, automata and attuned items.

The app keeps it with the trait: **Hubris**, beside Hephaestina's Personality Traits, records a sale, the Contest or a vendetta and adds its experience.

Stretching a Script

Not every Script fits. A Mystagogue may make one change to a Script in an Initiation.

The rule · DE pp. 388-389

To add a component, roll stress die + Intelligence + Lore against 9; to change one, 12. Fail, and this Initiation fails, though the Script as it was can be tried another season. Common extras: +1 for the Initiate serving the cult for a while, +1 for a sacrifice of wealth, +3 for a Quest.

Had Ottokar needed one more point, he could have made Hephaestina his servant on the road to Durenmar (+1). In **Vary the Script** choose **Add a component (9)**, and type 1 in **The change adds**. The line at the foot gives the roll the change needs and the Initiation Total if it works. The roll itself is made when the season is played, and the Diary records it: on a failure, "the Initiation fails; the Script as it was may be tried another season".

A Quest done once

Scripts often overlap, and a Quest an Initiate has already performed can't be used again as it is.

> **The rule · Legends of Hermes pp. 50-51**
>
> A Script whose Quests or Ordeals the Initiate already performed or suffered must be changed: modify the shared element (Intelligence + Cult Lore against 12) or replace it with a different one (against 15).

Each Quest of a Script written out as its components is recorded on the Initiate when the rite is carried out, and shown as **Quests performed** on her This Season, beside her past Ordeals. A later plan whose Script names one of them again says so, and that Quest adds nothing to the Script; in **Vary the Script**, choose **Change a component** (12) or **Replace a component** (15) and type what the change adds.

4. The other Houses

Each Mystery House's Scripts are on the same **Hedge Script** list, and each has its own rules that the plan checks.

House Bjornaer. Every Bjornaer's Heartbeast comes from **the Ritual of Twelve Years**, held at the House's Gathering: Target 15, Script +6 (a place and time resonant with the House's ancestors, +3, and the permanent loss of the ability to bind a familiar, +3), plus a point for every witness whose heartbeast shares the probationer's temperament and minus one for each opposed (HoH:MC p. 26). Type that Participation Modifier in Other modifier. The season adds Heartbeast 1, and refuses anyone who has ever bound a familiar. The deeper Mysteries (the Inner Heartbeast: Epitome, Chimera or Anima, and its refinements) need House Bjornaer Lore 5.

House Merinita. Each of the House's lineages has its Scripts on the list (the Line of Quendalon's Animae Magic, the Heirs to Merlin's Charm Magic and the rest). An Initiate into an Inner Mystery needs House Merinita Lore 1, and its Mystagogues usually have 4 or 5 (HoH:MC p. 88). Glamour always brings the Major Flaw Vulnerable Magic as its Ordeal: type its condition on the plan.

House Criamon. A Criamon doesn't climb a ladder of Virtues; he walks a path of five stations toward the Enigma. Each station needs House Criamon Lore one more than its place on the path, a trial or investiture, and insight found in a story; the printed Scripts assume a guide with Presence + Lore of 6 (HoH:MC p. 60). A Criamon's sheet has **The Enigma** chapter, where **Follow an Avenue** plans the next station, and **Change Path** sets which path he walks. With no guide chosen, the House's own guide leads.

5. Hedge Initiations

Hedge wizards pass powers on the same way, with their tradition's own Characteristic and Lore in place of Presence and the cult's.

The rule · Hedge Magic Revised pp. 13-14

A hedge Initiation is a Mystagogue's Initiation Total against the Script's Ease Factor. If the Mystagogue doesn't know the power, the Ease Factor rises by 3 for a Minor Virtue, 9 for a Major. Some traditions can't Initiate themselves.
An unGifted Initiate's Initiation must include an Ordeal, his past Ordeals don't help, and an unGifted Mystagogue must know the power.

Choose the tradition's Script under **Hedge Script**. The app uses the tradition's own Characteristic and Lore and the Script's printed bonus, adds anything typed in Script bonus to it, and takes the Script's Ease Factor as the Target. Tick **Mystagogue knows the power** when he has it as an Ability rather than a Virtue (a gruagach's Give, say). Grete the Wise's folk witches have their own Scripts: see *Beyond the Order*.

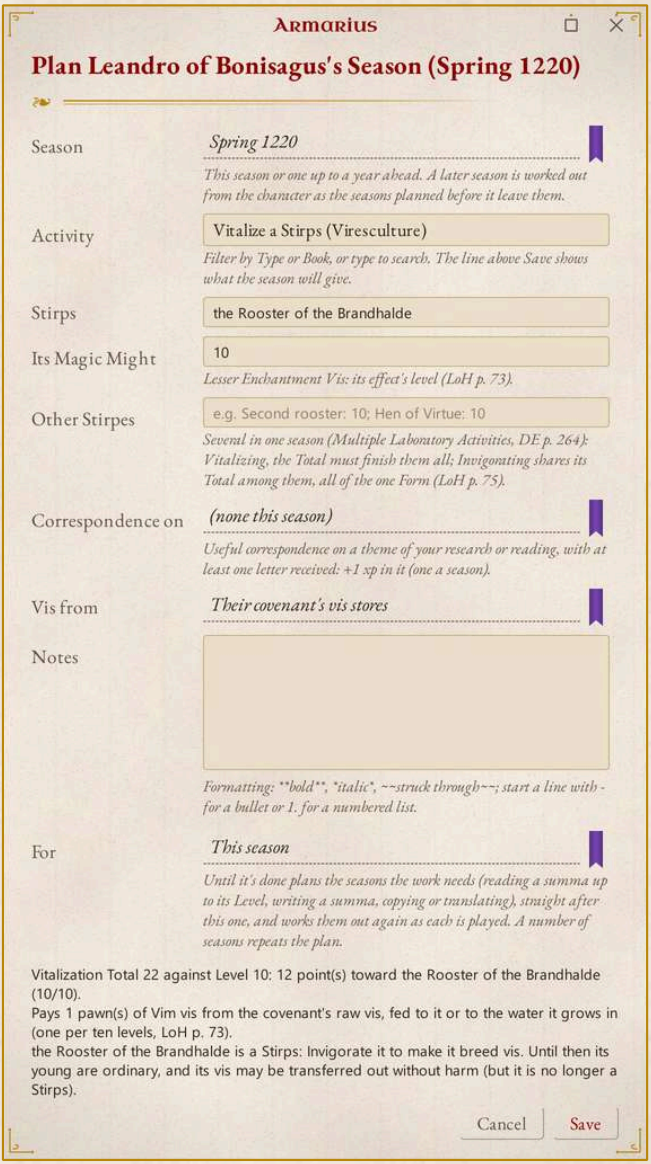
6. Vitalization: growing vis

The Mysteries of *Legends of Hermes* include one with a very practical end. Hérisson of Bjornaer's Hermetic Viresculture breeds vis: it makes a magical creature or plant into a **Stirps** whose young carry vis of their own. Leandro learned it from the Sept of Hérisson as a Supernatural Ability, and sets to work on a cockerel of the Brandhalde with a Magic Might of 10.

The rule · Legends of Hermes pp. 72-74

Vitalization makes the Stirps: Intelligence + Creo + Vim + Hermetic Viresculture + aura against its Magic Might, each season banking what the total beats the Might by, until the bank reaches it; a pawn of Vim vis per ten levels. Invigoration makes it breed: Intelligence + Creo + its Form (with a Vim requisite) + Viresculture + aura; a breeding season for every ten points or part, each yielding a fifth of its Might (rounded up) in pawns of its Form, one in ten of them a new Stirps. It must be kept in a Magic aura and fed from one.

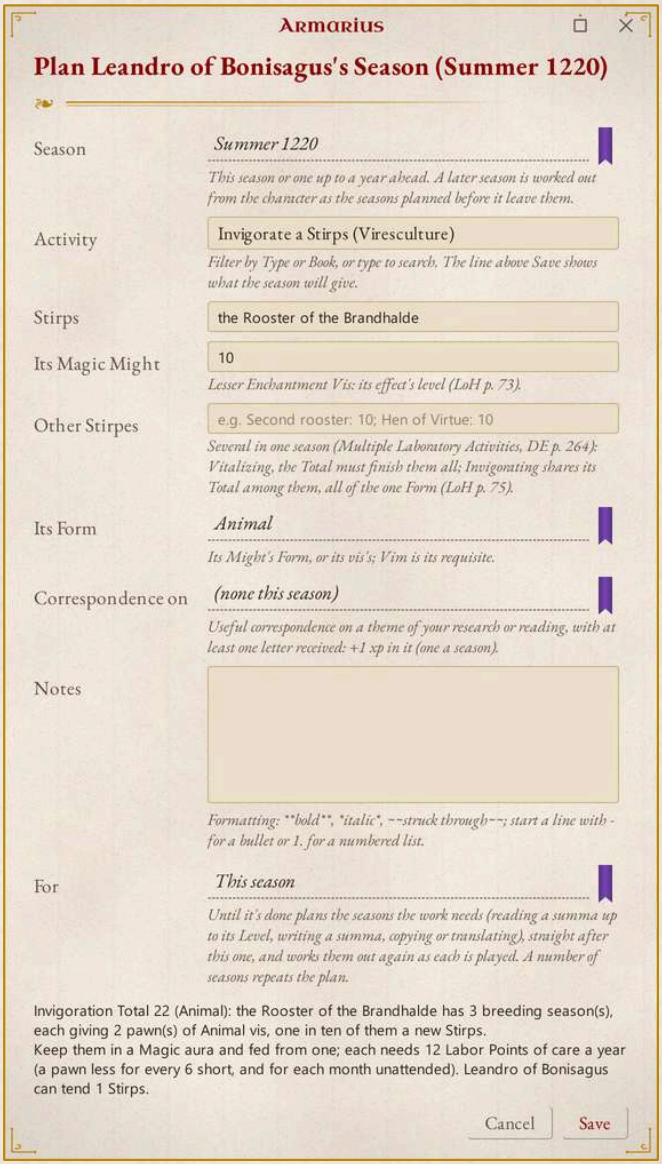
With *Legends of Hermes* in play and the Ability on his sheet, Leandro's Plan Season offers **Vitalize a Stirps** and **Invigorate a Stirps** (under Work & trade). Name the creature, type its Magic Might, and say where the Vim comes from.



Plan Leandro of Bonisagus's Season (Spring 1220): Vitalize a Stirps (Viresculture), Stirps "the Rooster of the Brandhalde", Its Magic Might 10, Vis from their covenant's vis stores. The foot reads "Vitalization Total 22 against Level 10: 12 point(s) toward the Rooster of the Brandhalde (10/10). Pays 1 pawn(s) of Vim vis from the covenant's raw vis, fed to it or to the water it grows in (one per ten levels, LoH p. 73).", and says it must be Invigorated before it breeds vis.

Intelligence 3 + Creo 10 + Vim 5 + Viresculture 1 + aura 3 = 22: one season.

The next season, Invigorate it, with Animal as its Form.



Plan Leandro of Bonisagus's Season (Summer 1220): Invigorate a Stirps (Viresculture), the same rooster, Its Magic Might 10, Its Form Animal. The foot reads "Invigoration Total 22 (Animal): the Rooster of the Brandhalde has 3 breeding season(s), each giving 2 pawn(s) of Animal vis, one in ten of them a new Stirps", and the care it needs: "each needs 12 Labor Points of care a year... Leandro of Bonisagus can tend 1 Stirps."

What happened. Three breeding seasons of two pawns of Animal vis each. A creature breeds in spring, a plant in autumn: each breeding season the harvest goes into Leandro's own raw vis, up to his Viresculture score in pawns (*Legends of Hermes* pp. 74-75), and the Diary says so.

What you do by hand

- **The journey**: the season's journey to Durenmar is part of the Script; plan its season yourself.
- **Bjornaer's Participation Modifier** is typed as the other modifier, and an inner heartbeast's refinements are noted on the sheet by hand.

Where the rules come from

Ars Magica Definitive Edition: House Verditius and Hubris (pp. 241-242); Mystery Initiation, the Initiation Total and Target Levels (p. 387); past Ordeals, Scripts and their elements, varying a Script (p. 388); failing a variation (p. 389).

Houses of Hermes: Mystery Cults: the Ritual of Twelve Years (p. 26); Criamon stations, avenues and guides (pp. 59-60); House Merinita Lore (p. 88); Verditius Cult Lore and the House's Script parts (p. 117); the Outer Mystery and the Inner Mysteries' Lore (p. 118); Hubris (pp. 118-120); the House's Ordeals (pp. 120-121); Verditius Elder Runes and their Script (pp. 127-128).

Hedge Magic, Revised Edition: hedge Initiations and unGifted Initiations (pp. 13-14). *Legends of Hermes*: overlapping Scripts (pp. 50-51); Hermetic Viresculture, Vitalization and Invigoration, and the harvests (pp. 72-75).



Armarius

A saga manager for Ars Magica

The Hidden Arts

Alchemy and the elixirs of long life, the Great Talisman, reading the future in fire, walking in dreams, magic by number and by building, and a scholar's medicines: the Mysteries of The Mysteries Revised Edition, and a little natural philosophy besides.

Guide 7 of 17

Hermetic magic as Bonisagus wrote it is only the start. The Mystery Cults keep older and stranger arts: the alchemist who lets vis distil itself while he works on something else, the diviner who reads the answer to a question in a flame, the dream-walker, the numerologist whose little formulae need no die, the architect who enchants a whole building. Each is learned by Initiation (see *The Mystery Cults*); this guide is about using them once you have them.

At Rabenstein in 1223: **Leandro of Bonisagus** turns alchemist, **Adelheid of Flambeau** learns to read fire and to count her way to small magics, **Ottokar of Verditius** binds the covenant's gatehouse into one great enchantment and walks in other men's dreams, and **Magister Albrecht of Esslingen**, who has no Gift at all, makes medicines by natural philosophy.

The rules are *The Mysteries, Revised Edition* (TMRE): Hermetic Alchemy and the Elixirs (pp. 39-44), Divination (pp. 59-63), the Great Talisman (pp. 89-90), Hermetic Numerology and Architecture (pp. 91-99), Dream Magic (pp. 102-107) and Hermetic Sacrifice (p. 117); with *Art & Academe* for natural philosophy's formulae (pp. 69-78). Where they touch the *Ars Magica Definitive Edition* (DE), the Definitive Edition wins.

Most of these arts live in two places in the app. Their seasons are on the **Plan Season** list, under Mysteries, Study or Work & trade, shown only to a character with the Virtue. Their rolls are buttons beside a chapter's sections (Abilities, Known Spells, This Season), again only for someone who has the Virtue.

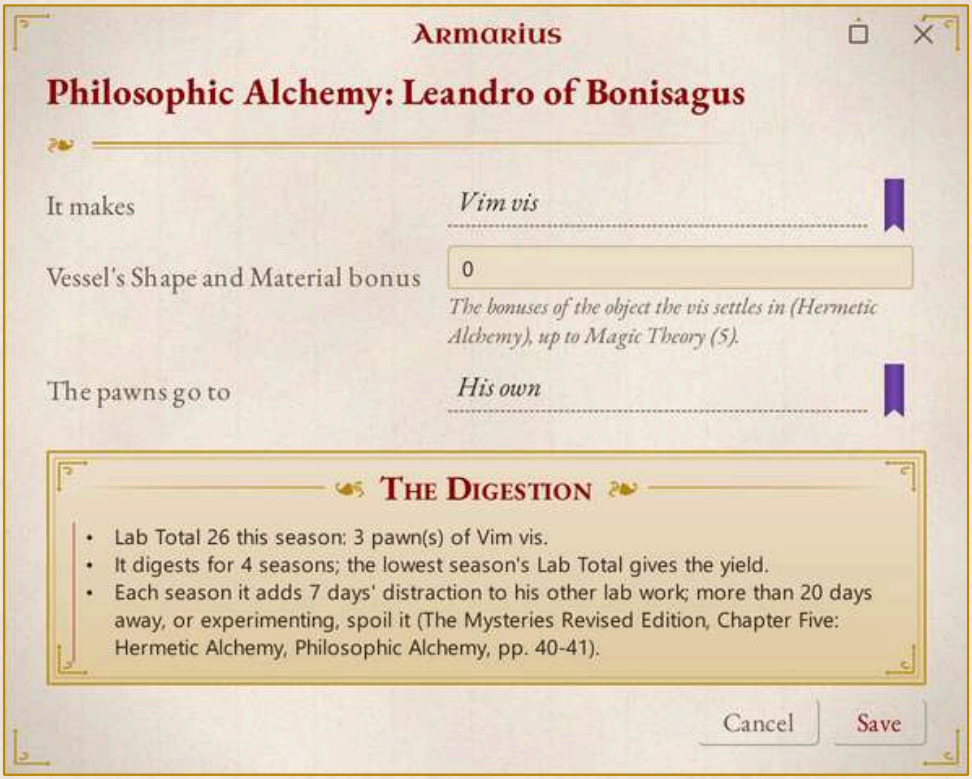
1. Philosophic Alchemy

Leandro extracts vis like any magus, but as an alchemist he can settle the process to digest by itself while he works on something else.

The rule · TMRE pp. 39-41

Hermetic Alchemy extracts vis with the Creo Vim Lab Total plus a vessel's Shape and Material bonus (at most Magic Theory): a pawn of Vim for every ten points, or a Form's vis at a pawn for every twenty. Philosophic Alchemy settles the extraction to digest on its own: the magus tends it seven days a season, as a distraction to his other lab work, and more than twenty days away (or experimenting) spoils it. The Minor Virtue takes four seasons and yields by the lowest season's total; the Major takes one. It can make ready-opened enchantment spaces in a device instead of vis.

On Leandro's **Planning** chapter, under A Season's Work, click **Philosophic Alchemy**. Choose what **It makes** (Vim vis, a Form's vis at a twentieth, or open spaces in an unopened device), the **Vessel's Shape and Material bonus**, and where **The pawns go to**.



Philosophic Alchemy: Leandro of Bonisagus, It makes Vim vis, Vessel's Shape and Material bonus 0, The pawns go to His own. The Digestion box reads "Lab Total 26 this season: 3 pawn(s) of Vim vis. It digests for 4 seasons; the lowest season's Lab Total gives the yield. Each season it adds 7 days' distraction to his other lab work; more than 20 days away, or experimenting, spoil it (The Mysteries Revised Edition, Chapter Five: Hermetic Alchemy, Philosophic Alchemy, pp. 40-41)."

What happened. The digestion runs for a year beside whatever else Leandro does in his Sanctum. Each season's Lab Total (less any days away) is written in his and the laboratory's Diaries, and the lowest of the four gives the pawns. While it runs, his other lab work carries the seven days, and the same button shows it and can abandon it.

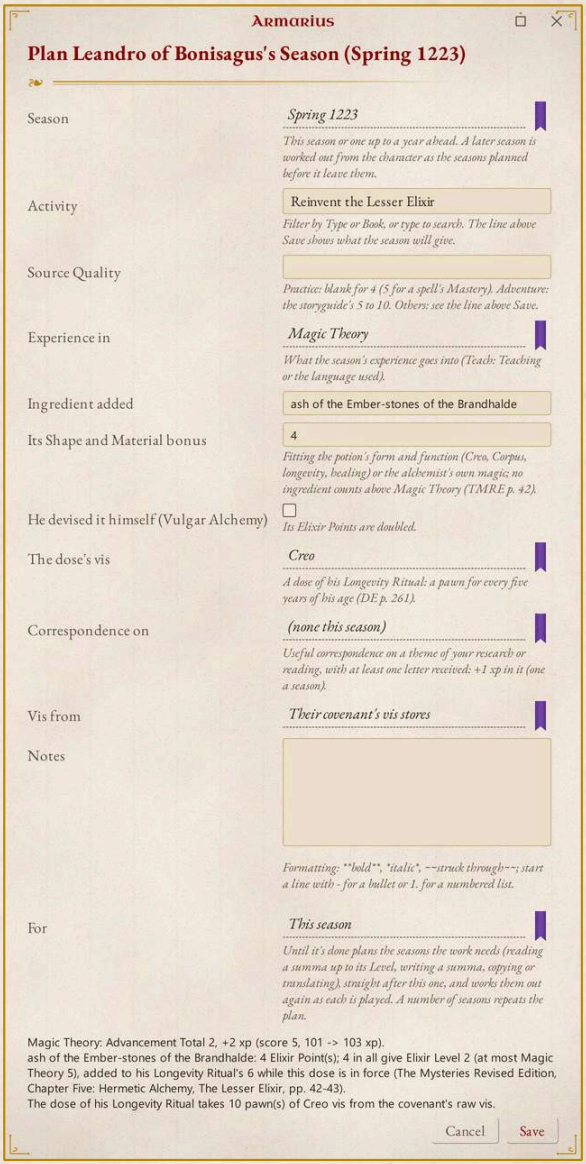
2. The Lesser Elixir

Leandro has been under a Longevity Ritual since 1220 (*A Year at Rabenstein*). An alchemist can make it stronger, and Leandro has studied the art.

The rule · TMRE pp. 42-43

Each season reinventing the Lesser Elixir adds a special ingredient, worth its Shape and Material bonus in Elixir Points (doubled for one he devised himself by Vulgar Alchemy; none above his Magic Theory). The points give the Elixir Level as experience gives an Art's score (1, 3, 6, 10, 15…), at most his Magic Theory, and the Elixir Level adds to his Longevity Ritual's aging bonus. The season brews a dose of his ritual from its Lab Text: a pawn of Creo, Corpus or Vim for every five years of age, at most his score in that Art. An aging crisis ends it with the ritual.

Plan a season of **Reinvent the Lesser Elixir** (under Mysteries). Name the **Ingredient added** and its **Shape and Material bonus**, tick **He devised it himself** if so, and choose **The dose's vis** and where it comes from. Like other lab work it gives 2 xp of Exposure: choose Magic Theory under **Experience in**.



Plan Leandro of Bonisagus's Season (Spring 1223): Reinvent the Lesser Elixir, Experience in Magic Theory, Ingredient added "ash of the Ember-stones of the Brandhalde", Its Shape and Material bonus 4, the dose's vis Creo from their covenant's vis stores. The foot reads "Magic Theory: Advancement Total 2, +2 xp (score 5, 101 -> 103 xp). ash of the Ember-stones of the Brandhalde: 4 Elixir Point(s); 4 in all give Elixir Level 2 (at most Magic Theory 5), added to his Longevity Ritual's 6 while this dose is in force. The dose of his Longevity Ritual takes 10 pawn(s) of Creo vis from the covenant's raw vis."

If the store can't pay, the line says so in red ("The dose takes 10 pawn(s) of Creo vis; the covenant's raw vis has 3") and the plan won't save.

> **What happened.** Leandro's aging rolls now subtract 6 + 2 = 8, until an aging crisis ends the ritual.

The Great Elixir goes further: an alchemist with Unaging and the Lesser Elixir enchants a potion that may turn him into an immortal being of Magic (TMRE pp. 43-44). When he drinks it, **Test the Great Elixir**, beside his Aging & Warping section, asks the Grant Might effect's level (it gives Magic Might of half of level - 20) and rolls a simple die + Stamina + his Lesser Elixir Level + 1 for each earlier attempt, against his age / 10, rounded up. Pass, and his sheet shows "A being of Magic", with his Magic Might beside his Size: he makes no more aging rolls and gains no Warping.

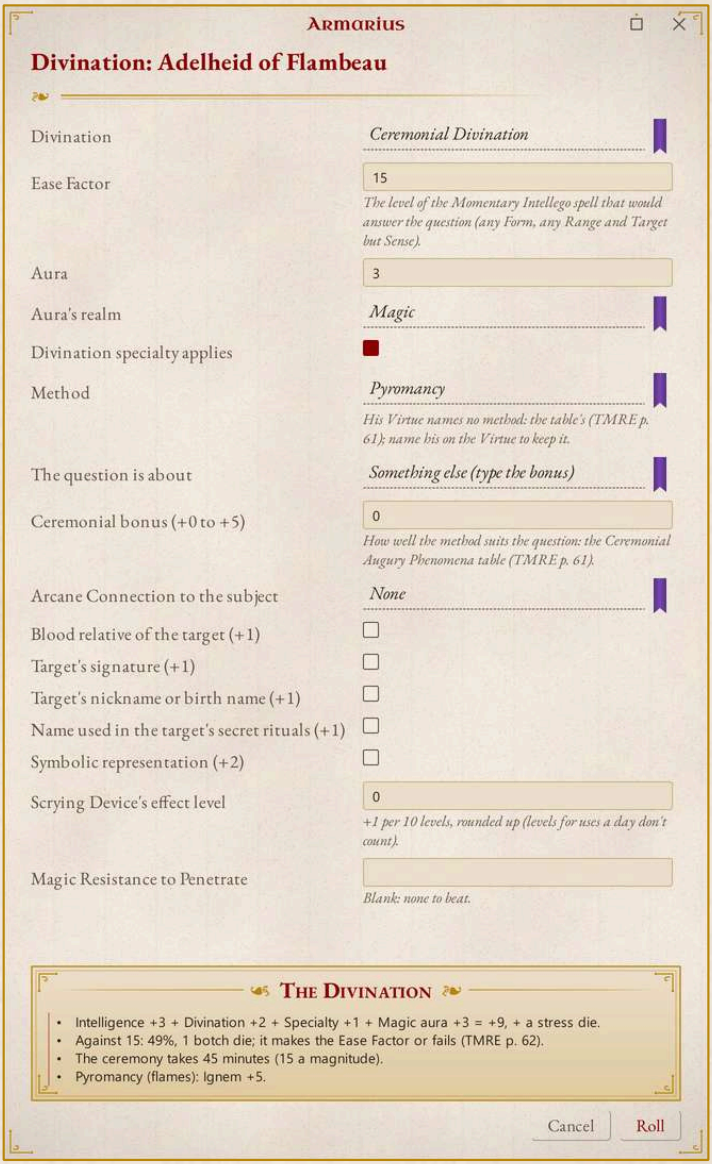
3. Divination

Adelheid has learned to read fire: Divination & Augury, by pyromancy, the flames of a brazier answering a question she puts to them.

The rule · TMRE pp. 59-62

A divination answers one question as a Momentary Intellego spell of any Form would, and its Ease Factor is that spell's level ("Is the Baron's envoy lying to me?" is 15). Casual, in a round: stress die + Perception + Divination + aura + the storyguide's bonus for apt omens. Ceremonial, fifteen minutes a magnitude: stress die + Intelligence + Divination + aura + the method's ceremonial bonus + sympathetic connections. It makes the Ease Factor or it doesn't: no open-ended result.

On her **Deeds** chapter, under Insight, click **Divination**. Choose casual or ceremonial, type the **Ease Factor**, and tick what helps: her specialty, an Arcane Connection or sympathetic links to the subject. **Method** is the one her Virtue names; if it names none, the form starts at the table's first (Aeromancy), so choose Pyromancy, or name it on the Virtue to keep it. For a ceremony, **The question is about** offers her method's uses from the book's table (Pyromancy's Ignem, say, or Aeromancy's weather), which fill in the ceremonial bonus; choose Something else to type it yourself.



Divination: Adelheid of Flambeau, Ceremonial Divination, Ease Factor 15, Aura 3 (Magic), specialty ticked, Method Pyromancy, The question is about Something else, Ceremonial bonus 0. The Divination box reads "Intelligence +3 + Divination +2 + Specialty +1 + Magic aura +3 = +9, + a stress die.", "Against 15: 49%, 1 botch die; it makes the Ease Factor or fails (TMRE p. 62).", "The ceremony takes 45 minutes (15 a magnitude).", and "Pyromancy (flames): Ignem +5."

Roll rolls it and keeps it in her Diary. **Astrology**, beside it for a magus with Planetary or Celestial Magic, reckons horoscopes, favourable hours and astrological durations (TMRE pp. 48-54).

4. The Great Talisman

Adelheid's Wand of Fire is her talisman (*Enchantments*). The Great Talisman makes it more, as the Mystery set out below explains step by step.

> **The rule · TMRE pp. 89-90**
>
> With the Great Talisman, a magus gains a new attunement each season merely by using his talisman, without working on it (still one a season), and may craft new components into it whenever he reopens it, up to his Magic Theory in all.
> The Consummate Talisman goes further: its Personal Muto Vim effects work on his Formulaic spells.

Nothing new to plan: the wand's details in The Ember Cell's Stores now say what her Talisman Mysteries allow, and its attunements are added on the device as before.

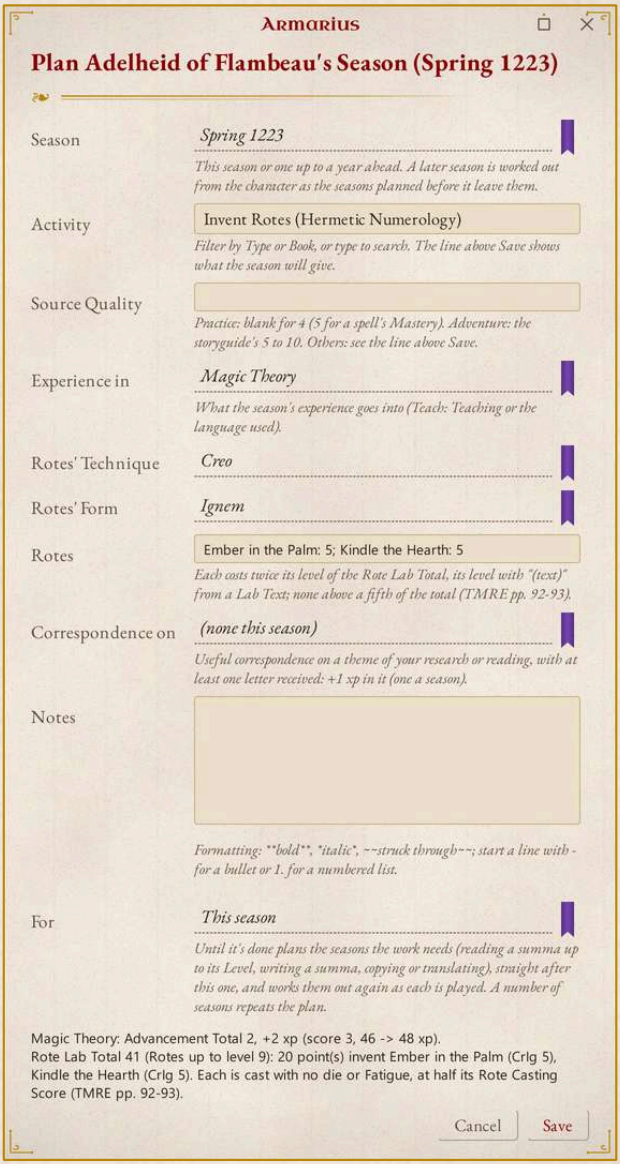
5. Numerology: Rotes

Adelheid also took Hermetic Numerology, for the little spells it gives, the Rotes, which she invents in the laboratory like any spell.

The rule · TMRE pp. 92-93

A Rote is a tiny formula cast with no die and no Fatigue, quietly and without gestures: its Casting Total is half of Stamina + Technique + Form + Artes Liberales (arithmetic) + aura, rounded up. The Rote Lab Total is the usual Lab Total plus Artes Liberales (at most Magic Theory) and a Numerologist's Book's bonus; no Rote may be above a fifth of it, rounded up, and each costs twice its level of the total (its level, from a Lab Text), so several are invented in a season.

Plan **Invent Rotes (Hermetic Numerology)** on her Planning chapter: choose the **Rotes' Technique** and **Rotes' Form**, type the **Rotes** as "Name: level; Name: level", and choose Magic Theory under **Experience in**.



Plan Adelheid of Flambeau's Season (Spring 1223): Invent Rotes (Hermetic Numerology), Experience in Magic Theory, Creo Ignem, Rotes "Ember in the Palm: 5; Kindle the Hearth: 5". The foot reads "Magic Theory: Advancement Total 2, +2 xp (score 3, 46 -> 48 xp). Rote Lab Total 41 (Rotes up to level 9): 20 point(s) invent Ember in the Palm (CrIg 5), Kindle the Hearth (CrIg 5). Each is cast with no die or Fatigue, at half its Rote Casting Score (TMRE pp. 92-93).

Ask for one too high and the form says so ("A Rote Lab Total of 41 designs Rotes of level 1 to 9"). The Rotes she knows are listed with her casting scores on the Hermetic Magic chapter. A **Numerologist's Book**, an enchanted book opened for it, adds +4 (a lesser book) or +8 (a greater one): mark it with the device's **Arithmetic magic** field.

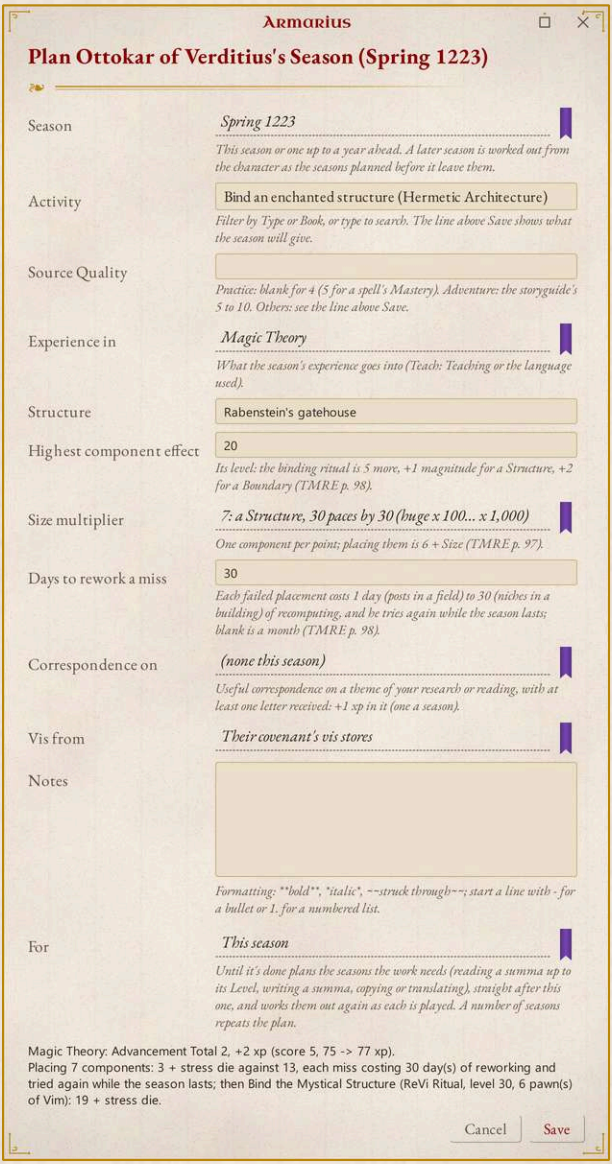
6. Hermetic Architecture

Ottokar wants Rabenstein's gatehouse to know who passes through it. A gatehouse is too big for any laboratory, so he enchants it in pieces.

The rule · TMRE pp. 97-98

The structure's material x Size multiplier (a small room 5, a Room 6, a Structure 7, a Boundary 8) sets the enchantment it needs; the magus makes that many identical component devices and enchants them as usual. He then places them, Intelligence + Artes Liberales (geometry) against 6 + Size (a miss costs a day to a month of reworking), and casts Bind the Mystical Structure, a Rego Vim Mystery Ritual of at least the highest component effect's level + 5, a magnitude more for a Structure and two for a Boundary.

Make and enchant the components in his lab first, marking each as an Architecture component with its device's **Arithmetic magic** field. Then plan **Bind an enchanted structure (Hermetic Architecture)**: name the structure, type its highest component effect's level, choose its **Size multiplier**, and the days a miss costs.



Plan Ottokar of Verditius's Season (Spring 1223): Bind an enchanted structure (Hermetic Architecture), Experience in Magic Theory, Structure "Rabenstein's gatehouse", Highest component effect 20, Size multiplier 7 (a Structure, 30 paces by 30), 30 days to rework a miss, vis from the covenant's stores. The foot reads "Magic Theory: Advancement Total 2, +2 xp (score 5, 75 -> 77 xp). Placing 7 components: 3 + stress die against 13, each miss costing 30 day(s) of reworking and tried again while the season lasts; then Bind the Mystical Structure (ReVi Ritual, level 30, 6 pawn(s) of Vim): 19 + stress die."

What happened. When the season is played, the app rolls the placing as often as the season allows, notes each miss and the day the components were placed, then the ritual. The vis must be within his Vim score and in the store the plan takes it from: with too little, the plan refuses ("Bind the Mystical Structure (level 30) takes 6 pawn(s) of Vim vis; Ottokar of Verditius's raw vis has 0").

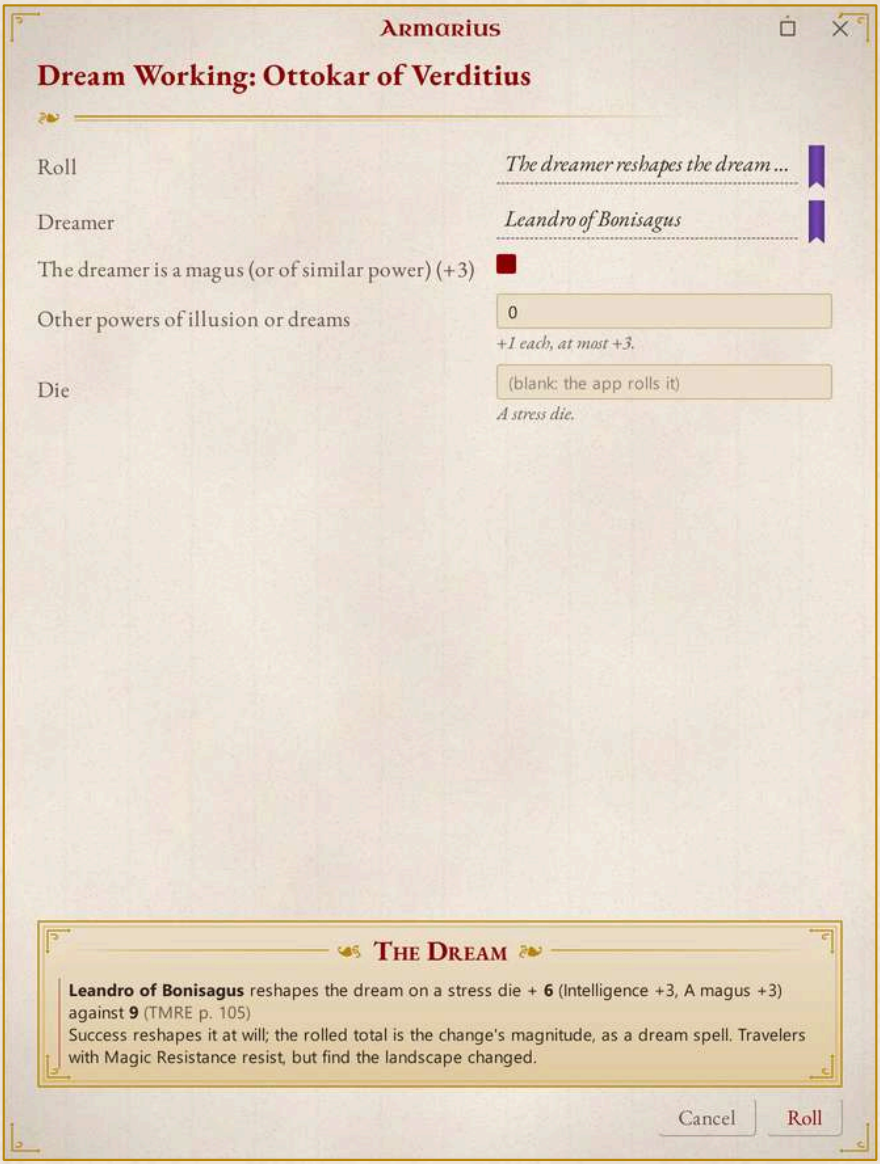
7. Dream Magic

Ottokar has one more secret, which he shares with very few of his sodales at Rabenstein: he walks in other people's dreams, and can change what happens in them.

The rule · TMRE pp. 102-106

In a dream every spell is Imaginem: he casts with his Technique and Imaginem whatever the effect's Form. The aura is the dream setting's, not his body's; only dream wounds count, and a spirit loses no Fatigue. His Magic Resistance there is Imaginem + 5 x Parma Magica + the aura. The dreamer can notice travellers (Perception + Awareness against 9) and reshape the dream (Intelligence + 3 for a magus + other dream powers, against 9). A botch's Warping and any Twilight are real.

On his **Hermetic Magic** chapter, beside Known Spells, click **Dream Working** and choose what's rolled: a spell in the dream, the dreamer noticing travellers or reshaping the dream, a wound, or the sleeping body being disturbed.



Dream Working: Ottokar of Verditius, Roll "The dreamer reshapes the dream", Dreamer Leandro of Bonisagus, the dreamer is a magus (+3) ticked. The Dream box reads "Leandro of Bonisagus reshapes the dream on a stress die + 6 (Intelligence +3, A magus +3) against 9 (TMRE p. 105)."

Roll writes it in his Diary.

8. Hermetic Sacrifice

The rule · TMRE p. 117; Errata p. 51

A pure, unblemished beast sacrificed on a pagan deity's altar stands in for 1 (a lamb) to 6 (a lion) pawns of the vis of a Ritual that summons that deity, cast through the altar. A beast made or changed by magic never serves, and forcing the spirit with Hermetic Synthemata spoils the altar.

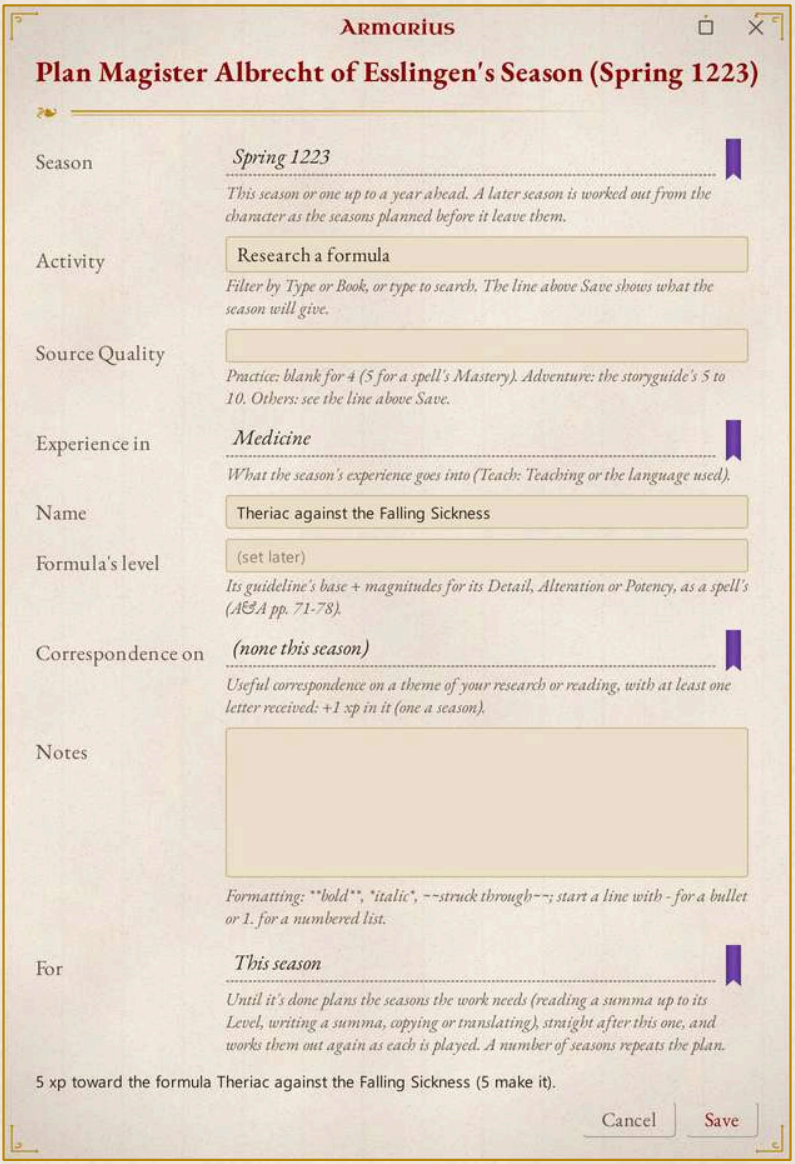
A magus who knows it finds **Hermetic Sacrifice** beside his Known Spells: choose a Ritual he knows, and the sacrifice, and it shows the vis still needed. **Pay the vis still needed from** takes it from his own raw vis, his laboratory's or the covenant's stores; choose **Not now** to pay it at the table. (Ottokar doesn't know it, and the button says so.)

9. A scholar's medicines

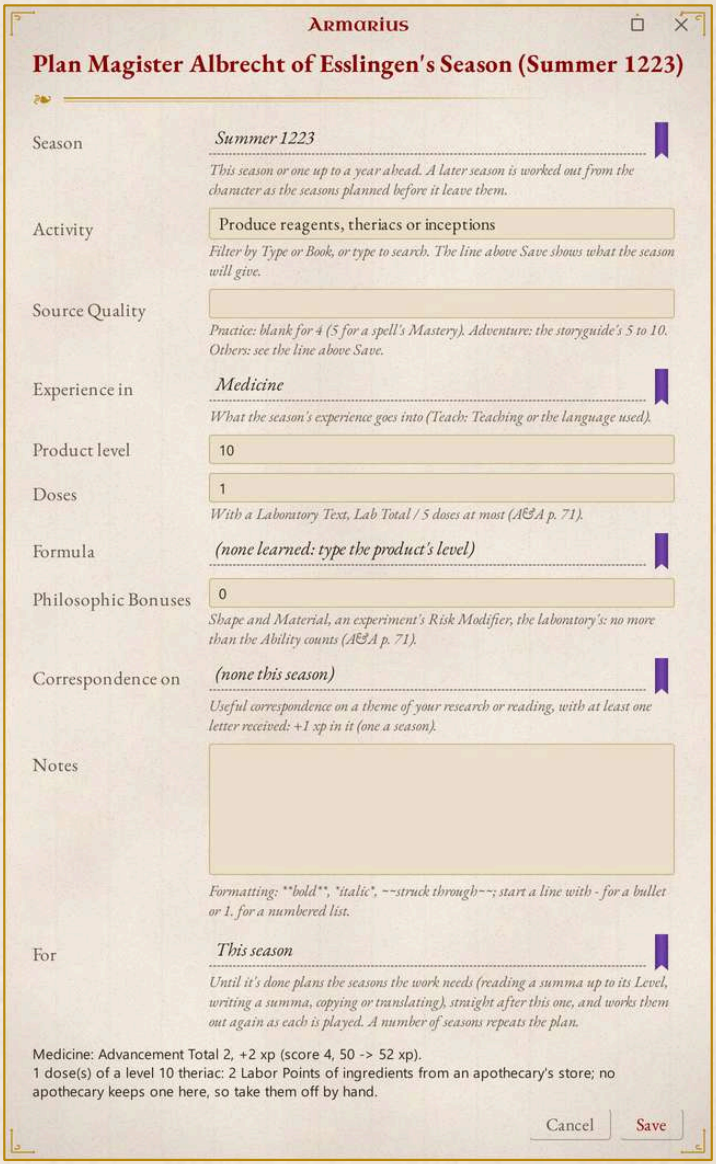
Magister Albrecht has no Gift, but natural philosophy has its own powerful works: formulae, recipes like Lab Texts, made in a laboratory without magic.

> **The rule · Art & Academe pp. 69-71**
>
> Three kinds: astrological inceptions (Artes Liberales), alchemical reagents (Philosophiae) and pharmaceutical theriacs (Medicine). Five experience points in the Ability make a formula. Concocting it: Intelligence + the Ability + philosophic bonuses (never more than the Ability) against its level; the first time, each season banks the difference until it reaches the level, and from its Laboratory Text a season makes Lab Total / 5 doses. Each reagent or theriac costs an apothecary's store a Labor Point per 5 levels.

Plan **Research a formula** to put five xp into one (name it: Albrecht's is a *Theriac against the Falling Sickness*), then **Produce reagents, theriacs or inceptions** to make it.



Plan Magister Albrecht of Esslingen's Season (Spring 1223): Research a formula, Name "Theriac against the Falling Sickness". The foot reads "5 xp toward the formula Theriac against the Falling Sickness (5 make it)."



Plan Magister Albrecht of Esslingen's Season (Summer 1223): Produce reagents, theriacs or inceptions, Experience in Medicine, Product level 10, Doses 1. The foot reads "Medicine: Advancement Total 2, +2 xp (score 4, 50 -> 52 xp). 1 dose(s) of a level 10 theriac: 2 Labor Points of ingredients from an apothecary's store; no apothecary keeps one here, so take them off by hand."

A theriac's ingredients come from the maker's own store if he has Profession: Apothecary, or from the best apothecary at his covenant, whose Labor Points they come off when the season is played. Rabenstein has no apothecary yet, so Albrecht buys his herbs in Ulm.

The apothecary's store itself, **Keep an apothecary's store**, is a season's work for someone with Profession: Apothecary, and **Apothecary's Store**, under A Season's Work, searches for or preserves an ingredient (*Art & Academe* pp. 63-66).

What you do by hand

- **A theriac with no apothecary at hand**: take the Labor Points off by hand where the line says so.
- **Talisman attunements under the Great Talisman** are still added on the device yourself, one a season.
- **The apt omens** of a casual divination: type the storyguide's bonus.
- **Dream journeys** are played at the table; the app rolls only what you ask.

Where the rules come from

The Mysteries, Revised Edition: Hermetic Alchemy and Philosophic Alchemy (pp. 39-41); the Lesser Elixir (pp. 42-43); the Great Elixir (pp. 43-44); Planetary and Celestial Magic (pp. 48-54); Hermetic Divination and its Ease Factors (pp. 59-60); Casual and Ceremonial Divination (pp. 61-62); the Great and Consummate Talisman (pp. 89-90); the Numerologist's Book and Rotes (pp. 92-93); Hermetic Architecture and Bind the Mystical Structure (pp. 97-98); Dream Magic (pp. 102-106); Hermetic Sacrifice (p. 117). *Errata*: Hermetic Sacrifice (p. 51).

Art & Academe: the apothecary's store (pp. 63-66); ligatures and formulae (pp. 68-71).



Armarius

A saga manager for Ars Magica

Beyond the Order

Grete the Wise, a Gifted folk witch of the Swabian Alb; the other hedge traditions and the Order's rivals; and Father Benno's holy influence in the village church.

Guide 8 of 17

Not every wizard in Mythic Europe swore the Oath of Hermes. Hedge wizards have their own traditions, Arts and ways of working; in the East the summoners of the Order of Suleiman bind jinn; four rival traditions are a match for the Order itself; and the Church has its own kind of power, which no magus can command.

This guide makes **Grete the Wise**, a Gifted folk witch of 25 who heals Rabenstein's covenfolk and curses the people who annoy them, step by step. Then it tours the other traditions the app knows, and ends in the village church below the crag with **Father Benno**.

The rules are *Hedge Magic, Revised Edition* (HMRE), chapter three, Folk Witches (pp. 33-39), on top of the *Ars Magica Definitive Edition*'s (DE) character creation (pp. 43-50); *The Cradle & the Crescent* for the Order of Suleiman (pp. 19-60) and the Nizari mustajibs (pp. 162-165); *Rival Magic* for the Order's rivals (pp. 6-141); and *Realms of Power: The Divine* (RoP:D) and *The Church* for holy power. Where they disagree with the Definitive Edition, the Definitive Edition wins.

1. Offering the tradition

Every tradition of a book in play is offered until you turn it off, so a book put in play brings its traditions with it. On the saga's **Saga Settings** chapter, click Saga Content's card under **Content in Play**. Put *Hedge Magic* in play on its **Books** chapter (Books in Play), and its six traditions are offered at once. To keep the pickers short, open the **Traditions** chapter and flip off the switches of the ones your saga doesn't use; each book's heading has a switch for all of its traditions at once.



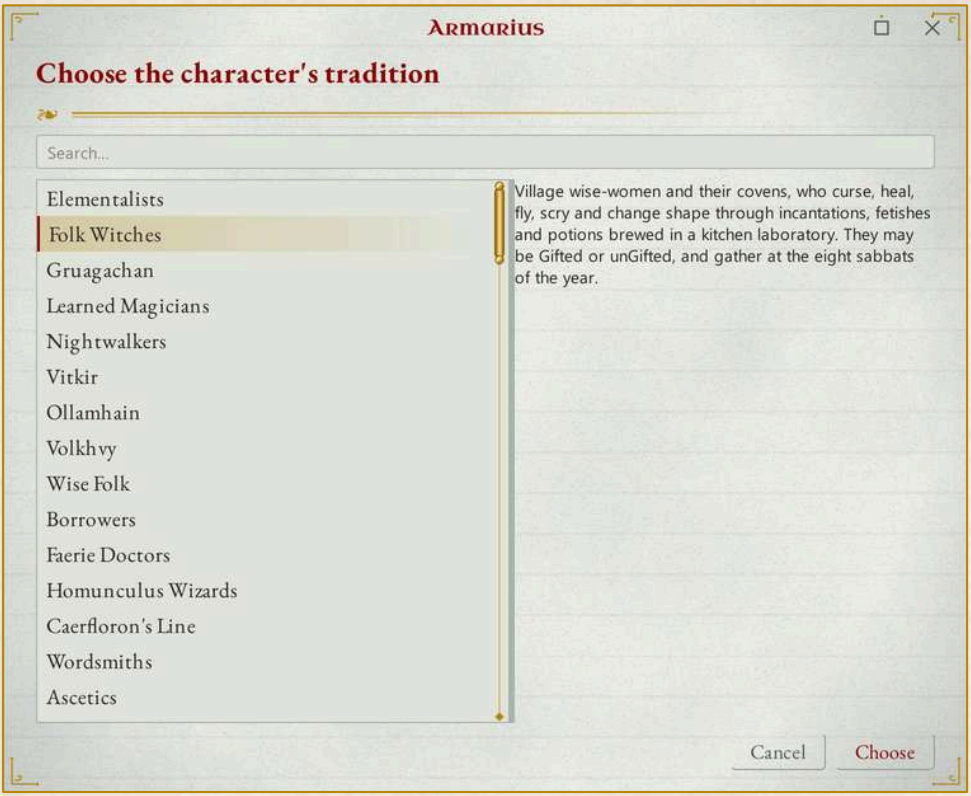
Saga Content's Traditions chapter: "Traditions Offered (95 of 95)", a heading for each book with its "All offered" switch (Ars Magica Definitive Edition, Houses of Hermes: Mystery Cults, Societates, The Mysteries Revised Edition...), and under each a card per tradition with its name, its switch and its kind (Nemthengacha, Ex Miscellanea Tradition; the four Houses, Mystery Cult; Donatores Requietis Aeternae, Ex Miscellanea Tradition · Divine).

2. A new companion with a tradition

The rule · HMRE pp. 34-35

A folk witch may be Gifted or not, and is a companion or a grog. She takes the free Social Status Folk Witch, and at least one Flaw that affects her magic. Around age ten a witch adopts her, and her apprenticeship, usually ten years, gives 200 xp on any Abilities. A Gifted witch's Opening makes seven Supernatural Abilities her own: Animal Ken, Cursing, Dowsing, Flight, Healing, Second Sight and Shapeshifter.

Make a new companion as usual (see *Making a Magus* for the worksheet). On the **Concept** step, **Choose tradition** lists the traditions the saga offers. Pick Folk Witches, and the worksheet adds the Folk Witch status and a new step, **Tradition Training**.



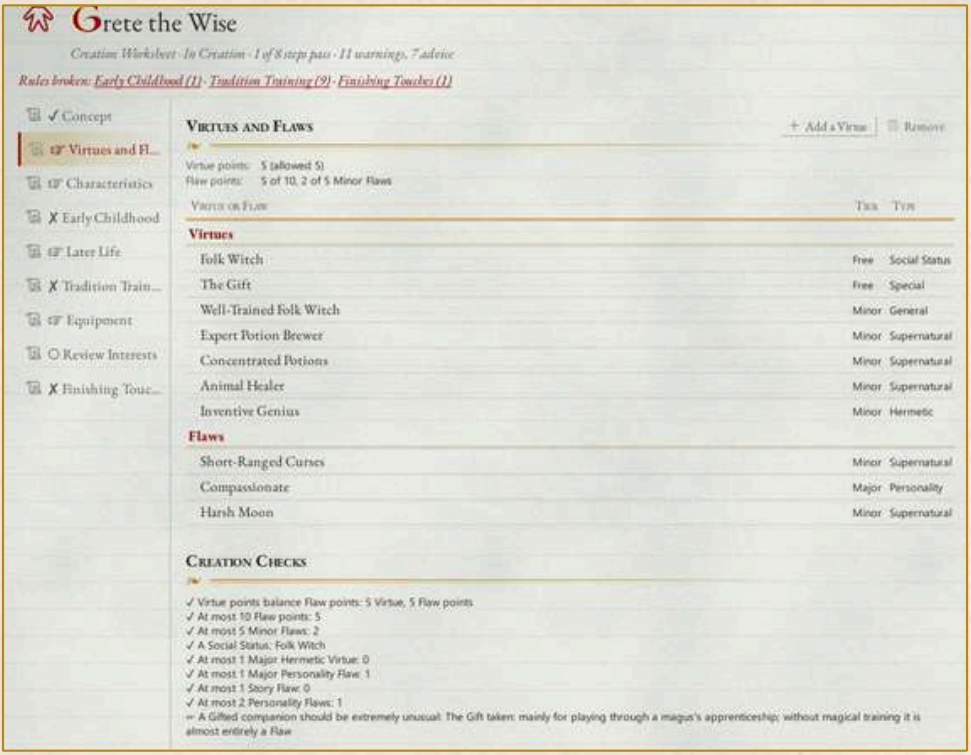
Choose the character's tradition: the traditions the saga offers, Folk Witches chosen, with the tradition described beside the list ("Village wise-women and their covens...").

3. Virtues and Flaws

Grete takes The Gift, free, so the Opening gives her all seven powers. Her Flaws are Compassionate (Major), Short-Ranged Curses and Harsh Moon, both folk witch Flaws that touch her magic. That pays for five Minor Virtues: Well-Trained Folk Witch, Expert Potion Brewer, Concentrated Potions, Animal Healer and Inventive Genius.

The Virtues · HMRE pp. 35-36

Well-Trained Folk Witch: 50 more xp in her apprenticeship. Expert Potion Brewer: doubles the Ability in her potion Lab Total. Concentrated Potions: twice the vis in a season. Animal Healer: Healing for animals. A Gifted folk witch may also take Hermetic Virtues that fit, Inventive Genius among them.



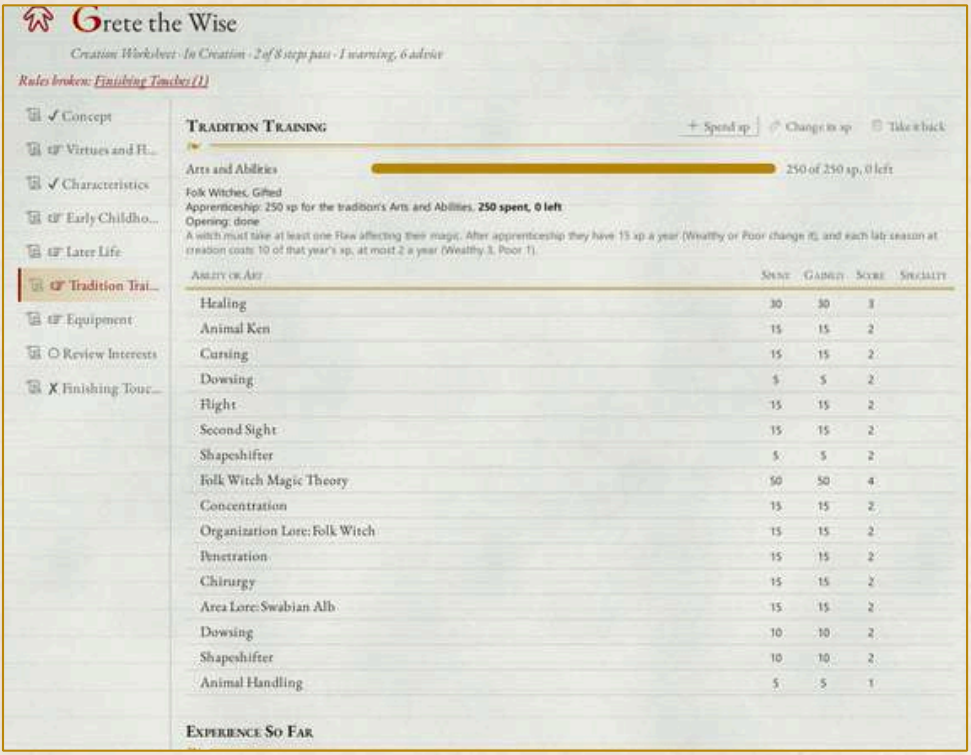
Virtues and Flaws: Folk Witch and The Gift free, the five Minor Virtues, and Short-Ranged Curses, Compassionate (Major) and Harsh Moon; 5 Virtue points against 5 Flaw points. The advice at the foot of the Creation Checks is the book's, that a Gifted companion should be extremely unusual.

4. Tradition Training

The new step is the witch's apprenticeship. Click **Open the Arts** first: it gives a Gifted witch her seven powers and Folk Witch Magic Theory at 0. Then **Spend xp**: the budget is 250 xp, the book's 200 and 50 for Well-Trained. Grete spends it on her seven powers, Folk Witch Magic Theory 4, and the Abilities the book suggests: Concentration, Organization Lore: Folk Witch, Penetration, Chirurgy, her Area Lore, and 5 xp of Animal Handling.

Minimum scores · HMRE p. 34

After her apprenticeship a Gifted folk witch should have 1 in each of the seven powers and in Folk Witch Magic Theory. It's a good idea to have Animal Handling, Concentration, Organization Lore: Folk Witch and Penetration too.



Tradition Training: "250 of 250 xp, 0 left", Folk Witches, Gifted, Opening: done; Healing 30 xp (score 3), the other six powers 15 xp each (Dowsing and Shapeshifter in two spends of 5 and 10), Folk Witch Magic Theory 50 xp (score 4), the suggested Abilities at 15, Animal Handling 5; then Experience So Far, and the Creation Checks for each power's minimum, all met.

The book allows any Abilities in a folk witch's apprenticeship, and names Penetration among the useful ones; the step takes it like the rest.

5. Later Life

The book's timeline is five years of childhood, five of later life until she's adopted at ten, ten years of apprenticeship, then 15 xp a year again until now: ten years of later life in all, 150 xp. The Later Life step leaves the apprenticeship's ten years out, so it offers just that: 150 xp.

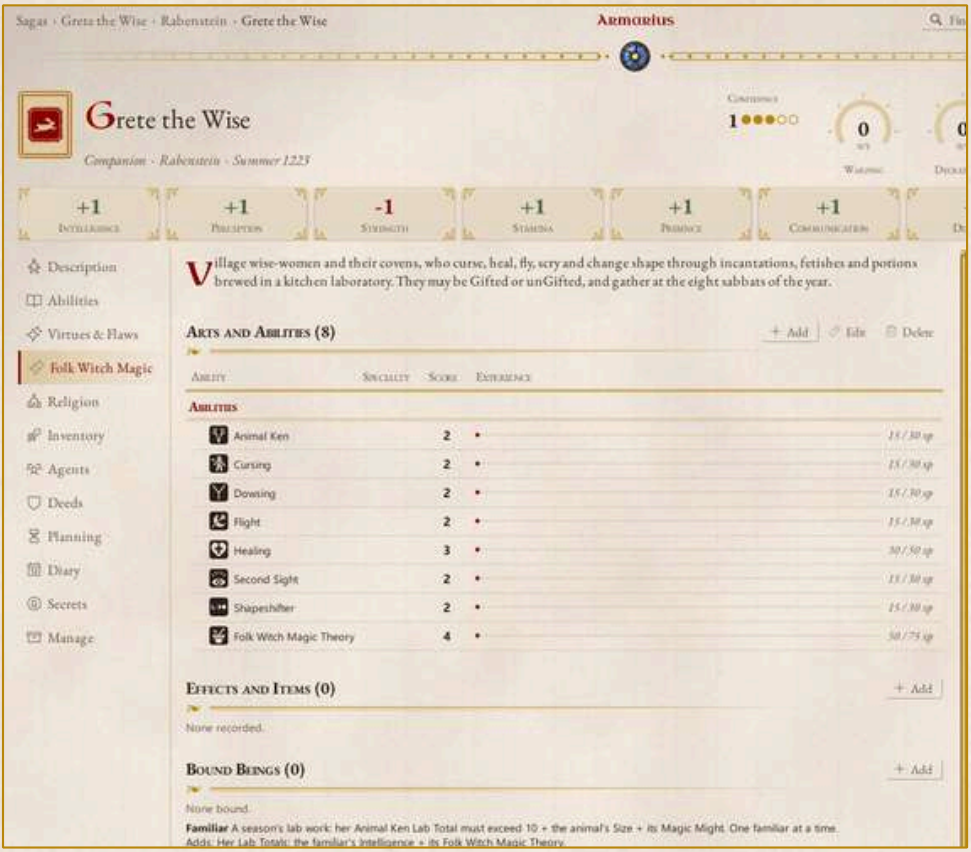
6. Grete in play

With personality traits (Compassionate +3, Loyal to her coven +2, Curious +1) and Confidence 1, **Move to In Play** takes her to a normal sheet with a chapter of her own: **Folk Witch Magic**. The confirmation ("Creation checks: 5 advice") lists only advice, such as specialties left blank and no equipment recorded, so go ahead.

Casting · HMRE pp. 36-38

Casting Score = Characteristic + Ability + aura; Casting Total = Casting Score + a stress die, against the Ease Factor of the effect. A Gifted witch can add a pawn of vis per point. Each power uses its own Characteristic: Communication for Animal Ken, Dexterity for Cursing, Stamina for Healing and Flight. A botch gives a Warping Point for each 0.

The chapter has her Arts and Abilities, her Effects and Items, and her Bound Beings (a folk witch's familiar), then **Casting**, with each power's Casting Score, and her **Lab Totals** for a season's work in her kitchen, and what a sabbat adds. **Cast a Power**, beside her Abilities, rolls one casting by the tradition's rule: choose the power, type the Ease Factor, the aura and any pawns of vis, and it says whether it works and writes it in her Diary; a botch's zeroes give their Warping Points.



Grete's Folk Witch Magic chapter: her eight Arts and Abilities with their scores and experience, Effects and Items, Bound Beings with the familiar rules, and Casting: "Healing (Sta) 7 as level 15", "Cursing (Dex) 7", the others 6; and her Folk witch Lab Totals, Healing (Int) 11, the others 10, and the sabbat's bonuses.

> **What happened.** Grete the Wise is In Play: Healing 3, the other six powers at 2, Folk Witch Magic Theory 4. Her Healing Casting Score is Stamina +1, Healing 3 and the aura's 3: 7.

Her seasons are on her Planning chapter as for anyone else, with her tradition's own work under **Tradition** in the activity list: brewing a potion or making a fetish, binding a familiar, opening a student's Gift. The tradition chapter's **Seasons** lists them with her best Lab Total for each, and the tradition's printed Initiation Scripts with her total as Mystagogue (see *The Mystery Cults*).

7. The other hedge traditions

The same steps make any of them: offer the tradition, choose it on Concept, train it, and the sheet gains a chapter named for its magic. The app has:

- **Hedge Magic**'s six: elementalists, folk witches, gruagachan, learned magicians, nightwalkers and vitkir.
- **Realms of Power** traditions: the faerie traditions (ollamhain, volkhvy, wise folk, faerie doctors and more), the Divine's holy traditions (ascetics, cantores, sufis, kabbalists, the Ba'al Shem and others), and the Infernal's (Luciferans, strigae and more).
- The **Ex Miscellanea** traditions of *Houses of Hermes: Societates*, and the regional books' own.

A tradition's Arts advance on the table its book gives (most like Hermetic Arts, a Difficult Art like an Ability), and each has its own casting, defenses and Lab Totals on its chapter.

To make a character already in play a member, open their **Abilities** chapter, click **Traditions** and tick theirs: the Virtues and Social Status its members need are added, and a note says what was added. Joining doesn't Open a Gifted member's Gift: a Gifted master of the tradition does that, usually at the start of an apprenticeship (*Hedge Magic, Revised Edition* p. 7). Plan the master's season as **Open a student's Gift to a tradition**: it brings the Opening's Arts and Abilities at 0 and its free Virtues.

8. The Order of Suleiman and the mustajibs

In the Levant and beyond, the Order's nearest equivalent is the Order of Suleiman: sahirs, mostly unGifted Muslim summoners who bind jinn by Solomon's names (*The Cradle & the Crescent* pp. 19-31). The app offers them as the **Sahirs (Suhhar Sulayman)** tradition, with their Solomonic Arts on their chapter and the jinn they summon among their Bound Beings.
The Nizari **mustajibs**, the Isma'ili mystics of Alamut who read the hidden meaning, the *batin*, of the Qur'an, are their own tradition too (pp. 162-165).

The Cradle & the Crescent is a Tribunal book as well: see *The Saga and Its World* for starting a saga from it.

9. Rival Magic

Four traditions match the Order in power: the **Amazon sorceresses**, the **Augustan Brotherhood**, the **Muspelli** of the far north, and the **sorcerers of Soqotra** (*Rival Magic*). All need The Gift, and all Open an apprentice's Gift as the Order opens the Arts.

> **The rule · Rival Magic p. 6**
>
> Opening the Gift takes a season of master and apprentice. An apprentice with no Supernatural Abilities or Arts is Opened automatically; one who has them sets an Opening Ease Factor of twice their total scores (+12 if another tradition opened the Gift already), against the master's Opening Total. A magus opening the Arts of an apprentice already Opened by another tradition needs 30 more on his Intellego Vim Lab Total.

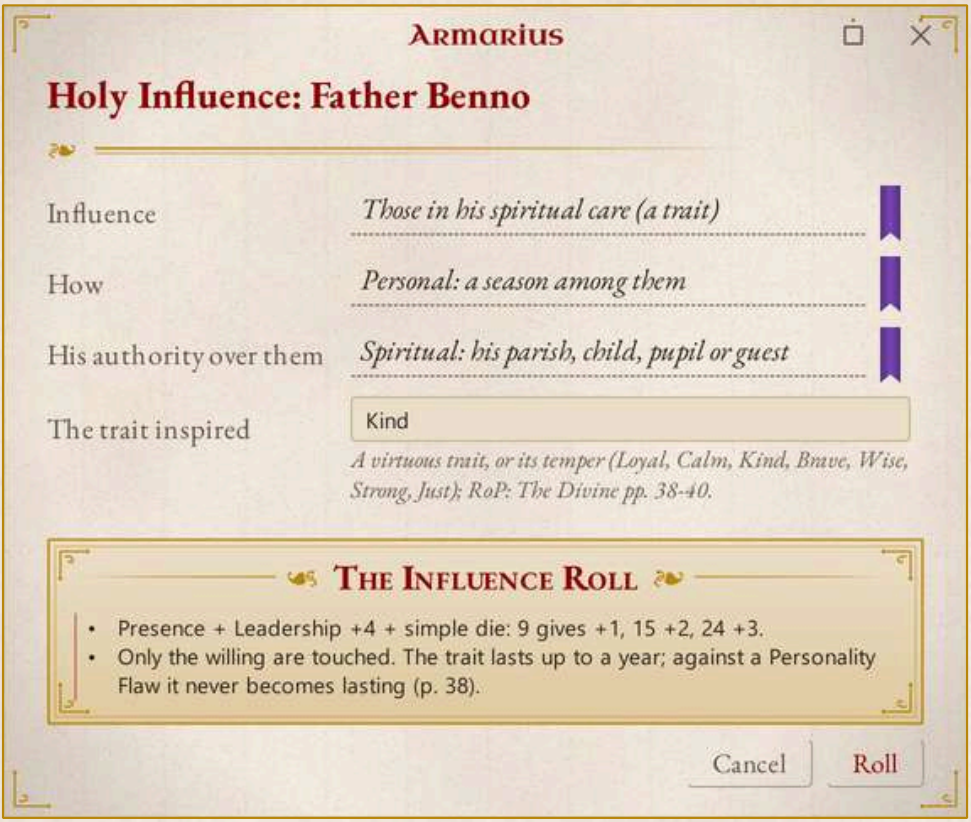
Plan it on the master's sheet as **Open a student's Gift to a tradition**, and the tradition chapter's **Opening** says what the master's total is set against. The app applies Rival Magic's extra 30 when Leandro or any magus opens such a child's Arts (*Making a Magus*).

10. Holy power: Father Benno

The village church below Rabenstein has a priest, and the Church has a power of its own. Make Father Benno from the Definitive Edition's **The Priest** template (a companion): it starts In Play, with Priest, Inspirational, Sense Holiness and Unholiness, a Relic, Leadership 3 and Folk Ken 6.

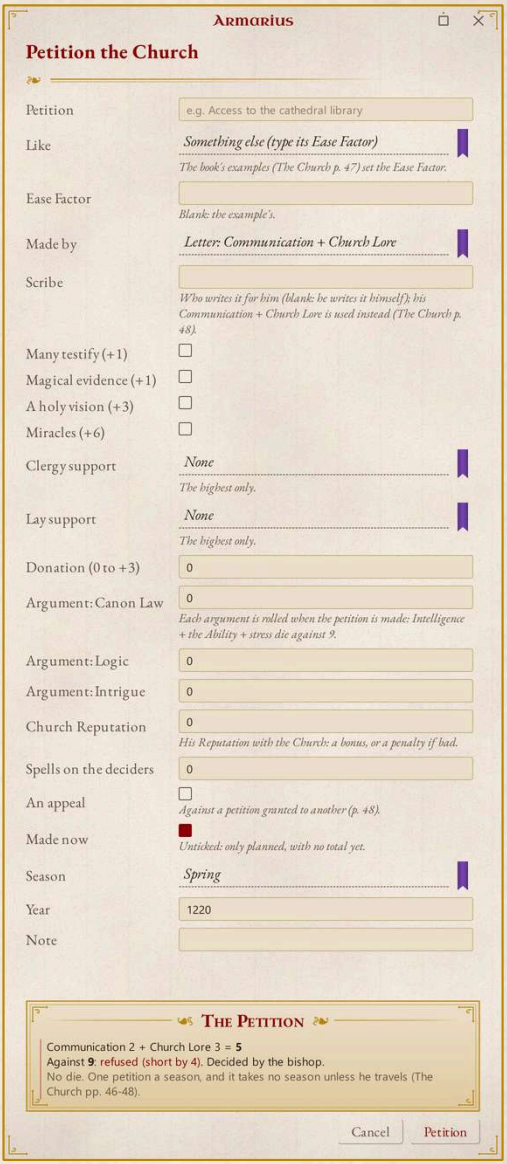
> **The rule · RoP:D pp. 36-38**
>
> A priest or anyone with spiritual authority leads others to virtue: a simple die + Presence + Leadership; 9 gives the trait he preaches +1, 15 +2, 24 +3 (the most). Only the willing are touched. A season among them lasts up to a year; a short ceremony, for a Faith or Confidence Point, much less. The same total can temper a Divine aura instead.

His **Religion** chapter holds the Divine's buttons: **Holy Influence**, **Invoke God's Aid**, **Invoke a Saint**, **Devotion Points**, **Mystic Path**, and the Church's own, **Petition the Church**, **Add Canon Case** and **Holy Orders**.



Holy Influence: Father Benno, Influence "Those in his spiritual care (a trait)", How "Personal: a season among them", His authority over them "Spiritual: his parish, child, pupil or guest", the trait inspired "Kind". The Influence Roll box reads "Presence + Leadership +4 + simple die: 9 gives +1, 15 +2, 24 +3." and "Only the willing are touched. The trait lasts up to a year; against a Personality Flaw it never becomes lasting (p. 38)."

Petition the Church asks the bishop for something (a dispensation, a benefice) with Communication + Church Lore against the petition's Ease Factor, no die (*The Church* pp. 46-48). **Holy Orders** opens a **Church** chapter with his grade, his standing, and the ladder to the next grade, an **Ordination** season's examination.



Petition the Church: made by Letter (Communication + Church Lore), with the book's helps (testimony, evidence, support, a donation, arguments) all unused. The Petition box reads "Communication 2 + Church Lore 3 = 5. Against 9: refused (short by 4). Decided by the bishop. No die. One petition a season, and it takes no season unless he travels (The Church pp. 46-48)."

Magi have their own road to the spirits: Hermetic Theurgy (*The Mysteries Revised Edition* pp. 64-88), whose figures are under **Spirits and Names**, in Magic Outside the Lab on a theurgist's Hermetic Magic chapter.

What you do by hand

- **A Gifted newcomer's Opening**: plan it as a master's season; ticking the tradition alone doesn't Open the Gift.

Where the rules come from

Hedge Magic, Revised Edition: Opening the Gift to a tradition (p. 7); folk witches and their covens (p. 33); creating a folk witch, minimum scores and the Folk Witch Virtue (p. 34); the folk witch Virtues and Flaws (pp. 35-36); Folk Witch Magic and casting (pp. 36-38).

Ars Magica Definitive Edition: The Priest (p. 34); character creation (pp. 43-50).

The Cradle & the Crescent: the Order of Suleiman (pp. 19-60); the Nizaris (pp. 162-165). *Rival Magic*: common rules for non-Hermetic magic and Opening the Gift (p. 6); the Amazons (pp. 13-46), the Augustan Brotherhood (pp. 47-74), the Muspelli (pp. 75-109), the Sorcerers of Soqotra (pp. 110-141).

Realms of Power: The Divine: holy influence (pp. 36-38). *The Church*: petitions (pp. 46-48). *The Mysteries, Revised Edition*: spirit magic and Hermetic Theurgy (pp. 64-88).



Armarius

A saga manager for Ars Magica

Founding and Keeping a Covenant

Falkenwacht, a small Spring covenant built by the book, and then the business of keeping it: its treasury, its trade with the towns, and the long road from Spring to Summer.

Guide 9 of 17

Before the magi, the covenant. A new saga starts with the troupe deciding together where the characters live: how rich it is, what's in its library, where its vis comes from, and what trouble lives next door. After that comes the part nobody writes stories about until it goes wrong: paying for bread, wages and candles, year after year.

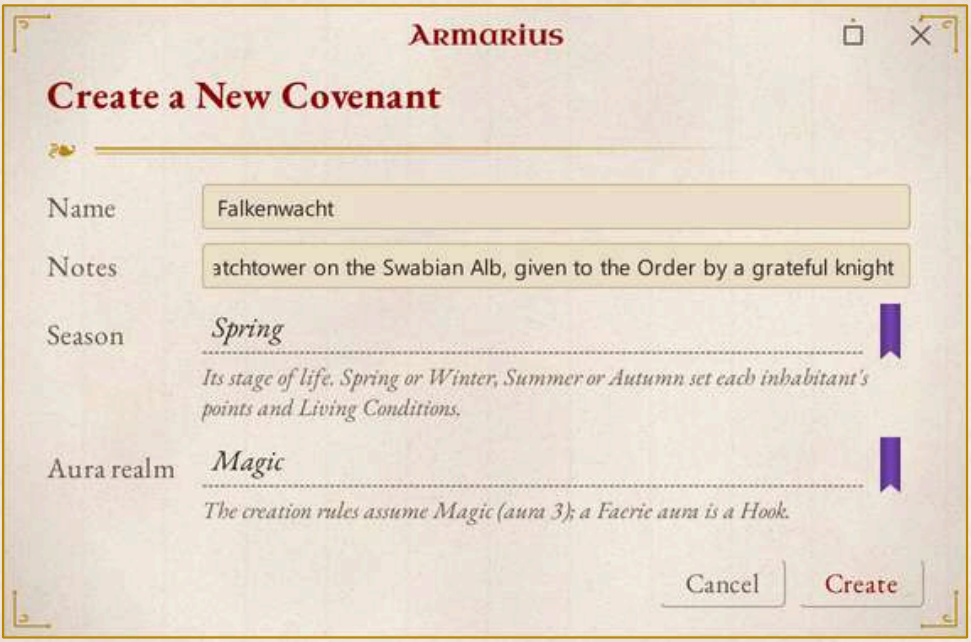
This guide founds **Falkenwacht**, a watchtower further along the Swabian Alb given to the Order by a grateful knight in 1223, on the same Creation Worksheet the app uses for characters. Then it opens the covenant's books, looks at the towns it trades with, and at what changes as a covenant grows from Spring towards Summer.

The rules are the *Ars Magica Definitive Edition*'s (DE) chapter six, Covenants (pp. 177-196); *Covenants* adds to the finances (chapter five, pp. 56-69) and Loyalty; *City & Guild* has labor, towns and guilds (pp. 8-50); and *Transforming Mythic Europe* (TME) lets magic save the covenant money (pp. 120-121).

1. A new covenant

On the saga's page, open **The Covenants** and click the **New Covenant** card at the end of the covenants: it asks for a name, a line of notes, its season and its aura's realm. Falkenwacht is a Spring covenant: young, small, and hopeful. It starts In Creation, and the worksheet opens on its first step, Baseline.

> **The rule · DE p. 179**
>
> Every covenant starts with the baseline for free: a stone building in a Magic aura of 3, enough mundane resources that nobody worries about food, about one grog and two other covenfolk per magus, and a standard laboratory for each magus.



Create a New Covenant: Name "Falkenwacht", Notes "...watchtower on the Swabian Alb, given to the Order by a grateful knight", Season Spring, Aura realm Magic.

2. Baseline: how powerful?

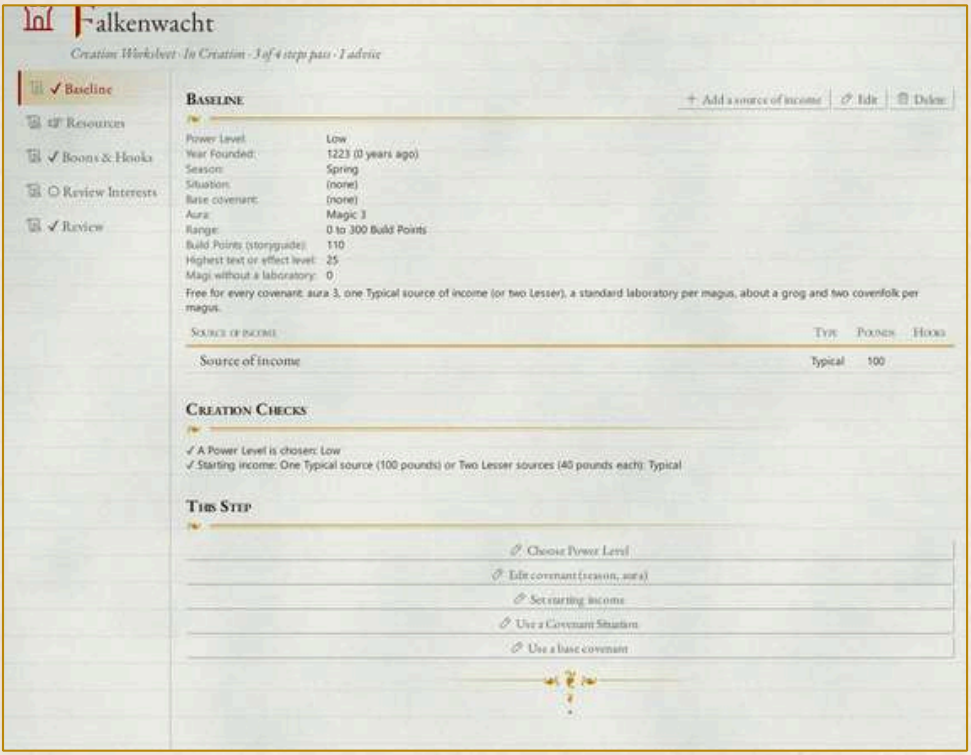
The rule · DE p. 179

The troupe picks the Power Level the player magi can reach: Low 0-300 Build Points (no Lab Text or enchantment over level 25), Medium 300-1250 (level 40, at least 10 years old), High 1250-2500, or Legendary. A weak covenant, the book's example, spends 200.

Choose Power Level asks for the level, the storyguide's Build Points and the Year Founded. We want something scrappy: Low, with 110 Build Points. Then **Set starting income**: one Typical source (100 pounds a year) or two Lesser ones (40 each). Falkenwacht takes the Typical source: tolls on the road below the tower.

The rule · DE pp. 188-189

A covenant's base is one Typical source of income (100 pounds a year), or two Lesser ones (40 each). It assumes about six magi: add 15 pounds for each magus over that, take 15 off for each under (6 for a single Lesser source).



Baseline done: Power Level Low, founded 1223, Spring, aura Magic 3, 110 Build Points, highest text or effect level 25, one Typical source of income of 100 pounds, and both checks met.

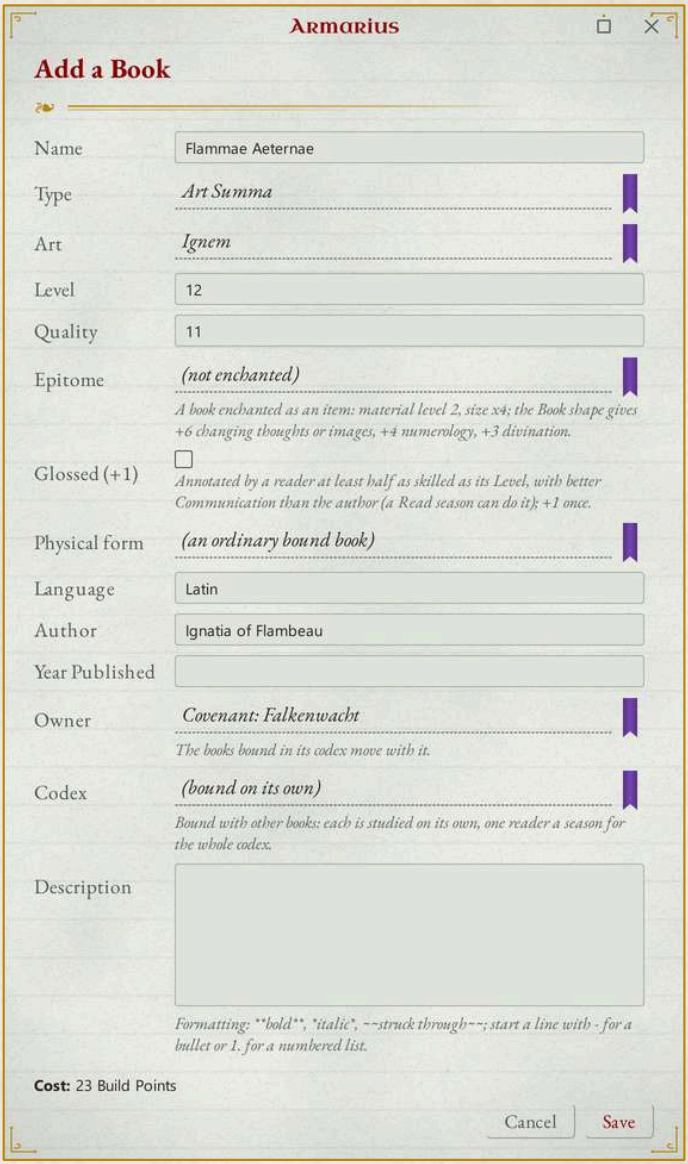
Use a base covenant starts from one of the book's three instead (Weak, Medium, Powerful), with placeholder books and vis to fill in, and **Use a Covenant Situation** takes one of the books' ready-made sets of Boons and Hooks.

3. Resources: spending the Build Points

The **Resources** step is the shopping list. **Buy something** asks what: a new book, a vis source, a vis stock, an enchanted item, or a specialist, craftsperson, teacher or guard. Each one's form says what it costs as you type.

What things cost · DE pp. 179-181

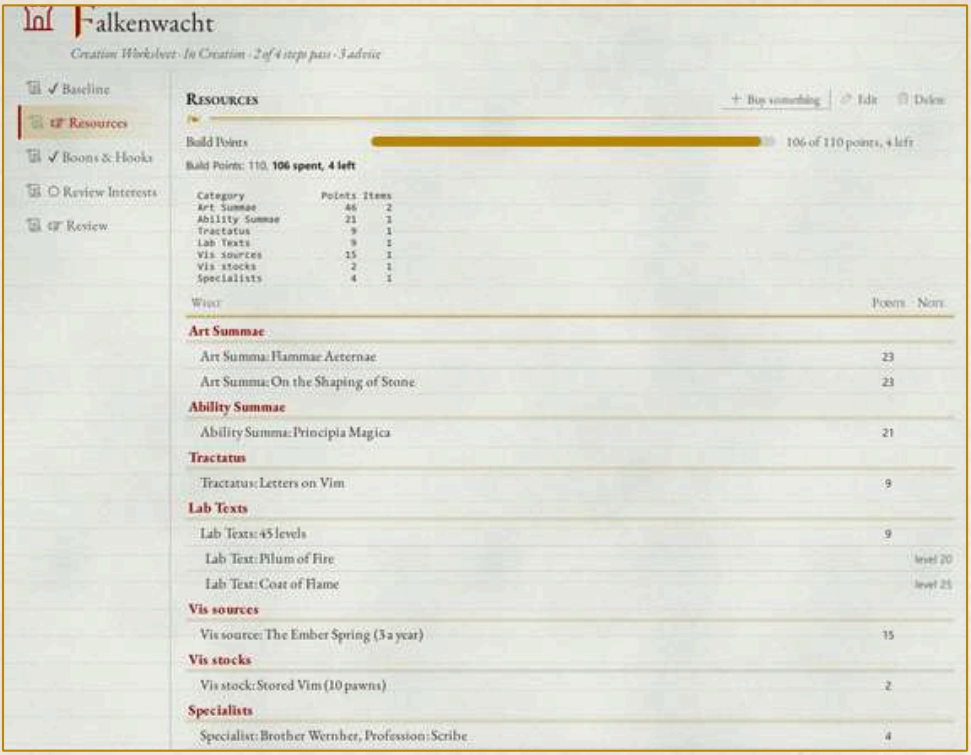
Art summa: level + quality, level at most 20, quality at most 11 + (20 - level). Ability summa: quality + 3 x level, level at most 8. Tractatus: its quality, at most 11. Lab Texts: 1 per 5 levels. Vis source: 5 per pawn a year. Vis stock: 1 per 5 pawns. Specialist: their highest Ability score.



Add a Book: Flammae Aeternae, an Ignem summa of Level 12 and Quality 11. Cost: 23 Build Points.

Here's what Falkenwacht bought, 106 of its 110 Build Points:

Resource	Build Points
Flammae Aeternae, Ignem summa L12 Q11	23
On the Shaping of Stone, Terram summa L10 Q13	23
Principia Magica, Magic Theory summa L4 Q9	21 (9 + 12)
Letters on Vim, Vim tractatus Q9	9
Lab Texts for *Pilum of Fire* (20) and *Coat of Flame* (25): 45 levels	9
The Ember Spring, 3 pawns of Ignem vis each Summer	15
10 pawns of Vim in store	2
Brother Wernher, a scribe with Profession: Scribe 4	4



The Resources step: the Build Points bar at "106 of 110 points, 4 left", a tally by category, everything bought under its heading, and the checks, with "Build Points spent: 4 unspent" as advice.

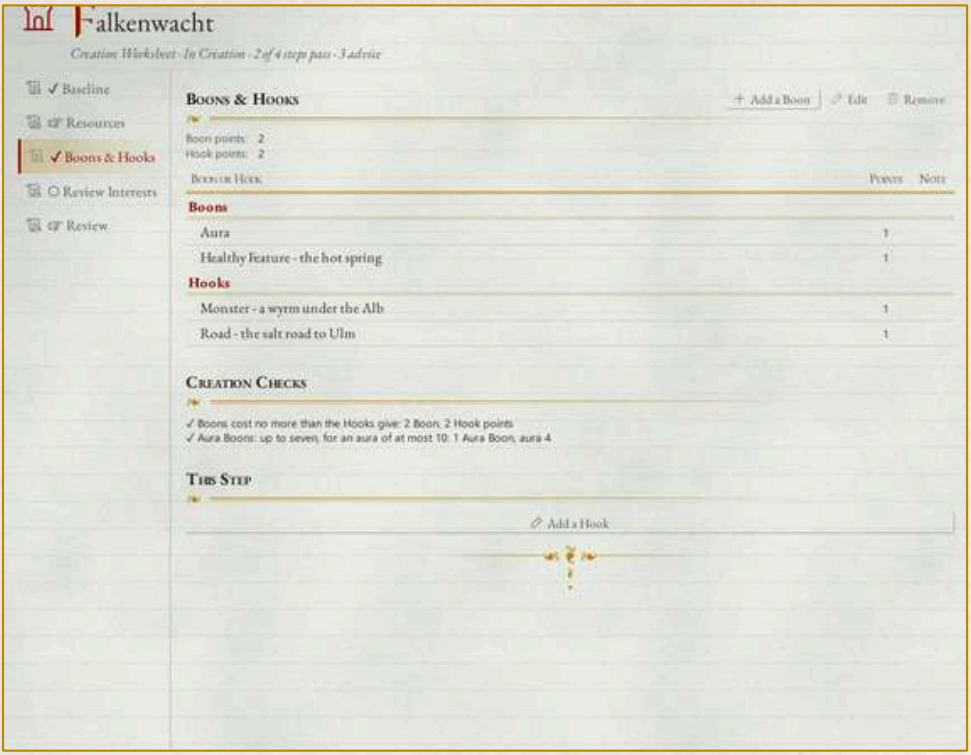
> **What happened.** 106 of 110 Build Points spent. Every book is inside the creation limits and nothing is over level 25, so the checks pass; the 4 left over earn a ☞ (advice), not a ✗.

4. Boons and Hooks

The rule · DE pp. 181-184

Hooks are story trouble the troupe wants (Minor 1 point, Major 3); they don't give Build Points but pay for Boons (Minor 1, Major 3). A Minor Aura Boon raises the Magic aura by 1 (up to seven times).

Falkenwacht takes two Minor Hooks: a **Monster** (a wyrm sleeping under the Alb) and a **Road** (the salt road to Ulm runs past the gate, and so does everyone on it). That pays for two Minor Boons: **Aura**, taking it to 4, and a **Healthy Feature**, the hot spring. **Add a Boon** and **Add a Hook** each open the list with its rules beside it, then ask for a line of detail.



Boons & Hooks: Aura and Healthy Feature (the hot spring) as Boons, Monster (a wyrm under the Alb) and Road (the salt road to Ulm) as Hooks, 2 Boon points against 2 Hook points, and the checks "Boons cost no more than the Hooks give" and "Aura Boons: up to seven, for an aura of at most 10: 1 Aura Boon, aura 4".

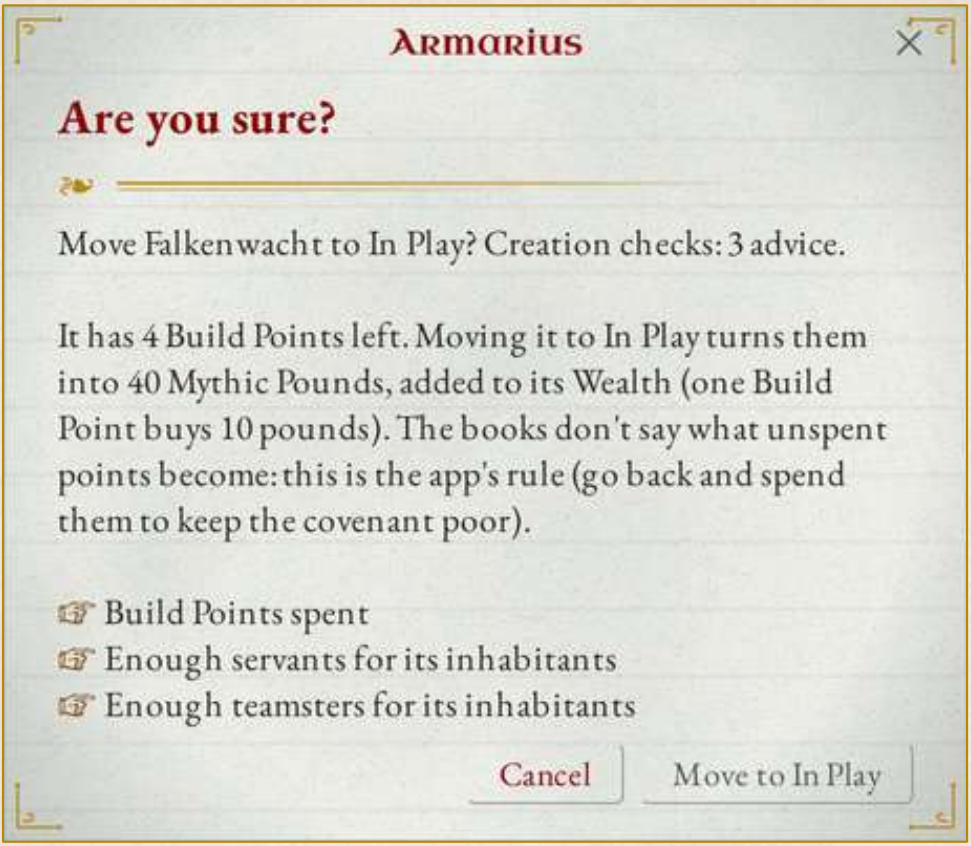
A Contested, Indiscreet or Dwindling Resource Hook names one of the covenant's sources: **Edit** on it chooses which, and that source is then marked to match.

Hooks are the troupe's story ideas, and once the covenant is in play they can turn into stories. **Suggest a Story**, beside the Hooks, takes one (the wyrm, say), proposes a title from its name and detail, and shows what the Hook says; change the title, choose the season it's set for, and **Accept** makes it an open Story Event in the covenant's Diary and an entry on Ahead for that season. The story itself is yours to write.

5. Review, and into play

Review Interests comes first: untick anything the covenant will never take up, such as Manors or Ships, and that chapter stays off its sheet. **Review** then lists anything still open. Ours is all advice: the four spare Build Points, and a reminder that the covenant will need servants and teamsters once it has inhabitants. It also says how many people the baseline gives free, about one grog and two other covenfolk for each magus, and **Add the baseline's people** puts them on the Inhabitants as a row of grogs and a row of servants and craftsmen, whose numbers you can change there (DE p. 179). Falkenwacht's magi haven't moved in yet, so there's no one to add.

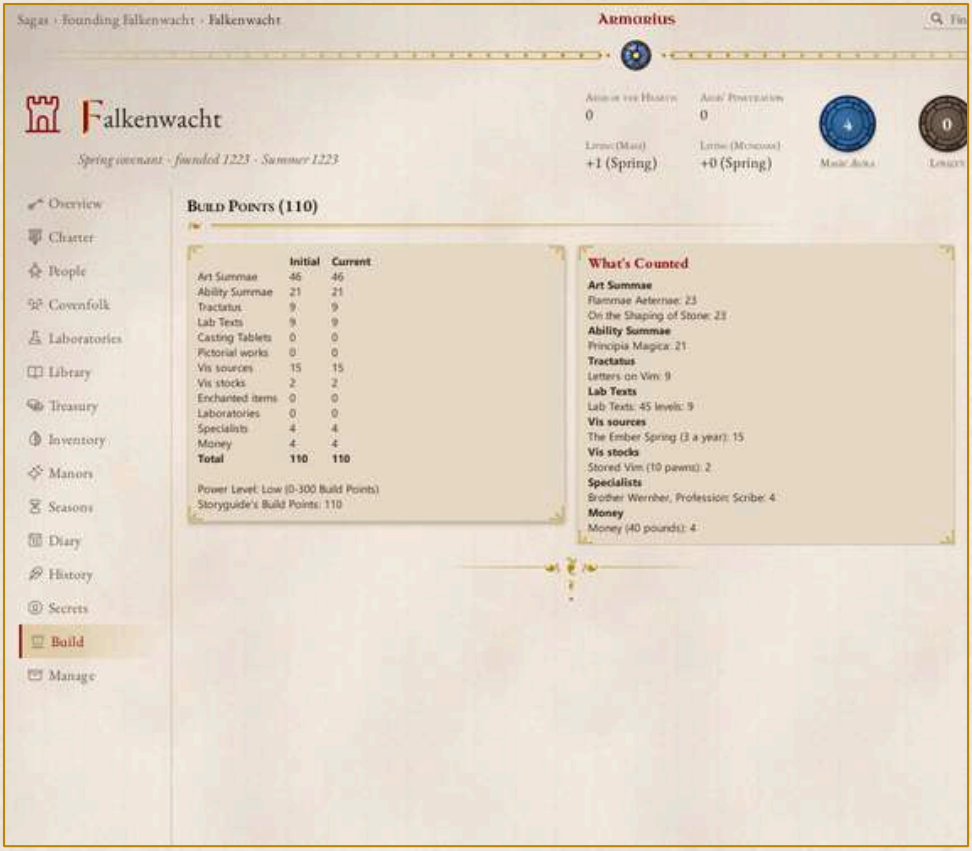
Move to In Play asks once more.



Are you sure? "Move Falkenwacht to In Play? Creation checks: 3 advice. It has 4 Build Points left. Moving it to In Play turns them into 40 Mythic Pounds, added to its Wealth (one Build Point buys 10 pounds). The books don't say what unspent points become: this is the app's rule (go back and spend them to keep the covenant poor).", and the three advice lines: Build Points spent, enough servants, enough teamsters.

The book doesn't say what happens to unspent Build Points. The app's rule is that each becomes 10 pounds of Wealth, and the question says so, so you can go back and spend them instead.

What happened. Falkenwacht is In Play: aura 4, a library of four books and two Lab Texts, 3 pawns of Ignem a year, 10 of Vim in store, a scribe, and 40 pounds in the strongbox. Its **Build** chapter keeps what the Build Points bought.



Falkenwacht In Play, Magic Aura 4: its Build chapter, Build Points (110), 106 of resources and 4 of Money in the Initial and Current columns, and What's Counted listing each purchase, down to "Money (40 pounds): 4".

Its **Living Conditions** follow its season while they're left blank on **Edit**: +1 for its magi and 0 for everyone else in a Spring covenant (DE p. 190).

6. The covenant's books: the Treasury

Choose **Treasury** in the chapters on the left. At the top is **The Year's Account**: Annual Income, Annual Expense and the Surplus. Below are **Wealth** (with the cost before savings, the savings, what it can afford and next year's inflation), **What the Year Is Reckoned On** (points of inhabitants, laboratories, weapons and armour), and the tables: Sources of Income, Yearly Expenditure, Cost Savings and The Year's Purchases.

The rule · DE pp. 189-194

Each inhabitant is worth points: a magus 5 in a Spring or Winter covenant (10 in Summer or Autumn), a companion 3, a specialist or craftsman 2, other covenfolk 1, a horse 1. The year costs, per 10 points of inhabitants, 1 pound for buildings, 2 for consumables, 5 for provisions and 2 for wages; a standard laboratory a pound; weapons and armour a pound per 320 points; a pound of writing materials for each magus and scribe; and at least a pound of sundries. A covenant needs 2 servants for every 10 points of its other inhabitants, and a teamster for every 10 after that.



Falkenwacht's Treasury chapter, The Year's Account · 1223: Annual Income 100 £, Annual Expense 6 £, Surplus +94 £; Wealth 40 £, Before Savings 6, Cost Savings 0, Can Afford about 100 points, Next Year's Inflation +0; Points of Inhabitants 2, Laboratories 0, Weapons & Armor 0; Sources of Income (1), its Typical source at 100, and Yearly Expenditure below, each row with how it's reckoned.

What happened. With only Brother Wernher living there so far, Falkenwacht spends 6 pounds a year against its 100. When its magi move in, with their labs, grogs and servants, the expense climbs quickly: every row works itself out from the rest of the sheet, and the inspector shows how the row you click was reckoned.

What you type here: **Wealth** (Edit beside it), the **Tithes**, **Inflation** and **Sundry** rows, any **Emergency Savings**, and the sources of income. **Give Silver** sends pounds to a character or another covenant. Under **The Year's Purchases**, **Buy from Goods** buys a priced good from the Goods catalog and **Add** anything else; they go onto Sundry, and when the year closes each is written in the Diary under Purchases & Sales.

> **The rule · DE p. 185**
>
> At a Prevailing Loyalty of -6 or below, the covenfolk work sullenly, and any source of income that relies on their labour is halved.

Tick **Relies on the covenfolk's work** on each source of income that does (a farm, a mill, a workshop), and the year's Income counts it at half whenever the covenfolk's Loyalty falls that low.

The end of the year

When Winter is advanced, the surplus goes into Wealth, and a deficit that Emergency Savings didn't cover comes out of it. Inflation should creep up too.

> **The rule · DE p. 193**
>
> A covenant's spending slowly raises the prices it pays. Inflation starts at 0 in the first year and rises by about a pound for every hundred pounds spent each year: less in a good year, more when the magi spend lavishly, and not at all in a year when spending falls.

The year-end question says so ("inflation grows a pound per hundred spent"), and the Advance Season card does it.

Saving and earning

Laborers save a pound of Provisions each (up to half of it), and **craftspeople** save in their field (a smith on consumables, a mason on buildings): add them on the Covenfolk chapter and the Cost Savings fill in.

> **The rule · DE p. 194; Covenants p. 67; TME pp. 120-121**
>
> Magic can save money too: an enchanted device that does covenfolk's work saves a pound a year for each magnitude of its effects; a Ritual cast for the covenant, five pounds a magnitude; together they count as laborers, so no more than half the Provisions.

The **Magic** row of Cost Savings counts the covenant's devices ticked as doing covenfolk's work, and the year's Rituals. To grow an income, click a source and **Improve**: pick the year's effect (*Covenants* pp. 57-58), and tick **Improved by magic** if the magi did it. The form warns when magic makes more than the 2 pounds a magus a year that several Tribunals allow.

7. Towns and guilds

Falkenwacht sells its tolls' worth in Ulm, and Ulm is a town with a charter, a council and guilds. Towns are **neighbours** in the saga's **The Region** chapter (*The Saga and Its World* covers the Region): **New Town** makes one, and its page has chapters for its **Charter**, its **Guilds** and its **Court**, and its fairs and markets.

> **The rule · City & Guild pp. 8-14, 41-50**
>
> A town's charter is granted by a lord, the Church, or held by the townsmen as a commune; it sets the town's privileges (its own courts, a market, a cap on fines, toll exemptions) and its tax. A citizen has a sympathetic connection to everyone under the same charter. Guilds are craft, service or merchant guilds, of apprentices, journeymen and masters; an apprentice's piece after seven years is a stress die + a Characteristic + Craft against 9.

For a merchant companion, *City & Guild*'s Labor Points measure his business. A season of work earns (Characteristic + Craft, or Communication + Profession) x his Wealth Multiplier, and a story can earn seasons' worth (*City & Guild* pp. 38-40). On his **Planning** chapter, **Labor Points from a Story** and **Invest Time or Money** sit under A Season's Work: speculation, charity, a marriage broker, a lavish party, each with its own roll (pp. 110-129).

8. Spring to Summer

A covenant has seasons as a character has ages. Falkenwacht is Spring: new, poor, hopeful. In a few decades, with a full library and a famous name, it may be Summer; much later, Autumn, and at last Winter.

> **The rule · DE pp. 174–176, 190**
>
> A Spring covenant is new and still finding its feet; Summer is its prime, with established resources and reputation; Autumn has more than it can use and is growing set in its ways; Winter is in decline. The season decides the Living Conditions modifier (Spring and Winter +1 for magi and 0 for others; Summer and Autumn +2 and +1) and how many points each inhabitant costs.

The covenant's season is its own setting on **Edit**: change it when the troupe agrees the covenant has grown up. The points of inhabitants follow it at once, and so do Living Conditions left blank.

What you do by hand

- **Hooks' stories**: Suggest a Story schedules one, but what happens in it is the storyguide's.
- **Inflation's** good and bad years are yours to adjust on its row.
- **A covenant's season** changes only when you change it.

Where the rules come from

Ars Magica Definitive Edition: covenant seasons (pp. 174-176); covenant situations (pp. 177-178); base covenants (p. 178); the baseline, Power Levels and books' costs (p. 179); Lab Texts, Casting Tablets, vis and enchanted items (p. 180); specialists and Hooks (pp. 181-182); Boons (pp. 183-184); Loyalty (p. 185); sources of income and their size (pp. 188-189); points of inhabitants, servants and teamsters, Living Conditions (pp. 190-191); expenditure, inflation and cost saving (pp. 193-194).

Covenants: income modification and magic in the economy (pp. 57-58); magical cost savings (p. 67). *Transforming Mythic Europe*: magic and the covenant's purchases (pp. 120-121). *City & Guild*: town charters (pp. 8-14); labor and Labor Points (pp. 38-40); guilds (pp. 41-50); merchants' investments (pp. 110-129).



Armarius

A saga manager for Ars Magica

Great Works

The Raven Tower rises over Rabenstein, the covenant's barge takes to the Danube, and Leandro's garden of magical beasts: Hermetic Projects, start to finish.

Guide 10 of 17

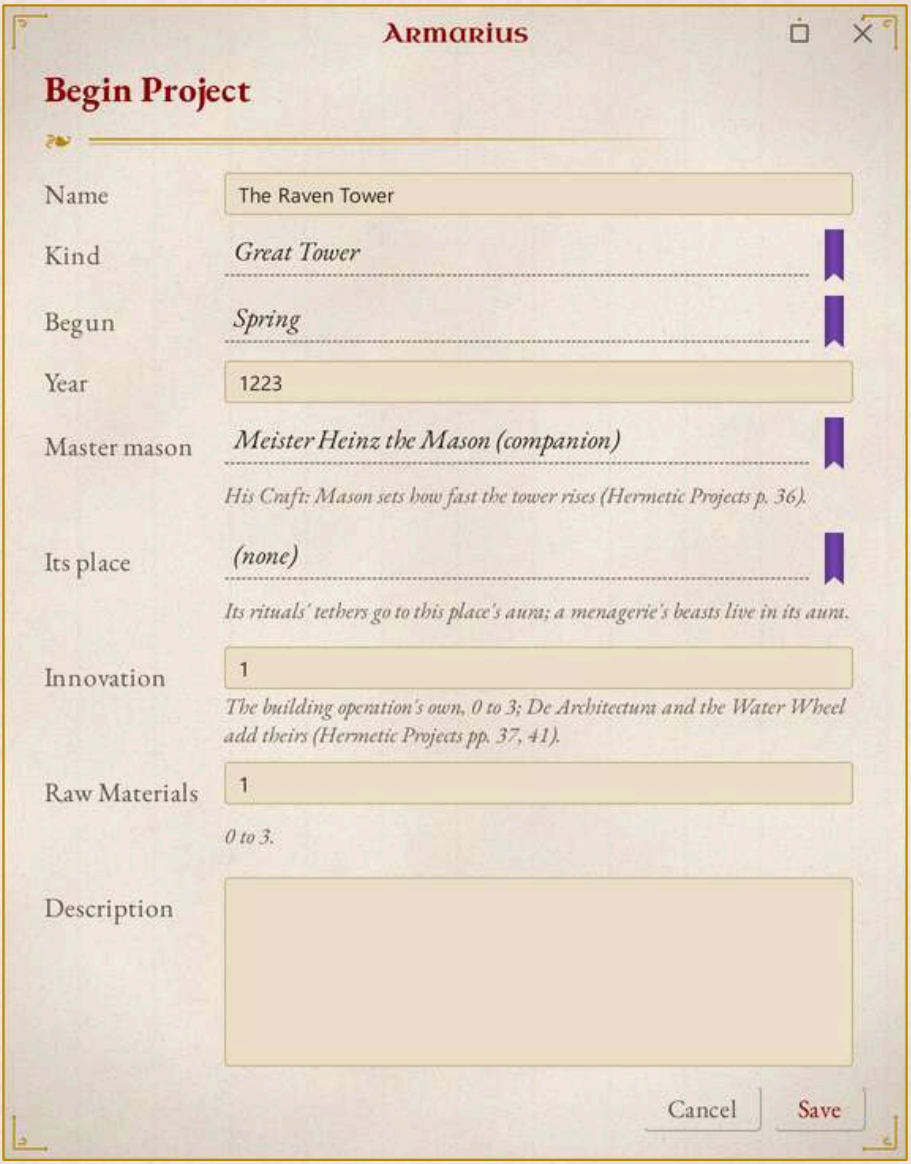
Some magi want more than a better spell. They want a tower a mile high, a ship that sails without wind, a garden of beasts out of the bestiaries. *Hermetic Projects* calls these great works, projects that outlast a magus's career and change the covenant that undertakes them, and it gives each one its own rules.

This guide follows three of them at Rabenstein from Spring 1223. **The Raven Tower**, begun with **Meister Heinz**, a mason the covenant hired from Ulm, and raised partly by ritual magic; **the Ulm barge**, the covenant's river boat on the Danube; and **the Beast-Garden**, where Leandro of Bonisagus keeps a white hart and hind of the Brandhalde with **Martin the Woodward** as their keeper.

The rules are *Hermetic Projects* (HP): the Great Tower (chapter three, pp. 29-52), the Hermetic Shipyard (chapter four, pp. 53-76) and the Menagerie of Magical Beasts (chapter seven, pp. 119-142), with *City & Guild* for workshops and damage (pp. 65-77, 86-87) and the *Ars Magica Definitive Edition* (DE) for taming beasts (pp. 384-385).

1. Beginning a project

A covenant's great works live on a **Projects** chapter, which appears once one is begun. On Rabenstein's **Seasons** chapter, under **Undertakings**, click **Begin Project**. Name it, choose the **Kind** (a Great Tower, a Menagerie, or one of the staged works in chapter 5), when it was begun, and, for a tower, its **Master mason**, its place (whose aura its rituals feed) and the building operation's **Innovation** and **Raw Materials**, 0 to 3 each.



Begin Project: Name "The Raven Tower", Kind Great Tower, Begun Spring 1223, Master mason Meister Heinz the Mason, Innovation 1, Raw Materials 1.

2. The Great Tower

The rule · HP pp. 36-38

A mason with an effective Craft: Mason of 5 builds one level of the tower, 20 feet, a season; 10 builds two, 15 three. The whole building operation is the master mason's workshop: Workshop Total = Intelligence + Craft: Mason + Innovation + Raw Materials, against 3 for shoddy work, 6 standard, 12 superior, 15 excellent. The tower's damage levels come from its weakest work: 1, 2, 3 or 4 by quality, x4 for something of its size. Storms, fire, earthquakes and assaults call for a stress check: stress die + Craft: Mason (+3 excellent, +1 superior, -1 shoddy, -1 repaired) against 15.

What happened. The Projects chapter now shows the tower: its height, when it was begun, its quality and damage levels, its tethers, and the master mason's lines.



Rabenstein's Projects chapter: Hermetic Projects (1) lists The Raven Tower, Great Tower, 1223, not built; below, The Raven Tower: Great Tower, with Edit Project, Stress Check and Conjure Levels; Height 0 ft (0 levels), Begun Spring 1223, Quality "nothing built yet"; "Master mason: Meister Heinz the Mason, Int +1, Craft: Mason 6 = 6: 1 level a season, 80 ft a year; 10 for two levels. Workshop Total: Int 1 + Craft: Mason 6 + Innovation 1 + Raw Materials 1 = 9: Standard work now."; Works (0) and Craft Devices (+0, at most +6) below.

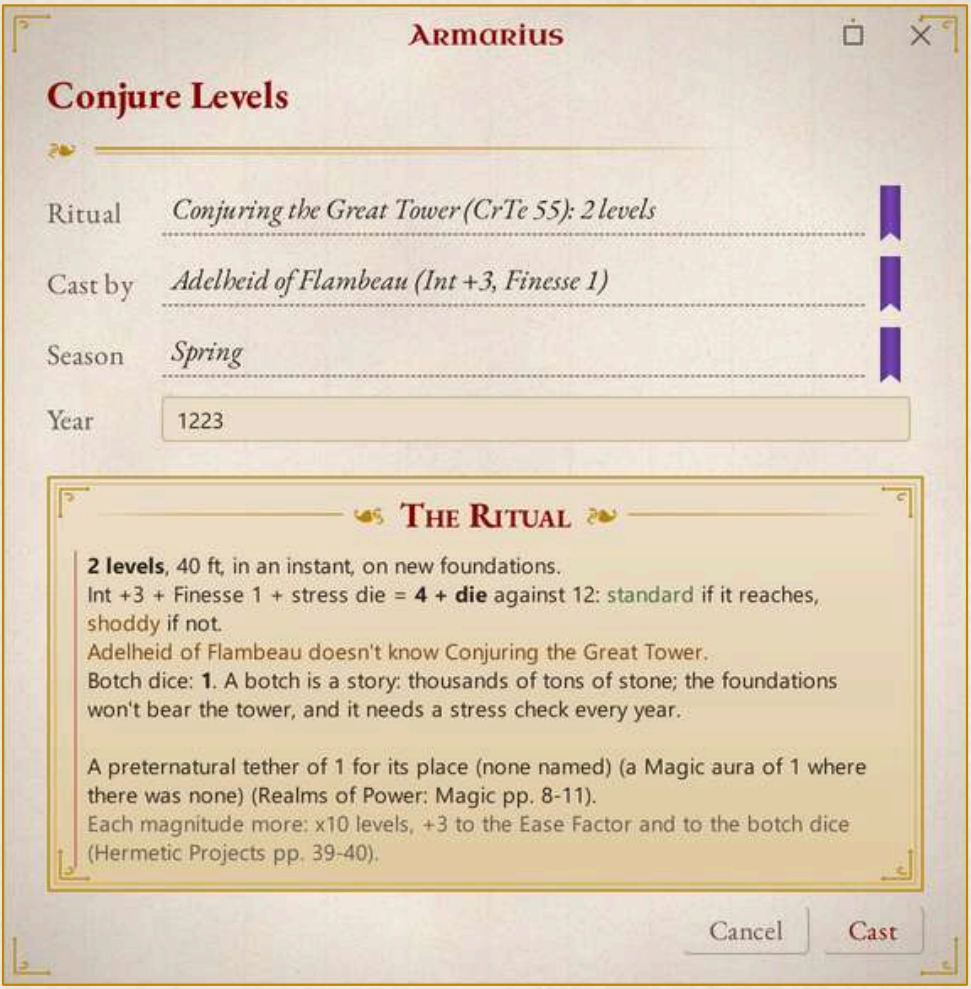
Raising it by ritual

Building a mile-high tower stone by stone takes a lifetime, so the magi start it with a Ritual. **Conjure Levels**, beside the tower, works one out.

The rule · HP p. 39

Conjuring the Great Tower (CrTe 55 Ritual) raises the foundations and the first two levels; Heights of the Great Tower (CrTe 50) adds four more. The caster rolls Intelligence + Finesse + stress die against 12: standard work if it reaches, shoddy if not; a botch leaves foundations that need a stress check every year. Each casting gives the place a preternatural tether of 1, a Magic aura of 1 where there was none.

Choose the **Ritual** and who **Cast** it, and the foot gives the roll.



Conjure Levels: Ritual "Conjuring the Great Tower (CrTe 55): 2 levels", Cast by Adelheid of Flambeau. The foot reads "2 levels, 40 ft, in an instant, on new foundations. Int +3 + Finesse 1 + stress die = 4 + die against 12: standard if it reaches, shoddy if not", warns "Adelheid of Flambeau doesn't know Conjuring the Great Tower", and gives the botch dice and the tether.

The Ritual is a level 55 invention (HP gives its Lab Totals: 110 for one season down to 69 for four); the form warns when the caster doesn't know it, so invent it first (*The Laboratory*). **Cast** keeps the casting in the tower's **Works**.

The mason's seasons

Meister Heinz's work is planned on his own sheet: on his **Planning** chapter, plan **Build the Great Tower**, and choose the **Work on the tower**: build new levels, repair a damage level, or rebuild a shoddy section as standard. A repair season builds nothing else (HP p. 38).

The **Craft Devices** list holds the enchanted tools that speed him: each kind (*The Arms of Hercules*, *True Falsework*, *The Stonemason's Art*, *The Laborer's Rest*) adds +1 to his Craft: Mason for the rate, never more in all than his own score; a *Flying Buttress* adds +1 to stress checks instead, and the *Water Wheel* +1 Innovation (HP pp. 39-41). Owning *De Architectura* adds +1 Innovation, to +3.

When a storm comes, **Stress Check** asks the event and its severity and rolls it: a failure loses a damage level, a botch more, and each lost level is a partial collapse and a story.

3. The covenant's ship

Rabenstein sells its wool in Ulm, and the Danube is the road. A river barge of the covenant's own saves the carters' fees.

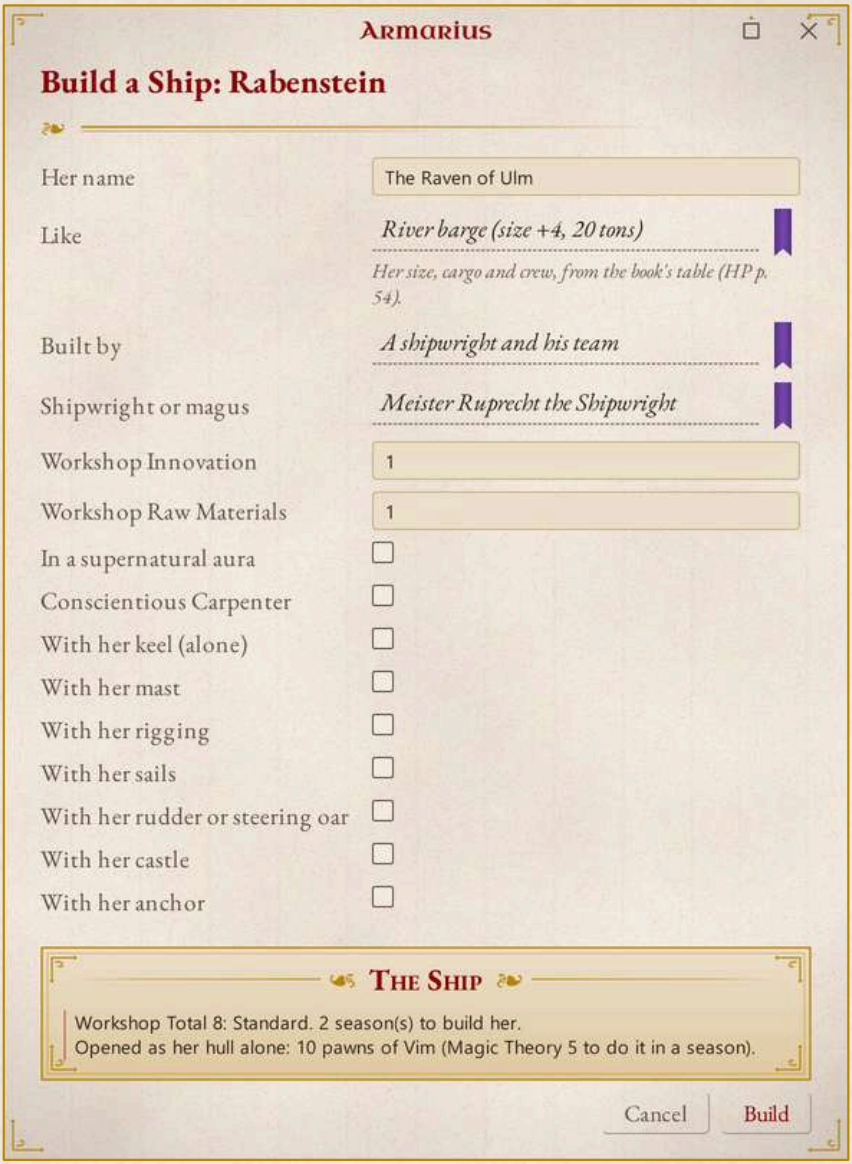
The rule · HP pp. 53-54

A ship's damage levels are her quality's base (shoddy 1, standard 2, superior 3, excellent 4, supernatural 5) times her size's modifier; she takes damage only from storms, fire, naval combat and magic. An enchanted ship adds the magnitude of all her invested effects to her stress checks. HP's table gives each kind of ship's size, cargo, crew and cost: a river barge is size +4, 20 tons, 3 crew; a medium cog +6, 100 tons, 12 crew.

Rabenstein hires **Meister Ruprecht**, a shipwright of Ulm (Intelligence +1, Profession: Shipwright 5), to build her. On Rabenstein's **Inventory** chapter, beside **Ships**, click **Build a Ship**. Name her (*The Raven of Ulm*), choose what she's **Like** from the book's table, and how she's **Built by**: a shipwright and his team, Rego craft magic, or a Creo ritual. Choose Ruprecht as the **Shipwright or magus** and type his workshop's **Innovation** and **Raw Materials** (1 each).

The rule · HP pp. 62-63; City & Guild pp. 67-68

A shipwright with Profession: Shipwright 5 and a team of about ten finishes a ship in two seasons, in one at 10. Her quality comes from his Workshop Total, Intelligence + Profession: Shipwright + the workshop's Innovation and Raw Materials, against the Craft Levels: 3 Shoddy, 6 Standard, 12 Superior, 15 Excellent. Rego craft magic or a Creo ritual can build her faster.



Build a Ship: Her name "The Raven of Ulm", Like "River barge (size +4, 20 tons)", Built by "A shipwright and his team", Meister Ruprecht the Shipwright, Workshop Innovation 1, Raw Materials 1. The foot reads "Workshop Total 8: Standard. 2 season(s) to build her. Opened as her hull alone: 10 pawns of Vim (Magic Theory 5 to do it in a season)."

> **What happened.** "Meister Ruprecht the Shipwright's Workshop Total 8 makes her Standard; 2 season(s) to build. The Raven of Ulm joins the Ships list. She is finished at the end of Summer 1223 (on Ahead)." The covenant's Diary keeps the building. The foot also says what opening her for enchantment would take: her hull alone, or her mast, rigging and the rest ticked as the parts of a compound device (HP pp. 66-67).

A ship the covenant already owns goes in with **Add** under Ships instead: choose what she's **Like**, and her size, cargo and crew fill in; set her quality, her captain and her home port.

Beside her, **Stress Check** rolls a storm or a fire (a stress die + the captain's Profession + her quality + her enchantments' magnitudes, against 15), and **Ship Combat** settles a meeting with another ship: the captains roll, the winner boards or slips away, and a boarding sets up a Fight on the saga's **Conflicts** for the crews (*City & Guild* pp. 77, 86-87; see *War*).

The Hermetic Shipyard itself, a laboratory grown big enough to enchant a whole ship on the slipway (HP chapter four), is a laboratory with the book's boat shed and Wheel, built and improved as any laboratory is.

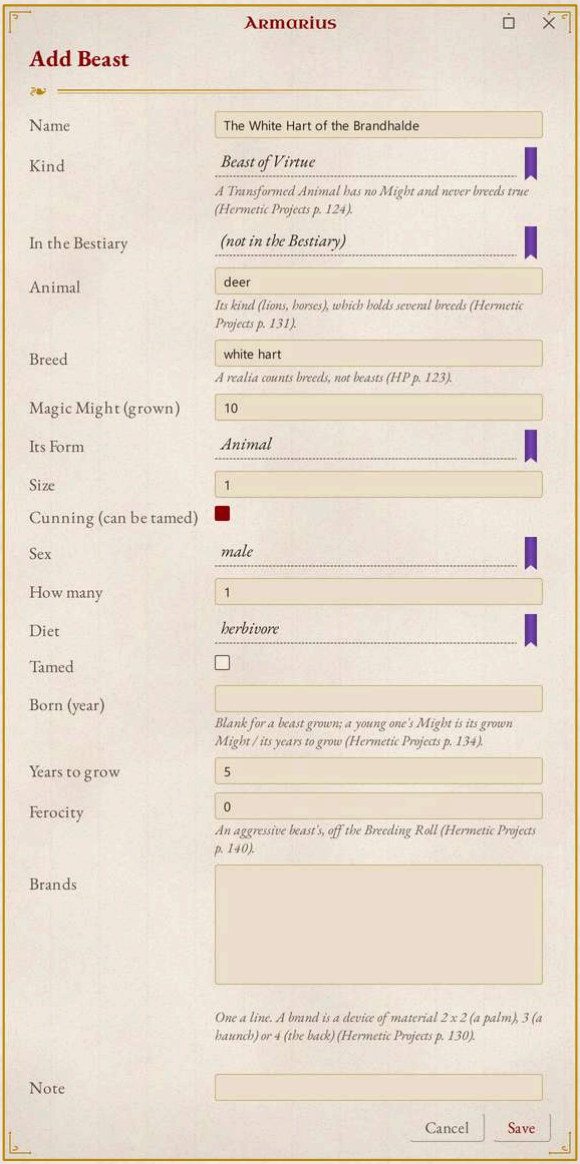
4. The Beast-Garden

Leandro has always wanted a menagerie, and in 1223 the troupe brings home a white hart and hind from the Brandhalde, Beasts of Virtue with a Magic Might of 10.

Begin a second project, Kind **Menagerie**. Its form names the **Lead handler** (Martin the Woodward) and up to two more, its **Owner** (Leandro) and the name of **His Reputation** for it ("Keeper of Beasts"), and **Its place**, whose aura the beasts live in.

> **The rule · HP pp. 119-138**
>
> A beast lives badly in a Magic aura weaker than a fifth of its Might, rounded up. Each handler can tend 10 domesticated herbivores per point of Animal Handling, half as many carnivores, a fifth as many wild beasts. A beast costs points of inhabitants as a horse costs 1, half as much for each Size smaller, double for each Size larger, and double again for a carnivore. Studied, the menagerie counts as a tractatus of Quality equal to its magical breeds.

Choose **Show Project** on the projects list to put the menagerie on the chapter in place of the tower. Then, under **Beasts**, **Add** each animal: its kind (a Beast of Virtue, a Beast of Legend, or a Transformed Animal, which never breeds true), its animal and breed, its Might and Form, Size, sex and diet, and whether it has Cunning (only then can it be tamed). "In the Bestiary" fills these in from a creature of the saga's Bestiary (on the saga's **Compendium** chapter).



Add Beast: "The White Hart of the Brandhalde", Beast of Virtue, Animal deer, Breed white hart, Magic Might 10, Form Animal, Size 1, Cunning ticked, male, herbivore.

Taming

The rule · DE pp. 384-385; HP p. 135

Taming a beast is a season's work. A magus works in his laboratory with his Rego (its Form) Lab Total, plus Animal Handling and Animal Ken, less the beast's Might; anyone else uses Intelligence + Animal Handling + Animal Ken - its Might, less the Gift's penalty. The points add up over consecutive seasons, and the beast is tamed when they reach its Might. A beast with Cunning can be tamed; an intelligent one must be befriended.

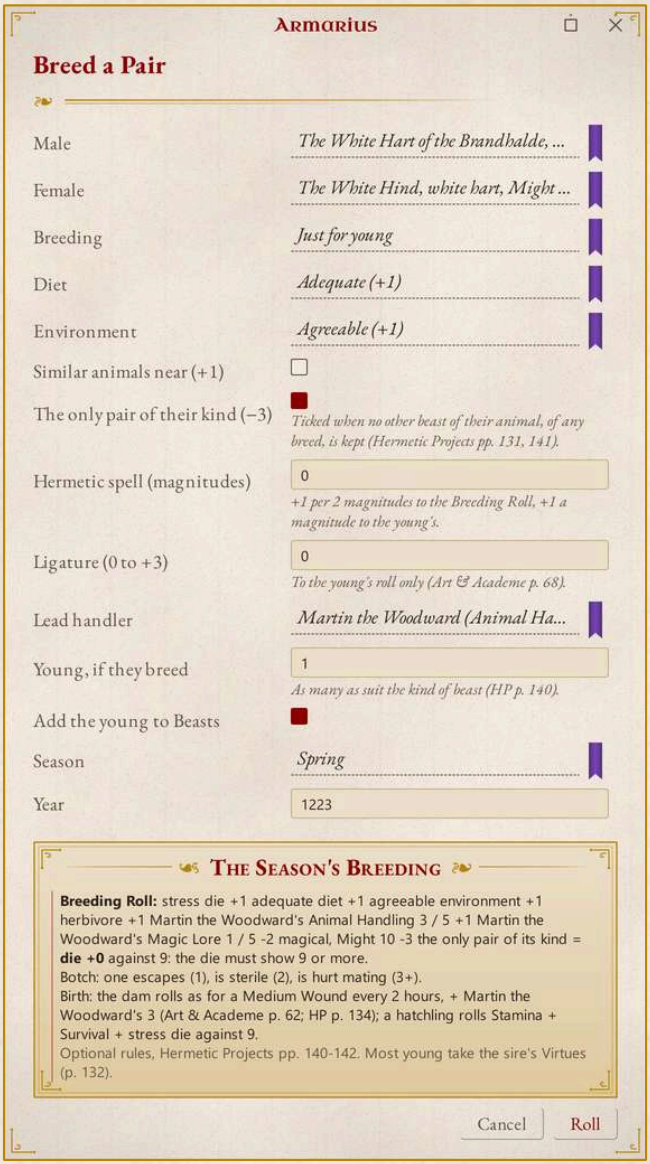
Click a beast and **Tame a Beast**, and choose who tames it. A magus's or companion's taming becomes a planned season, worked out when the season is played; a grog plans no seasons, so Martin's season is kept at once.

Breeding

The rule · HP pp. 140-142 (optional)

A Breeding Roll is a stress die + adequate diet +1 + agreeable surroundings +1 + a spell +1 per 2 magnitudes + herbivore +1 (carnivore -1) + the lead handler's Animal Handling / 5 and Magic Lore / 5 (each rounded up), - the beast's Might in magnitudes, -3 for the only pair of its kind, +1 for similar animals near, +3 if both are tamed, - an aggressive beast's Ferocity, against 9. A botch: one escapes, is sterile, or is hurt.

Under **Breedings**, **Add** (Breed a Pair): choose the male and female, what the breeding aims at (just young, the best of the breed, or a new line), the conditions, and the lead handler. The line spells out the roll before you roll it.



Breed a Pair: Male the White Hart, Female the White Hind, Breeding "Just for young", Diet Adequate, Environment Agreeable, The only pair of their kind ticked, Lead handler Martin the Woodward. The foot reads "Breeding Roll: stress die +1 adequate diet +1 agreeable environment +1 herbivore +1 Martin the Woodward's Animal Handling 3 / 5 +1 Martin the Woodward's Magic Lore 1 / 5 -2 magical, Might 10 -3 the only pair of its kind = die +0 against 9: the die must show 9 or more."

What happened. It's a long shot until the deer are tamed (+3) and Martin learns more: the die needs a 9. **Roll** keeps the breeding and, with "Add the young to Beasts" ticked, adds each fawn that lives, born this year and growing into its Might over five years.

The keeper's Reputation

The rule · HP p. 138

A menagerie earns its owner a Reputation. The storyguide awards its experience, and the book suggests a point for every ten visitors, a point per magnitude of the Might of each beast captured that year, a point for each year past the first, and a point for each beast sold to another magus.

At the end of the year, **Reputation Award** on the Beasts list works it out: type the visitors, tick the beasts captured this year, say whether it's past its first year and how many beasts were sold. The storyguide may change any figure. Saving adds the experience to Leandro's "Keeper of Beasts", which rises as an Ability does, and writes it in his Diary.

5. Other great works

Begin Project also offers three works the book follows stage by stage: **a Burning City** (a covenant in the heart of a volcano, HP pp. 9-28), **an Intangible Assassin** (the tunnel spells, for Wizard's War, pp. 77-95) and **a Living Corpse** (a ghost bound to an animated corpse, pp. 96-118). Most of each is spells and devices the magi invent as lab work, so the project keeps its chapter's stages and the seasons spent on each: choose the stage under **Spent on a project's stage** on a magus's lab plan, and the season is kept with that stage's works when it's played. Each has its own buttons for the chapter's rules: a Burning City's **Warning Bell** (its volcano's hazards are on Take Harm), an Assassin's **Gather a Connection** and **Lower an Aegis**, a Corpse's **Death Roll**.

What you do by hand

- **The staged projects' spells and devices** are invented as ordinary lab work; the project keeps the seasons spent.
- **The tower's story effects**, a collapse or a crisis of supplies, are yours to play out.

Where the rules come from

Hermetic Projects: the Great Tower's rate of progress, workshops and De Architectura (pp. 36-37); damage, stress checks and repairs (p. 38); construction magic and Conjuring the Great Tower (p. 39); Heights of the Great Tower and craft devices (pp. 39-41); the Hermetic Shipyard, ship damage and ship sizes (pp. 53-54); building a ship (pp. 62-65) and opening her (pp. 66-67); the Burning City (pp. 9-28); the Intangible Assassin (pp. 77-95); the Living Corpse (pp. 96-118); the Menagerie of Magical Beasts (pp. 119-138); optional rules for breeding (pp. 140-142).

City & Guild: workshops (p. 65); Craft Levels and the time to build (pp. 67-68); damage levels (p. 77); ship combat (pp. 86-87). *Ars Magica Definitive Edition*: taming and training animals (pp. 384-385).



Armarius

A saga manager for Ars Magica

A Knight's Life

Sir Gauthier of Montbrun keeps, grows and hands on his fief, Sir Aimery of Vaux talks a monk into spying for him, and both ride to the lists.

Guide 11 of 17

Not everyone at Rabenstein's table is a magus. The covenant's neighbours are knights and barons, and some of its companions are knights themselves. *Lords of Men* gives them their own rules: how a manor works, how a lord keeps horses and hawks and hands his land on, how a man of influence binds others to him, and how a knight wins renown at tournament.

This guide follows two of them. **Sir Gauthier of Montbrun**, a landed knight from Lorraine who holds his manors of **Baron Gottfried of Urach**, lists his manors, buys another, clears new fields, keeps his horses and dies; then the covenant of **Val Sombre**, across the valley, checks its land against its income. **Sir Aimery of Vaux**, Rabenstein's companion knight, wins **Brother Anselm**, the abbey's librarian, as his agent. Last, both of them ride to a tournament.

The rules are *Lords of Men* (LoM): its household, inheritance and relief (chapter two, pp. 9-11, 18), Control Through Emotional Bonds (pp. 22-25), establishments (chapter five, pp. 58-61), tournaments (pp. 64-69), Manorial Fiefs (chapter six, pp. 71-87) and the optional combat rules (chapter nine, pp. 126-132); *Covenants* for a covenant's income (chapter five, pp. 56-60); and the *Ars Magica Definitive Edition* (DE) for a widow's and a daughter's share (pp. 512-513), which wins where it touches the same ground.

1. What a manor is

Open Sir Gauthier's record and choose the **Manors** chapter. He holds two manors of the Baron: **Montbrun**, where his hall stands, and **Sankt Alban** in the woods.

> **The rule · LoM p. 72**
>
> A manor is around 600 acres, a third more or less without being unusual, and yields its lord 20 pounds a year in labour, goods and money: enough for a knight's household and gear, but not for a lost warhorse or a ransom. A hide (120-144 acres) is worth 4 pounds to the lord, a virgater family (24-32 acres) about a pound; a bovate is half a virgate, a cottar has ten acres or less, and the usual spread is 20% virgaters, 30% bovaters, 50% cottars. A mill or bakery the fief holds by custom is already inside the 20 pounds (p. 85).

The ledger shows each manor's acres, its land by legal status and its yield, and the line above adds them up. Choose a row and the inspector works out the rest: Montbrun's peasants follow the book's 20/30/50, its demesne flock is the usual 600 sheep for open land (two-thirds of the manor's 900, with about 150 pigs), and its crops are sown and reaped at the book's rates.

The rule · LoM pp. 75-76, 79-82

Land has six legal statuses: allod (held outright, with no lord), demesne (the lord's own), glebe (the Church's), rented to free peasants, villein land, and waste (p. 75). A winter crop is sown at 2 bushels an acre and yields 8, a spring crop 4 and 16. The average lord's flock is 600 sheep, over a thousand on marshland and 300 in wooded country; it is two-thirds of the manor's sheep, and the swineherd keeps a quarter as many pigs (p. 76). The manor court's fines (entry, heriot, mortuary, tallage, merchet and the rest) have no fixed sums (pp. 79-82).

The court's fines are kept as ticks and a line of words, since the book gives no sums for them.



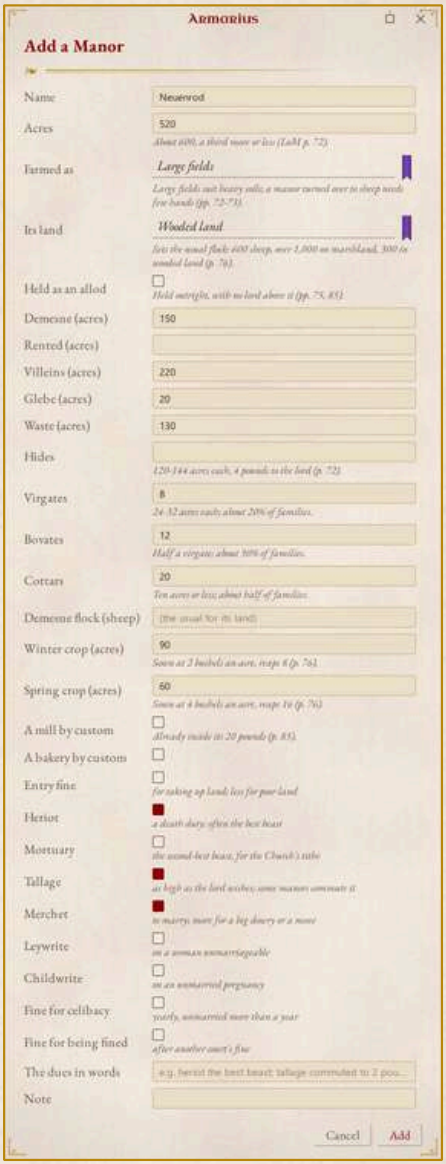
Sir Gauthier's Manors chapter: the line reads "Yield: 40 pounds a year (2 x 20, LoM p. 72) · Land: 1,200 acres"; Montbrun is chosen, and the inspector shows its land, peasants, flock and crops, each figure with its page; the stables sit under Establishments and the relief of 10 pounds under Household.

What happened. Sir Gauthier has 2 manors, 1,200 acres and 40 pounds a year; his relief to the Baron stands at 10 pounds.

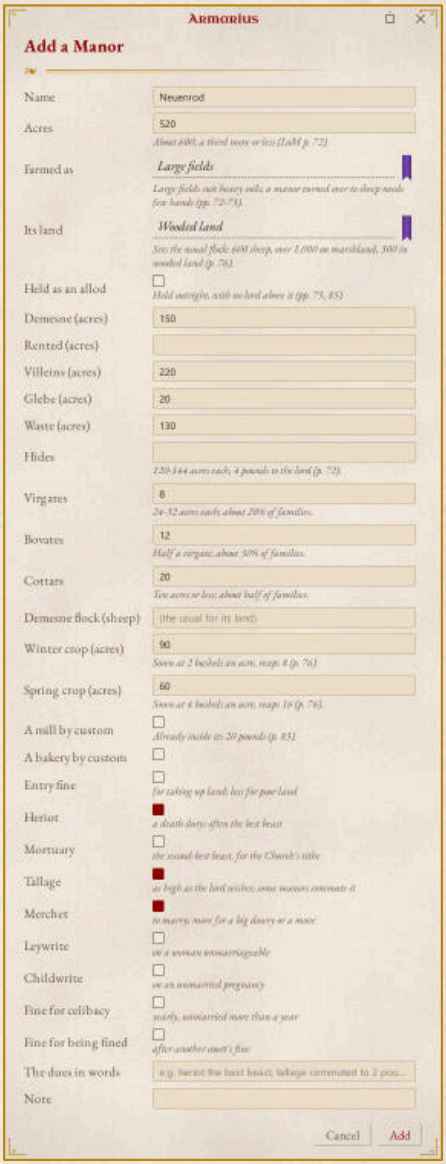
2. Adding a manor

His father left him a third holding, **Neuenrod**, carved out of the forest a generation ago. Click **Add** on the Manors list and the form asks for its size, how it is farmed, its land, its peasants, its crops and its court.

Neuenrod is 520 acres, inside the third either side of 600. It is wooded land, so the usual flock drops to 300. Its land is 150 acres of demesne, 220 of villein land, 20 of glebe and 130 of waste, with 8 virgaters, 12 bovaters and 20 cottars, and its court takes a heriot, merchet and tallage. Every hint beside a field quotes its rule and page, and every field is optional: fill in what your story needs.



Add a Manor, filled in for Neuenrod: its size, farming and land, then its peasants, flock and crops.



The same form further down: what the manor holds by custom, and its court's dues.

What happened. A third manor: 60 pounds a year, and the relief rises to 15. Choose its row and the inspector finds its peasants worth about 8 pounds to the lord.

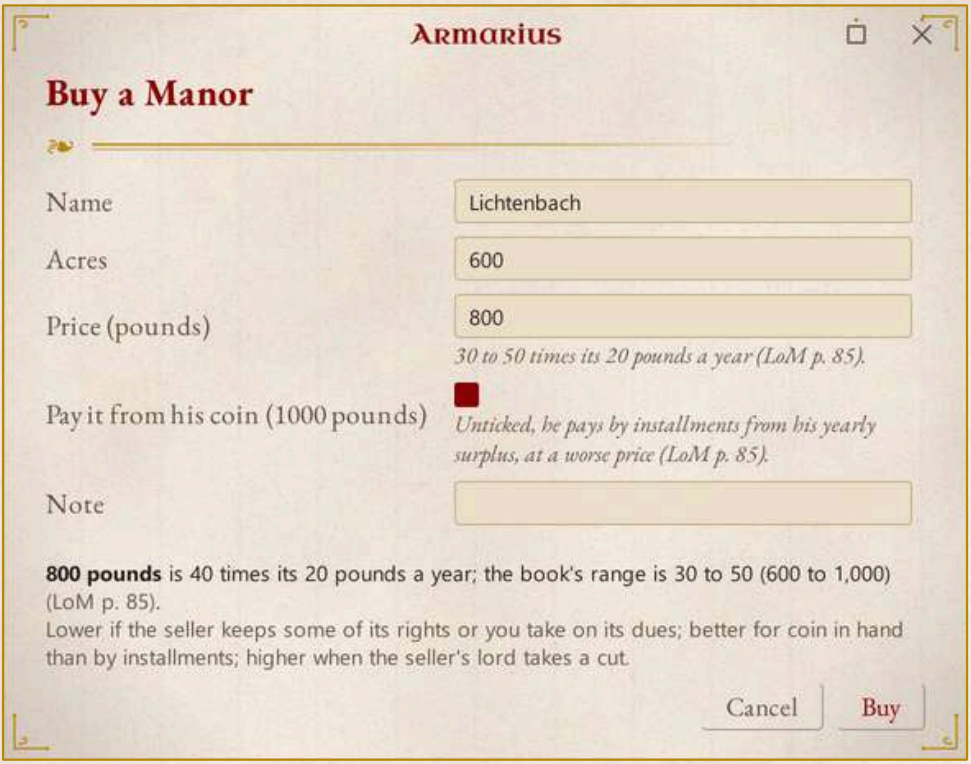
3. Buying land

His neighbour at **Lichtenbach** needs coin for a pilgrimage and offers his manor. Click **Buy a Manor**, beside Add on the Manors list.

The rule · LoM p. 85

Land costs 30 to 50 times its yearly income, so a manor of 20 pounds a year sells for 600 to 1,000 pounds. The price drops if the seller keeps some of its rights or the buyer takes on some of its dues, and for coin in hand rather than instalments over many years; it rises when the seller's own lord demands a cut.

The seller wants coin in hand and has no lord's cut to pay, so they settle in the middle: 800 pounds, 40 times its income. The box under the form does the sum as you type, and warns if the price leaves the book's range.



Buy a Manor: Lichtenbach, 600 acres, price 800 pounds, "Pay it from his coin (1000 pounds)" ticked; the box reads "800 pounds is 40 times its 20 pounds a year; the book's range is 30 to 50 (600 to 1,000)".

How he pays is on the same form. Sir Gauthier's **Coin in hand**, on Edit Lord, is 1,000 pounds, his father's tournament winnings, so tick **Pay it from his coin**. Unticked, he would pay by installments from his yearly surplus, at a worse price, and the result would count the years.

> **What happened.** Lichtenbach joins the ledger: four manors, 2,320 acres, 80 pounds a year. "Paid from his coin: 200 pounds left", and the purchase goes in his Diary.

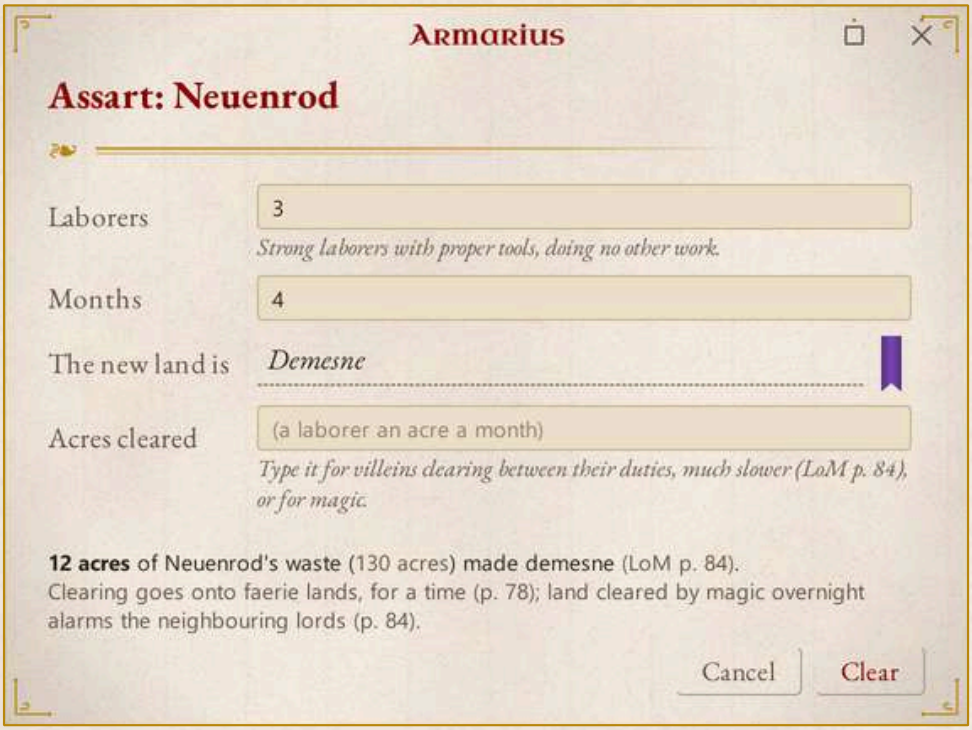
4. Assarting the waste

Neuenrod still has 130 acres of waste, and with the valley's villages growing, the steward wants more ploughland out of it. Choose Neuenrod and click **Assart**.

The rule · LoM p. 84 (reprinted in the Errata, p. 74)

A single strong labourer with proper tools clears one acre of lightly wooded land a month, doing no other work; villeins clearing between their duties are much slower. Cleared land is faerie ground for a while (p. 78), and land cleared overnight by magic tells the neighbouring lords someone has hired a huge workforce (p. 84).

Three labourers for four months clear 3 x 4 = 12 acres, and the box works it out before you clear. The new land can go to the demesne, to rent, to villeins or to the glebe; Sir Gauthier keeps it. For villeins or magic, type the acres instead.



Assart: Neuenrod: 3 laborers, 4 months, the new land is Demesne; the box reads "12 acres of Neuenrod's waste (130 acres) made demesne".

What happened. Neuenrod now has 162 acres of demesne and 118 of waste. Its yield stays at 20 pounds: the book keeps every manor at 20.

5. Kennels, mews and stables

No knight is complete without his horses, and Sir Gauthier fancies hawks. The **Establishments** list keeps kennels, mews and stables, each at a quality from Shoddy to Royal.

The rule · LoM pp. 58-60 (Errata p. 74)

Each quality sets a capacity, a maintenance a year, a staff and a Living Conditions modifier (the tables on p. 60, with the Excellent stables row as the Errata give it: 40 horses, 3 pounds a horse, 12 staff, +2). Up to a third again of the capacity may be young or breeding stock (p. 58). Every noble keeps Standard stables free, and stables that befit their owner's rank cost nothing, but kennels and mews always pay. Superior and better need a specialist with the Profession (Marshal, Falconer or Master of Kennels), and a positive Living Conditions needs that Profession at twice the modifier (pp. 59-60). Unpaid upkeep drops an establishment a class and costs 15% of the animals a season (p. 59).

His Superior stables hold 10 horses under **Lothar the marshal**, Profession: Marshal 4, twice the +1 they need. Click **Add** on Establishments for a Superior mews of 8 birds. The ledger marks the empty Specialist cell with a red dash at once, and the inspector says why.



The Manors chapter with four manors, 80 pounds a year from 2,320 acres. The Establishments ledger: the stables, 10 of 18 horses at 0 pounds, kept free as befits him, and the new mews, 8 of 15 birds at 5 pounds a year, a red dash for its Specialist; the inspector warns "Superior needs a specialist with Profession: Falconer (p. 59)".

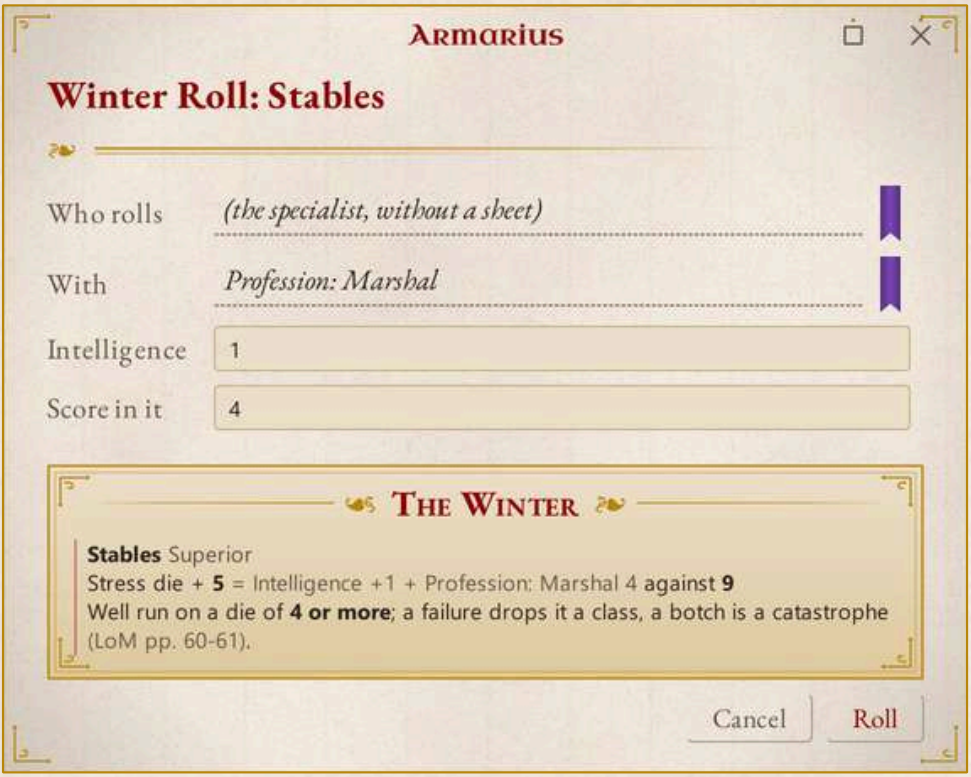
> **What happened.** The stables cost nothing; the mews cost 5 pounds a year and want a falconer. The app counts a landed knight as a noble, whose Superior stables are free, though the book's own example has a knight pay for them (p. 59). If your troupe sees Sir Gauthier as only a knight, his stables cost 2 pounds a horse: you'll need to add that to his spending by hand.

6. The Winter Roll

Every winter the specialist answers for the year's care of the animals, and a bad year shows in thinner horses and a worse stable. Choose the stables and click **Winter Roll**.

> **The rule · LoM pp. 60-61**
>
> Roll a stress die + Intelligence + Animal Handling, or + the Profession, against an Ease Factor of 9, once a year in winter. Success: well run. Failure: the establishment drops a class until a later success brings it back one, while its maintenance stays at the original level. A botch is a catastrophe: fire, disease, theft, or a story to resolve.

Lothar has no sheet of his own, so the form takes his Intelligence +1 and Marshal 4 from the stables' record: he needs a 4 or better. (Choose someone from the saga in **Who rolls** and the app reads their sheet instead.)



Winter Roll: Stables: Who rolls "(the specialist, without a sheet)", With Profession: Marshal, Intelligence 1, Score in it 4; The Winter reads "Stress die + 5 = Intelligence +1 + Profession: Marshal 4 against 9. Well run on a die of 4 or more".

What happened. A 7: 7 + 5 = 12 against 9. The stables are well run this year, and the roll is noted on their record.

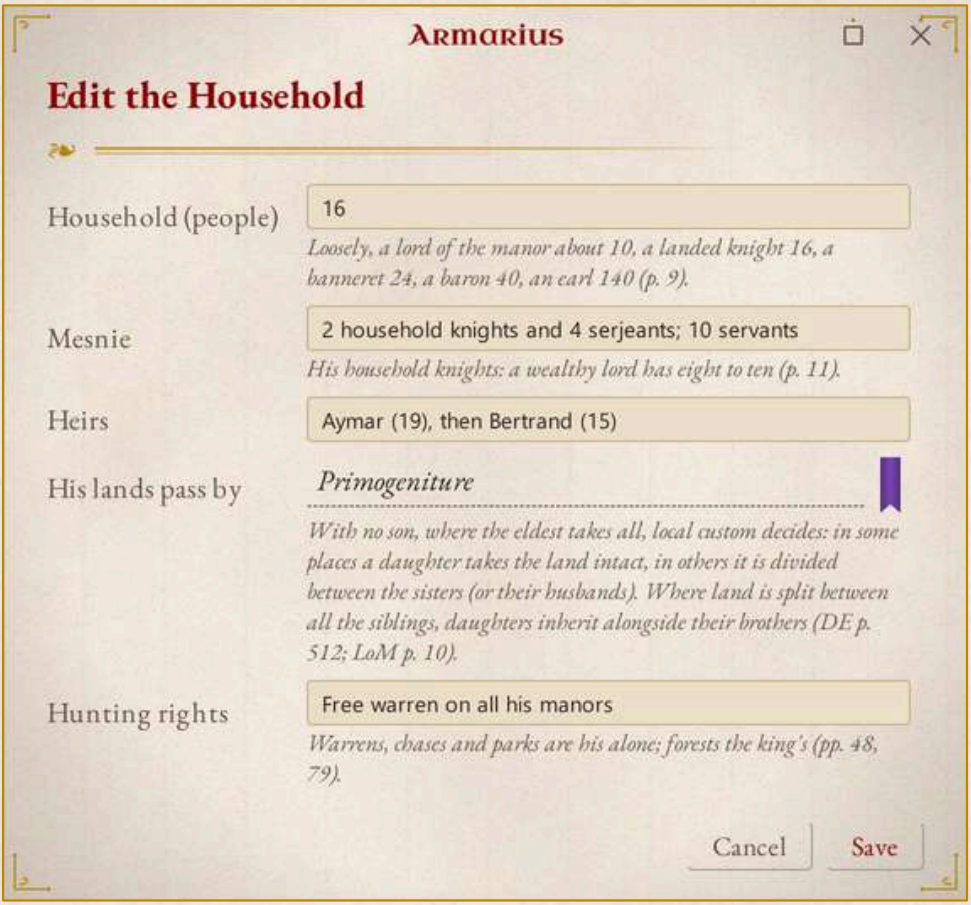
7. The household, and a death

Below the lists sits the **Household**: the people a lord feeds, his knights, his heirs and his hunting. Click **Edit Household**.

The rule · LoM pp. 9-11, 18

Loosely, a lord of the manor's household is about 10, a landed knight's 16, a banneret's 24, a baron's 40, an earl's 140 (p. 9). His household knights are his mesnie; a wealthy lord has eight to ten (p. 11). Where Norman custom rules, everything goes to the heir he names, or the eldest, or the strongest his liege picks; elsewhere the lands are divided between the sons (p. 10). An heir pays his liege relief, about a year's income, but at most 5 pounds a manor, or 100 for a great baron (p. 18).

Sir Gauthier's household is 16 souls, 2 knights and 4 serjeants, his two sons, and free warren on all his manors.

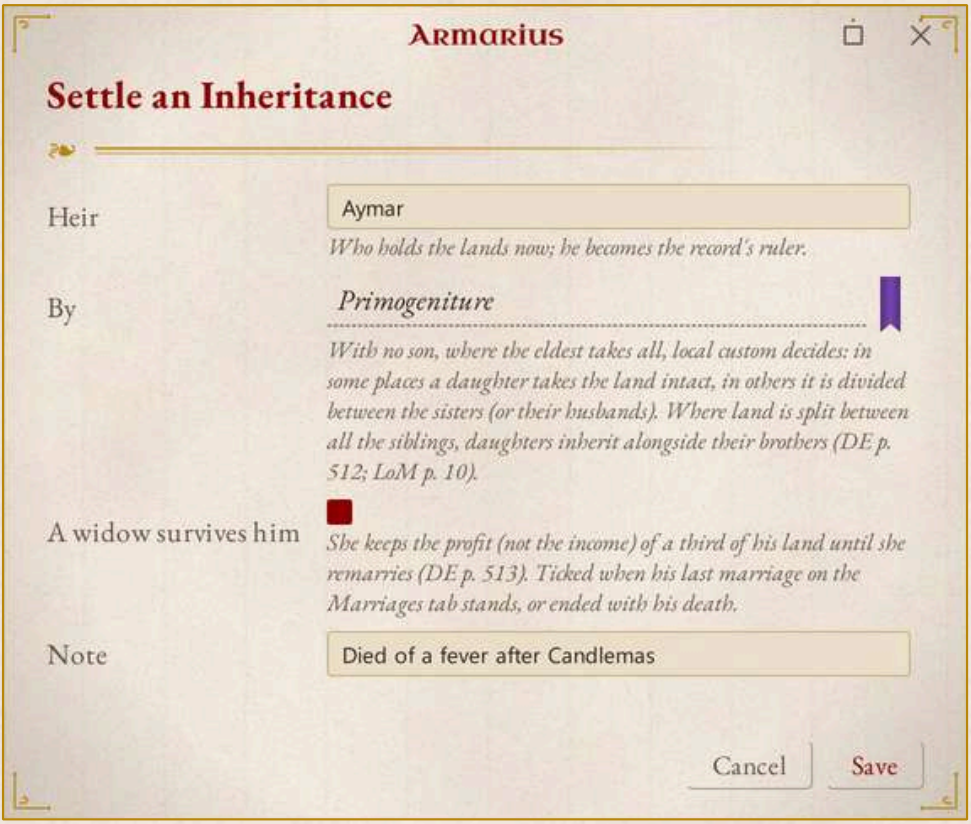


Edit the Household: Household 16, Mesnie "2 household knights and 4 serjeants; 10 servants", Heirs "Aymar (19), then Bertrand (15)", His lands pass by Primogeniture, Hunting rights "Free warren on all his manors".

A fever takes Sir Gauthier after Candlemas in 1224. Click **Settle an Inheritance**. The heir comes from the household (Aymar, the elder son), the custom is primogeniture, and his widow survives him.

The rule · DE pp. 512-513

A widow keeps the profit, not the income, of a third of her husband's land until she remarries (p. 513). Lands go to sons before daughters; where the eldest takes all, a daughter with no brothers takes the land intact, and elsewhere it is divided between the sisters (p. 512). *Lords of Men* gives the widow a third of his estate (p. 11); the Definitive Edition's narrower rule is the one used here.



Settle an Inheritance: Heir Aymar, By Primogeniture, A widow survives him ticked (its hint: she keeps the profit, not the income, of a third of his land until she remarries, DE p. 513), Note "Died of a fever after Candlemas".

What happened. "Aymar inherits from Sir Gauthier (primogeniture). He owes Baron Gottfried of Urach relief of 20 pounds (4 manors x 5). The widow keeps the profit (not the income) of a third of his land until she remarries (DE p. 513)." Aymar rules the fief now, and the Diary keeps the death. The household still names Aymar as heir, so, as the notice says, edit the Household to name his own heirs next.

8. A covenant's manors

Across the valley, **Val Sombre** holds four manors of its own. A covenant's Manors chapter is the same, with one difference that matters: its manors are never added to its income.

The rule · Covenants pp. 56-60

A covenant's income comes from its sources of income; a Typical source is about 100 pounds a year (p. 57). That figure is the surplus after operating costs: the peasants, staff and raw materials are already paid for (p. 58). Each year the storyguide applies the Income Modification table to each source, usually Status Quo (p. 57). Farmland is the Agriculture source (p. 58); pasture is the separate Livestock source (p. 60). *Lords of Men* adds that each troupe may farm its land any way it likes (p. 73), and that the oldest covenants predate the manors and hold allods (p. 85).

So above the manors sits a box called **Beside the Income**, which asks which source they describe. Click **Choose the Sources** and pick Val Sombre's Agriculture source, *The fields of the Val*: farmed manors go beside Agriculture, sheep manors beside Livestock.



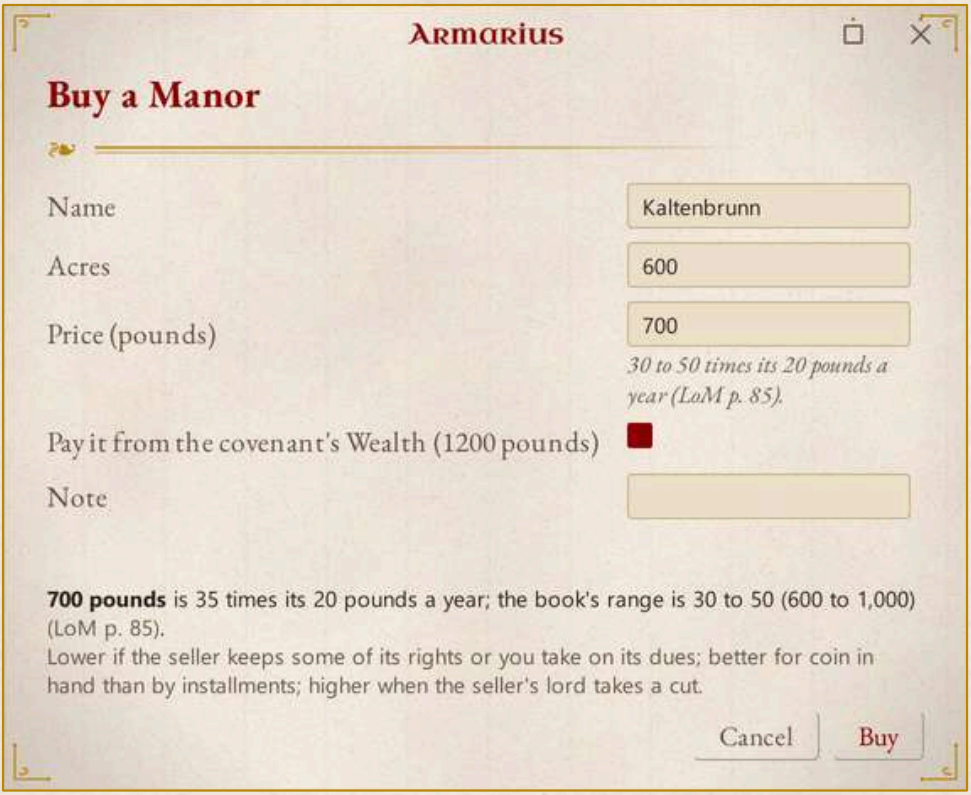
Val Sombre's Manors chapter after Choose the Sources. Beside the Income reads "Agriculture source: The fields of the Val (Typical): 100 pounds this year" and "Its manors' check: 4 x 20 = 80 pounds (LoM p. 72): 20 pounds below the source this year"; below it, Manors (4): Talhof, Steinbach, Rotenfels and Wiesental.

Four manors come to 80 pounds against a Typical source of 100, so the land is 20 pounds short of what the source claims. That's a question for your troupe, not an error: either the source is worth less, or there's a fifth manor nobody wrote down.

What happened. The Treasury's income is untouched: still 100 pounds from the fields.

Closing the gap

The troupe decides Val Sombre buys the manor of **Kaltenbrunn**. Click **Buy a Manor**; for a covenant the form offers to pay from its Wealth, which holds 1,200 pounds. The price is 700 pounds, 35 times its income.



Buy a Manor for Val Sombre: Kaltenbrunn, 600 acres, 700 pounds, "Pay it from the covenant's Wealth (1200 pounds)" ticked; the box reads "700 pounds is 35 times its 20 pounds a year".

What happened. "Paid from its Wealth: 500 pounds left." Wealth falls to 500 pounds, and five manors make 100 pounds, the source's figure exactly. The covenant's income is still the source's 100; if a year's Income Modification moves the source, the check moves with it.

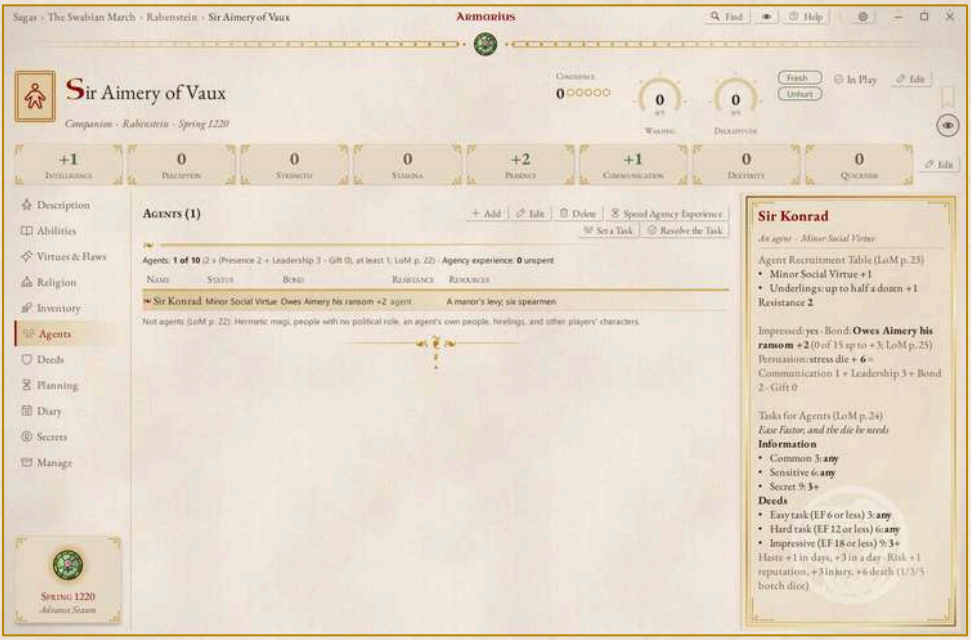
9. How many friends can a knight have?

Sir Aimery wants a man inside the abbey down the valley. Open his record and choose the **Agents** chapter. Before you recruit anyone, it tells you how many agents he can hold on to: run too many and he slowly loses his grip on all of them.

The rule · LoM p. 22

A character may have 2 x (Presence + Intrigue or Leadership - the Gift's social penalty) agents, and never fewer than 1. Hermetic magi, people with no political role, an agent's own underlings, hirelings and other players' characters never count.

Sir Aimery has Presence +2, Leadership 3 and Intrigue 2, and no Gift to put people off. The app takes the better of the two Abilities, so his limit is 2 x (2 + 3) = 10. He already has one agent: **Sir Konrad**, a knight who owes him his life.



Sir Aimery's Agents chapter: the line above the ledger reads "Agents: 1 of 10 (2 x (Presence 2 + Leadership 3 - Gift 0), at least 1; LoM p. 22) · Agency experience: 0 unspent", Sir Konrad is the one agent ("Owes Aimery his ransom +2"), those who don't count sit under the ledger, and Add, Edit, Delete, Spend Agency Experience, Set a Task and Resolve the Task are along the top.

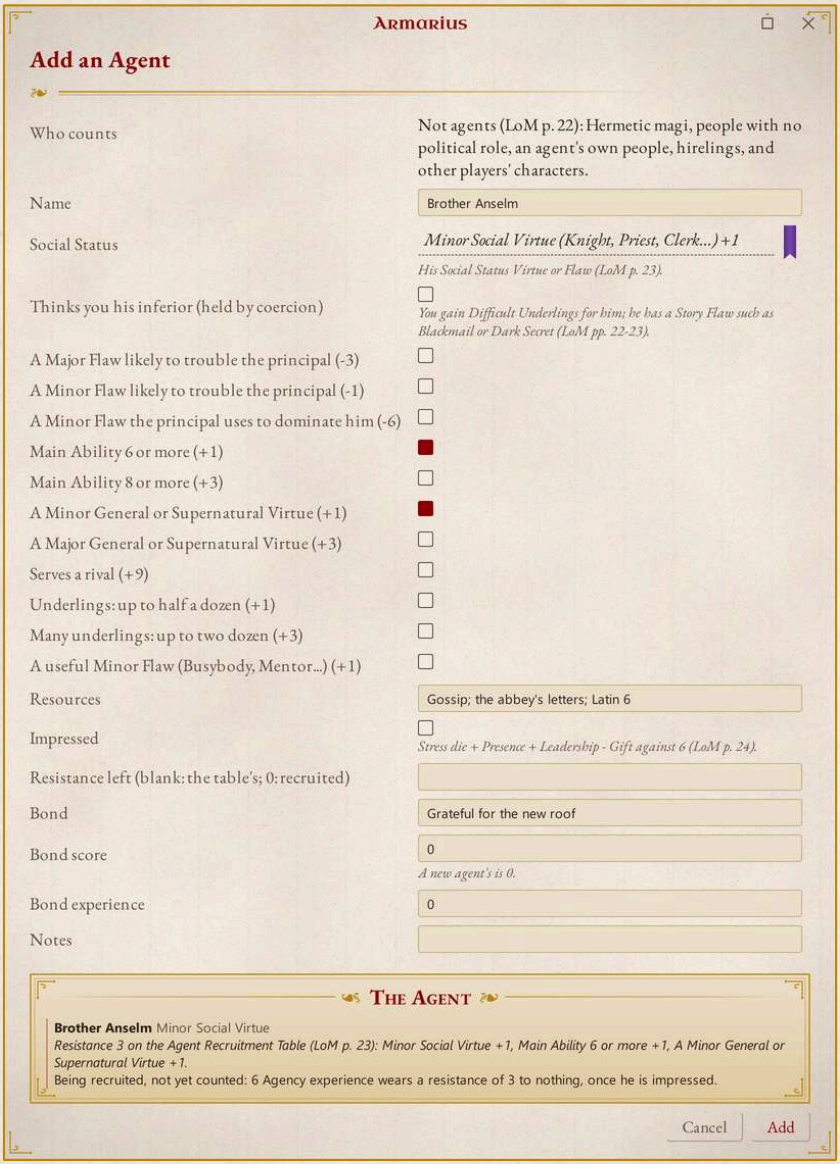
> **What happened.** Sir Aimery holds 1 agent of a possible 10, with no Agency experience banked yet.

10. Sizing up Brother Anselm

Brother Anselm reads Latin like a bishop, hears all the gossip, and every letter the abbot sends crosses his desk. Click **Add**, and the form asks what makes him easy or hard to win.

> **The rule · LoM pp. 22-24**
>
> An agent needs a name, a Social Status, a Bond (a Personality Trait saying why he sticks with you) and a list of what he brings. His starting resistance comes from the Agent Recruitment Table (p. 23): 3 for a Major Social Virtue, 1 for a Minor, 0 for a Free one, -1 or -3 for Social Flaws, then pluses for each resource he'll use for you and minuses for Flaws that trouble you or give you a hold over him. It never drops below 1. Count only the resources he'll use in your service (p. 24).

Anselm is a priest-monk, a Minor Social Virtue (+1). His Latin 6 is a main Ability of 6 or more (+1), and Gossip is a Minor General Virtue (+1): resistance 3. The box at the foot of the form works it out as you tick. His Bond goes in now, ready for when he's won: "Grateful for the new roof".



Add an Agent, filled in for Brother Anselm: Social Status Minor Social Virtue, "Main Ability 6 or more (+1)" and "A Minor General or Supernatural Virtue (+1)" ticked, Resources "Gossip; the abbey's letters; Latin 6", Bond "Grateful for the new roof"; The Agent box reads "Resistance 3 on the Agent Recruitment Table" and "6 Agency experience wears a resistance of 3 to nothing, once he is impressed".

What happened. Anselm joins the ledger as a potential agent with resistance 3. The limit still reads 1 of 10: only people actually recruited count.

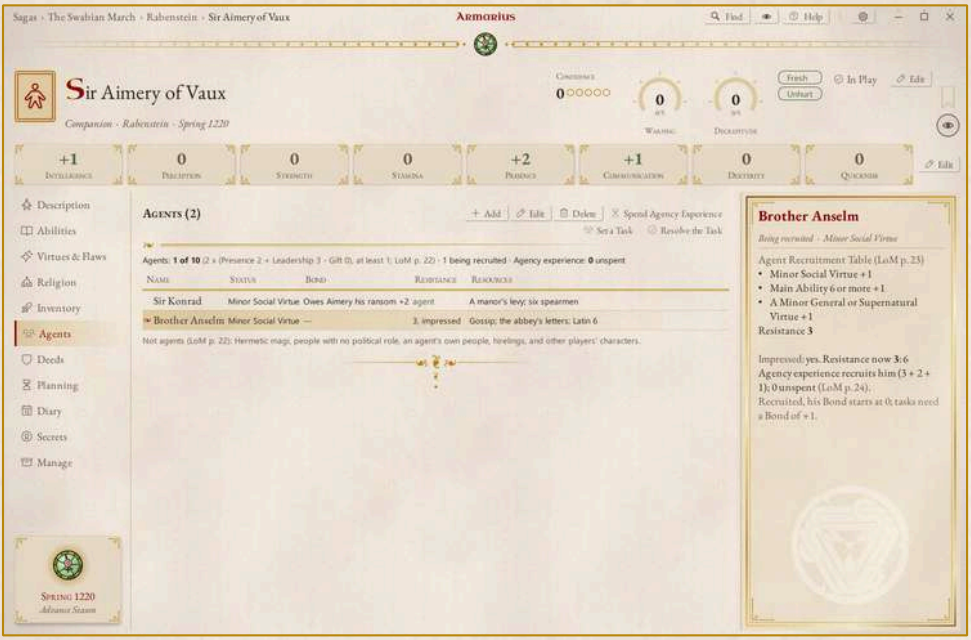
11. Impress him first

Nobody takes your offers seriously until you've made a splash in their life. Sir Aimery found the thieves who had been stripping the lead off the abbey roof.

The rule · LoM p. 24

Roll a stress die + Presence + Leadership - the Gift's social penalty against an Ease Factor of 6. Fail, and he can't be impressed until you meet him in another story. A recruiter can make the roll for you with his own scores.

With Anselm's row chosen, **Impress** appears among the buttons (only for someone not yet impressed). Sir Aimery adds 5 against 6, so any die but a zero gets him there. Click it.



The Agents chapter after the roll: Anselm's row reads "3, impressed", the line above adds "1 being recruited", and the inspector says "Impressed: yes. Resistance now 3: 6 Agency experience recruits him (3 + 2 + 1)".

> **What happened.** "Impress Brother Anselm: the die shows 4, + 5 (Presence 2 + Leadership 3 - Gift 0) = 9 against 6." Anselm is impressed, and his resistance can now be worn down.

12. Agency experience wears him down

You don't spend seasons wooing people: it happens alongside your adventures, as the people you meet see what you can do.

The rule · LoM p. 24; DE p. 376

Each time you gain Adventure experience you gain as much Agency experience. A resistance drops by 1 for as many Agency points as it currently stands at, so 3 costs 3, then 2 costs 2, then 1 costs 1. At 0 he is your agent, with a Bond of 0. An adventure's Source Quality is 5 to 10, set by the storyguide (DE p. 376).

The roof-thieves story was worth 7 experience, and when the season advances as an Adventure the app adds 7 Agency experience by itself. Click **Spend Agency Experience**, leave it on "Wear down his resistance", and put in 6. The **What It Buys** box shows the result before you commit.



Spend Agency Experience: Brother Anselm: Unspent "7 Agency experience; 3 pounds of silver carried", Spend on "Wear down his resistance (LoM p. 24)", 6; What It Buys reads "Resistance 3 to 0, for 6 Agency experience. He becomes an agent, with a Bond of 0."

What happened. Anselm is an agent, the limit reads 2 of 10, and Sir Aimery has 1 Agency experience left. The inspector is firm, though: a Bond of +1 is needed before he takes a task.

13. Firming up the Bond

A Bond of 0 means he likes you, but not enough to lift a finger for you. Before Anselm will take on a task, his Bond has to reach +1.

The rule · LoM p. 25; DE p. 49

Agency experience raises a Bond as an Ability rises: 5 points for +1, 10 more for +2, and so on (the Advancement Table, DE p. 49). Money works too, but badly: 5 Agency experience per pound, and only for an agent who isn't already prosperous and doesn't think taking money for service a sin.

Sir Aimery has only 1 point left, so he reaches for his purse. A monk taking cash is iffy under that last clause, so the pound goes to the roofer, which Anselm can hardly object to. In Spend Agency Experience, switch to "Raise his Bond with money" and spend 1 pound. The form says how much silver he carries, and warns when money won't work.



Spend Agency Experience: Brother Anselm: Unspent "1 Agency experience; 3 pounds of silver carried", Spend on "Raise his Bond with money (5 a pound)", Pounds 1; What It Buys reads "Bond +0 to +1 (0 of 10 xp to +2)".

What happened. Bond +1, "Grateful for the new roof". Sir Aimery is down to 2 pounds, and the inspector now shows his persuasion total and the Tasks for Agents table, with the die needed for each.

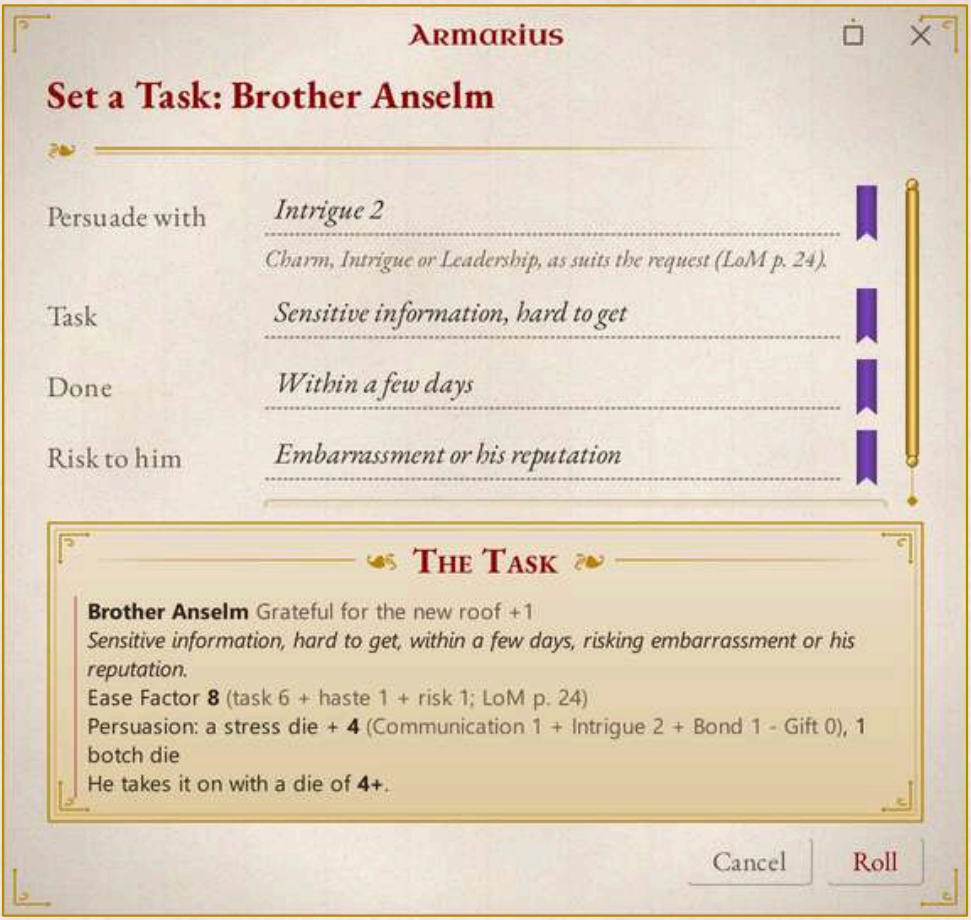
14. Setting a task

The abbot has been sending a lot of letters to Metz lately, and Sir Aimery would very much like to know who reads them. Choose Anselm and click **Set a Task**.

The rule · LoM p. 24

The agent needs the resources and Abilities for the job, and a Bond of +1. Roll a die + Communication + Charm, Intrigue or Leadership (whichever suits) + Bond - the Gift's penalty against the Tasks for Agents table: 3, 6 or 9 for common, sensitive or secret information (or an Easy, Hard or Impressive deed), +1 if it's needed within days and +3 within a day, and +1, +3 or +6 for a risk to his reputation, his liberty or his life. No risk means a simple die; the risks add 1, 3 or 5 botch dice. Plain passive news needs no roll at all.

Reading the abbot's post is sensitive (6), Sir Aimery wants it within a few days (+1), and if Anselm is caught he's embarrassed (+1, one botch die): Ease Factor 8. Sweet-talking a monk into spying is Intrigue rather than Leadership, so Sir Aimery persuades with Communication 1 + Intrigue 2 + Bond 1 = 4. (Leadership would give 5, but it doesn't suit the scene, and the form lets you choose.)



Set a Task: Brother Anselm: Persuade with Intrigue 2, Task "Sensitive information, hard to get", Done "Within a few days", Risk to him "Embarrassment or his reputation". The Task reads "Ease Factor 8 (task 6 + haste 1 + risk 1)", "Persuasion: a stress die + 4 (Communication 1 + Intrigue 2 + Bond 1 - Gift 0), 1 botch die" and "He takes it on with a die of 4+".

Click **Roll**.

What happened. "The die shows 6, + 4 (Intrigue) = 10 against 8. He takes the task on (sensitive information, hard to get)." The agent's own attempt is his roll against the task's Ease Factor, or a quick scene the storyguide runs (p. 24). For the roll, choose Anselm and click **Resolve the Task**: type the Characteristic and Ability he uses (his resources are free text, so the app can't look them up), and **Roll** rolls a die + those against the Ease Factor and writes the outcome in Sir Aimery's Diary.

Keeping him sweet

The rule · LoM pp. 24-25

Passive news, anything he knows or can casually ask about, is free and needs no roll. Digging up private information more than once a season may cost him Bond. A Minor Flaw that eats his time makes him unavailable a quarter of the time you want him, a Major one half the time. Helping him in a story earns Agency experience to raise his Bond, just as recruiting did.

15. To the lists

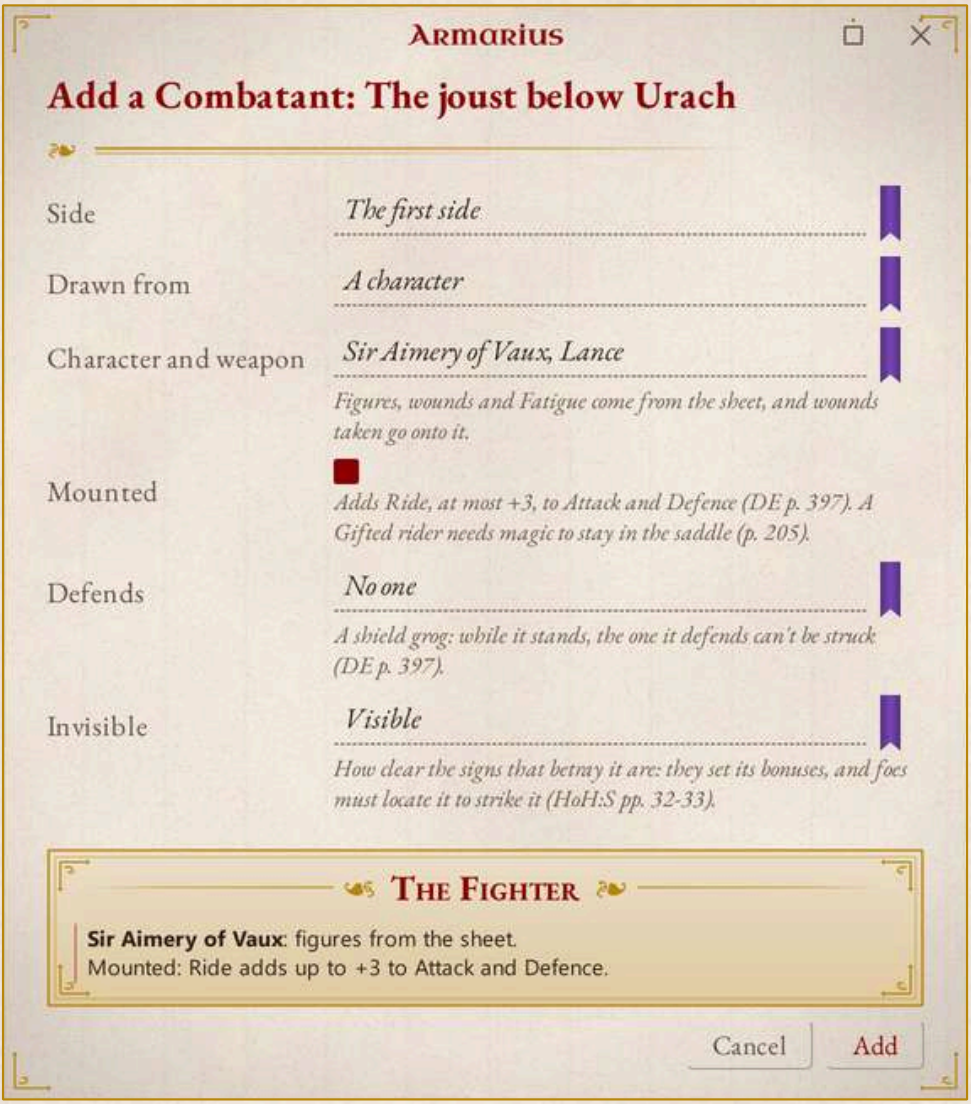
In the summer of 1223 the Baron of Urach holds a tournament on the meadows below his castle, and both knights ride.

The rule · LoM pp. 64-68

A tournament opens with the commencailles, single combats by jousting or on foot, and ends in the melee, where companies of knights try to force each other to surrender and pay ransom: horse and armour from a wealthy knight, one of them from a knight of average means, perhaps weapons from a poor one (p. 67). Knights fight with the non-lethal rules, choosing round by round whether to fight in earnest; a joust uses the shock of the charge to see who is unhorsed (pp. 67-68). A ransom not paid is an experience point toward a fitting bad Reputation (p. 67).

A joust in the Fights

A single combat is a **Fight** on the saga's **Conflicts** page (*War* walks through one blow by blow). Add Sir Aimery and his opponent, each with his lance, and tick **Mounted** for both: Ride, at most +3, adds to Attack and Defence, and a mounted man's lance fights as a Single Weapon (LoM p. 126; DE p. 397). For a bout fought to yield rather than to kill, choose **Scuffle** as the action, or switch on the **Bruises** card under Optional Rules on the saga's **Saga Settings** chapter, so that non-lethal blows leave bruises that heal within hours (LoM pp. 131-132).

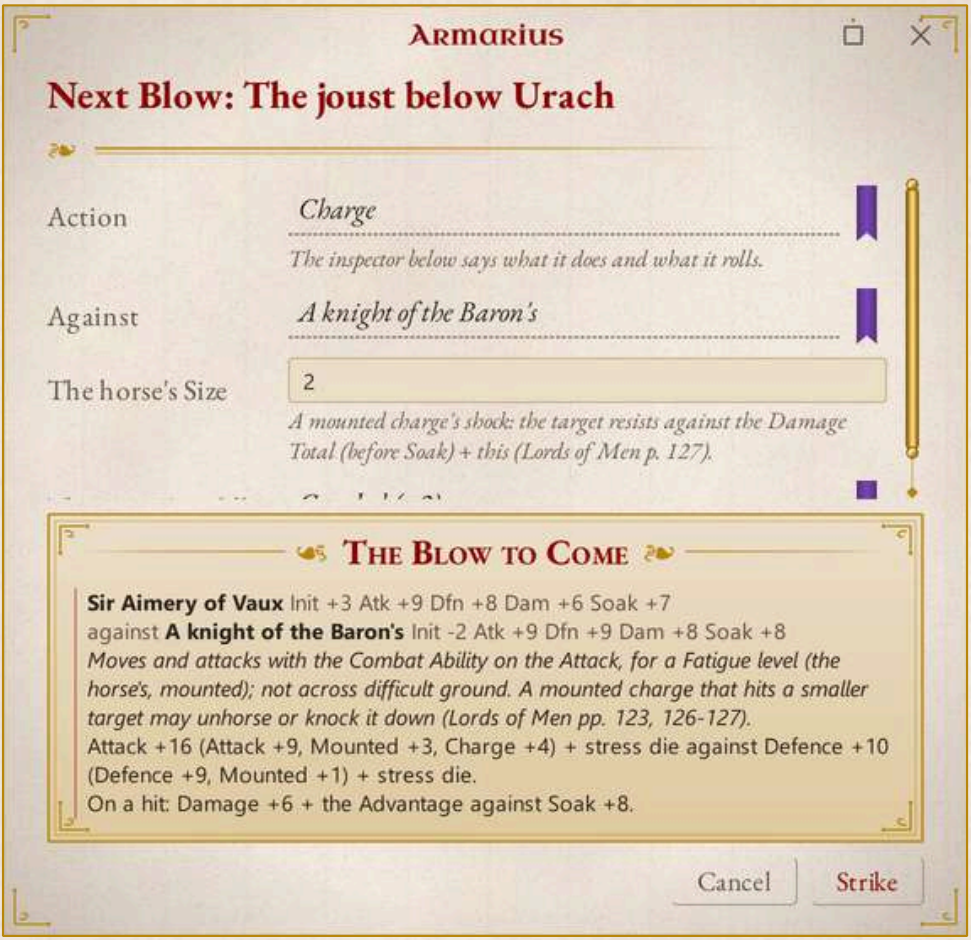


Add a Combatant: The joust below Urach: The first side, Drawn from a character, "Sir Aimery of Vaux, Lance", Mounted ticked; The Fighter reads "Sir Aimery of Vaux: figures from the sheet. Mounted: Ride adds up to +3 to Attack and Defence."

The rule · LoM pp. 126-127 (optional)

A mounted charge adds the rider's Combat Ability to his Attack, and the horse spends the Fatigue level. With the Shock of the Charge, a target the charge hits rolls to stay upright: Dexterity + Ride + saddle (+3 for a cantled saddle, -3 without stirrups) + stress die mounted, or Strength + Size + Combat Ability + stress die on foot, against the blow's Damage Total before Soak + the horse's Size. Failing, he falls prone.

At the call to charge, choose **Charge** as Sir Aimery's action in **Next Blow**. It adds his Combat Ability to the Attack and spends a Fatigue level (the horse's, which the app doesn't track). Type **The horse's Size** and choose **The target's saddle** (cantled +3 at a tournament, or no stirrups -3): if the lance hits a smaller target, **The Blow to Come** spells out the shock test, and **Strike** rolls it.



Next Blow: The joust below Urach: Action Charge, Against "A knight of the Baron's", The horse's Size 2. The Blow to Come reads "Attack +16 (Attack +9, Mounted +3, Charge +4) + stress die against Defence +10 (Defence +9, Mounted +1) + stress die" and "On a hit: Damage +6 + the Advantage against Soak +8", after the note that a mounted charge that hits a smaller target may unhorse or knock it down.

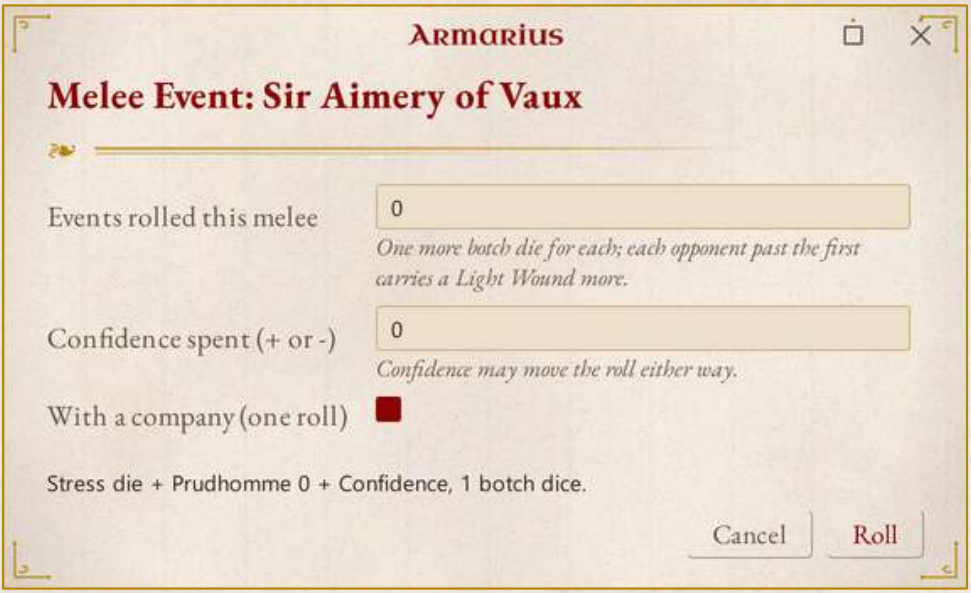
What happened. The lance strikes home. If the target fails the shock test, he's unhorsed and prone, and the chronicle says so.

The melee

The rule · LoM pp. 67-68

For the grand charge, each character (or each company, rolling once) makes a stress roll on the Melee Events Table, + his Prudhomme Reputation, with Confidence to nudge it either way and 1 botch die + 1 per event already rolled. The result is the opponent who presents himself, from an inexperienced knight (0-2) to a large company of three combat groups (17+). Each later event finds the opponents with one more short-term Light Wound. A fair ransom is horse and armour from a wealthy knight, one of them from a knight of average means, perhaps weapons from a poor one; never service or an oath.

Melee Event, on Sir Aimery's Deeds chapter under Knightly, rolls the table. Tick **With a company** for Rabenstein's little company's single roll, and add any Confidence spent. The result names the knight or company that presents itself, the ransom fair from him, and the Light Wounds his opponents already carry; the roll goes in his Diary.



Melee Event: Sir Aimery of Vaux: Events rolled this melee 0, Confidence spent 0, With a company (one roll) ticked; the foot reads "Stress die + Prudhomme 0 + Confidence, 1 botch dice."

> **What happened.** "4 on the Melee Events Table: A lone Poor knight presents himself as a target. A fair ransom: perhaps his weapons (p. 67)." As the first event of the melee, his opponent carries no extra Light Wound.

Play the fight it throws up as a Fight like the joust; taking the ransom is played out too.

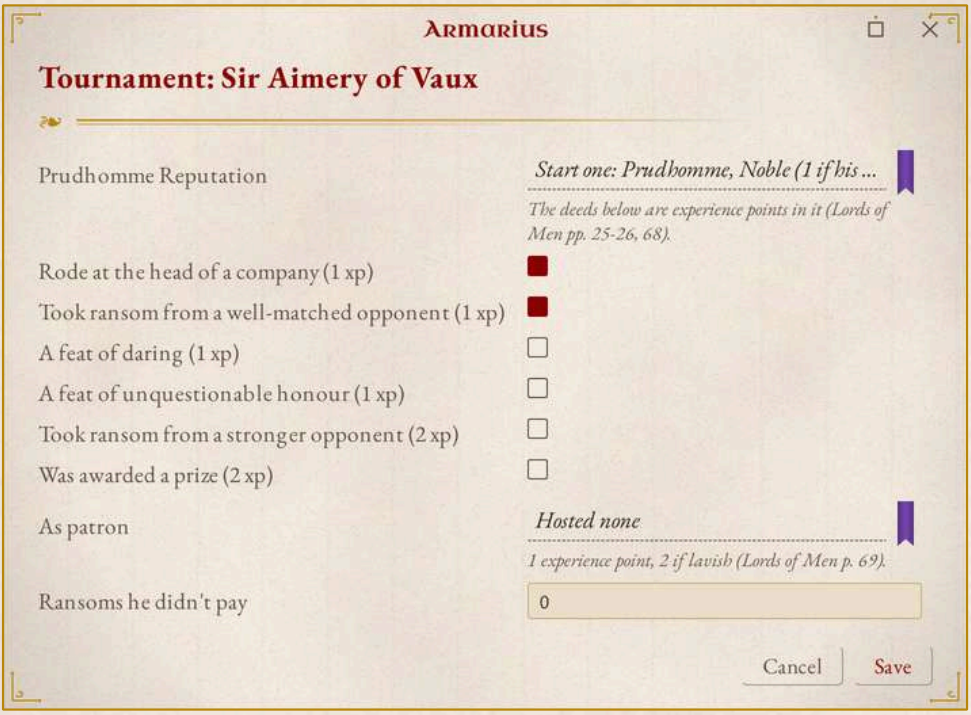
Prudhomme

A knight's prize Reputation is **Prudhomme**: tournaments read it. If he hasn't one, the Tournament form below starts it for him as a Noble Reputation.

The rule · LoM pp. 25, 68-69

Entering feudal life, by birth or as a vassal, starts a Noble Reputation at 1 (p. 25). In a season of tourneying a knight gains the highest of these, in experience points toward his Prudhomme: riding at the head of a company, ransoming a well-matched opponent, a feat of daring, a feat of unquestionable honour, 1 each; ransoming a stronger opponent, or winning a prize, 2 (p. 68). Hosting one or more tournaments in a season earns the patron 1, a lavish one 2, and an artist's record of them 1 more; patrons hosting together share the points (p. 69). A prize is worth about a pound per point of the winner's Prudhomme (p. 69).

At the season's end, **Tournament**, on his Planning chapter under A Season's Work, counts it. Choose his Prudhomme Reputation and tick what he did: Sir Aimery rode at the head of Rabenstein's little company and took a well-matched knight's horse, 1 experience point each, and only the highest counts: 1. Each ransom he didn't pay would be a point toward a fitting bad Reputation. The result also says what a prize for him is worth, a pound a point of his Prudhomme, and the Labor Points a season on the circuit would make him; it's all written in his Diary.



Tournament: Sir Aimery of Vaux: Prudhomme Reputation "Start one: Prudhomme, Noble (1 if his first Noble Reputation)", "Rode at the head of a company (1 xp)" and "Took ransom from a well-matched opponent (1 xp)" ticked; As patron "Hosted none"; Ransoms he didn't pay 0.

> **What happened.** "Started Prudhomme at 1. Prudhomme: 1 experience point(s) (1 as a knight), 1 toward the next level." A prize for him is worth about a pound, and on the circuit he makes 15 Labor Points a season: 3 seasons a year would keep him as an errant knight.

The Baron, as patron, gains 1 too; his record is a lord's, so add it on his Reputations by hand.

The rule · LoM p. 69

A knight who makes his living on the circuit gains Dexterity + Single (or Great) Weapon Labor Points a season, times 2 if he is Poor, 3 if average, 6 if Wealthy, and needs 36 a year: three seasons of tourneying a year for a Poor knight, two for an average one, one for a Wealthy one.

What you do by hand

- **A patron's Prudhomme**: a lord's record has no Tournament button; add the patron's points by hand.
- **Ransoms**: taking one is played out, and the horse or armour moves by hand.
- **A knight who pays for his stables**: if your troupe sees him as only a knight, add 2 pounds a horse to his spending (LoM p. 59).

Where the rules come from

Lords of Men: household sizes (p. 9); inheritance (p. 10); the widow's third and the mesnie (p. 11); relief (p. 18); agents, the Agent Recruitment Table, impressing, Agency experience and the Tasks for Agents table (pp. 22-24); availability, maintaining agents and money (p. 25); Noble Reputation and Prudhomme (p. 25); establishments and the Winter Roll (pp. 58-61); tournaments, ransoms, jousting, the Melee Events Table, Prudhomme and patronage (pp. 64-69); the manor and its income (p. 72); farming as you like (p. 73); land's legal status (p. 75); crops, flocks and pigs (p. 76); waste and faerie land (p. 78); the manor court (pp. 79-82); assarting (p. 84); buying land, customary mills and allods (p. 85); mounted combat and the Shock of the Charge (pp. 126-127); non-lethal combat (pp. 131-132).

Covenants: sources of income and Income Modification (pp. 56-57); operating costs and Agriculture (p. 58); Livestock (p. 60).

Ars Magica Definitive Edition: the Advancement Table (p. 49); Adventure experience (p. 376); Reputation experience (p. 386); mounted combat (p. 397); daughters inheriting (p. 512); the widow's portion (p. 513).

Errata: the Excellent stables row and the assarting text (p. 74).



Armarius

A saga manager for Ars Magica

War

The Baron of Urach beats Lord Heinrich at the ford below Falkenstein and then sits down before his castle until it falls: armies, battles, a fight on horseback and a siege.

Guide 12 of 17

In 1223 Baron Gottfried of Urach loses patience with his troublesome neighbour, **Lord Heinrich of Falkenstein**, who holds a ford and the tower keep above it. Rabenstein can't stay out of it: the Baron is its most important neighbour, and two of its companions ride with him. **Sir Aimery of Vaux** scouts the ground and leads the Baron's men in the thick of it, and **Ulrich the Bold**, Rabenstein's turb captain, goes after Heinrich's captain, **Sir Bero**.

Battles and sieges in *Lords of Men* aren't fought blow by blow. A battle is a handful of battlefield events, each a scene with one player character at its heart, and how that scene goes is how the battle goes. A siege is a run of events at the castle's own pace. The app keeps the numbers under **Conflicts** on the saga's page; you play the scenes.

The rules are *Lords of Men* (LoM), chapter eight, Massed Combat (pp. 102-116), with its mounted combat (chapter nine, pp. 126-127), and the *Ars Magica Definitive Edition* (DE) for fights and combat groups (pp. 394-398), which wins where the two disagree.

1. Raising the armies

Before anybody fights, you need to know how big each army is. The app counts in combat groups of five men, as the book does, and works a lord's own forces out from his title and wealth on his **Fief** chapter.

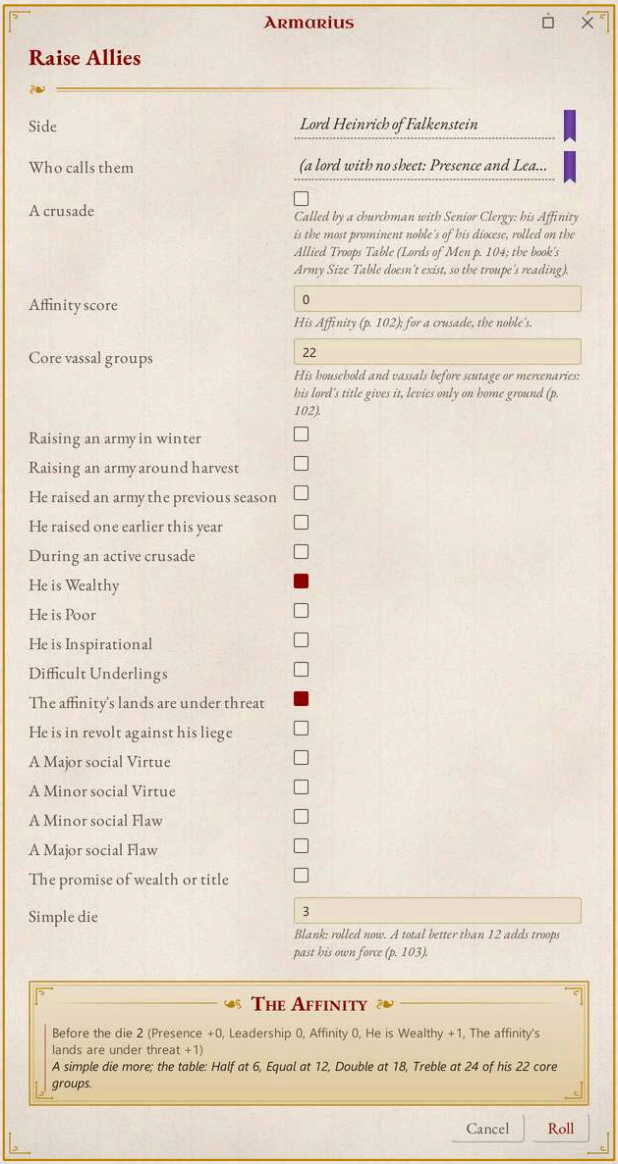
> **The rule · LoM pp. 102-104**
>
> A lord's vassals give him a set number of groups by title (p. 102): a Wealthy Landed Noble 1 of knights, 1 of serjeants, 10 of infantry and archers and 10 of levies; a Greater Baron 4, 4, 40 and 40. Levies come out only on home ground. He can also call on his allies with a Presence + Leadership + Affinity simple roll: 6 brings half his own force again, 12 as many again, 18 double, 24 treble (p. 103). And he can hire mercenaries from his budget: 15 pounds a group of knights, 5 of serjeants, 2 of infantry or archers, 1 of levies (p. 104). Every ten groups need a group of baggage, and each one short is -1 to totals based on Leadership (p. 102).

The Baron marches into someone else's land, so he leaves his levies at home: 4 + 4 + 40 = 48 groups. Lord Heinrich defends his own ford with everything: 1 + 1 + 10 + 10 = 22. His call to his allies comes to 5, short of the 6 he needs, but he spends 4 of his 5-pound budget on two groups of mercenary infantry, which makes 24.



The Baron of Urach's Fief chapter: Title "Baron, wealthy", Mercenary budget "100 pounds a year", Army "20 knights, 20 serjeants, 200 infantry; 200 levies at home", read off Lords of Men's tables, with his Affinity, Castles and Gratitude below.

The rest is mustered on the battle itself, once it's added (chapter 2). On the battle's card in Conflicts, click **Muster and Aftermath**. **Raise Allies** takes the side, who calls them (Lord Heinrich has no sheet, so his Presence and Leadership count 0), his **Affinity score** and his **Core vassal groups**, with a tick for each of the Allied Troops Table's modifiers: he is Wealthy (+1) and his lands are under threat (+1). Type the **Simple die** if you rolled it at the table, or leave it blank and **Roll** rolls it. **Hire Mercenaries** takes the groups of each kind he buys, up to his budget, and offers a War Loan if he'd rather borrow.



Raise Allies: Side Lord Heinrich of Falkenstein, Who calls them "(a lord with no sheet: Presence and Leadership 0)", Affinity score 0, Core vassal groups 22, "He is Wealthy" and "The affinity's lands are under threat" ticked, Simple die 3. The Affinity reads "Before the die 2 (Presence +0, Leadership 0, Affinity 0, He is Wealthy +1, The affinity's lands are under threat +1)" and "the table: Half at 6, Equal at 12, Double at 18, Treble at 24 of his 22 core groups".

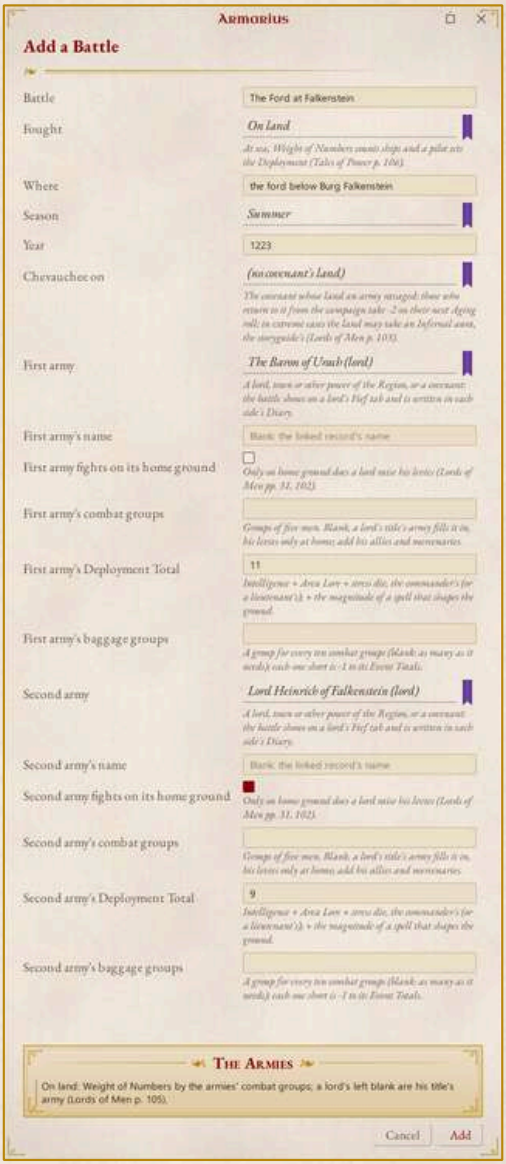
> **What happened.** 48 groups for the Baron, filled in from his title. "Allies called: 2 + die 3 = 5: none come." His 2 groups of mercenary infantry cost 4 of his 5 pounds, and he stands at 24. Both go in his Diary.

2. Lining up at the ford

On the saga's page, open **Conflicts** and click **Add** under **Battles**. Each army can be linked to a lord, town or covenant, which puts the battle on that lord's page too and writes each event in his Diary.

> **The rule · LoM pp. 104-105**
>
> Each side's commander (or a lieutenant he trusts) makes a Deployment Total: Intelligence + Area Lore + stress die, plus the magnitude of any spell that shapes the ground. The difference is the Territorial Advantage, fixed for the whole battle. The Weight of Numbers comes from the ratio of the armies, rounded down: 3:2 is ±1, 2:1 ±2, 3:1 ±3, 4:1 or more ±4, and it is worked out again as groups are lost.

Sir Aimery scouts the ground for the Baron: Intelligence +1, Area Lore 3 and a 7 on the die make 11. Heinrich's man manages 9. So the Baron has +2 for the ground, and 48 against 24 is exactly 2:1, +2 for numbers as well. Leave the groups and baggage blank and the app fills them in from each lord's title (Heinrich's mercenaries join after, by Muster): the Baron needs 5 groups of baggage, Heinrich 3.



Add a Battle: "The Ford at Falkenstein", Fought On land, Where "the ford below Burg Falkenstein", Summer 1223; First army The Baron of Urach (lord), Second army Lord Heinrich of Falkenstein (lord), their combat groups and baggage left blank and "Second army fights on its home ground" ticked; Deployment Totals 11 and 9.

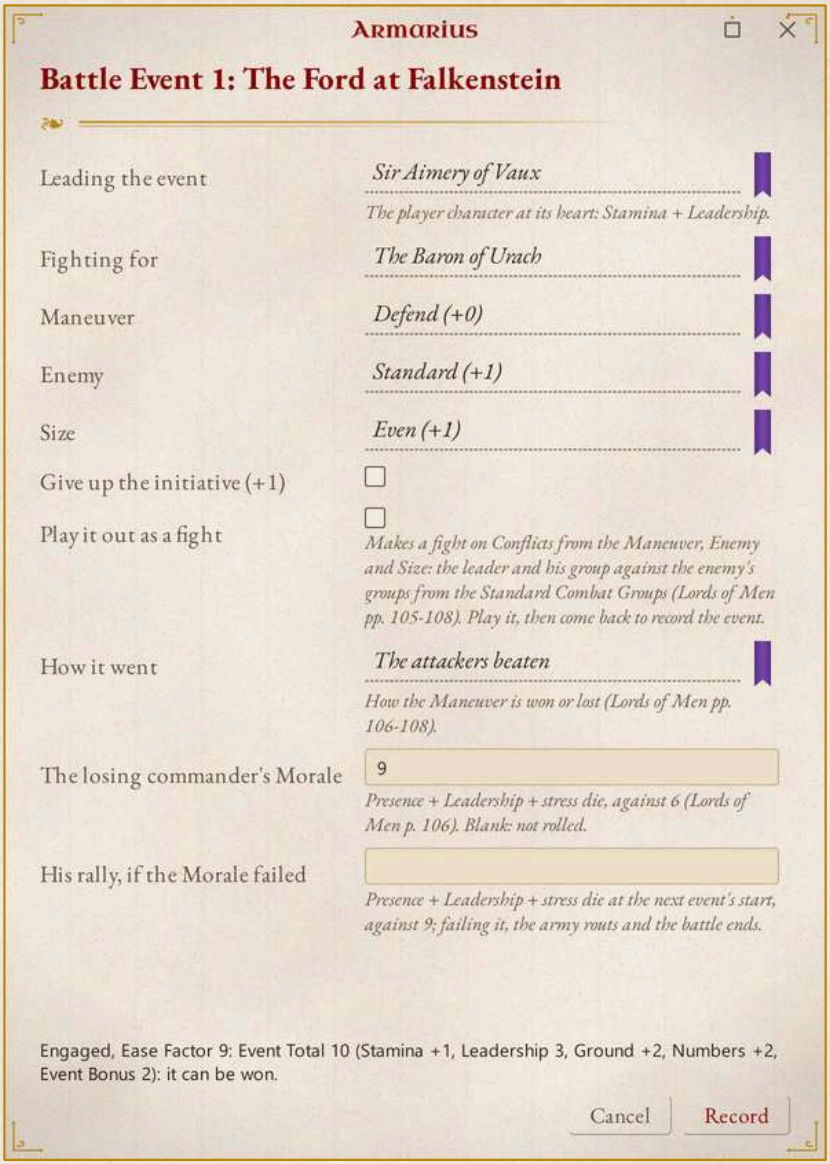
What happened. The Ford at Falkenstein: 48 groups against 24, and for the Baron, Territorial Advantage +2 and Weight of Numbers +2.

3. The first event: hold the line

The rule · LoM pp. 105-106

Each event has an Ease Factor that climbs as the day wears on: Engaged 9, Advantage or Setback 12, Imminent Victory or Defeat 15. The leading character picks a Maneuver (Defend +0, Attack +1, Run the Gauntlet +2, Take +3, Heroic Gesture +4), an Enemy (Inexpensive +0, Standard +1, Expensive +2, Special +3, Baggage +4) and a Size (Lesser +0, Even +1, Outnumbered +2, Overwhelmed +3, I Stand Alone +4). Event Total = Stamina + Leadership + Territorial Advantage + Weight of Numbers + those three, and +1 for giving up the initiative. Below the Ease Factor the event is still played, but it can't be won.

Heinrich's spearmen come at the ford, and Sir Aimery has to hold. That's the book's own **Hold the Line** (p. 106): Defend +0, Even +1, Standard +1. On the battle's card, click **Battle Event**. The line above **Record** adds it up as you choose: Stamina +1, Leadership 3, ground +2, numbers +2 and the event's +2 make 10, enough for 9.



Battle Event 1: The Ford at Falkenstein: Sir Aimery of Vaux fighting for the Baron of Urach, Defend (+0), Standard (+1), Even (+1), How it went "The attackers beaten", Morale 9. The line reads "Engaged, Ease Factor 9: Event Total 10 (Stamina +1, Leadership 3, Ground +2, Numbers +2, Event Bonus 2): it can be won."

Now play the scene at the table as an ordinary fight.

The rule · LoM p. 106

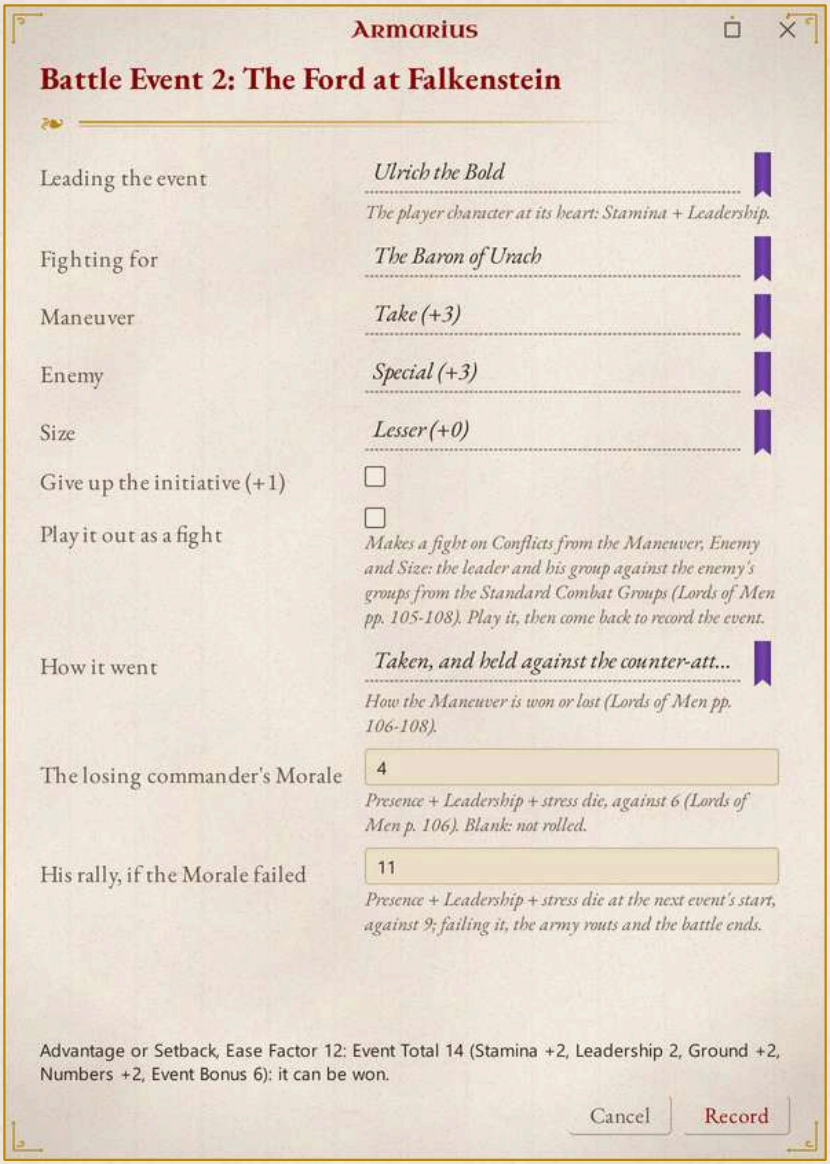
The side that loses an event also loses its Size x the winner's Weight of Numbers in combat groups (only when the winner's bonus is positive), of the kind its Enemy names. Its commander then rolls Morale against 6; failing, he gets one rally against 9 at the start of the next event, and failing that his army breaks.

Aimery's men held, and Heinrich's commander rolled a 9 for Morale. Back in the form, choose **How it went** (The attackers beaten), type the Morale roll, and click **Record**.

> **What happened.** Won. Heinrich loses Even (1) x 2 = 2 groups of infantry and drops to 22; his Morale holds. 48 to 22 is still more than 2:1, so the numbers stay at +2. The event is written in both lords' Diaries and in Sir Aimery's.

4. The second event: a ransom, on horseback

Later in the day Sir Bero gets cut off from his bodyguard, and Ulrich the Bold sees his chance. The book's **Ransom** event (p. 107) is Take +3, Lesser +0, Special +3: Ulrich's Stamina +2 and Leadership 2, plus +2 and +2, plus 6, make 14 against the Ease Factor of 12.

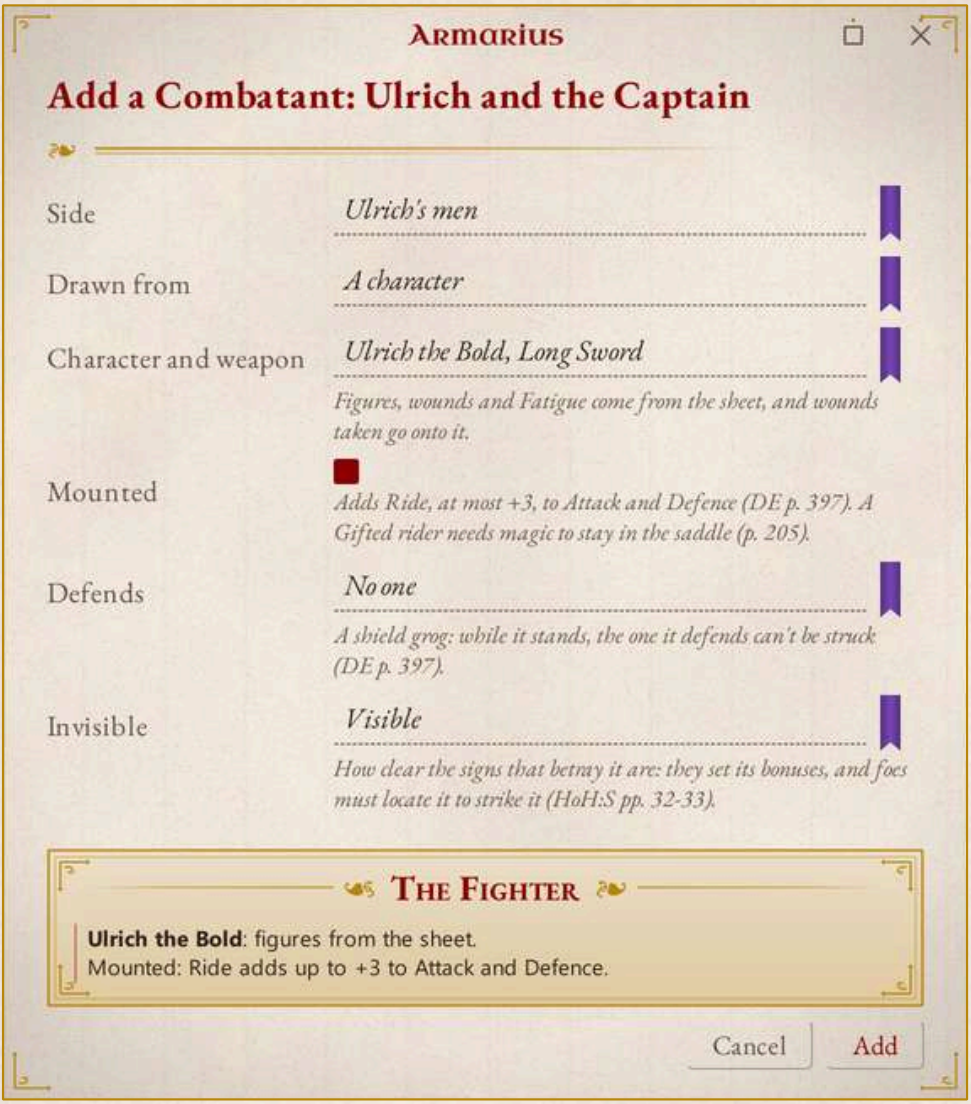


Battle Event 2: Ulrich the Bold fighting for the Baron of Urach, Take (+3), Special (+3), Lesser (+0), How it went "Taken, and held against the counter-attack", Morale 4, rally 11. The line reads "Advantage or Setback, Ease Factor 12: Event Total 14 (Stamina +2, Leadership 2, Ground +2, Numbers +2, Event Bonus 6): it can be won."

Lords of Men's own example battle plays this scene as a single combat while the rest of the group deals with the bodyguards (p. 109), so play it as a **Fight**. (Ticking **Play it out as a fight** on the Battle Event makes one for you, the leader and his group against the groups the event names; here we want the single combat.) Under **Fights** in Conflicts, click **Add** (call it *Ulrich and the Captain*, the sides *Ulrich's men* and *Falkenstein's household*), open it, and click **Add Combatant**. Ulrich comes off his sheet with his long sword; Sir Bero is typed in. Tick **Mounted** for both.

The rule · DE p. 397; LoM pp. 126-127

A mounted character adds his Ride, at most +3, to Attack and Defence. *Lords of Men* gives the Attack bonus to melee only, and adds options of its own: charges where the horse spends the Fatigue, the shock of the charge, gaits, and untrained horses that panic.



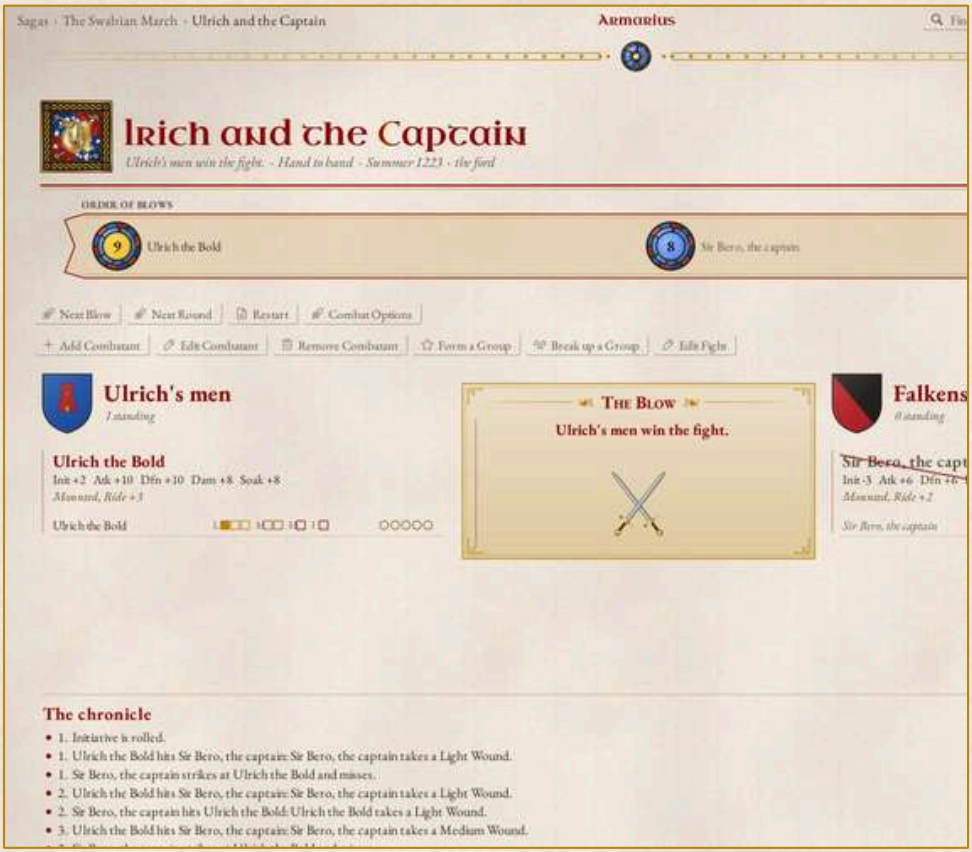
Add a Combatant: Ulrich and the Captain: Side Ulrich's men, Drawn from a character, "Ulrich the Bold, Long Sword", Mounted ticked. The Fighter at the foot reads "Ulrich the Bold: figures from the sheet. Mounted: Ride adds up to +3 to Attack and Defence."

Click **Next Blow** (or **Next Round** to let everyone strike their obvious target). The first one rolls Initiative: Ulrich 9, Bero 8. **The Blow to Come** spells out what will be rolled, riding included: Ulrich's Attack +11 and Ride +3 against Bero's Defence and his Ride +2.



The fight's page in round two: the order of blows across the top (Ulrich the Bold 9, Sir Bero 8), each fighter's card with figures, "Mounted, Ride +3" or "+2", and wounds (Bero's first Light Wound marked), and The Blow in the middle working the last one out line by line: "Sir Bero, the captain strikes at Ulrich the Bold and misses", Attack +12 + stress die 6 = 18 against Defence +14 + stress die 4 = 18.

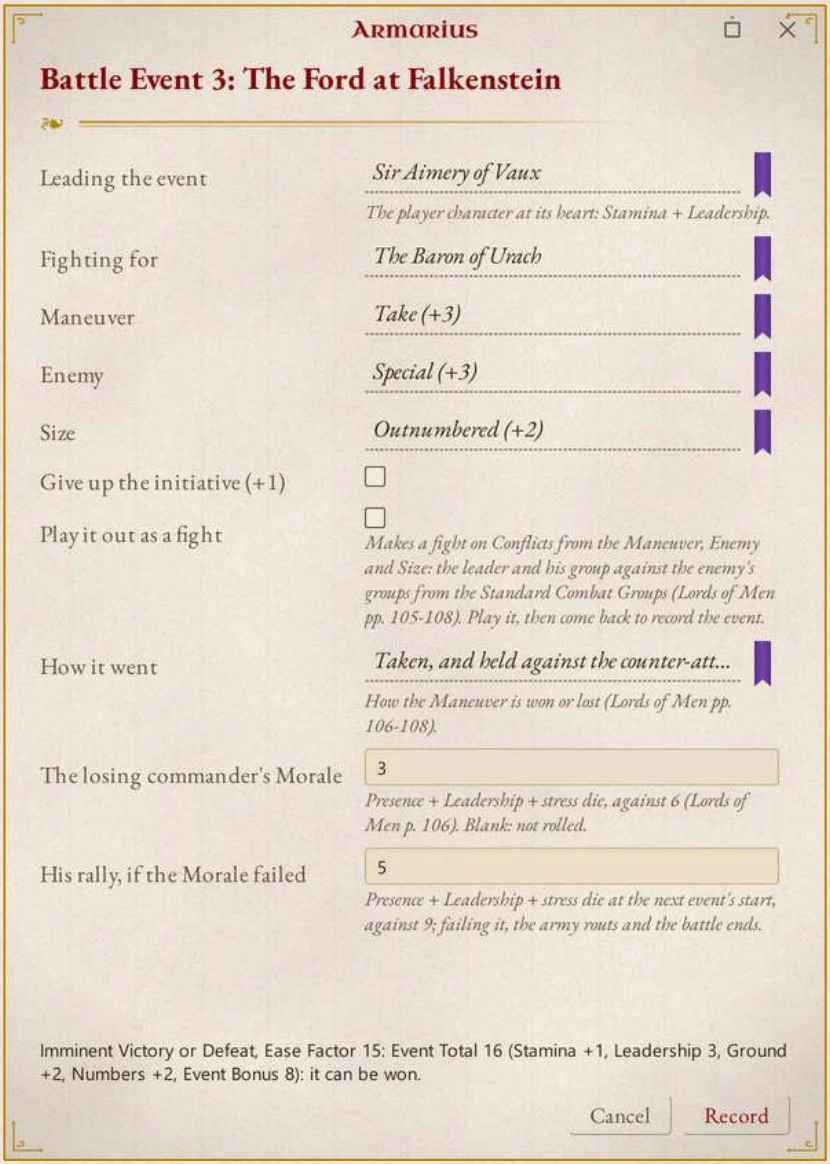
What happened. Four rounds later Bero is struck down: two Light Wounds, a Medium and finally an Incapacitating one. Ulrich's men win the fight, and Ulrich's one Light Wound goes straight onto his sheet. Back in Battle Event, the Ransom is won. Its Size is Lesser (0), so Heinrich loses no extra groups: small heroics swing a battle without grinding the enemy down. His commander's Morale was a 4 and failed, but he rallied with an 11.



The fight's page at the end: "Ulrich's men win the fight" under its name and in The Blow, Sir Bero struck through with 0 standing, and the chronicle listing each blow and wound round by round, from "Initiative is rolled" to "4. Ulrich's men win the fight."

5. The third event: seize the colours

Last stage, Imminent Victory or Defeat, Ease Factor 15. Sir Aimery's 8 (Stamina +1, Leadership 3, +2, +2) needs an event of 7. He goes for Heinrich's banner, the book's **Seize the Colors** (p. 107): Take +3, Outnumbered +2, Special +3, for a total of 16.



Battle Event 3: Sir Aimery of Vaux, Take (+3), Special (+3), Outnumbered (+2), Heinrich's failed Morale 3 and failed rally 5 typed in. The line reads "Imminent Victory or Defeat, Ease Factor 15: Event Total 16 (Stamina +1, Leadership 3, Ground +2, Numbers +2, Event Bonus 8): it can be won."

> **What happened.** Aimery takes the banner. Heinrich loses Outnumbered (2) x 2 = 4 more groups and drops to 18. His commander rolls a 3 for Morale and then a 5 to rally: "Lord Heinrich of Falkenstein's army is disordered: a player character may rally it at the next event." A failed rally disorders an army; a second while it's disordered routs it (LoM p. 106).

Heinrich has no hero to rally his men, and the sun is going down. Click **Muster and Aftermath** again and choose **End of the Day**.

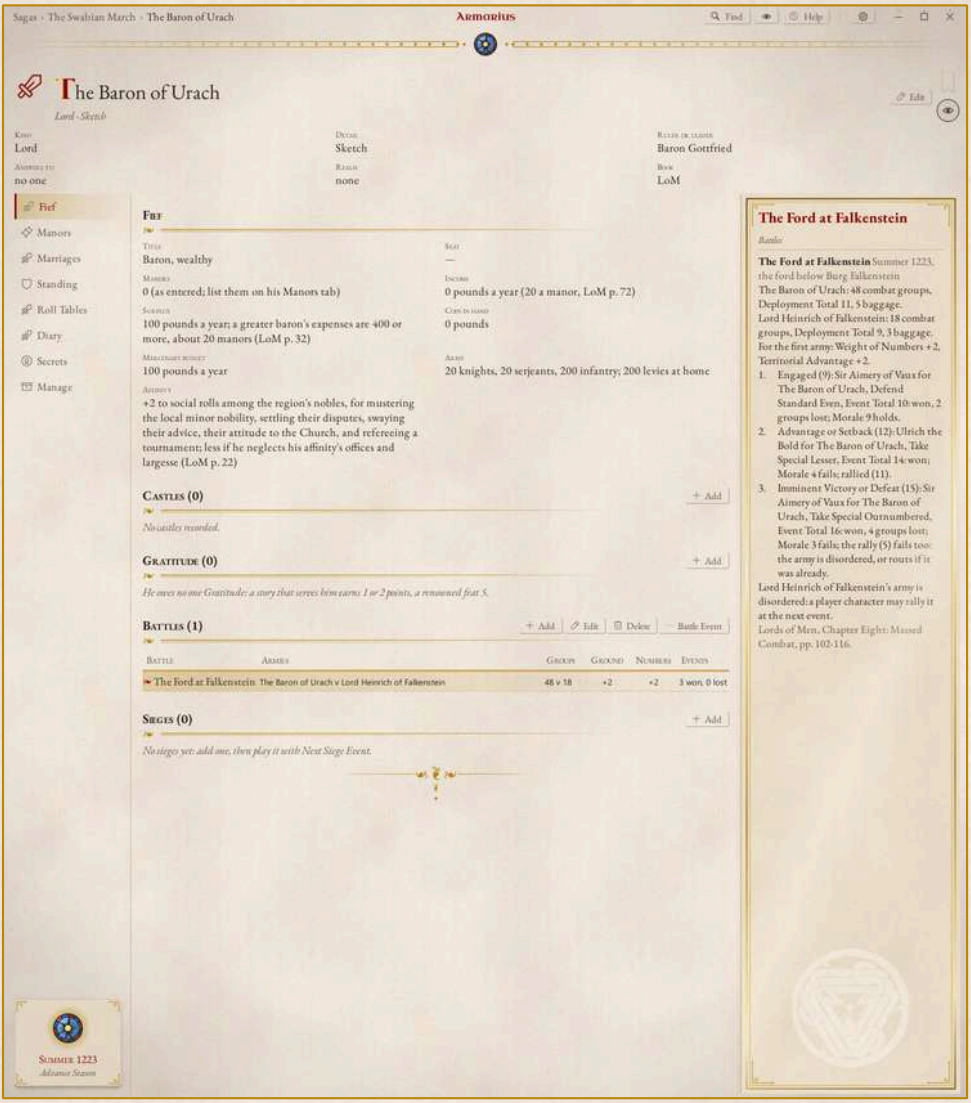
> **The rule · LoM p. 108**
>
> After a won battle, every victorious character earns a Confidence Point for each event won, whether he led it or not, and the army's leader gains an experience point toward a fitting Reputation. The wounded are seen to by the army's chirurgeons.

Choose **A side wins the day**, the Baron as **The victors**, and their commander (the Baron has no sheet, so leave it at none).



End of the Day: How the day ends "A side wins the day", The victors the Baron of Urach, The victors' commander "(none)", That Reputation "Victorious commander".

> **What happened.** "The Baron of Urach won the day, 3 event(s) won.
> Ulrich the Bold: +3 Confidence Point(s). Sir Aimery of Vaux: +3 Confidence Point(s)." It goes in both lords' Diaries. The Baron's Reputation point is yours to add on his record.



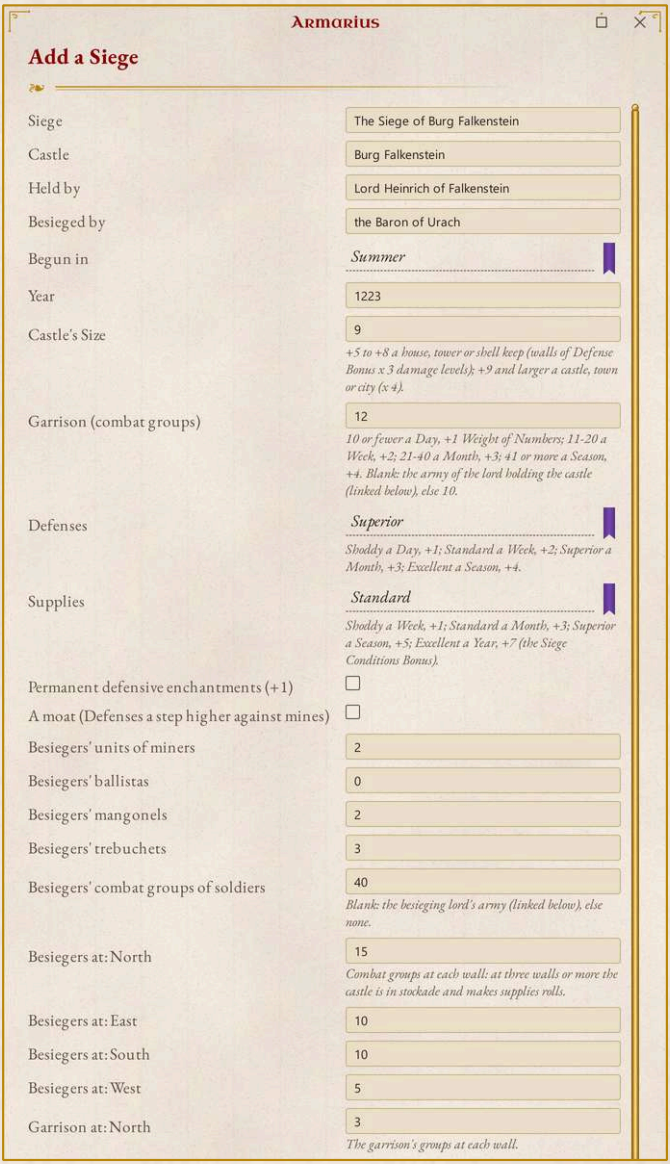
The Baron's Fief chapter with the battle chosen: Battles (1) reads The Ford at Falkenstein, 48 v 18, Ground +2, Numbers +2, 3 won, 0 lost; the inspector gives each army, the ground and numbers, and every event with its total, losses and Morale, ending "Lord Heinrich of Falkenstein's army is disordered: a player character may rally it at the next event."

6. Laying siege to Burg Falkenstein

What's left of Heinrich's men run for his castle, and the Baron follows. Back in Conflicts, click **Add** under **Sieges**. It's a long form, because a castle has a lot going on.

> **The rule · LoM pp. 111-112**
>
> A castle has three characteristics, each with an interval. Garrison by groups: 10 or fewer a Day and Weight of Numbers +1, 11-20 a Week +2, 21-40 a Month +3, more a Season +4. Defenses by quality: Shoddy a Day and Defense Bonus +1, Standard a Week +2, Superior a Month +3, Excellent a Season +4. Supplies: Shoddy a Week and Siege Conditions Bonus +1, Standard a Month +3, Superior a Season +5, Excellent a Year +7. Siege events come at the shortest interval. Each of the four walls has Defense Bonus x 3 damage levels, or x 4 at Size +9 and up.

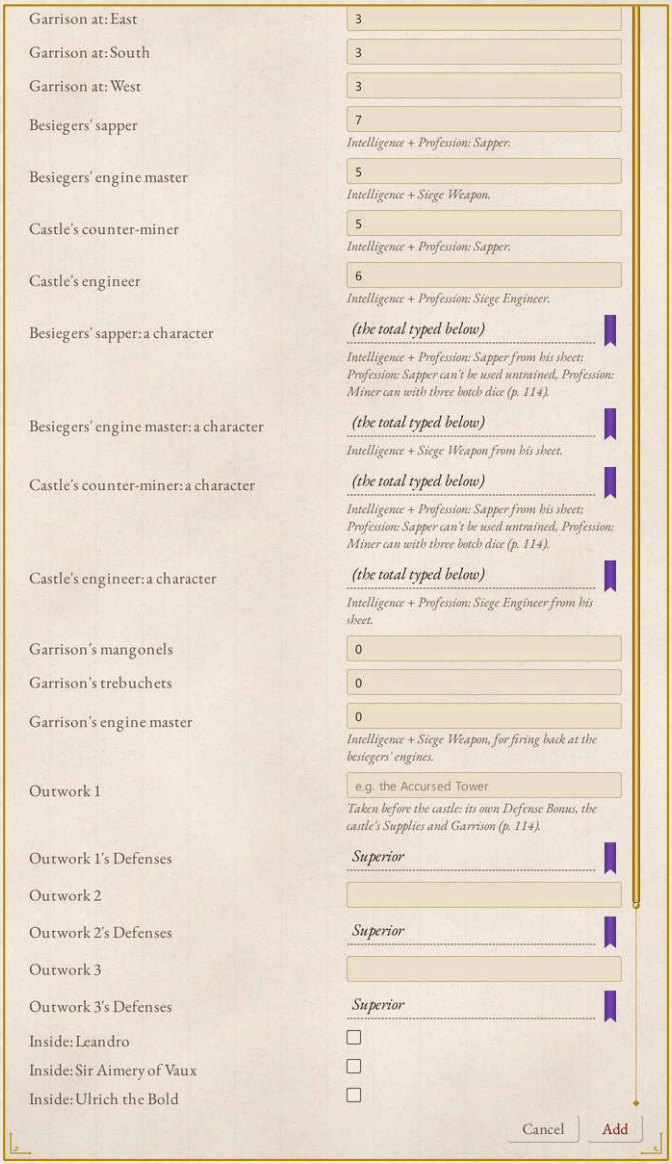
Burg Falkenstein is a tower keep, a minor castle, so its Defenses are Superior (+3); with its courtyard wall it counts as a fortified castle of Size +9, so each wall has 3 x 4 = 12 damage levels. Twelve groups made it inside (a Week, +2), with Standard supplies (a Month). So the siege moves a week at a time.
The Baron brings two units of miners, two mangonels, three trebuchets and 40 groups of soldiers.



Add a Siege, the castle half: "The Siege of Burg Falkenstein", Castle Burg Falkenstein, Held by Lord Heinrich of Falkenstein, Besieged by the Baron of Urach, Summer 1223, Size 9, Garrison 12, Defenses Superior, Supplies Standard, each step's interval and bonus in its hint; then the besiegers' 2 units of miners, 2 mangonels, 3 trebuchets and 40 groups of soldiers.

The rule · LoM pp. 112-114

Each side puts its units at the four walls. Besiegers at three walls or more hold the castle in stockade, and then it makes a supplies roll every Supplies interval.
The experts matter too: the sapper and the castle's counter-miner (Intelligence + Profession: Sapper), the engine master (Intelligence + Siege Weapon) and the castle's engineer (Intelligence + Profession: Siege Engineer).



Add a Siege, the other half: the besiegers at North 15, East 10, South 10, West 5 and the garrison 3 at each wall; the four experts (sapper 7, engine master 5, counter-miner 5, engineer 6), each of whom may be a character instead; the garrison's own engines, up to three outworks, and who is inside.

What happened. The siege of Burg Falkenstein begins: events every week, every wall at 12 of 12, and the castle in stockade.



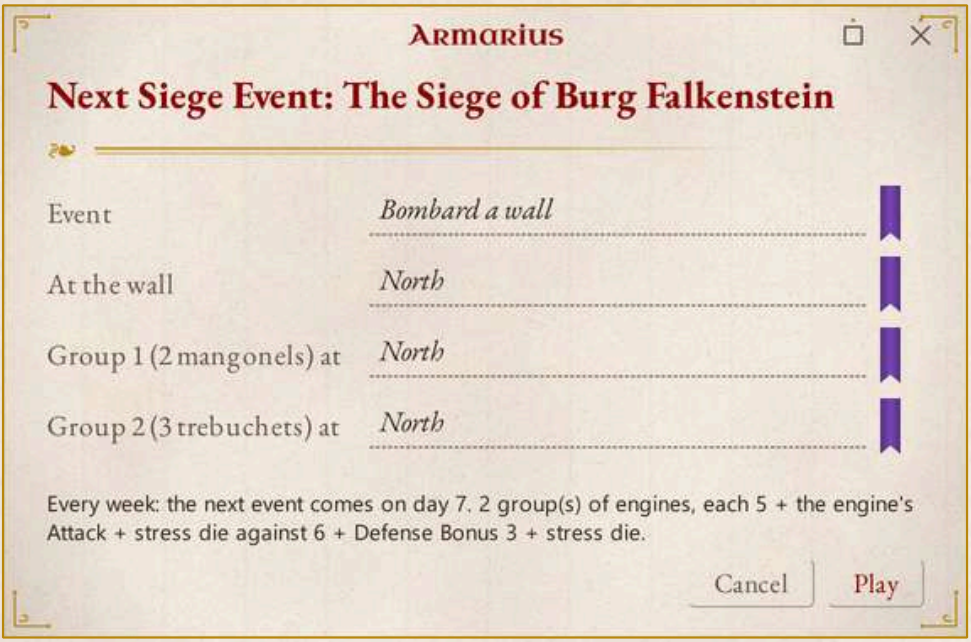
The siege's own page, "just begun", with the Summer 1223 medallion: the castle's figures and gauges on the left (12 groups, Superior, Standard), the plan in the middle with the sappers' mine and the five engines, and on the right the Baron's army, the stockade held at North 15, East 10, South 10, West 5, and every wall at 12 of 12.

7. Engines, mines and a sally

Click **Next Siege Event** on the siege's page and choose what the besiegers do this week. Start by pounding the North wall with the engines.

The rule · LoM pp. 113-114

Engines attack in groups of up to five. Each group rolls Intelligence + Siege Weapon + the engine's Attack (mangonel +3, trebuchet +1) + stress die against the castle's engineer, Intelligence + Profession: Siege Engineer + Defense Bonus + stress die, and hits when it exceeds it. A hit takes a damage level for every engine in the group. A wall at 0 no longer gives its Defense Bonus.



Next Siege Event: Event "Bombard a wall", At the wall North, Group 1 (2 mangonels) and Group 2 (3 trebuchets) both at North. The line reads "Every week: the next event comes on day 7. 2 group(s) of engines, each 5 + the engine's Attack + stress die against 6 + Defense Bonus 3 + stress die."

> **What happened.** The mangonels get 13 against 11 and the trebuchets 12 against 9: both hit, so the North wall loses 2 + 3 = 5 damage levels and has 7 left.

A week later the sappers dig under the East wall. Burg Falkenstein has no moat, which matters.

The rule · LoM pp. 113-114

Mine Attack: Intelligence + Profession: Sapper + stress die, against the castle's counter-miner + Defense Bonus + stress die (with a moat, the Defenses count a step higher). If the attack exceeds the defence, the Defenses drop a step; a botched defence drops them two. A botched attack kills a unit of miners.

What happened. The mine under the East wall: 16 against 12, and the Defenses fall from Superior to Standard (Defense Bonus +2).

The garrison has had enough of the trebuchets, and sallies out against them.

The rule · LoM p. 115

A sally is played at Battle Ease Factor 9, with neither ground nor numbers. The sallying force has to get out, reach its target and get back. Win, and those enemy units are removed. The baggage can't be targeted.

Play it out at the table. The garrison wins, so in the form you say so and pick the target: Trebuchet. Then two weeks of nothing much: **Keep the stockade** just lets time pass (**Run the Stockade**, on **Siege Actions**, waits as many intervals as you ask in one go).

What happened. On day 14 the sally burns all three trebuchets; days 21 and 28 are quiet.

8. Are they hungry yet?

With besiegers at all four walls, Falkenstein is in stockade, and the app makes the supplies rolls as they fall due: with Standard supplies, one a month.

The rule · LoM p. 112

Supplies roll: Siege Conditions Bonus + stress die against 3 + the Garrison's Weight of Numbers + the years under siege. Fail and the Supplies drop a step, so the rolls come more often. Fail at Shoddy and the castle surrenders. A botch (1 + full seasons under siege, in botch dice) means disease.



The siege's page "1 month and 5 days" in: the Defenses down to Standard (+2), the Supplies still Standard, the trebuchets gone from the plan, the North wall at 7 of 12, the stockade held at all four walls, and the chronicle opening with day 0's bombardment.

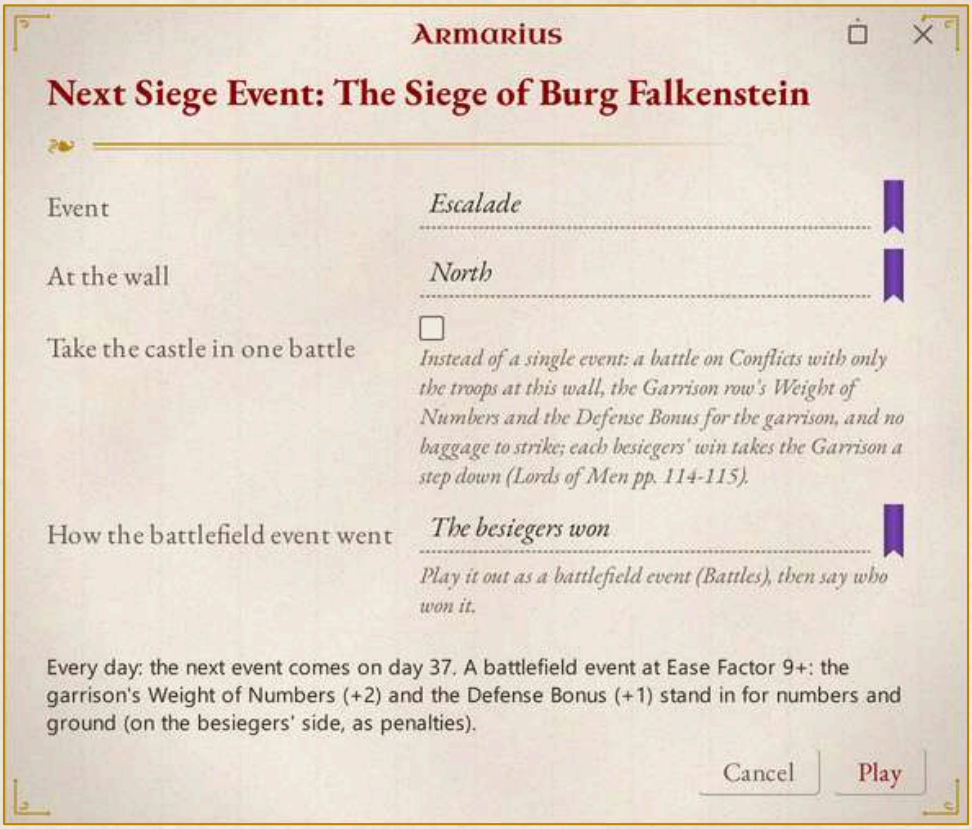
What happened. 3 + 6 = 9 against 3 + 2 + 0 = 5: the supplies hold. Heinrich can sit there for months, so the Baron decides to dig again.

9. The breach

On day 35 the sappers go under the North wall, the one the engines already battered. 16 against 11: the Defenses drop to Shoddy. Shoddy Defenses have an interval of a Day, so from now on something happens every day.

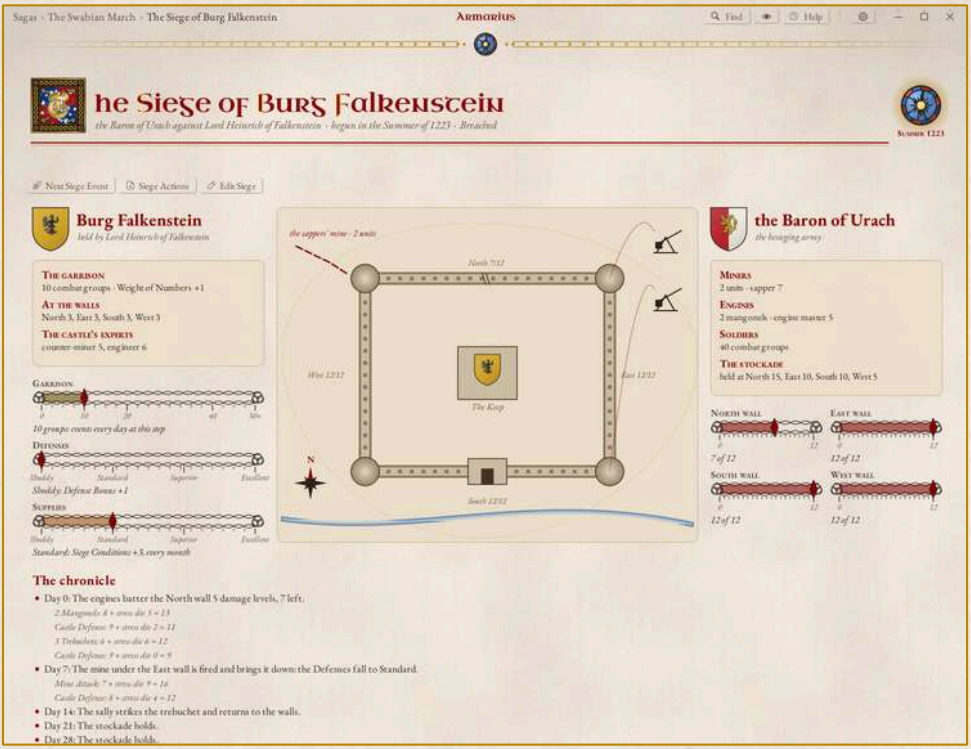
> **The rule · LoM pp. 114-115**
>
> An escalade is a battlefield event at the wall, using only the troops at that wall. The Garrison's Weight of Numbers stands in for the numbers and the Defense Bonus for the ground, both against the attackers. Each besiegers' win takes the Garrison down a step, and a win against a Shoddy wall breaches the castle: the fight inside is then an ordinary battle.

Choose **Escalade** at the North wall; the line spells out the Garrison's +2 and the Defense Bonus of +1 the attackers face. Play the scaling as the book's **Scale the Ladders** (p. 115): Run the Gauntlet +2, Overwhelmed +3, Standard +2. Sir Aimery gets to the top, and the form only needs to know **How the battlefield event went**.



Next Siege Event: Event "Escalade", At the wall North, Take the castle in one battle unticked, How the battlefield event went "The besiegers won". The line reads "Every day: the next event comes on day 37. A battlefield event at Ease Factor 9+: the garrison's Weight of Numbers (+2) and the Defense Bonus (+1) stand in for numbers and ground (on the besiegers' side, as penalties)."

What happened. On day 36 "the besiegers carry the North wall and breach the castle: fight the battle inside with the battle rules." The Garrison drops to 10 groups and the siege ends; a line saying so goes in the Diaries of Lord Heinrich and the Baron. The fight for the keep is a new battle, if Heinrich still wants one.



The siege's page at the end: Breached; Garrison 10 (Weight of Numbers +1, events every day), Defenses Shoddy (+1), the North wall at 7 of 12, only the two mangonels left, and the chronicle of each event from day 0 to day 36 with its dice.

The rule · LoM p. 112

Characters under siege suffer -2 Living Conditions for each year in which they spend at least a season under siege; a year with a season in a campaigning army is -1 (p. 102).

What you do by hand

- **The Morale and rally rolls** are yours to roll and type.
- **A commander with no sheet**: a lord's Reputation point after a victory goes on his record by hand.
- **Prisoners and ransoms** after a battle (LoM p. 108) are played out.
- **Deprivation checks** for the characters inside a castle whose supplies fail (ArM5 p. 180) are made at the table.

Siege Actions also plays the rest of the book's siege: changing deployments, a supplies story or spell, the garrison's own engines firing back, outworks, Raise the Veronese Flag, and the castle taken (LoM pp. 112-116).

Where the rules come from

Lords of Men, chapter eight: armies, baggage and vassal forces (p. 102); allies (pp. 102-103); the mercenary budget and mercenary costs (pp. 103-104); Deployment and Territorial Advantage (p. 104); magic and Weight of Numbers, battlefield events and the Event Total (p. 105); Maneuver, Size, Enemy, losses and Morale (p. 106); example events (pp. 106-108); the end of the day (pp. 108-109); the aftermath and standard combat groups (p. 108); the example battle (p. 109); castles, Garrison and Defenses (pp. 110-111); wall damage levels, Supplies, stockade and siege engines (pp. 112-113); undermining, artillery and escalade (pp. 113-115); sallies and example siege events (p. 115); aftermath and siege magic (p. 116). Chapter nine: mounted combat and the shock of the charge (pp. 126-127).

Ars Magica Definitive Edition: combat and combat groups (pp. 394-398); mounted combat (p. 397).

Errata: Seal the Breach rises to level 20 (Lords of Men p. 116), and the Mounted Movement tables' headings are fixed (p. 127) (Errata pp. 74-75).



Armarius

A saga manager for Ars Magica

Hermetic Politics

The Rhine Tribunal of 1221 hears a motion and a charge, Adelheid settles a quarrel by certamen, and a Tremere answers with a Wizard's War.

Guide 13 of 17

Magi are solitary by nature, and political by necessity. Every seven years the magi of a Tribunal gather to argue, vote and settle their quarrels; between meetings they duel in certamen, declare Wizard's War, and scheme. This guide follows the Rhine Tribunal of Spring 1221 at Durenmar, then Adelheid of Flambeau's quarrel with **Rudolf of Tremere**, a magus of Val Sombre, which ends in certamen in 1223 and a Wizard's War after it.

The rules are the *Ars Magica Definitive Edition* (DE): the Code of Hermes, Wizard's War and Tribunals (pp. 18-23) and certamen (pp. 231-233); *Houses of Hermes: Societates* for Wizard's War in practice (pp. 22-23), House Flambeau's acclaim (p. 31), disguises and personae (pp. 87-90) and the Fine Art of Debate (pp. 90-92); *Houses of Hermes: True Lineages* for intrigue (p. 24), the high crimes (p. 46), Wizard's War law (pp. 47-48) and hearings and penalties (pp. 58-59); and *Guardians of the Forests* for the Rhine's own customs.

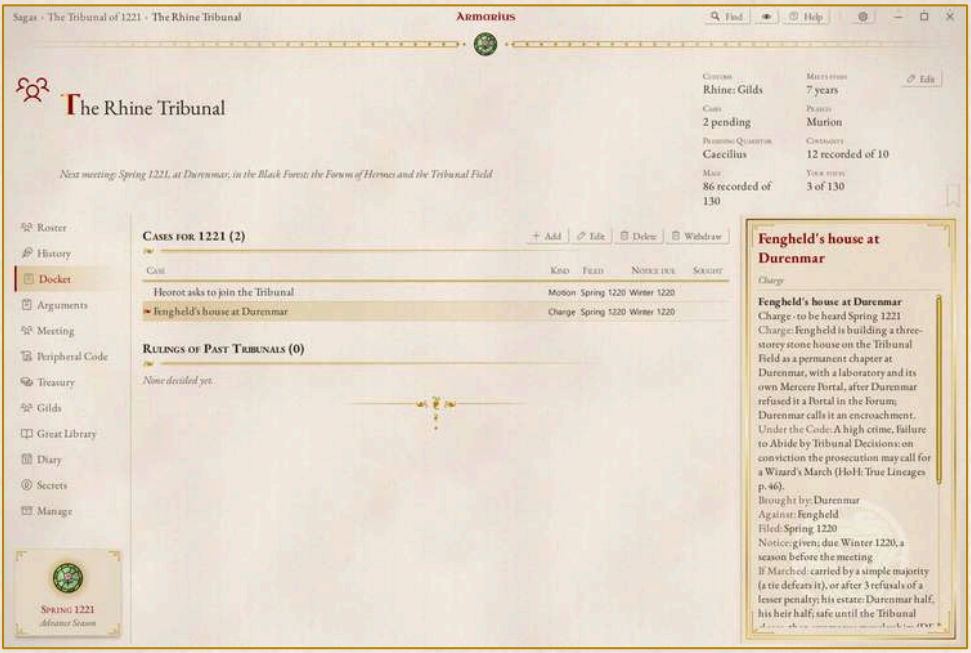
The saga in this guide was started from the Rhine pack (see *The Saga and Its World*), so the hall holds the pack's ten covenants and their magi, beside Rabenstein and Val Sombre.

1. The docket

The rule · DE pp. 22-23

A legal Tribunal needs twelve magi in person from four covenants, and a Quaesitor, who counts for the quorum but doesn't vote. Magi may vote by proxy. The Praeco, the oldest magus present, chairs, chooses the order of business and votes only to break ties. Regional Tribunals meet once every seven years.

Open the Rhine Tribunal (from the saga's Region, or with **Find**) and choose its **Docket** chapter. The pack brought nine cases for 1221; this meeting keeps two, to keep things short. **Heorot asks to join the Tribunal** is a motion from the young covenant on Zealand. **Fengheld's house at Durenmar** is a charge Durenmar brings against Fengheld for building a stone house on the Tribunal Field. Each case keeps who brings it, who it's against, its evidence and when notice is due.

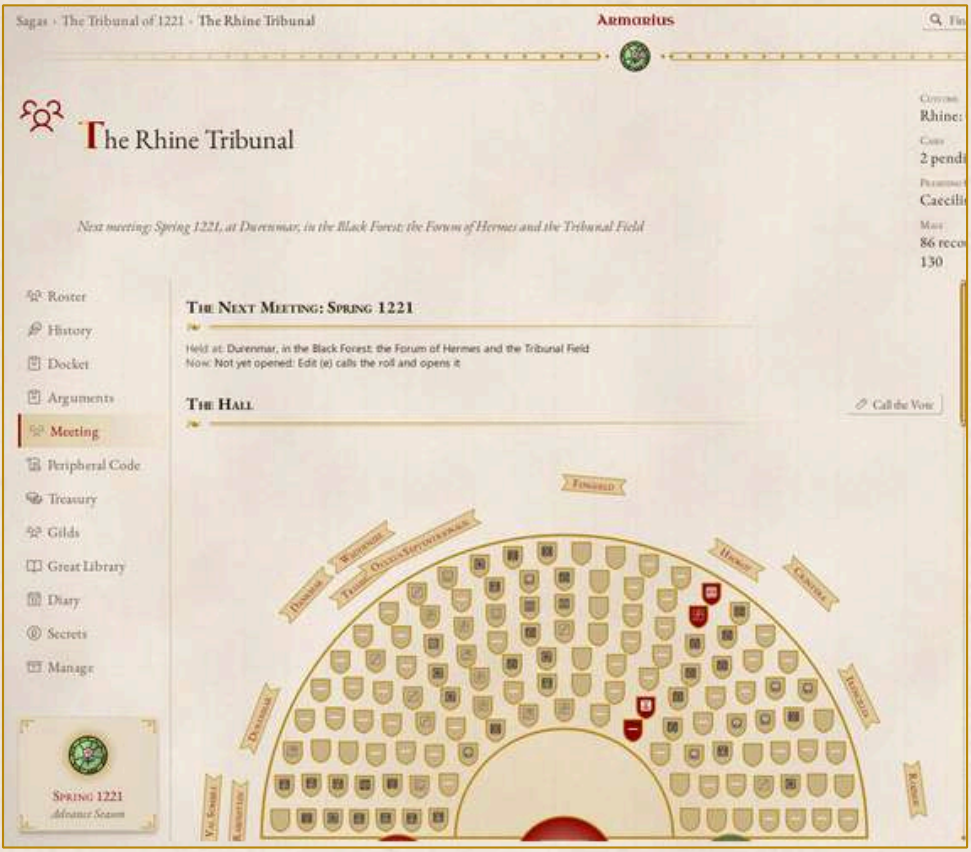


The Rhine Tribunal's Docket chapter: Cases for 1221 (2), Heorot asks to join the Tribunal (Motion) and Fengheld's house at Durenmar (Charge), each filed Spring 1220 with notice due Winter 1220, the second chosen and its details in the inspector; Rulings of Past Tribunals (0) below.

A charge's details say whether the Code makes it a high crime (HoH: True Lineages p. 46). Fengheld's house is one: "Failure to Abide by Tribunal Decisions: on conviction the prosecution may call for a Wizard's March".

2. Before it opens

Choose the **Meeting** chapter. It shows the hall, every vote a shield in its covenant's colours with the Praeco (Murion) in the middle, a scale for the vote in hand, and under it the **Order of Business**, three days of it. Its **Now** line reads "Not yet opened". Click **Hold** to call the roll and open it; a card announces the meeting, with the year, the Tribunal, where it meets and its covenants' arms.



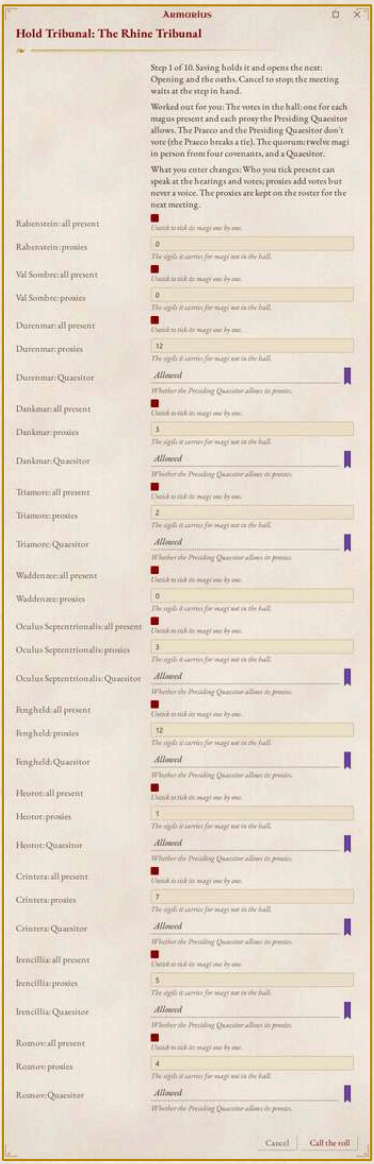
The Meeting chapter before the Tribunal opens: The Next Meeting: Spring 1221, held at Durenmar and not yet opened, and The Hall with Call the Vote, a shield for every vote round the Praeco's seat under each covenant's pennant.

3. The roll call

The meeting runs as ten steps, each a form that says what's worked out for you and what you can change. Saving one holds it and opens the next; Cancel stops, and the meeting waits at the step in hand.

The first step lists every covenant with all its magi present ticked, the proxy sigils each carries, and whether the Presiding Quaesitor allows them. Untick anyone who stayed home. Every magus of the Rhine came this year.

> **The rule · Guardians of the Forests p. 26**
> In the Rhine a master holds a retired magus's sigil by proxy, and an archmage two; so the old covenants carry far more votes than their magi.



Step 1 of 10, the roll call and proxies, the first covenants of the roll: each one's magi present, the proxy sigils it carries, and whether the Presiding Quaesitor allows them.

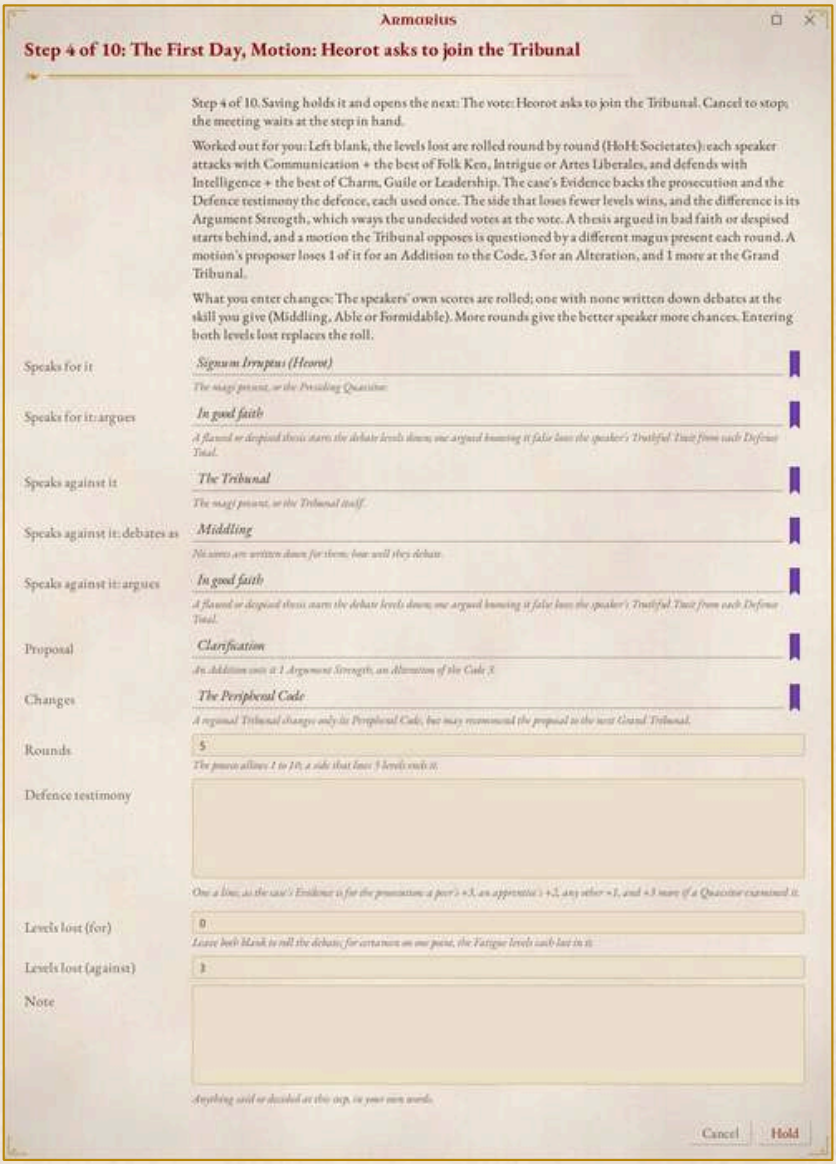
What happened. 130 votes in the hall, 49 of them by proxy, from twelve covenants: the quorum is met easily. Steps 2 and 3 open the Tribunal, swear the oaths, and introduce the new magi.

4. The motion and its debate

On the first day, Heorot's request. A motion is debated against the whole hall: Heorot's **Signum Irruptus** speaks for it, and "The Tribunal" against.

The rule · HoH: Societates pp. 90-92

A debate runs like certamen. Each round the speaker attacks with Communication + Folk Ken, Intrigue or Artes Liberales, and defends with Intelligence + Charm, Guile or Leadership; each attack Ability does better against one defence and worse against another (±3). A hit costs the other side debate Fatigue levels. The side that loses fewer wins, and the difference is its Argument Strength: 2 is an Edge, worth 10% of the undecided votes, rising to a Landslide (7+), worth 60% of them and 30% of the other side's. In a proposal case the proposer faces a different questioner each round, but the blows he lands all count against one opponent, the Tribunal.



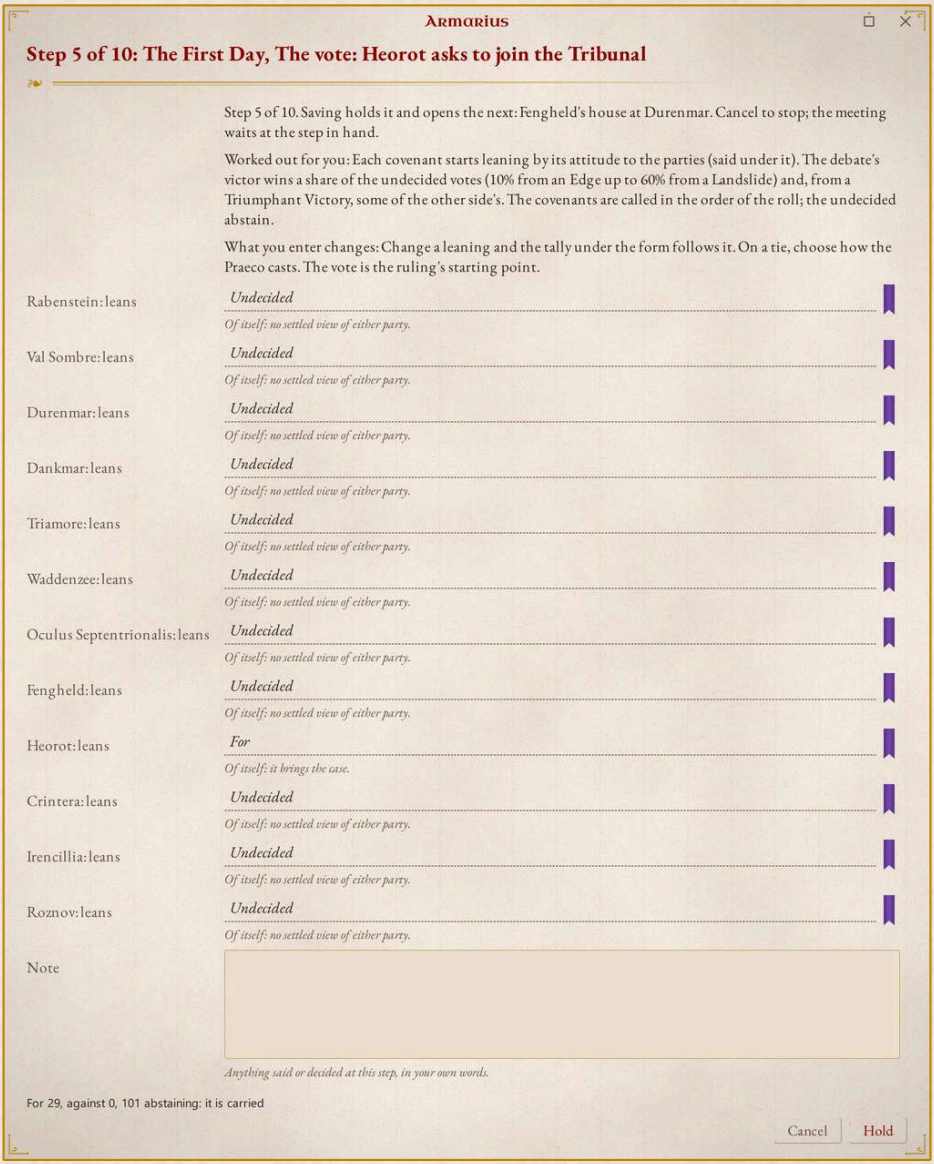
Step 4 of 10, the motion: Speaks for it Signum Irruptus, Speaks against it The Tribunal, each "debates as Middling" and "argues in good faith"; Proposal Clarification; Changes The Peripheral Code; Rounds 5; Levels lost 0 for and 3 against, as the debate was played at the table.

A speaker with no scores written down debates at the skill you give him: **Middling**, **Able** or **Formidable**. The book gives no figures for them, so these are the app's. Leave **Levels lost** blank and the app rolls the debate round by round; or play it out at the table and type both sides' losses.

> **What happened.** Signum Irruptus carries the hall with the Upper Hand (Argument Strength 3).

5. The vote

Each covenant leans for, against or undecided: a party votes its own side, and in the Rhine a covenant whose gild a party shares votes with its gild (*Guardians of the Forests* pp. 27-28); any other leans by its attitude to the parties. The tally under the form follows as you change any leaning.
The debate's victor wins his share of the undecided; the rest abstain.



Step 5 of 10, the vote: each covenant's leaning with the reason under it (Heorot For, "Of itself: it brings the case"; the rest Undecided) and the tally "For 29, against 0, 101 abstaining: it is carried".

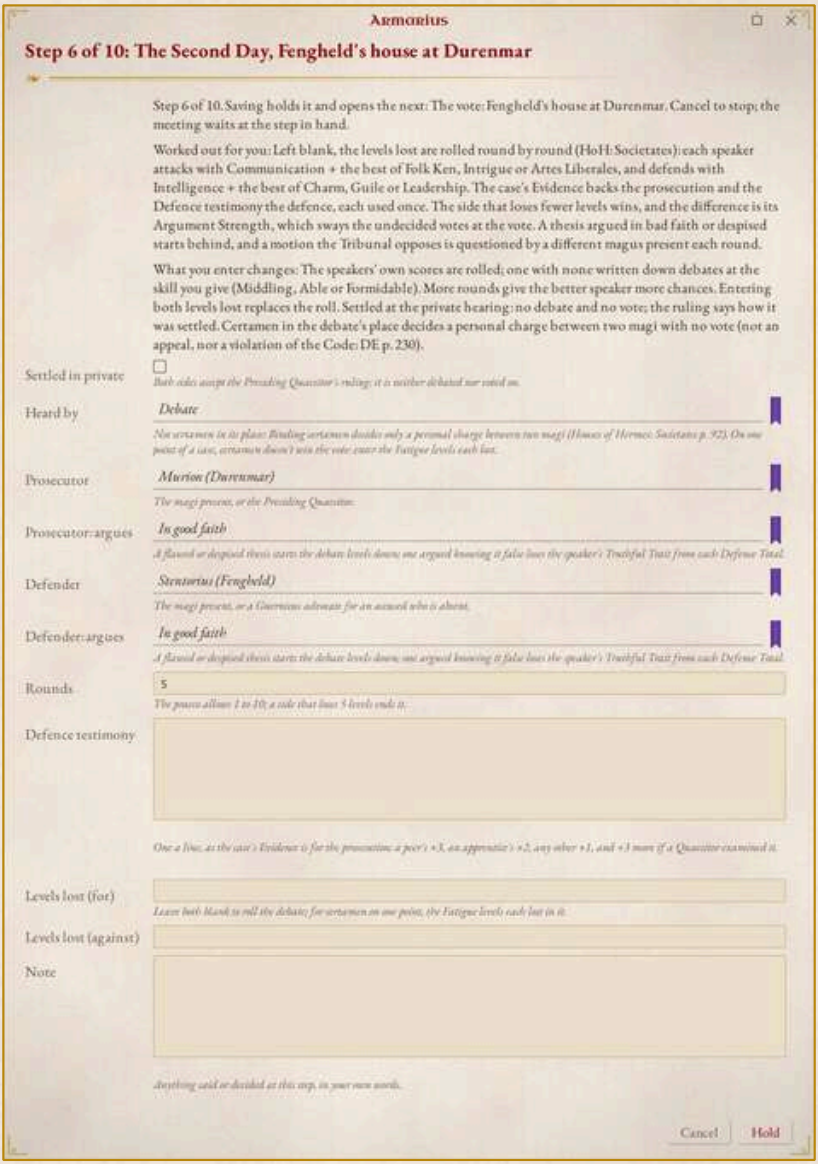
Save it, and on the Meeting chapter **Call the Vote** fills the hall's seats covenant by covenant, in the order of the roll.

> **What happened.** Heorot leans for itself, and the Upper Hand brings it a fifth of the undecided: 29 for, none against, 101 abstaining. The motion is carried, and Heorot joins the Rhine.

6. The charge

On the second day, Durenmar's charge against Fengheld. The Prosecutor and Defender are chosen from the magi present: Murion for Durenmar, Stentorius for Fengheld. The case's evidence backs the prosecution.

> **The rule · HoH: Societates p. 92; HoH: True Lineages p. 58**
>
> Each testimony may be used once in the debate: the prosecution's to raise an Attack Total, the defence's a Defence Total, +1 for written testimony or a mundane's, +2 for a social inferior's, +3 for a peer's, and +3 more if a Quaesitor examined it. The Tribunal votes by simple majority; the Praeco breaks a tie.

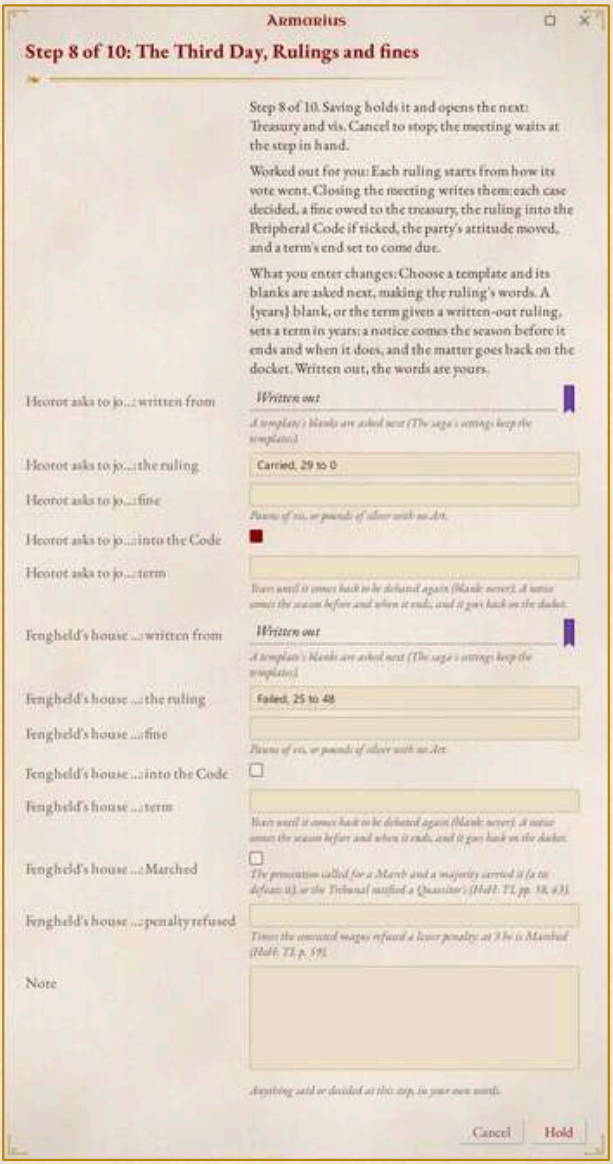


Step 6 of 10, the hearing: Heard by Debate, Murion (Durenmar) prosecutes and Stentorius (Fengheld) defends, both in good faith, over five rounds.

> **What happened.** Neither speaker carried the hall (no levels lost on either side), so the covenants vote on their leanings, Fengheld's gild-fellows with it: 25 for, 48 against, 57 abstaining. The charge fails, and Fengheld's house stays where it is.

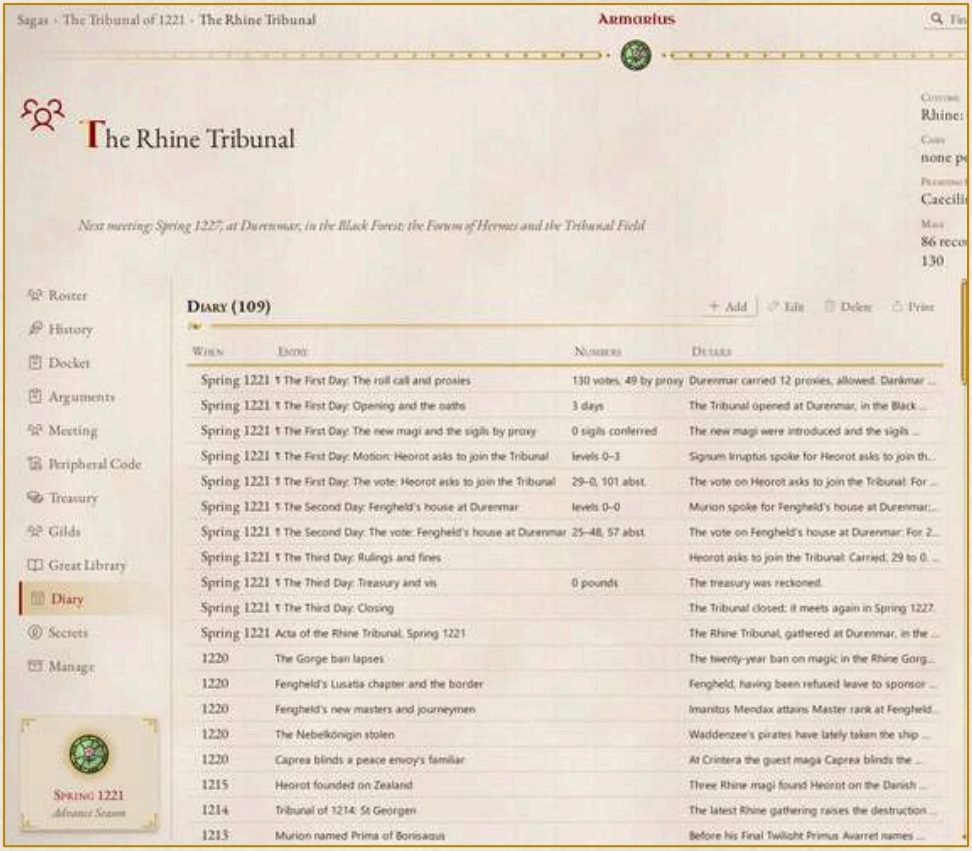
7. Rulings, Treasury and Closing

On the last day each case gets its ruling, written out or made from a template (a fine, a term, an acquittal), starting from how its vote went. A ruling can go into the Peripheral Code, fine a party, move an attitude, or set a term after which the matter comes back to the docket by itself. Then the Treasury, and the Closing.



Step 8 of 10, Rulings and fines: each case written out, "Carried, 29 to 0" for Heorot (into the Code ticked) and "Failed, 25 to 48" for Fengheld's house, with a fine, a term, and for the charge Marched and penalty refused, all left blank.

What happened. The Tribunal of 1221 is closed. Both cases move to **Rulings of Past Tribunals**, each step has its minutes in the Tribunal's Diary, the Acta are written, and the next meeting is set for Spring 1227.



The Tribunal's Diary afterwards: a line for each step, from "The First Day: The roll call and proxies" to "The Third Day: Closing", and the Acta.

The rule · DE p. 22; Guardians of the Forests pp. 140, 143

The Grand Tribunal meets every 33 years at Durenmar, with three representatives from each regional Tribunal and the Primi of the Houses. Seven years on from 1221 is 1228, a Grand Tribunal's year, so the Rhine holds its own meeting a year early, in 1227.

Working the corridors

Much of a Tribunal happens outside the hall. On a case's form, **Intrigue by** names who works on it before the meeting, and **Intrigue: to** what for, from learning someone's open political aim (6) to setting wavering allies against each other (12).

The rule · HoH: True Lineages p. 24

To influence someone, roll Presence + Intrigue; to draw information out of him, Communication + Intrigue, always a stress roll, less the Gift's penalty (-3, or -6 for the Blatant Gift) unless both are under Parma Magica. Against someone working against you, it's Presence + Intrigue + stress die against his Communication + Intrigue (or Guile) + stress die.

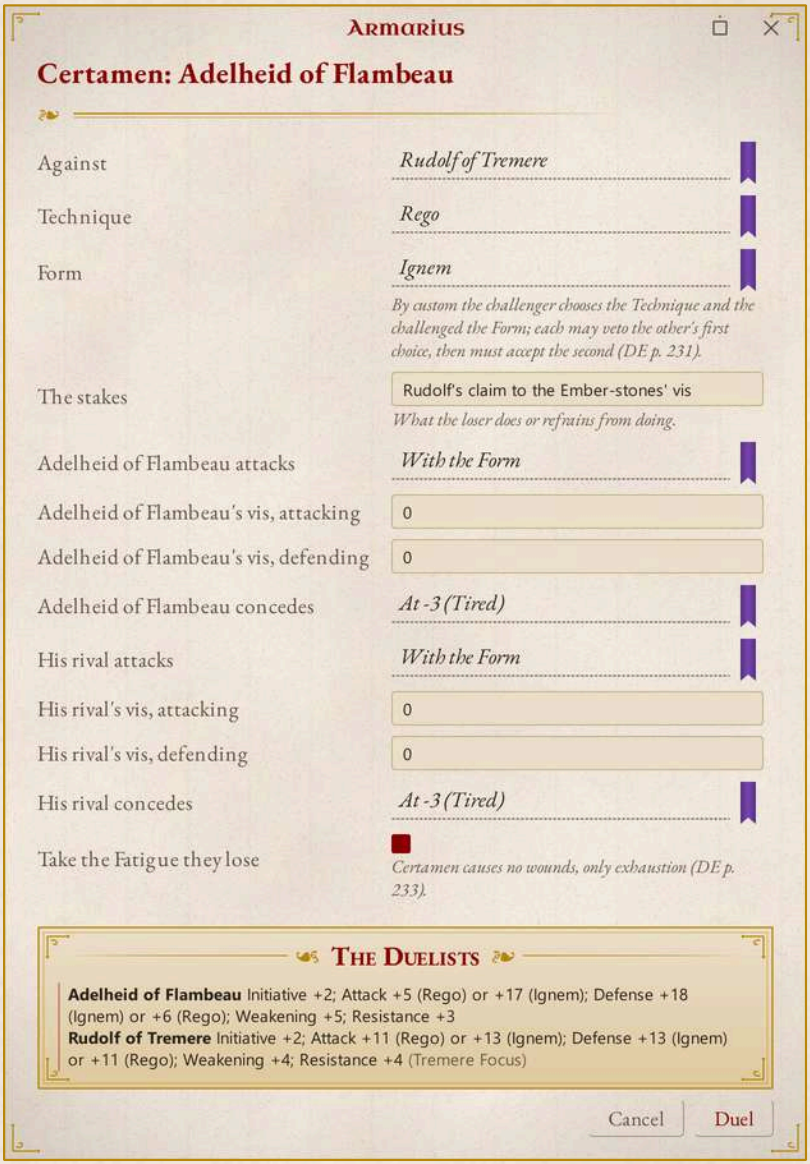
8. Certamen

In the Summer of 1223 Rudolf of Tremere, of Val Sombre, claims the Ember-stones' Ignem vis, which Adelheid has gathered since 1221. Rather than wait four years for the Tribunal, they settle it by certamen: if he loses, he gives up his claim; if she loses, she gives up the stones.

The rule · DE pp. 231-233

The challenger chooses the Technique and the other the Form; each may veto the other's first choice. Each round a magus uses one Art to attack and the other to defend. Initiative = Quickness + Finesse + stress die, once for the duel. Attack = Presence + one Art + stress die; Defence = Perception + the other Art + stress die; the Attack Advantage is the Attack Total less the Defence Total (a tie goes to the defender). Weakening = Intelligence + Penetration + Attack Advantage; Resistance = Stamina + Parma Magica (not x5). Every 5 points or fraction of Weakening over Resistance costs a Fatigue level. Every Tremere has a Minor Magical Focus in certamen: the lower of the two Arts counts double.

On Adelheid's **Hermetic Magic** chapter, click **Certamen**, under Magic Outside the Lab. Choose her rival (**Against**: Rudolf, a magus of the saga), the **Technique** (Rudolf chooses Rego) and the **Form** (Adelheid chooses Ignem, her best Art), and type **The stakes**. Each side has a plan for the whole duel: which Art he attacks with, the pawns of vis he spends a round on attack and defence, and when he concedes. Adelheid attacks with the Form, Ignem, and concedes at -3; so does Rudolf.



Certamen: Adelheid of Flambeau, Against Rudolf of Tremere, Technique Rego, Form Ignem, The stakes "Rudolf's claim to the Ember-stones' vis", each attacking with the Form. The panel reads "Adelheid of Flambeau: Initiative +2; Attack +5 (Rego) or +17 (Ignem); Defense +18 (Ignem) or +6 (Rego); Weakening +5; Resistance +3" and "Rudolf of Tremere: Initiative +2; Attack +11 (Rego) or +13 (Ignem); Defense +13 (Ignem) or +11 (Rego); Weakening +4; Resistance +4 (Tremere Focus)".

The panel does the sums from both sheets. Rudolf's Ignem 6 is the lower of his two Arts, so his Tremere Focus counts it as 12.

> **What happened.** **Duel** plays every round. Initiative: Adelheid 6, Rudolf 4, so she strikes first. Round 1: her Ignem 24 against his Rego 17, Weakening 12 against Resistance 4: Rudolf loses 2 Fatigue levels. He answers 14 against her 9 and takes 2 from her. Round 2: her 20 against his 18, Weakening 7: one more level, and at -3 Rudolf concedes. "Adelheid of Flambeau wins: Rudolf of Tremere concedes at tired; his Parma Magica stands." With **Take the Fatigue they lose** ticked, the levels go on both sheets, and both Diaries keep the duel.

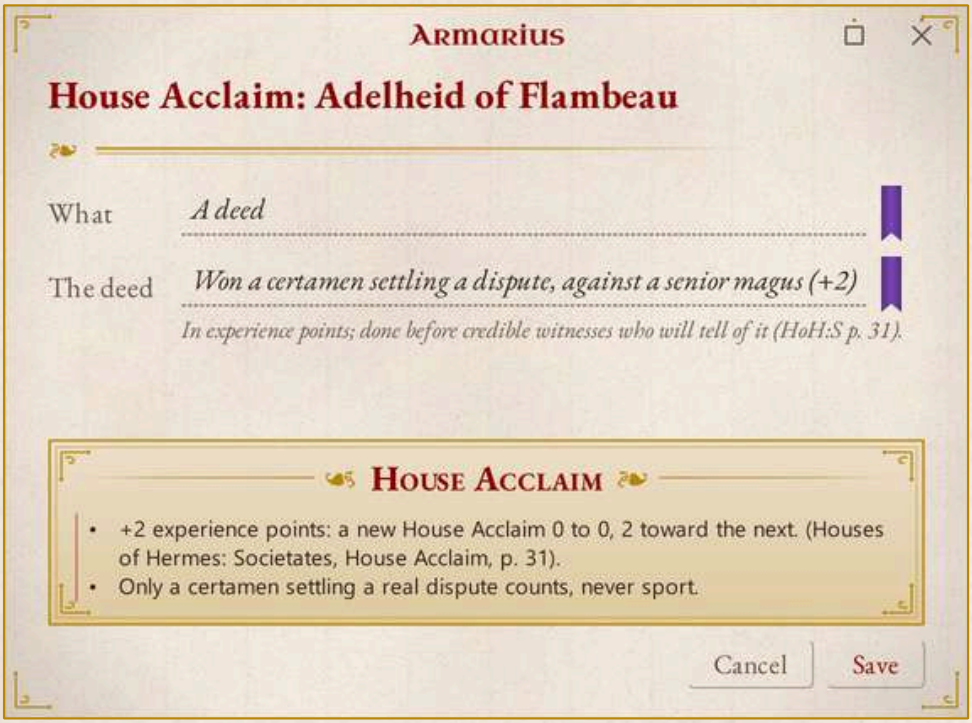
A magus can botch in certamen, and the book doesn't say what that does, so a botch stops the duel there: the storyguide says what comes of it, and the rest is played at the table.

House Acclaim

The rule · HoH: Societates p. 31

House Flambeau keeps a Hermetic Reputation, House Acclaim, known in the whole Order, which grows by deeds before credible witnesses: a certamen won is 1 experience point, 2 against a senior magus; a certamen lost -1. Certamen counts only when it settles a real dispute.

Rudolf is the senior magus, and the duel settled a real dispute. On her **Deeds** chapter, under Session & Reputation, click **House Acclaim**, choose **A deed** and "Won a certamen settling a dispute, against a senior magus": 2 experience points. The first award starts House Acclaim at 0, with 2 toward the next level, and each is kept in her Diary.



House Acclaim: Adelheid of Flambeau, What "A deed", The deed "Won a certamen settling a dispute, against a senior magus (+2)". The foot reads "+2 experience points: a new House Acclaim 0 to 0, 2 toward the next" and "Only a certamen settling a real dispute counts, never sport."

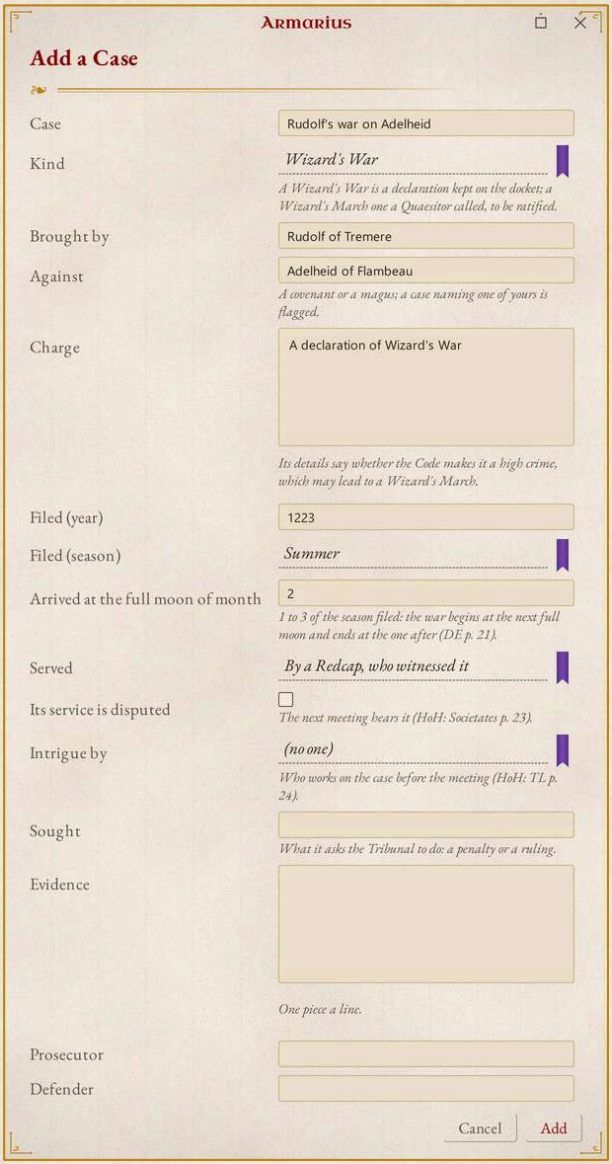
9. Wizard's War

Rudolf doesn't take it well. At the full moon of the second month of Summer 1223, a Redcap brings Adelheid his declaration of Wizard's War.

The rule · DE pp. 19, 21; HoH: Societates pp. 22-23; HoH: True Lineages p. 47

A declaration must arrive on the night of a full moon. The war begins at the next full moon and lasts until the one after: a month to prepare, then a month of war. Either may slay the other without retribution, but neither may harm other magi, their property, or scry on them; a magus hiding inside his covenant is protected by his sodales. A Redcap is the declaration's legal witness. Unjust or constant use of Wizard's War can end in a Wizard's March.

Back on the Rhine Tribunal's **Docket**, click **Add** under Cases. Choose **Kind** Wizard's War: the form drops what a war doesn't need and asks when the declaration **Arrived at the full moon of month** (1 to 3 of the season filed) and how it was **Served**.



Add a Case: Case "Rudolf's war on Adelheid", Kind Wizard's War, Brought by Rudolf of Tremere, Against Adelheid of Flambeau, Filed Summer 1223, Arrived at the full moon of month 2, Served "By a Redcap, who witnessed it".

What happened. The case's details give the war's dates: "declared at the full moon of the second month of Summer 1223; it begins at the next (the third month of Summer 1223) and lasts until the one after (the first month of Autumn 1223)". The war is duly served, with the Redcap as its witness, and the details say what the Code allows and what stays a crime. A war stays on the docket, "on the docket, not heard": no meeting hears it unless you tick **Its service is disputed**.

Rudolf's war on Adelheid

War

Rudolf's war on Adelheid Wizard's War · on the docket, not heard
Charge: A declaration of Wizard's War
Brought by: Rudolf of Tremere
Against: Adelheid of Flambeau
Filed: Summer 1223
War: declared at the full moon of the second month of Summer 1223; it begins at the next (the third month of Summer 1223) and lasts until the one after (the first month of Autumn 1223) (DE p. 21)
Now: to come: the month to prepare runs
Served: duly served: the Redcap is its legal witness (HoH: TL p. 47)
Under the Code: either may slay the other without retribution, and neither is charged for declaring it (DE p. 19; HoH: TL p. 47); harm to other magi, to property shared with them, or scrying on or attacking those not at war, stays a crime (HoH: Societates pp. 22-23; HoH: TL p. 47)

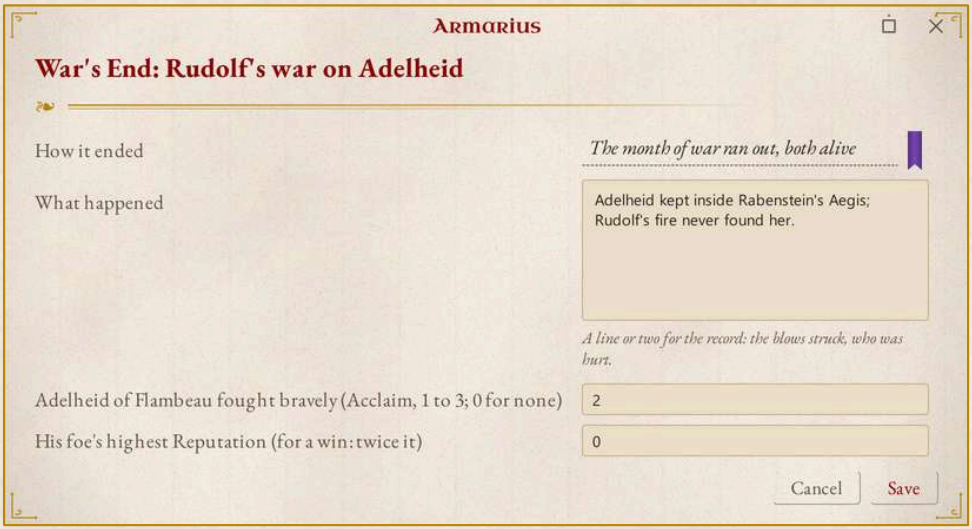
The war's details on the Docket: its dates, "Now: to come: the month to prepare runs", "Served: duly served: the Redcap is its legal witness", and what the Code allows.

Adelheid stays inside Rabenstein's Aegis for the month, and her sodales won't let Rudolf in. Play the war itself as a story, with Fights for any battle (see *War*).

When the month is out, choose the war on the Docket and click **War's End**: the month ran out with both alive, the declarer slew his foe, the foe slew the declarer, or they made peace, with a line on what happened. The war leaves the docket for the past rulings.

> **The rule · HoH: Societates p. 31**
>
> Fighting bravely in a Wizard's War is 1 to 3 experience points of House Acclaim, and winning one twice the foe's highest Reputation.

Adelheid kept her head down and both lived, but she held her ground: type 2 for her fighting bravely, and War's End gives them to her House Acclaim ("Adelheid of Flambeau: fought bravely +2"); both Diaries and the Tribunal's record it. A slain magus isn't marked dead on his sheet: do that as your saga does.

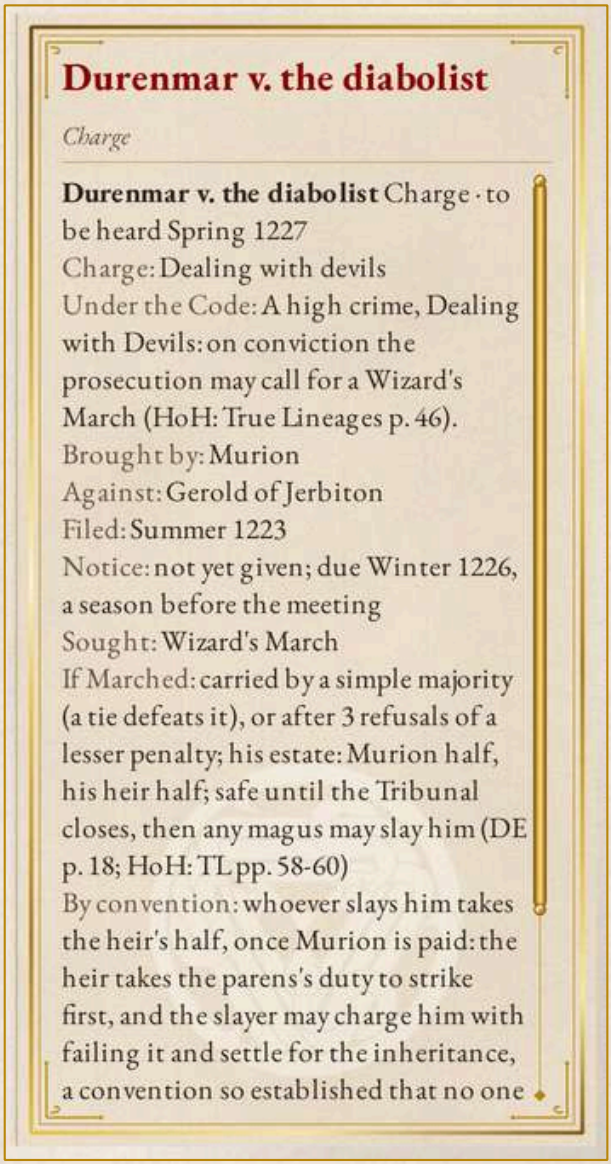


War's End: Rudolf's war on Adelheid: How it ended "The month of war ran out, both alive", What happened, and "Adelheid of Flambeau fought bravely (Acclaim, 1 to 3; 0 for none)".

10. A charge that could end in a March

Not every quarrel ends in a duel. Durenmar charges Gerold of Jerbiton with dealing with devils, and asks for the worst.

Add it as a charge, with **Sought** "Wizard's March".



Durenmar v. the diabolist

Charge

Durenmar v. the diabolist Charge · to be heard Spring 1227
Charge: Dealing with devils
Under the Code: A high crime, Dealing with Devils: on conviction the prosecution may call for a Wizard's March (HoH: True Lineages p. 46).
Brought by: Murion
Against: Gerold of Jerbiton
Filed: Summer 1223
Notice: not yet given; due Winter 1226, a season before the meeting
Sought: Wizard's March
If Marched: carried by a simple majority (a tie defeats it), or after 3 refusals of a lesser penalty; his estate: Murion half, his heir half; safe until the Tribunal closes, then any magus may slay him (DE p. 18; HoH: TL pp. 58-60)
By convention: whoever slays him takes the heir's half, once Murion is paid: the heir takes the parens's duty to strike first, and the slayer may charge him with failing it and settle for the inheritance, a convention so established that no one

The charge's details: "Under the Code: A high crime, Dealing with Devils: on conviction the prosecution may call for a Wizard's March"; "Notice: not yet given; due Winter 1226, a season before the meeting"; "If Marched: carried by a simple majority (a tie defeats it), or after 3 refusals of a lesser penalty; his estate: Murion half, his heir half".

The rule · DE p. 18; HoH: True Lineages pp. 58-59

After a conviction for a high crime the prosecution may call for a Wizard's March: the convicted magus pleads for mercy, the hall debates, and a simple majority carries it (a tie defeats it). Otherwise the Presiding Quaesitor offers a lesser penalty; refusing three times is a March. The victim takes a quarter of the outcast's estate, the prosecutor a quarter (half if he is also the victim), and his heir the rest. The Marched magus is cast out of the Order, and any magus may slay him.

When a meeting Marches a magus, closing it marks him renounced on his sheet (Renounced, and by whom), and the sheet says that any magus may slay him.

11. Disguises and personae

Some magi play politics behind another face: a merchant's, a priest's, or that of a magus who never existed at all, with a history and a Reputation of his own.

The rule · HoH: Societates pp. 87-90

A Disguise roll is Intelligence + Guile + stress die against 9, more for a change of status, appearance or sex, or little preparation; then Presence + Guile against the other's Intelligence + Folk Ken to talk with someone. A deep cover persona builds its own Reputation, a point or two of experience a year.

The Persona Virtue gives one flawless identity per point of its Ability: Stamina + Persona against 9 to take one or return; each starts with a Reputation of 1 and gains the experience put into Persona.

A magus of House Tytalus, one with the Persona Ability, or anyone with a cover recorded has a **Covers** section on his sheet. **Add** a deep cover (a name and role in a community, with its own Reputation there that Advance raises a season at a time while it's kept up) or a persona (one for each point of Persona).

The rule · HoH: Societates pp. 87-88

The Disguise roll is Intelligence + Guile + a stress die against 9 + the modifiers that apply (a change of social status +3, a minor alteration in appearance +1, a major one +3, a change of sex +6, minimal preparation +3, none +6), less the cover's Reputation while it's being defended rather than established. Talking with someone in disguise is Presence + Guile + a stress die against his Intelligence + Folk Ken + a stress die, a social roll, so the Gift's penalty counts.

Disguise Roll, beside Covers, rolls either: choose the cover and what applies, and the form shows whether it holds. Nothing is changed.

The Grand Tribunal and the secret societies

The rule · DE p. 22

The Grand Tribunal meets every 33 years at Durenmar, with three representatives from each regional Tribunal and the Primi of the Houses. The Primus of Bonisagus is its Praeco and the Primus of Guernicus its Presiding Quaesitor. It must be quorate as any legal Tribunal: twelve magi in person from four covenants, and a Quaesitor.

To hold it, make a Tribunal with **New Tribunal** and choose the Grand Tribunal's customs: they fill in its 33 years, Durenmar and the next Grand Tribunal's year (1228). Its **Delegates** chapter lists those who vote, three from each regional Tribunal and the Primi; naming the two Primi as magi of the saga makes them Praeco and Presiding Quaesitor. Its meeting is held as the Rhine's was, with the delegates counted for the quorum. (The *Grand Tribunal* rules sheet in your library is a separate board game, not saga rules.)

Secret societies, the *Mysteries Revised Edition*'s cults such as the Order of the Green Cockerel (p. 44), are a saga's Mystery Cults (*The Mystery Cults*). A cult of the saga can also have an agenda and attitudes, and its members lean with it at a Tribunal's votes.

What you do by hand

- **A certamen botch**, or a magus changing his plan mid-duel, is played at the table.
- **The war itself**: a Wizard's War is a story; play its fights as Fights, and mark a slain magus dead yourself.
- **The scenes of a Tribunal**: the speeches, the corridor deals and the certamen in the Forum are yours; the app keeps the outcome.
- **Who may vote**: Heorot, applying to join, still votes on its own motion; take its magi off the roll if your troupe says a covenant can't vote until it's a member.
- **Gild discipline** is the app's reading: a covenant leans with its members' gild, ahead of its attitudes; change any leaning at the meeting.

Where the rules come from

Ars Magica Definitive Edition: the Peripheral Code and the Wizard's March (p. 18); the Code of Hermes (p. 19); Wizard's War (p. 21); the Grand Tribunal, quorum, proxies and the Praeco (p. 22); regional Tribunals every seven years (p. 23); certamen (pp. 231-232); House Tremere's focus in certamen (p. 233).

Houses of Hermes: Societates: Wizard's War in practice and serving a declaration (pp. 22-23); House Flambeau's acclaim (p. 31); disguises, deep cover and personae (pp. 87-90); the Fine Art of Debate, testimony, proposals and certamen in place of debate (pp. 90-92).

Houses of Hermes: True Lineages: intrigue (p. 24); the high crimes (p. 46); Wizard's War law (pp. 47-48); the hearing, conviction and the March (p. 58); penalties and the outcast's estate (p. 59).

Guardians of the Forests: voting by proxy (p. 26); the Tribunal's dates (pp. 140, 143).

The Mysteries Revised Edition: the Order of the Green Cockerel (p. 44).



Armarius

A saga manager for Ars Magica

The Saga and Its World

Starting a saga with the whole Rhine Tribunal already in it, the other Tribunal books, and the yearly step that moves the world on each Winter.

Guide 14 of 17

Running a saga in a published Tribunal means a lot of typing before anyone rolls a die: covenants, magi, lords, forests, local laws. The app ships a content pack for each Tribunal book it covers, written in its own words from the book, so you can start a saga with the Tribunal already peopled. Then, once a year, it moves that world on.

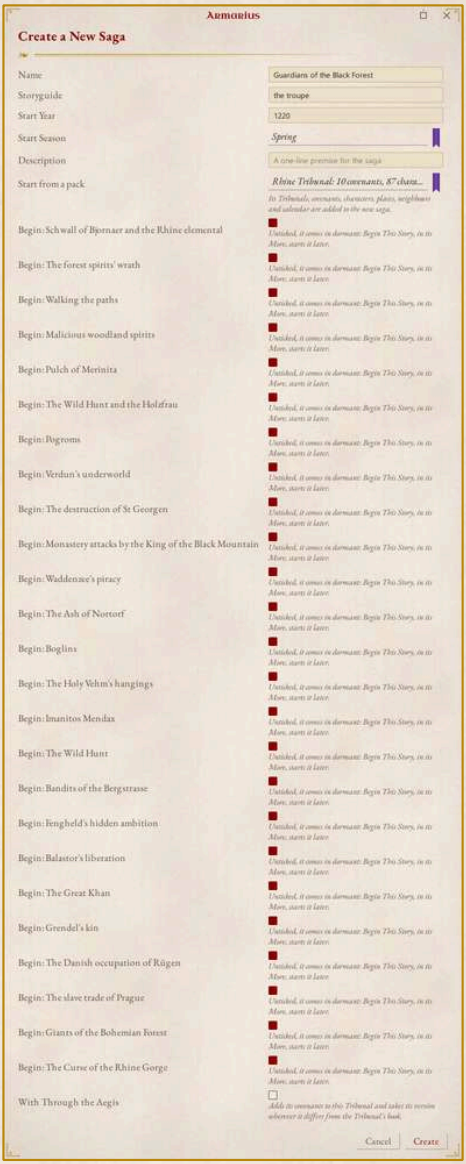
This guide starts a saga from *Guardians of the Forests*, the Rhine Tribunal, in Spring 1220, brings Rabenstein into it, looks at the other books' packs, and plays the world's first Winter, when the Wild Hunt rides.

The packs are content, not rules; where this guide says what a book says, it cites *Guardians of the Forests* (GotF) by page. The yearly step is the app's own bookkeeping, not a rule from the books.

1. A new saga from a pack

On the saga list, choose **New Saga**. Give it a name ("Guardians of the Black Forest"), a storyguide and a start date, and pick the book under **Start from a pack**. Each pack says what it brings: the Rhine Tribunal, 10 covenants, 87 characters, 325 places and neighbours and 20 creatures.

Under it is a **Begin** tick for each of the book's stories: the Wild Hunt, the Curse of the Rhine Gorge, Waddenzee's piracy and the rest. Untick the ones you want to keep for later, and they come in dormant: **Begin This Story**, in the story's More, starts it when you want it. At the foot, **With Through the Aegis** lays that supplement over the Tribunal; leave it unticked to play the Rhine as *Guardians of the Forests* has it.



Create a New Saga: Name "Guardians of the Black Forest", Storyguide "the troupe", Start Year 1220, Spring, Start from a pack "Rhine Tribunal: 10 covenants, 87 chara...", a ticked Begin box for each of its stories from Schwall of Bjornaer to the Curse of the Rhine Gorge, and With Through the Aegis unticked.

What happened. The saga opens with the whole Tribunal in it, in Spring 1220, and the pack's book is put in play, so its rules and neighbour kinds show.
The packs are written as of the book's own year; a saga started at another date keeps its own date.

2. The Covenants and the Region

The saga's **The Covenants** chapter shows every covenant as a card: Durenmar, Fengheld, Crintera and the rest, each with its season, founding year, aura and magi. **The Region** opens with the Tribunals as cards, then the Region's facts (among them the **Threat due**, the threat whose next stage comes soonest), then the mundane world, from Emperor Frederick II down: princes, cities, churches and factions. Filter them by region and kind, or choose **By place** to see them laid out on the land, each under the forest or valley it sits in. **Compendium** ends in the Bestiary: the creatures the book prints, each found at the place it haunts.



The Covenants chapter: the ten covenants of the Rhine as cards, each with its Tribunal, season, founding year, aura and magi.



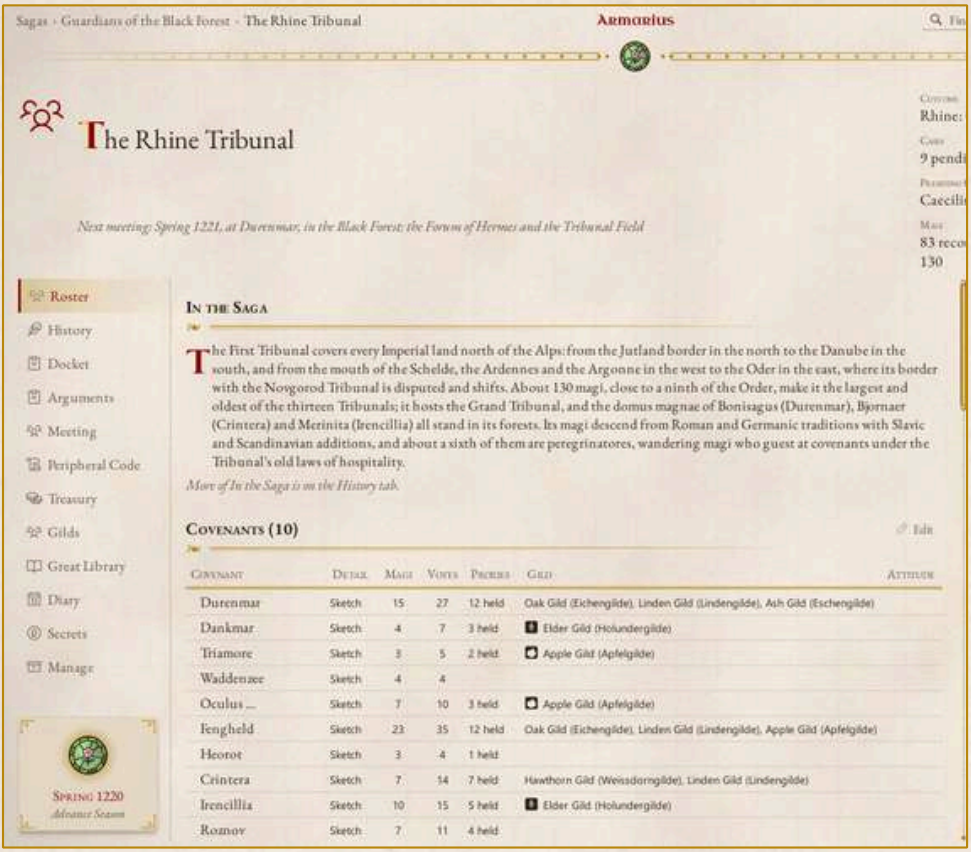
The Region chapter: the Rhine Tribunal's card (Praeco Murion, next meeting Spring 1221 at Durenmar), the Region's facts with the Wild Hunt as the threat due in Winter 1220, and Lords and Towns from Emperor Frederick II down.

3. The Tribunal

The Rhine Tribunal has a page of its own. Its header carries what matters at a glance: it meets every seven years, Murion is Praeco, the next meeting is Spring 1221 at Durenmar, and nine cases are pending. The **Roster** lists every covenant with its magi, votes and proxies.

The book · GotF pp. 26-27

In the Rhine a master is entrusted with a retired magus's voting sigil by proxy, and an archmage with another, so the old covenants carry more votes. The Praeco isn't the oldest magus but the Primus of House Bonisagus, who holds Bonisagus's own sigil.



The Rhine Tribunal's Roster: the header (Customs Rhine: Gilds, meets every 7 years, 9 cases pending, Praeco Murion), In the Saga, then each covenant's magi, votes, proxies and gilds.

The book · GotF pp. 27-28

The Rhine's magi belong to six political gilds, named after trees, that cut across House and covenant: the Oak Gild (the largest, led by Murion), and the Hawthorn, Ash, Elder, Linden and Apple Gilds. A magus belongs to one at most, and every gild forbids Wizard's War among its members.

The **Gilds** chapter lists each gild, its leader and members. The **Docket** holds the nine cases for the Tribunal of 1221, from Heorot's request to join to Waddenzee's piracy (*Hermetic Politics* holds that meeting), and the **Peripheral Code** the rulings the book names, each with its year. The **Great Library** keeps Durenmar's books.

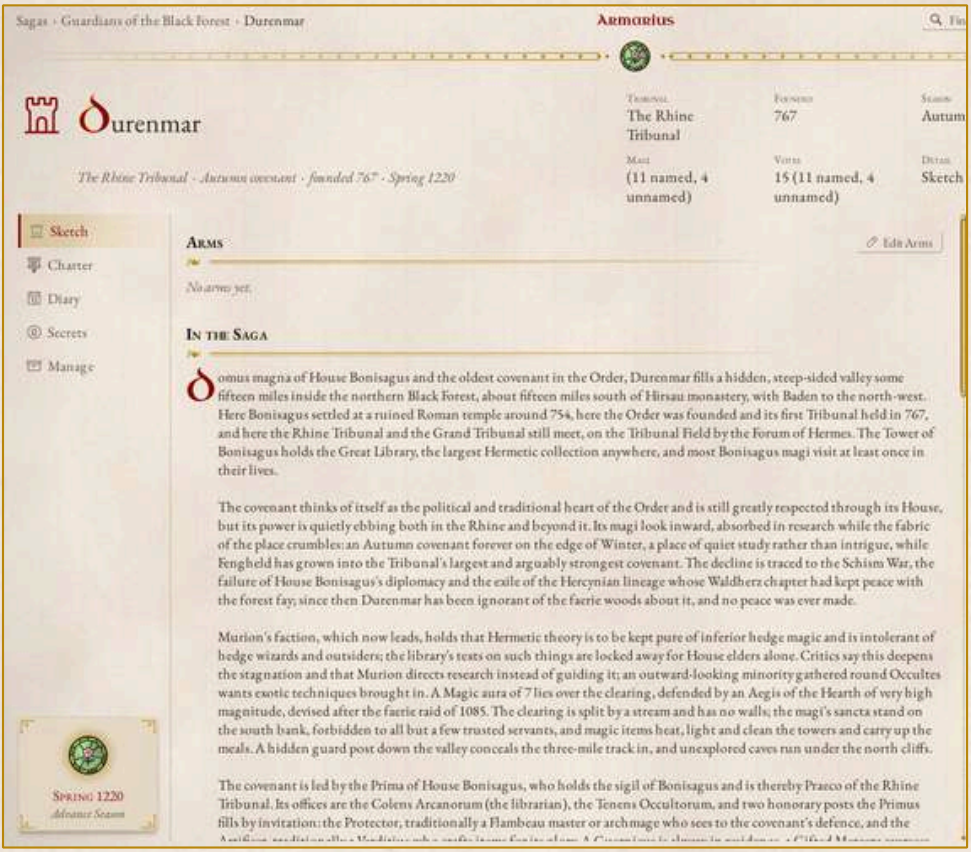


The Gilds chapter: each gild, its leader and members.

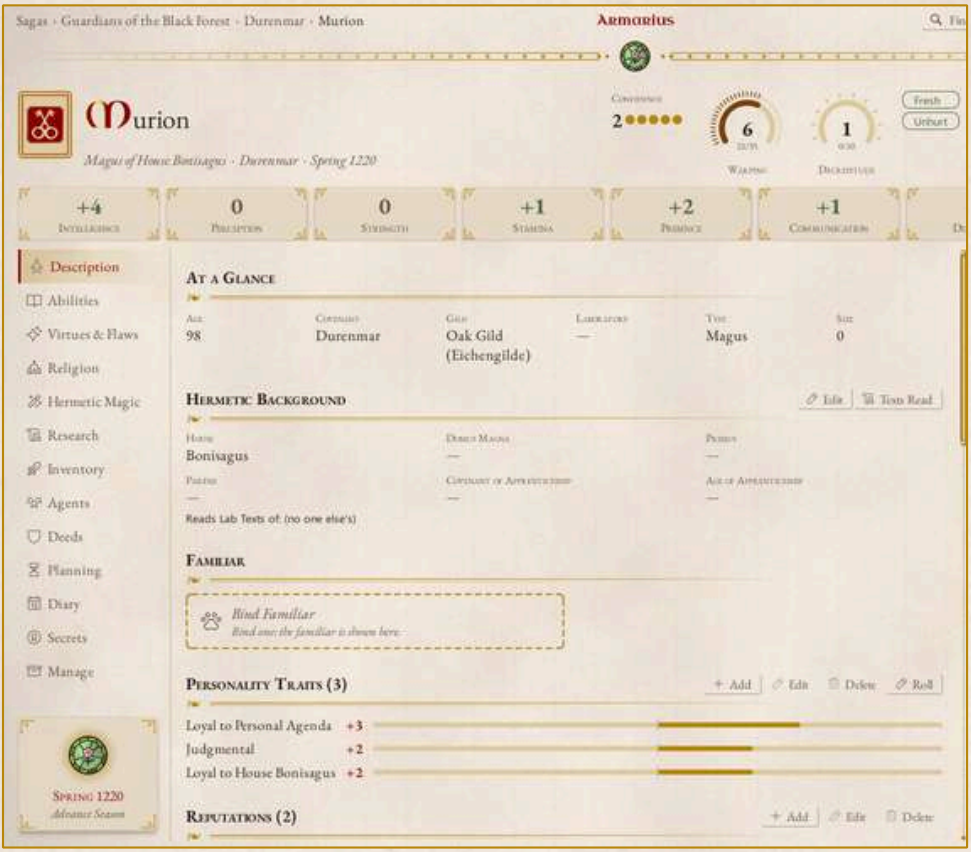
4. Covenants and magi

Each covenant comes as a sketch: a record with its summary, aura, founding and the magi the book names, but no full library or accounts, since your troupe doesn't play it. Its chapters are **Sketch**, **Charter**, **Diary**, **Secrets** and **Manage**.

Every magus the book names is a full character. Those with a printed stat block have the book's numbers; the rest are worked out from what the book says of them (House, age, favoured Arts, Virtues and Flaws) by the creation rules, and their Biography says so.



Durenmar as a sketch: Magic aura 7, founded 767, 11 named magi and 4 unnamed, and In the Saga, the book's account of the covenant.



Murion, Prima of Bonisagus and Praeco of the Rhine: a full character sheet, Oak Gild and all.

What the book tells the storyguide and not the players goes on each record's **Secrets** chapter, as a list of short titled secrets, so you can show the players a page without spoiling anything. When the players learn one, choose it and **Reveal** it: it moves into what they see, under **Known**. The eye in the top bar, beside Find, turns on **Player view**, which shows your own window as the players would see it.

Bringing Rabenstein in

The pack doesn't hold your own covenant. Make it with **New Covenant**, set its Tribunal to the Rhine, and Rabenstein's magi join the Tribunal's roll.

5. Adding a pack to a saga you already have

You don't have to start fresh. In an existing saga, on the saga's **Saga Management** chapter, choose **Import**, **A Content Pack**, and pick the pack's file from the app's *data/packs* folder. The form lets you untick parts you don't want (the mundane world, the history, the Bestiary, generated stats for the magi the book gives none), and previews before it imports. Anything the saga already has by the same name is kept as it is, so nothing is doubled.

6. The other Tribunal books

The same works for each book the app has a pack for. Each comes as of 1220, with its Tribunal (if it has one), covenants, magi, places, lords and stories:

- *Guardians of the Forests*: the Rhine Tribunal, 10 covenants, 87 characters.
- *The Lion and the Lily*: the Normandy Tribunal, 15 covenants, 57 characters, with its vis tenures and the Hermetic Tourney.
- *Faith & Flame*: the Provençal Tribunal, 11 covenants, 61 characters, with the Albigensian Crusade.
- *The Sundered Eagle*: the Theban Tribunal, 13 covenants in their four phylai, 58 characters.
- *Against the Dark*: the Transylvanian Tribunal, its oppida as covenants, 47 characters.
- *The Contested Isle*: the Hibernian Tribunal, 11 covenants, 51 characters, each covenant with its cathach.
- *Blood and Sand*: the Levant Tribunal, 12 covenants, 49 characters.
- *Sanctuary of Ice*: the Greater Alps Tribunal, 6 covenants, 52 characters, a Fourth Edition book converted by the *Definitive Edition*'s guide.
- *Heirs to Merlin*: the Stonehenge Tribunal, 9 covenants, 58 characters.
- *The Dragon and the Bear*: the Novgorod Tribunal, 4 covenants, 31 characters, also converted from the Fourth Edition.
- *The Cradle and the Crescent*: a region with no Tribunal, the Order of Suleiman's thirteen houses of wisdom as covenants, 282 places and neighbours.

Beside them come packs with no Tribunal of their own: *Land of Fire and Ice*, *Lands of the Nile* and *Between Sand and Sea* for their regions, *Antagonists* and *Legends of Hermes* for any saga, and the Dammërstein saga starter, a ready-made covenant that brings the Rhine pack in first.

Each Tribunal's own customs come with it: the Rhine's gilds, Normandy's Tourney and tenures, and so on. Where a book leaves a value out (an aura without a number, a founding year) the pack fills it in, and the pack's page in Help lists what it inferred and where it follows the *Definitive Edition* over the book.

7. A threat and its stages

The world around the covenants doesn't stand still. A **threat** is a story the storyguide has waiting: a list of stages, each with what the players can notice, what happens if they ignore it, and what stops it. Stages can come at fixed dates or be moved on by hand. The Rhine pack brings the book's stories as threats, and the Wild Hunt has three dated stages.

The book · GotF pp. 81-82

On stormy winter nights a troop of faeries of storm and winter sweeps across Germany, led by the Wild Huntsman, an Unseelie lord, hunting the Holzfrauen so that spring can't come. In the nine days before Walpurgis Night they chase Frau Holle, who becomes the goddess Walpurga on the Brocken and drives them off. A mortal who rides with the Hunt is found at dawn and never recovers.

Open the Wild Hunt from The Region: it's the **Threat due**, and the leaf (❧) after its name opens it. Its chapters are **Stages**, **Roll Tables**, **Diary**, **Standing**, **Secrets** and **Manage**. The top of Stages gives its antagonist (the Wild Huntsman, an Unseelie lord of Might 50), how it moves (fixed dates) and its **Clock**, a filled square for each stage that has come.

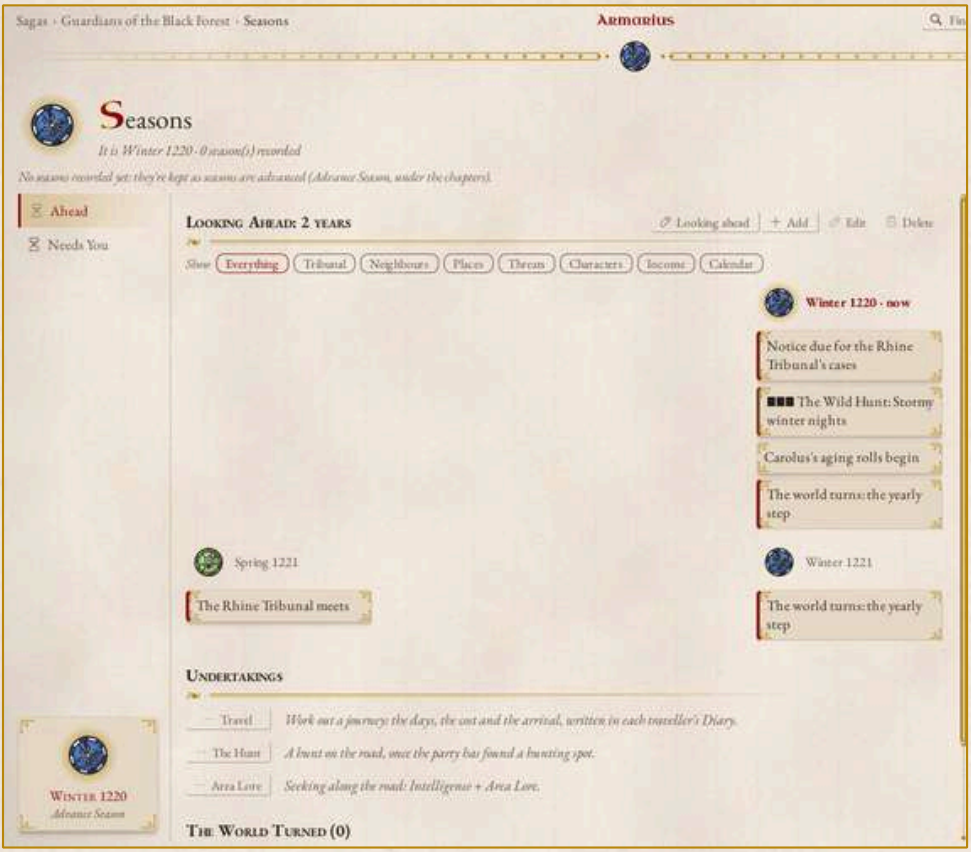
On **Stages**, **Edit** a stage to say what became of it: **Happened** if it came, **Stopped** or **Turned** if the troupe kept it from coming. Marking it so writes what the stage says follows (its *If ignored*, *If stopped* or *If turned*) in the threat's Diary and in each troupe covenant's, so the players' covenant sees what comes of it. Click a stage to read its clues and what stops it in the Inspector.



The Wild Hunt's Stages chapter in Winter 1220: the Clock at ■■■ 3 of 3, and Frau Holle's flight, Walpurgis Night and Stormy winter nights, each with its date, Reached, and what happens if it's ignored.

8. What's coming

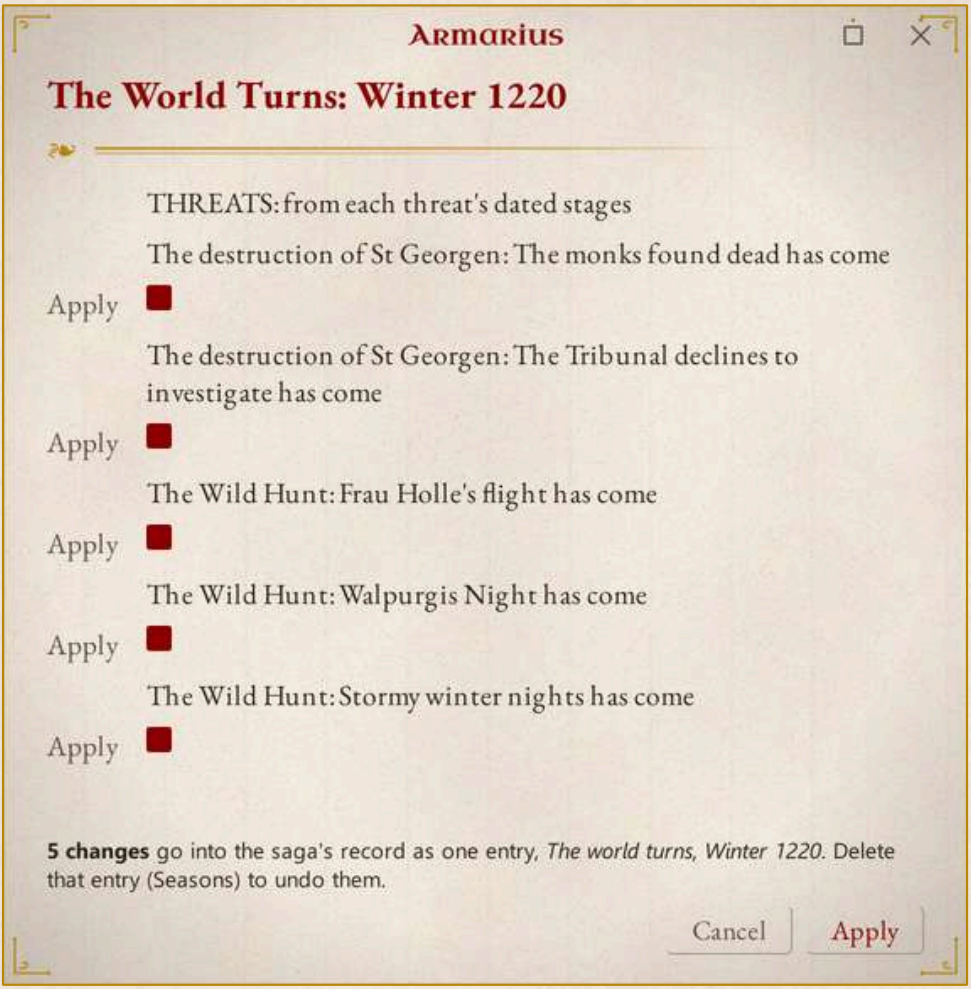
On the saga's **Seasons** page (open it from the saga's Seasons chapter), the **Ahead** chapter lays the next two years out as a calendar, a column of cards for each season: Tribunal meetings, threats' dated stages, aging, income, and every Winter the yearly step itself. The chips under the title (Everything, Tribunal, Neighbours, Places, Threats, Characters, Income, Calendar) show one kind at a time. Its other chapter, **Needs You**, gathers what's waiting on you: an overdue stage, an open story, a Flaw that hasn't had its spotlight.



The Ahead chapter in Winter 1220: Looking Ahead: 2 years, with the notice due for the Rhine Tribunal's cases, the Wild Hunt's Stormy winter nights, Carolus's aging rolls and the world's turn this Winter, and the Rhine Tribunal meeting in Spring 1221.

9. Winter 1220: the world turns

In Winter, click the **Advance Season** card at the foot of the chapters. The app asks to advance from Winter 1220 to Spring 1221 (a new year: each covenant's surplus is added to its Wealth), and then one more question: **The World Turns**, what the year brought beyond the covenants. Each line has an **Apply** tick, and only the ticked ones happen: threats' stages whose season has come, places' triggers, the year's fairs, loans to the Tribunal's treasury, and any attitudes you choose to move.



The World Turns: Winter 1220, under "Threats: from each threat's dated stages": "The destruction of St Georgen: The monks found dead has come", "The Tribunal declines to investigate has come", and the Wild Hunt's three stages (Frau Holle's flight, Walpurgis Night, Stormy winter nights), each ticked Apply; the foot reads "5 changes go into the saga's record as one entry, The world turns, Winter 1220. Delete that entry (Seasons) to undo them."

In the Rhine this year that's the destruction of St Georgen (its monks are found dead, and the Tribunal declines to investigate) and all three of the Wild Hunt's stages. Untick any your troupe headed off in play, and mark them Stopped or Turned on the threat's Stages instead. Here they all happen.

Under **Attitudes** the app lists the year's dealings with each neighbour: favours begun or repaid, and covenant Diary entries naming it. Where the favours make it plain, it suggests a change with its reason filled in, +1 for each favour the covenant did the neighbour or repaid it this year, at most +3; accept it as it stands or change it. A Diary entry alone suggests nothing, since the app can't tell how it went. In a new saga there are no favours yet, so this year the form holds only the threats.

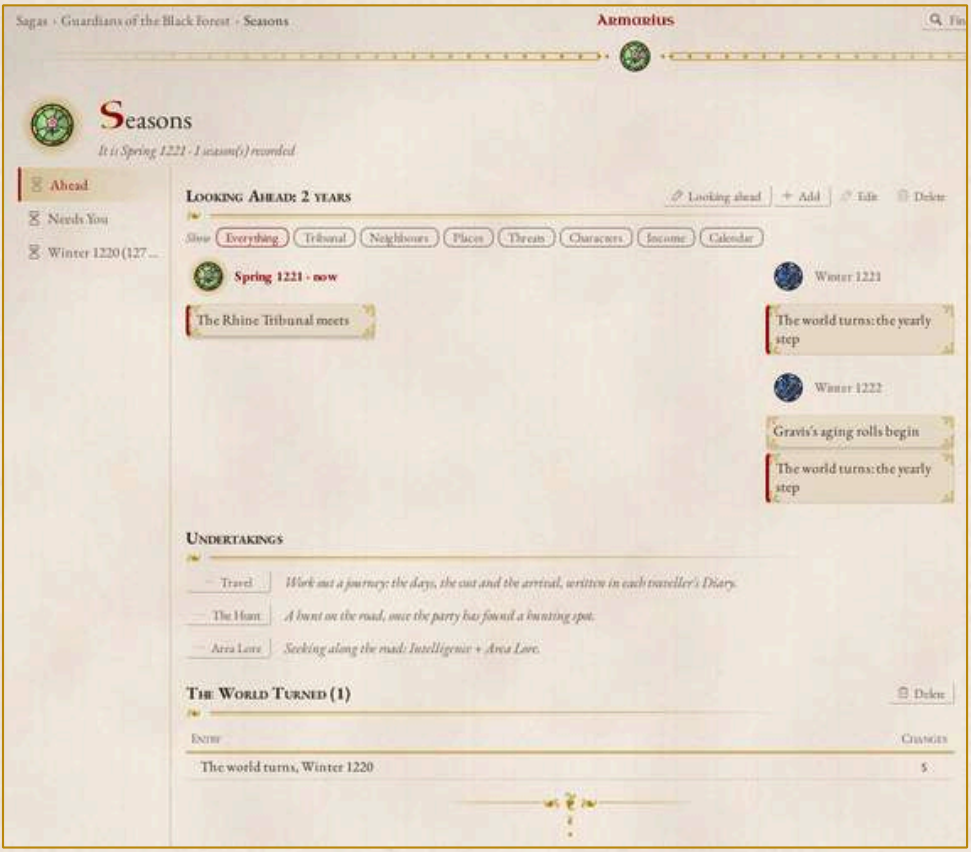
> **What happened.** Five changes go into one record, *The world turns, Winter 1220*. The Wild Hunt's stages all read Happened, its Clock is full at 3 of 3, and its next stage reads "none to come".



The Wild Hunt in Spring 1221: every stage Happened, the Clock at ■■■ 3 of 3, none to come.

10. Looking back, and undoing it

Each year's turn is kept under **The World Turned** on the Seasons page's Ahead chapter, with how many changes it made. Delete the entry and all of it is undone at once; anything you've changed by hand since is left alone, and the app says so. To take back the whole season and not just the world's turn, **Undo Last Season**, beside Set Date on the saga's Seasons chapter, puts the saga back as it was before you advanced.



Spring 1221: Looking Ahead: 2 years, with the Rhine Tribunal meeting this season, and The World Turned with Winter 1220's five changes.

> **What happened.** The world has moved on a year: the Hunt has passed, St Georgen's monks are dead, and the Tribunal of 1221 is next on the calendar.

What you do by hand

- **Your own covenant**: the pack doesn't hold it; make it with New Covenant in the Rhine.
- **Covenant sketches** have no library, vis or accounts: write one up fully when your troupe starts dealing with it.
- **Generated magi**: a pack magus without a printed stat block is worked out from the book's description, a reasonable guess rather than an official write-up.
- **What a threat does** when its stage comes is the storyguide's: the stage's own words go in the Diaries when you mark it on its Stages chapter, but the village the Hunt carried off is yours to write on the places and lords it touches. A stage the world turn marks happened writes nothing; read its *If ignored* on the Stages chapter.
- **Attitudes** move only when you save a change: the app suggests one from the year's favours, and anything else (a quarrel, a story's outcome) is your change with your reason.
- **Threats without dates** move on only when you set their stage by hand.

Where the content comes from

Guardians of the Forests: the Forum, the Mercere Portals and voting by proxy (p. 26); the Praeco (p. 27); the gilds (pp. 27-28); Walpurga, Frau Holle and the Wild Hunt (pp. 81-82). Each pack's Help page lists where it filled gaps or followed the *Definitive Edition*.

The other packs come from *The Lion and the Lily*, *Faith & Flame*, *The Sundered Eagle*, *Against the Dark*, *The Contested Isle*, *Blood and Sand* with *Secrets in Sand*, *Sanctuary of Ice*, *Heirs to Merlin*, *The Dragon and the Bear*, and *The Cradle and the Crescent*.



Armarius

A saga manager for Ars Magica

The Four Realms

Auras, regiones and Might in the Black Forest and beyond: a basilisk, a faerie mountain, a demon in a tower, a holy oak, and the vampires of Transylvania.

Guide 15 of 17

Every place in Mythic Europe may belong to one of four realms, Magic, Faerie, the Divine or the Infernal, and every creature with Might belongs to one of them too. The realm of a place changes what magic can do there, and the realm of a creature changes what it wants of you.

This guide takes Rabenstein's magi out of the Swabian Alb into the rest of the Rhine: Durenmar's valley and its basilisk, the faerie mountain of the Feldberg, Bishop Hatto's tower on the Rhine, the Externsteine and the Donar Oak. It uses the Rhine saga from *The Saga and Its World*, whose places and creatures come from *Guardians of the Forests*, and ends with the vampires of the Transylvanian pack.

The rules are the *Ars Magica Definitive Edition* (DE): realms, auras, Might and regiones (pp. 410-421), with *Realms of Power: Magic* (RoP: M), *Faerie* (RoP: F), *The Infernal* (RoP: I) and *The Divine* (RoP: D), and *Against the Dark* for vampires (pp. 114-121).

1. Auras and the four realms

A place with a realm has an aura from 1 to 10, and it changes every supernatural thing done there, for good or ill, whichever realm the magic comes from.

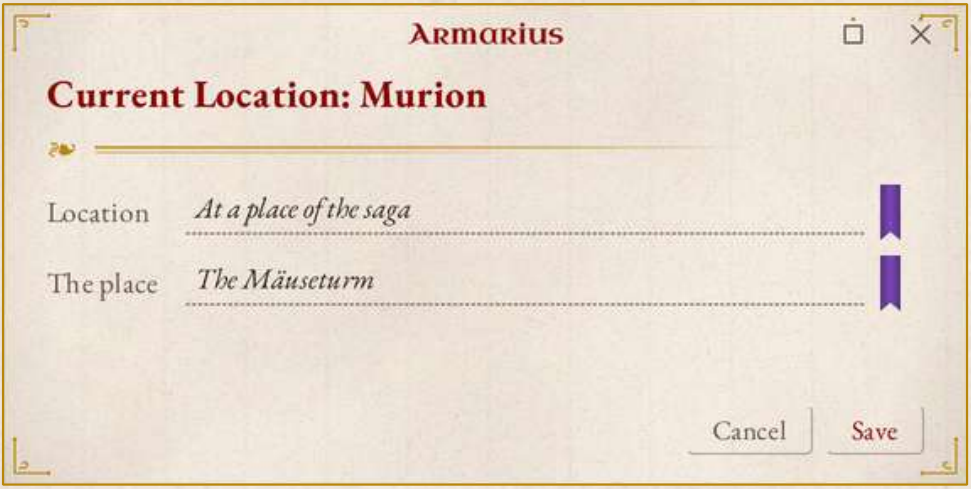
The rule · DE pp. 410-412

An aura modifies Casting Scores, Lab Totals, supernatural Abilities, Magic Resistance, and a creature's Penetration. By the Realm Interaction Table, Magic powers take + the aura in a Magic aura, + half the aura in a Faerie one, - the aura in an Infernal one and - 3 x the aura in a Divine one. Faerie powers take + the aura in Faerie, + half in Magic, - 2 x in Infernal and - 4 x in Divine; Infernal powers + the aura in Infernal, - the aura in Magic or Faerie and - 5 x in Divine. Divine powers aren't hampered by any aura. Every point of a foreign realm's aura is an extra botch die.

Rabenstein's own Magic aura of 3 is the medallion in its header, and every Casting Score and Lab Total of its magi already counts it. Out in the Rhine, each place on **The Region** shows its realm and aura beside its name: the valley of Durenmar Magic 7, the Feldberg Faerie 3, the Mäuseturm Infernal 3, the Externsteine Divine 4.

Work out what a trip costs before the magi go. Adelheid casting at the Mäuseturm loses 3 from every Casting Score and rolls 3 extra botch dice; at the Externsteine she loses 12, with 4 extra botch dice.

When a magus sets out, open his **Hermetic Magic** chapter and click **Current Location**, at its top under the line saying where he is. Choose **At a place of the saga** and the place (its aura and realm come with it), or **Somewhere else** and type its aura and realm. His Casting Scores, Penetration, and his tradition's and Mysteries' totals then count that aura by the Realm Interaction Table, and the Casting Scores say he's away. His seasons, lab work, aging and warping stay at home. Set him back **At home** when he returns. Saved, a notice says he's away and which aura his casting now counts, and the top of Hermetic Magic says the same: away, at the Mäuseturm, Infernal 3.



Current Location: Murion: Location "At a place of the saga", The place "The Mäuseturm".

In a Fight, **Edit Fight** sets the Magic aura where they fight, which adds to every Casting Total.



The Region chapter: the Rhine Tribunal's card, the Neighbours facts with the By kind and By place chips, and Lords and Towns as cards, with the Show filters by region and kind.

2. A regio: the Feldberg and the Hoellental

Some places hold regiones: layers of rising aura sharing one place, each a little further from the mundane world. Open **The Feldberg and the Hoellental** from The Region. Its **Regio** chapter shows its aura (Faerie 3), the tether that holds it (the great dark fir on the summit, the King Fir), and its **Regio Levels**: the Hoellental at Faerie 3, and above it the Black Mountain at Faerie 8.

> **The rule · DE p. 421**
>
> To see into a regio level, roll Perception + an appropriate Ability (Second Sight, Magic Sensitivity, or Sense Holiness and Unholiness for a Divine or Infernal level) + stress die, against 5 + 2 x the difference between your level's aura and the level you seek; from an aura of another realm, the two auras are added instead.

Choose the Black Mountain's row and its **See** reads 15, marked DE: 5 + 2 x (8 - 3); the Inspector shows the level in full. Write a level's own roll as "Per + Awareness against 9" when the book gives one (its **To enter**), and **Can enter** then shows which of your covenants' characters reach it with their scores alone.



The Feldberg's Regio chapter: Aura Faerie 3, Threshold "Surface: 30 points; Level 1: 21 points; Level 2: 6 points to cross into the Faerie Realm", Regio 2 levels, Tethers "The great dark fir on the summit, King Fir", Here the King Fir of the Black Forest; the Black Mountain's row chosen, See 15 DE, and the Inspector showing Level 2.

3. Might: Sordus the basilisk

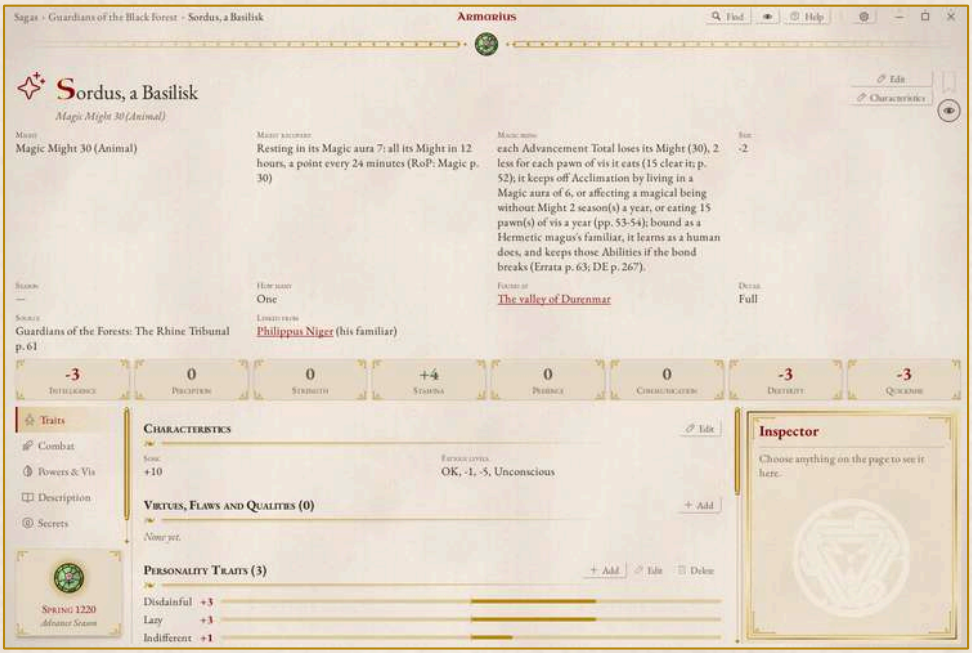
A creature with Might belongs to its realm. Open **Compendium** on the saga's page, where the Bestiary's creatures follow the Armarium and Custodia cards, and choose **Sordus, a Basilisk**, Philippus Niger's familiar, who lives in the valley of Durenmar.

> **The rule · DE p. 412**
>
> A creature's Magic Resistance is its Might Score + the aura modifier; its Penetration with a power is its Might Score - 5 x the Might Points the power costs + its Penetration + the aura modifier. Resistance from Might works like Hermetic resistance, against the powers of every realm.

Sordus has Magic Might 30 (Animal). In Durenmar's Magic aura of 7, he resists at 37.

> **The rule · RoP: M pp. 30, 52-54**
>
> A magic creature resting in a Magic aura regains its whole Might Pool in a time set by the aura less a fifth of its Might: 24 hours at 0, 12 hours at 1, down to 2 minutes at 9. A magic being's Might comes off every Advancement Total, 2 less for each pawn of vis it eats; and to keep off Acclimation each year it must live in a Magic aura of at least a fifth of its Might, or affect magical beings without Might, or eat vis.

What happened. The basilisk's facts work it all out: "Resting in its Magic aura 7: all its Might in 12 hours, a point every 24 minutes", and under **Magic being**, that each Advancement Total loses its Might (30), 2 less for each pawn of vis he eats (15 clear it), and that he keeps off Acclimation by living in a Magic aura of 6, by affecting a magical being without Might 2 seasons a year, or by eating 15 pawns of vis a year. As Philippus's familiar, it adds, he learns as a human does.

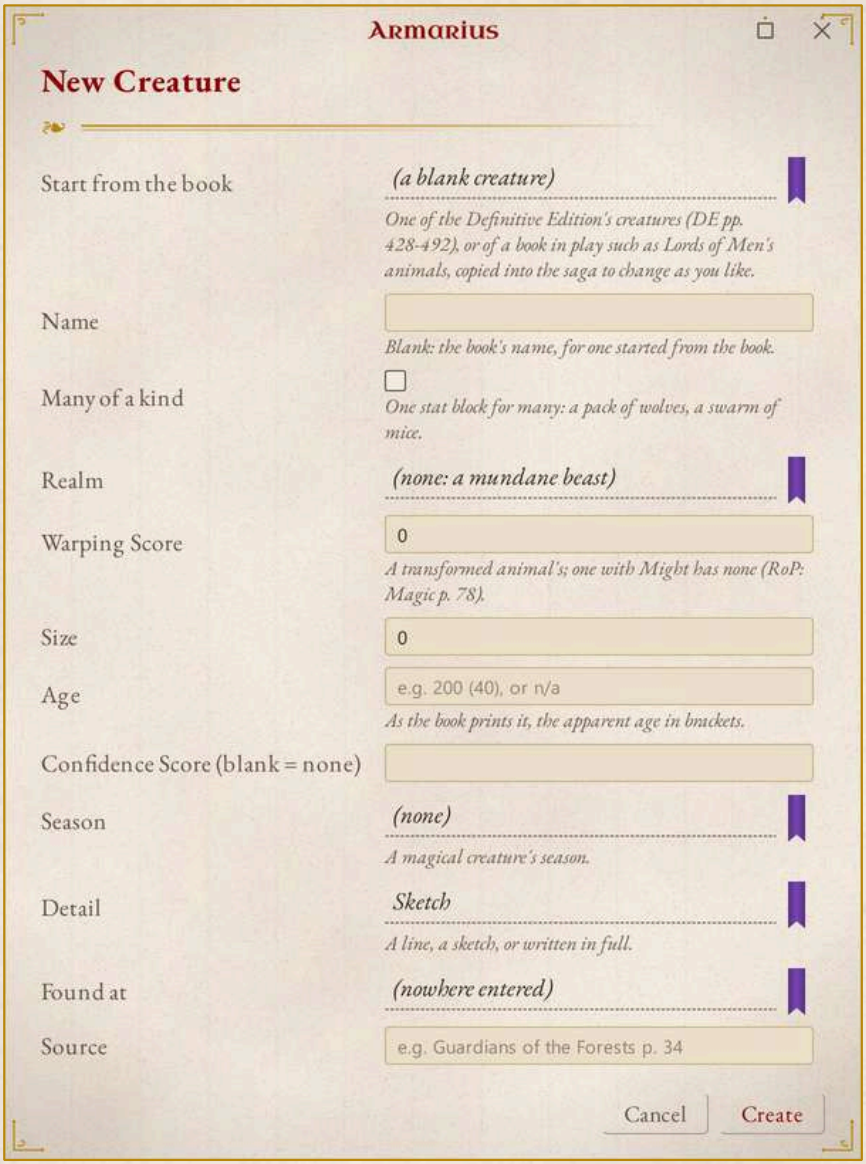


Sordus, a Basilisk: Magic Might 30 (Animal), Might recovery "Resting in its Magic aura 7: all its Might in 12 hours, a point every 24 minutes (RoP: Magic p. 30)", Magic being, Size -2, Found at The valley of Durenmar, Source Guardians of the Forests: The Rhine Tribunal p. 61, Linked from Philippus Niger (his familiar).

4. Building a creature

To add your own, click the **New Creature** card at the end of the Bestiary, on Compendium. **Start from the book** offers the Definitive Edition's own creatures, and those of a book in play such as *Lords of Men*'s animals; otherwise give its name, its **Realm** (choosing one brings up its **Might Score** and the realm's own fields), the **Might Form**, its Size and its season, then fill in its Characteristics, Virtues and Qualities, Abilities, attacks and powers on its chapters (**Traits**, **Combat**, **Powers & Vis**, **Description**).

The sheet checks a creature against its realm's book as you build it, always as advice: a magic creature's Qualities against its Might (RoP: M pp. 30-36); a faerie's build (RoP: F pp. 45-64); a demon's Order (RoP: I pp. 28-44); an angel's Choir (RoP: D pp. 18-26). The books' own creatures needn't balance, and nothing is refused.



New Creature: Start from the book "(a blank creature)", Name, Many of a kind, Realm "(none: a mundane beast)", Warping Score, Size, Age, Confidence Score, Season, Detail, Found at and Source.

5. Faerie: the Holzfrau and the Threshold

The Feldberg is faerie ground, and the Black Forest's wood-wives, the **Holzfrauen**, are faeries of Might 20, hunted every winter by the Wild Hunt (*The Saga and Its World*).

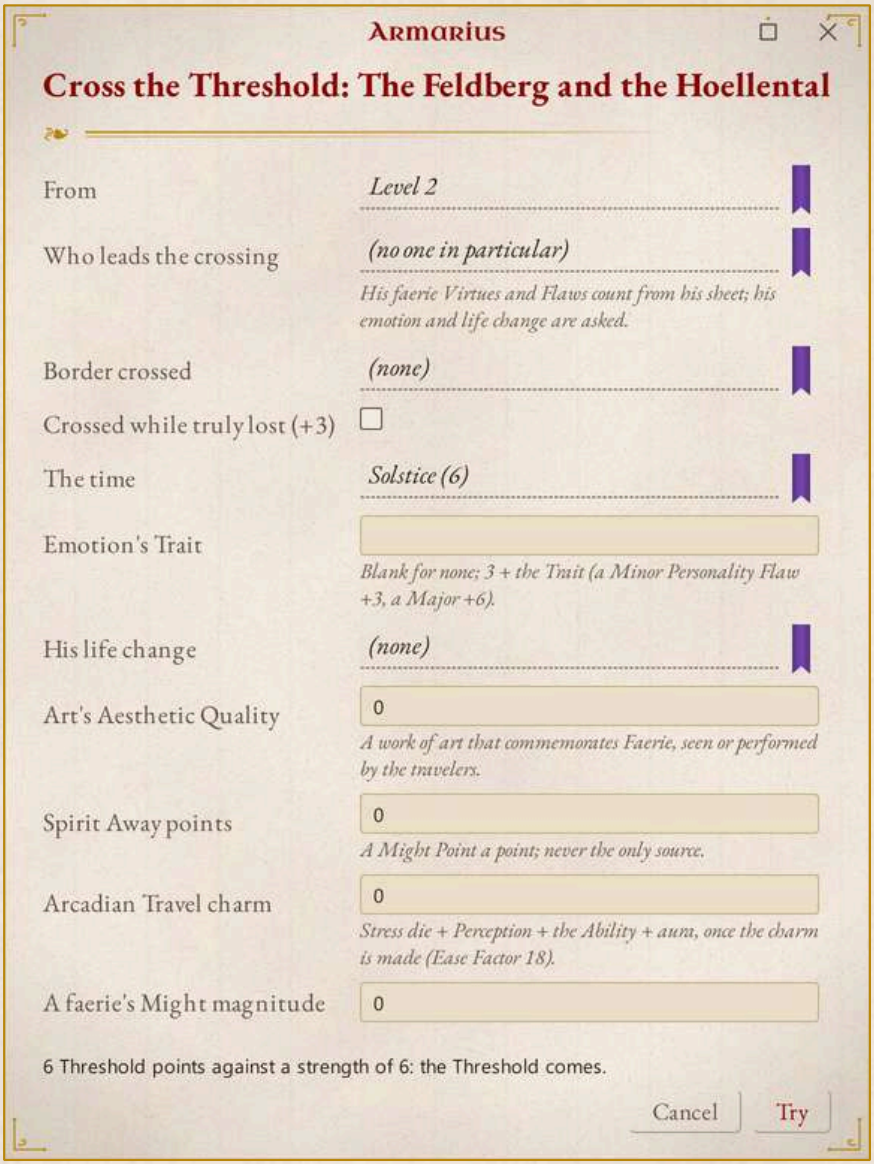
The rule · RoP: F pp. 21-24

Crossing into the Faerie Realm from a Faerie aura takes Threshold points: (13 - the aura's modifier on a Faerie power) x 3, a faerie regio level adding the surface's Faerie aura to its own. Points come from the border crossed, the time (new moon 1, full moon or a pagan holiday 3, solstice 6, equinox 9), the traveller (faerie Virtues, an extreme emotion, a life change), and a work of art about Faerie.

What happened. The Feldberg's **Threshold** fact reads "Surface: 30 points; Level 1: 21 points; Level 2: 6 points to cross into the Faerie Realm".

To try a crossing, click **Cross the Threshold**, beside the Regio heading on the Feldberg's page. Choose the level they start **From**, **Who leads the crossing** (his faerie Virtues and Flaws count from his sheet), the **Border crossed**, **The time**, his emotion and life change, a work of art, Spirit Away, an Arcadian Travel charm and a faerie's Might. The panel sets the points against the Threshold's strength as you go.

From Level 2, the Black Mountain, on a solstice night: "6 Threshold points against a strength of 6: the Threshold comes." **Try** writes the attempt in the place's Diary: "The Guardian of the Threshold stands before them, its Faerie Might at least 6; Intelligence + Faerie Lore against 6 gives hints of the way (RoP: Faerie p. 24)." Had it failed, the same circumstances couldn't open it again before the next moonrise (p. 21).



Cross the Threshold: The Feldberg and the Hoellental, From Level 2, Who leads the crossing "(no one in particular)", The time Solstice (6); the line at the foot reads "6 Threshold points against a strength of 6: the Threshold comes."

The rule · RoP: F pp. 40, 140-142

A faerie plays a part in the stories it takes part in, and wants a story to play it in: the Hero, the Villain, the Donor, the Helper, the Princess, the Task-Setter or the False Hero.

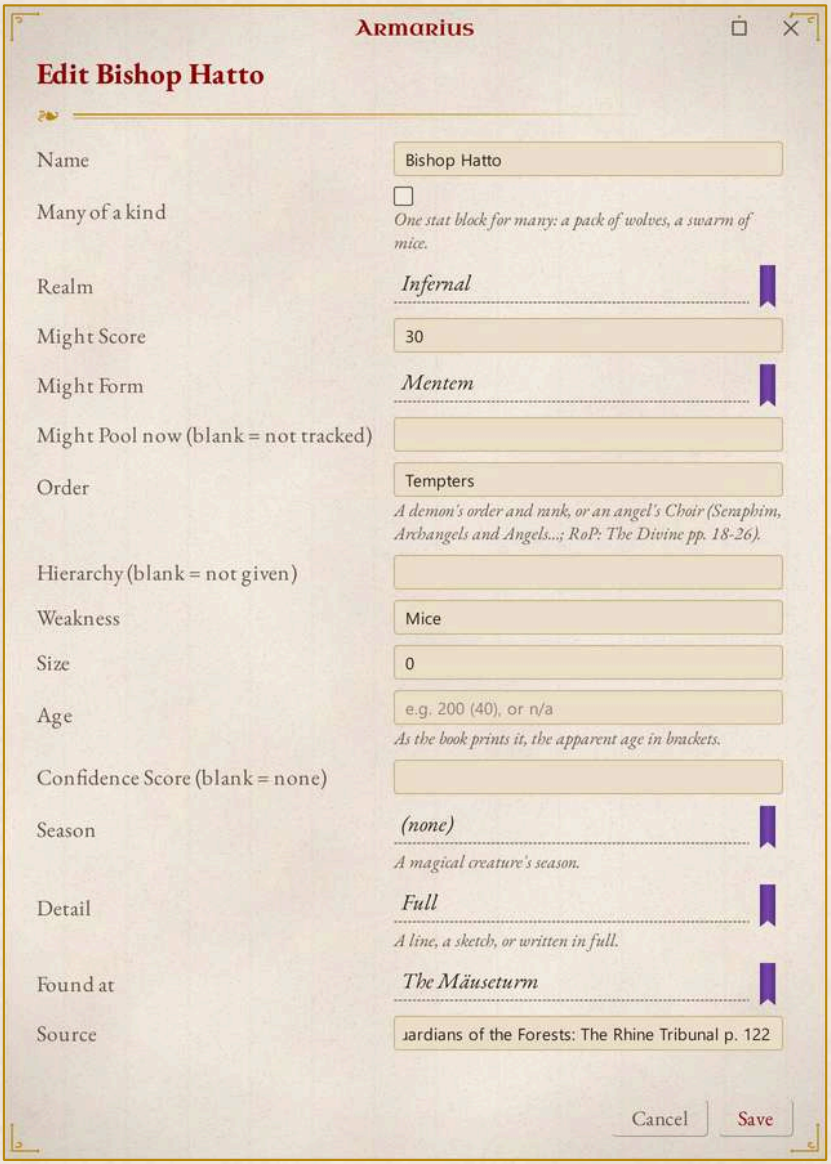
A Faerie creature's Edit form asks its **Role in its stories** and **The story it wants**, in a line. Give Old Wendel's talking hare its role (a Helper) when you add it, and the sheet keeps it in front of you.

6. The Infernal: Bishop Hatto's tower

On an island in the Rhine stands the **Mäuseturm**, the Mouse Tower, Infernal 3. Its master is **Bishop Hatto**, Infernal Might 30 (Mentem).

Every Hermetic casting there loses 3 and rolls 3 extra botch dice, and his Infernal powers take +3.

A demon's Edit form asks its **Order** (a demon's order and rank, or an angel's Choir; we typed "Tempters"), its **Hierarchy** and its **Weakness** ("Mice"). With them filled in, the sheet checks it against *Realms of Power: The Infernal*: the most Might its order and rank allow, its sin's Personality Trait, the powers every demon has, and its weakness.



Edit Bishop Hatto: Realm Infernal, Might Score 30, Might Form Mentem, Order "Tempters", Hierarchy blank, Weakness "Mice", Found at The Mäuseturm.

The rule · RoP: I pp. 23-24

A tempter leads others into sin with a simple die + Presence + Leadership: 9 gives the new trait +1, 12 +2, up to 24 for +6; only the willing are touched. On a stress die, the same total tarnishes an Infernal aura, adding to the matching traits of everyone inside it.

A person in the saga can do the same: on a character's Deeds chapter, under The Infernal, **Infernal Influence** rolls it and writes it in the Diary.

7. The Divine: the Externsteine and the Donar Oak

The **Externsteine**, the great rocks of the Teutoburger Forest, hold a Divine aura of 4, and the **Donar Oak** has Divine Might 40.

The rule · DE pp. 410-412

Divine powers have no penalty and no extra botch dice in any other realm's aura, but every other realm's powers suffer heavily in a Divine one: - 3 x the aura for Magic, - 4 x for Faerie, - 5 x for the Infernal.

Nobody at Rabenstein casts lightly at the Externsteine: -12 to every Casting Score, and four extra botch dice.

8. Parma Magica and the other realms

The rule · DE pp. 411-412, 524

Magic Resistance, a magus's from Parma Magica and his Form or a creature's from its Might, takes the aura modifier like any other supernatural total: a magus in a Magic aura of 4 has +4, a demon there -4. It resists the powers of every realm. As a house rule a troupe may give every Christian, Jew and Muslim Magic Resistance of 5 x the local Dominion aura (p. 524).

A magus's Magic Resistance is worked out on his sheet from Parma Magica, Form and the covenant's aura. Away from home, apply the aura where he is from the Realm Interaction Table yourself: Current Location moves his casting, not his Magic Resistance. To use the house rule, turn on the switch of **Dominion Magic Resistance**'s card on the saga's **Saga Settings** chapter, under Optional Rules, Realms and Auras: "Every Christian, Jew and Muslim has Magic Resistance of 5 x the local Dominion aura."

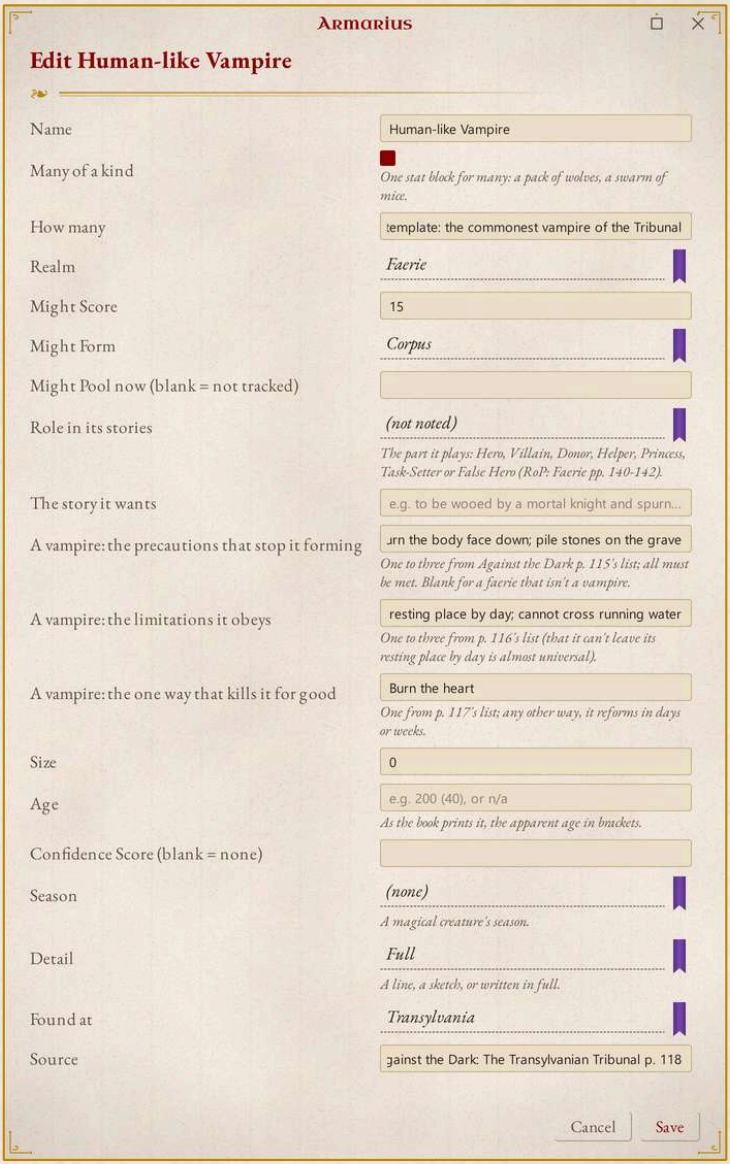
9. Vampires

The vampires of Transylvania come with the *Against the Dark* pack; start a saga from it, or import it (*The Saga and Its World*). Open the **Human-like Vampire** from its Bestiary, on Compendium, the commonest of them, Faerie Might 15.

> **The rule · Against the Dark pp. 114-117**
>
> A vampire is a faerie that feeds on blood and on the fear its story breeds. Every vampire has a physical form, a level of cognizance and a social Virtue or Flaw, Feast of the Dead, a Traditional Ward of sunlight, and the Lesser Power Sap the Life. Each is unique: choose one to three precautions that alone stop it forming, one to three limitations it must obey (running water, garlic, a line of thorns, red thread, the Cross and prayers…), and one way to kill it for good; slain any other way, it re-forms in days or weeks.

The pack's vampires are templates, so make this one your own. Click **Edit**: a faerie's form asks three more things of a vampire, typed from the book's lists. Ours, the dead miller of a Saxon village:

- **The precautions that stop it forming**: "Turn the body face down; pile stones on the grave".
- **The limitations it obeys**: "Cannot leave its resting place by day; cannot cross running water".
- **The one way that kills it for good**: "Burn the heart".



Edit Human-like Vampire: Faerie Might 15 (Corpus), Role in its stories "(not noted)" and The story it wants, and the three vampire fields filled in.

What happened. The sheet shows them beside its Role: **Stopped by (all of)**, **Limitations** and **Killed for good by**. Its **Vampire design** fact still reminds you that "None of p. 116's limitations is among its wards": it reads the creature's Traditional Wards, not this field, so add the ones that are wards as Traditional Wards too.



Human-like Vampire: Faerie Might 15 (Corpus), "a template: the commonest vampire of the Tribunal", Role not noted, Stopped by (all of), Limitations, Killed for good by, the Vampire design line, Found at Transylvania, Source Against the Dark: The Transylvanian Tribunal p. 118.

The rule · Against the Dark pp. 115-116

An old vampire, a kukudhi, moves far away and lives among people, no longer kept to its grave by day; its children are dhampirs. It is the only vampire suited to a player, best in a high-power saga among older magi.

What you do by hand

- **Magic Resistance away from home**: Current Location moves a magus's casting to the aura where he is; his Magic Resistance still counts his covenant's aura, so apply the place's from the Realm Interaction Table yourself.
- **The Faerie Realm beyond the Threshold** is a story; the app counts the crossing and stops at the Guardian.
- **A vampire's story**: its precautions, limitations and death are on its record; hunting it is a story.
- **Realm-specific play** (a faerie's vitality, a demon's temptations over a season, an angel's errand) is the storyguide's; the app keeps the creature and checks its build.

Where the rules come from

Ars Magica Definitive Edition: realm auras and the Realm Interaction Table (pp. 410-411); Magic Resistance, Penetration and Might (pp. 411-412); regiones and seeing into a level (p. 421); Dominion Magic Resistance as a house rule (p. 524).

Realms of Power: Magic: Might recovery (p. 30); Qualities (pp. 30-36); advancement and Acclimation (pp. 52-54). *Realms of Power: Faerie*: Thresholds (pp. 21-24); a faerie's role (pp. 40, 140-142); building faeries (pp. 45-64). *Realms of Power: The Infernal*: Infernal Influence and tarnish (pp. 23-24); demons' orders (pp. 28-44). *Realms of Power: The Divine*: the Choirs (pp. 18-26).

Against the Dark: vampires, precautions, the life cycle, limitations, powers and ways to kill them (pp. 114-117); the vampire bestiary (p. 118).

Guardians of the Forests: Sordus (p. 61); the Holzfrau (p. 36); Bishop Hatto (p. 122).



Armarius

A saga manager for Ars Magica

Rules of the House

A source of the saga's own, and the Virtues, Flaws, Boons, Abilities and spells your troupe writes for it.

Guide 16 of 17

Every troupe ends up with rules the books don't have. A Flaw someone wanted for their character, a Boon that grew out of a story, a faerie's knack the storyguide made up one evening. The app keeps them beside the books' own entries, so they turn up in the same pickers, and it lets you gather them under a **source** of the saga's own, a book that exists only in your saga, which you can put in or out of play like any other. House Rules, spells, goods and Mystery Cults can all cite one.

This guide follows Rabenstein in Summer 1223. Since her Twilight that Spring, the ravens of the crag won't leave Adelheid alone, and the troupe decides it deserves a Flaw. Before long there's a list: the Rabenstein House Rules. The storyguide also keeps a second list, notes on the faerie woods of the Swabian Alb, where Old Wendel's talking hare lives.

Where a rule is involved, the guide cites the *Definitive Edition* (DE) by page, and *Houses of Hermes: Societates* for designing a Supernatural Ability.

1. Why a source of your own

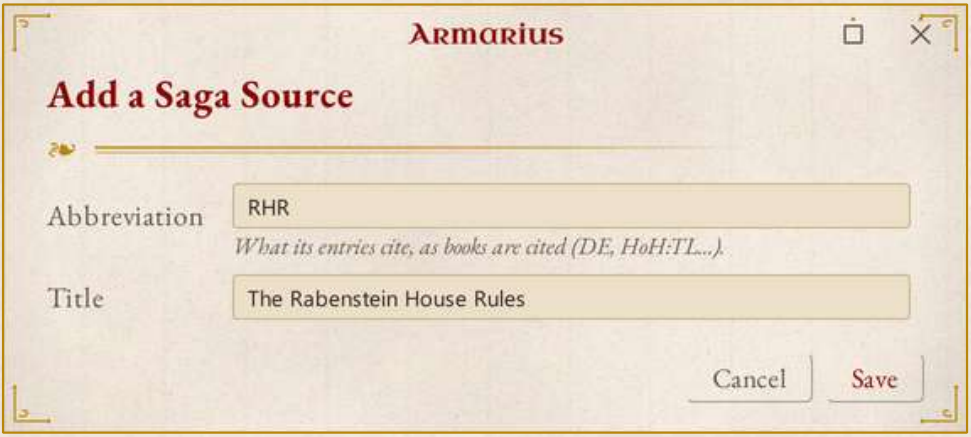
You don't need a source to write a house rule: an entry that cites none is simply always in play. A source earns its keep when you want to:

- **Say where an entry comes from**, as the books' entries do (DE, HoH:S...), so a player looking at a Virtue in a picker can tell it's one of yours.
- **Switch a set of entries off at once**, the way you'd take a supplement out of play. The storyguide's faerie notes can sit out of play until the troupe meets the woods' folk.

2. Adding a saga source

Open the saga's page, and on its **Saga Settings** chapter click **Saga Content**'s card, under **Content in Play**. Its first chapter, **Books**, shows every book the saga can use as a card, grouped by line, and below the cards the **Saga Sources** table. Click **Add** there.

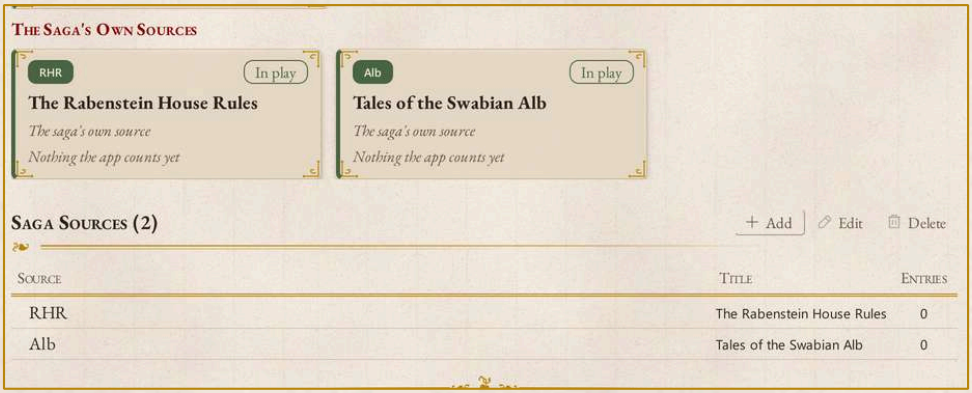
A source needs an **Abbreviation**, the short name its entries cite, and a **Title**. The abbreviation can't be one a book already uses (the app refuses "HoH:S", for instance) or one of the saga's other sources, and it can't contain a semicolon, which separates books in a citation.



Add a Saga Source: Abbreviation "RHR", Title "The Rabenstein House Rules".

Add a second one the same way for the storyguide's notes: "Alb", *Tales of the Swabian Alb*.

What happened. Both sources start in play. Each has a card of its own under **The Saga's Own Sources**, after the books, with an **In play** chip, and the count of books in play at the top of the page goes up by two. A new source's card reads "Nothing the app counts yet"; as entries come to cite it, the card lists what it brings (two Virtues and Flaws, a spell…) and the table's **Entries** column counts them.



The Books chapter: The Saga's Own Sources, with cards for The Rabenstein House Rules (RHR) and Tales of the Swabian Alb (Alb), each In play and "Nothing the app counts yet", and the Saga Sources table below them, 0 entries each.

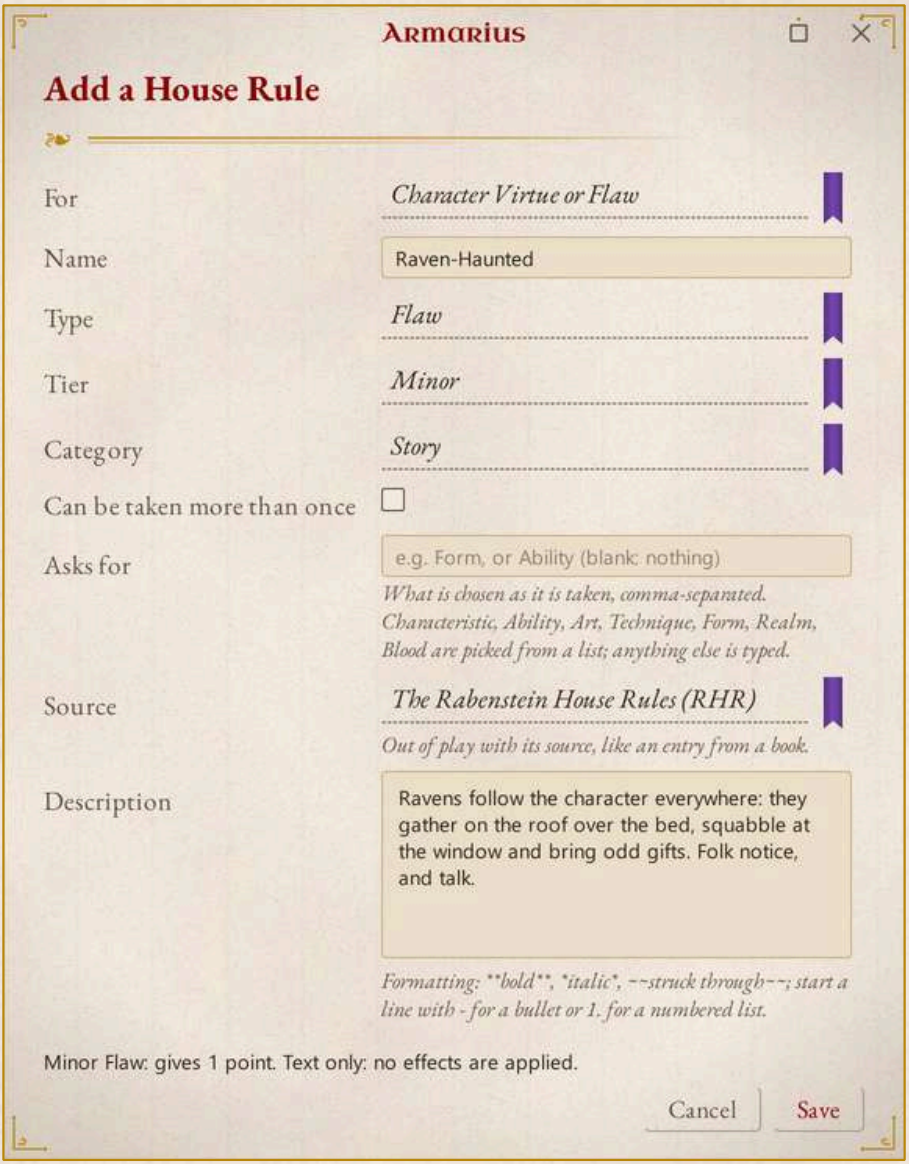
3. A Flaw: Raven-Haunted

House rules are written on Saga Content's **House Rules** chapter, not on the source: you make each entry, and its **Source** drop-down says which source it belongs to. That drop-down appears only once the saga has a source; left blank, the entry is always in play.

> **The book · DE p. 61**
>
> Virtues cost points and Flaws give them: three for a Major one, one for a Minor. General, Hermetic and Supernatural Flaws must hinder the character; Personality, Social Status and Story Flaws must lead to stories. A Flaw that does neither shouldn't be allowed.

Raven-Haunted leads to stories rather than hindering Adelheid, so it's a Story Flaw. Click **Add** and fill in:

- **For**: Character Virtue or Flaw. This is fixed once the entry is made.
- **Name**: Raven-Haunted.
- **Type**: Flaw; **Tier**: Minor; **Category**: Story.
- **Source**: The Rabenstein House Rules (RHR).
- **Description**: what it does, in the troupe's words.



Add a House Rule: Raven-Haunted, a Minor Story Flaw from The Rabenstein House Rules; the foot reads "Minor Flaw: gives 1 point. Text only: no effects are applied."

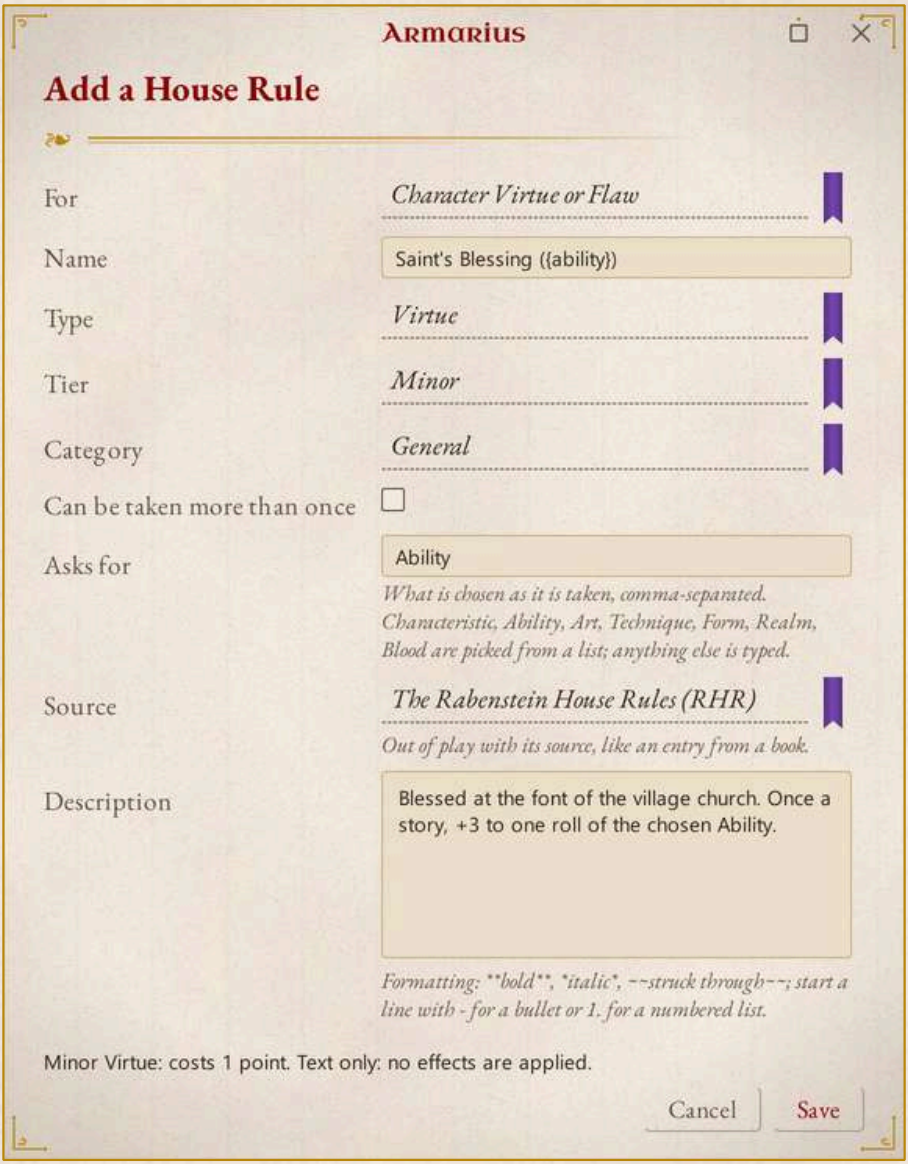
The line at the foot works out the points as you change the type and tier.

4. A Virtue that asks for a choice

Some Virtues ask for something when they're taken, as Puissant asks for an Ability. Father Benno has been blessing the covenfolk at the village font, and the troupe writes the blessing up as a Minor General Virtue that helps one Ability.

Make it as before, with **Name** "Saint's Blessing ({ability})" and **Asks for** "Ability". Whatever is chosen when a character takes it goes where the braces are, so a player who picks Bows has "Saint's Blessing (Bows)" on the sheet. Without braces, the choice follows the name in brackets.

Characteristic, Ability, Art, Technique, Form, Realm and Blood are picked from a list when the Virtue is taken; anything else you put in Asks for is typed. Several choices are separated by commas.



Add a House Rule: Saint's Blessing ({ability}), a Minor General Virtue that asks for an Ability, from The Rabenstein House Rules.

The book · DE p. 45

Companions and magi may take up to ten points of Flaws, and the same number of points of Virtues. Grogs take at most three, Minor ones only, and no Story Flaws.

A house rule counts against those limits like any book's Virtue or Flaw.

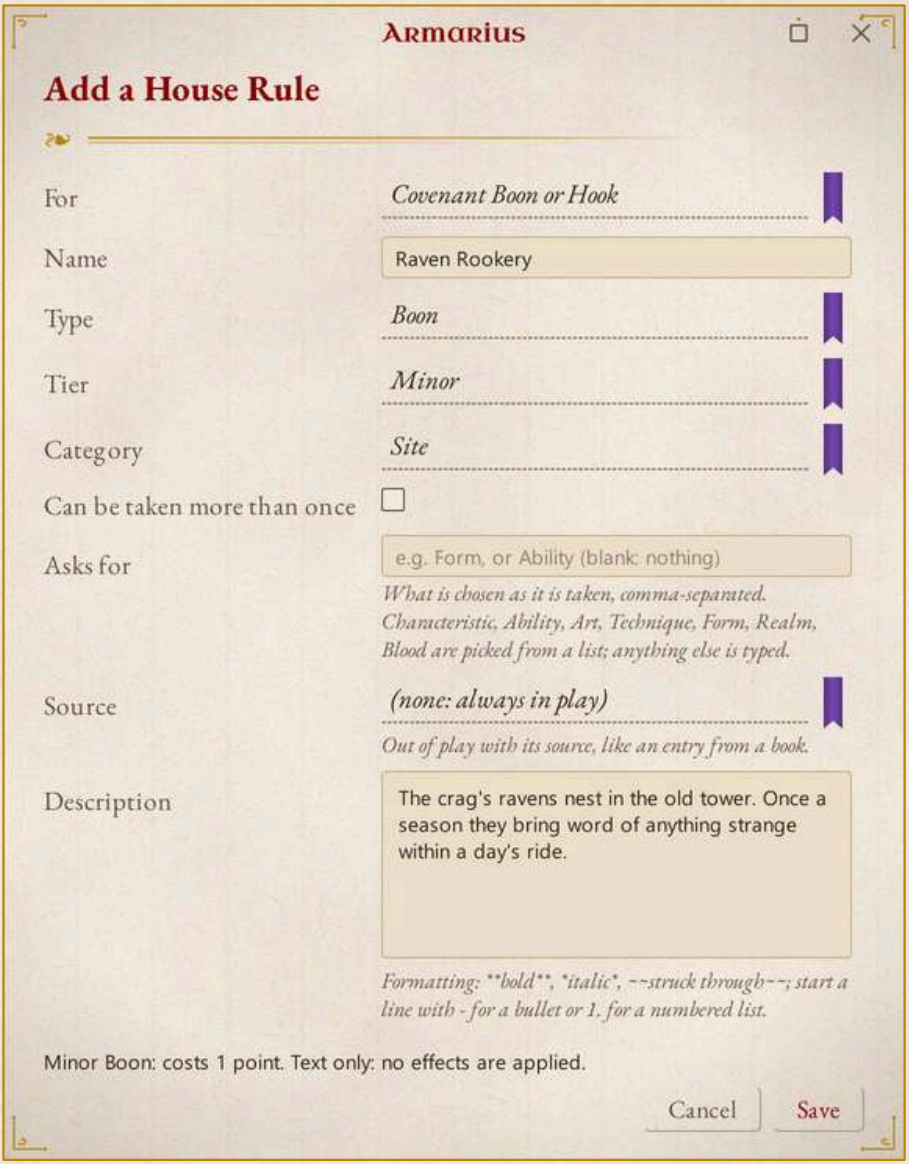
5. A Boon, and a laboratory's Flaw

The same form makes a covenant's Boons and Hooks and a laboratory's Virtues and Flaws: choose them under **For**, and the Type and Category lists change to match.

The book · DE p. 183

A Minor Boon costs one point and a Major one three, and they are paid for with Hooks, not Build Points.

The ravens nest in Rabenstein's old tower and bring word of strange doings, so the troupe gives the covenant a Minor Site Boon, **Raven Rookery**.
And the wind that comes through the Ember Cell's shutters becomes a Minor laboratory Flaw, **Draughty Crag**. Nobody is sure yet whether these two belong with the house rules, so leave their Source blank for now; section 7 moves them.



Add a House Rule: Raven Rookery, a Minor Covenant Boon (Site), its Source left blank.

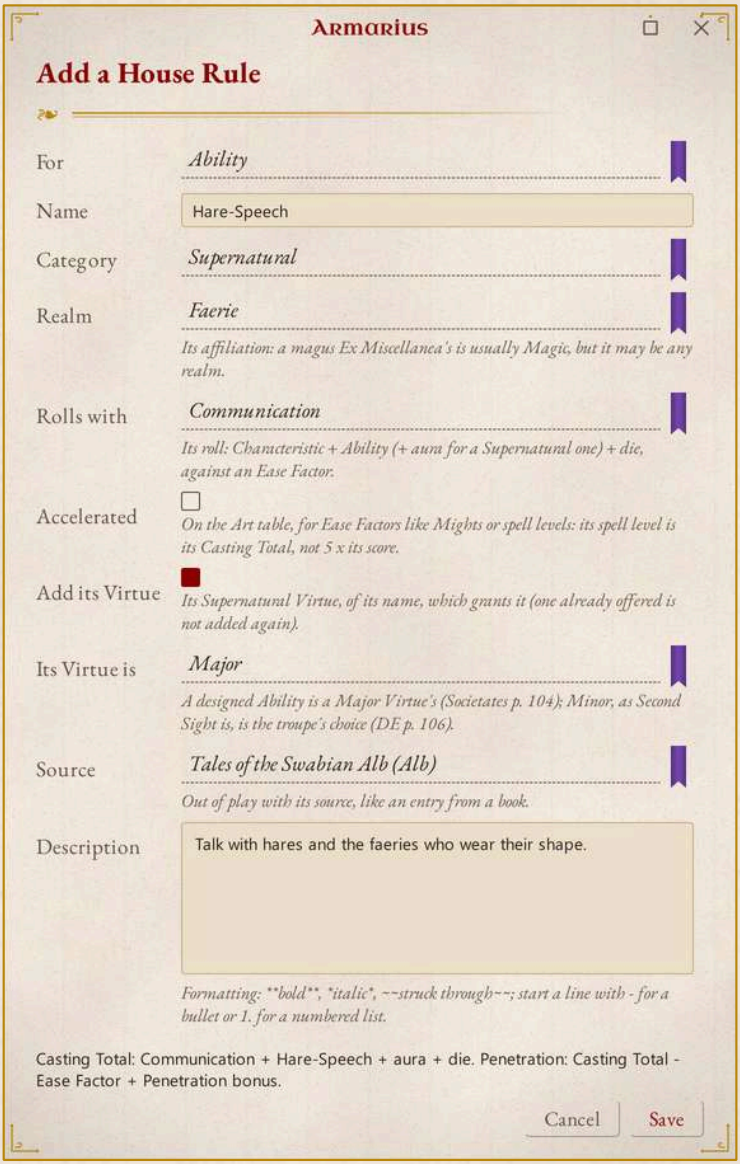
6. A Supernatural Ability: Hare-Speech

Old Wendel talks with his hare, and with the faeries who sometimes wear its shape. The storyguide writes that up as an Ability of the saga's own, in *Tales of the Swabian Alb*.

> **The book · HoH:S p. 104**
>
> A designed Supernatural Ability is a Major Supernatural Virtue. Its effects are described like a spell's: Range, Duration, Target and a base guideline. Three are fixed and the fourth grows with the Ability's score, or with the Ease Factor reached when it affects other beings. Its Casting Total is Characteristic + Ability + aura + die.

Choose **Ability** under For. The form asks different questions:

- **Category**: Supernatural.
- **Realm**: Faerie. A magus Ex Miscellanea's is usually Magic, but it can be any realm.
- **Rolls with**: Communication. Left blank, the storyguide chooses each time.
- **Accelerated**: unticked. An Accelerated Ability uses the Art table, for Ease Factors like a creature's Might (HoH:S p. 104; *Errata* p. 60 adds that it isn't limited at creation).
- **Add its Virtue**: ticked, **Major**. This makes the Supernatural Virtue that grants the Ability, under the same name and source.
- **Source**: Tales of the Swabian Alb (Alb).



Add a House Rule: Hare-Speech, a Supernatural Ability of the Faerie realm rolled with Communication, Add its Virtue ticked, Its Virtue is Major, from Tales of the Swabian Alb; the foot reads "Casting Total: Communication + Hare-Speech + aura + die. Penetration: Casting Total - Ease Factor + Penetration bonus."

Write in its Description what the hare-folk will and won't tell, and which of its four parameters grows.

7. The House Rules chapter

Each entry is a card with its type, tier and points: edged green, with a green tier chip, when it costs points, and red when it gives them. Hare-Speech shows twice, the Ability and the Virtue that grants it. Click a card and the Inspector shows it in full: what it's for, its points, its source and who holds it.



The House Rules chapter: Raven-Haunted, Saint's Blessing ({ability}), Hare-Speech (its Virtue and its Ability), Draughty Crag and Raven Rookery as cards.



Raven-Haunted

Character Flaw · Minor

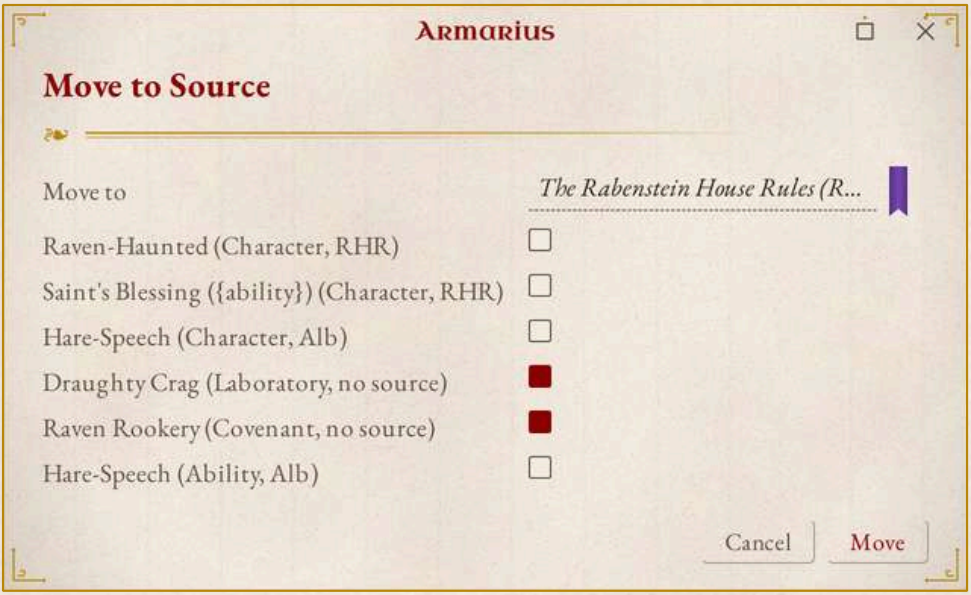
Raven-Haunted
For: Character Virtue or Flaw **Category:** Story
Points: Minor Flaw: gives 1 point
Source: The Rabenstein House Rules
Held by: (no one yet)

Ravens follow the character everywhere: they gather on the roof over the bed, squabble at the window and bring odd gifts. Folk notice, and talk.

The Inspector on Raven-Haunted: Character Flaw, Minor; For Character Virtue or Flaw, Category Story, Points "Minor Flaw: gives 1 point", Source The Rabenstein House Rules, Held by (no one yet), and its description.

Moving entries to a source

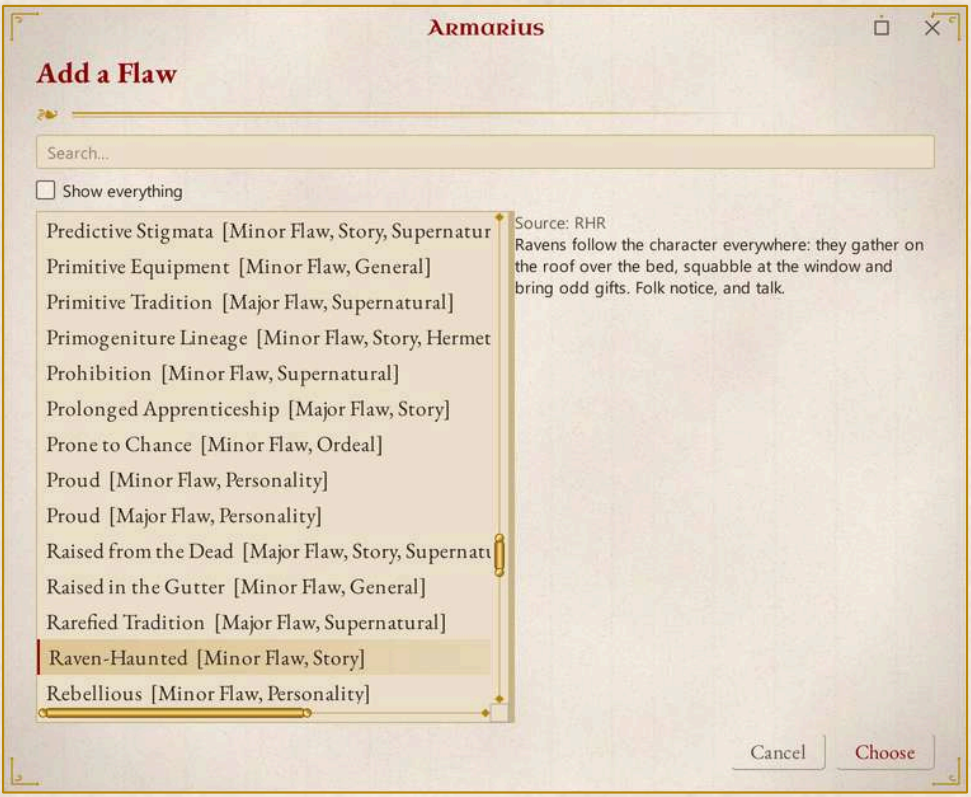
By the end of the season the troupe agrees that Raven Rookery and Draughty Crag are house rules like the rest. You could edit each one, but **Move to Source** over the cards moves several at once. Choose the source under **Move to**, tick the entries (each shows its source now) and click **Move**. Choosing no source instead puts the ticked entries back to always in play.



Move to Source: Move to The Rabenstein House Rules (RHR), with Draughty Crag and Raven Rookery, both "no source", ticked.

Taking them

House rules are offered wherever the books' entries are. On Adelheid's **Virtues & Flaws** chapter, **Add** under Flaws lists Raven-Haunted among the rest, alphabetically, and shows its source beside the description.



Add a Flaw: Raven-Haunted [Minor Flaw, Story] chosen, "Source: RHR" and its description beside the list.

Saint's Blessing asks for its Ability as it's taken, and Rabenstein's **Boons** offer Raven Rookery among the Site Boons.

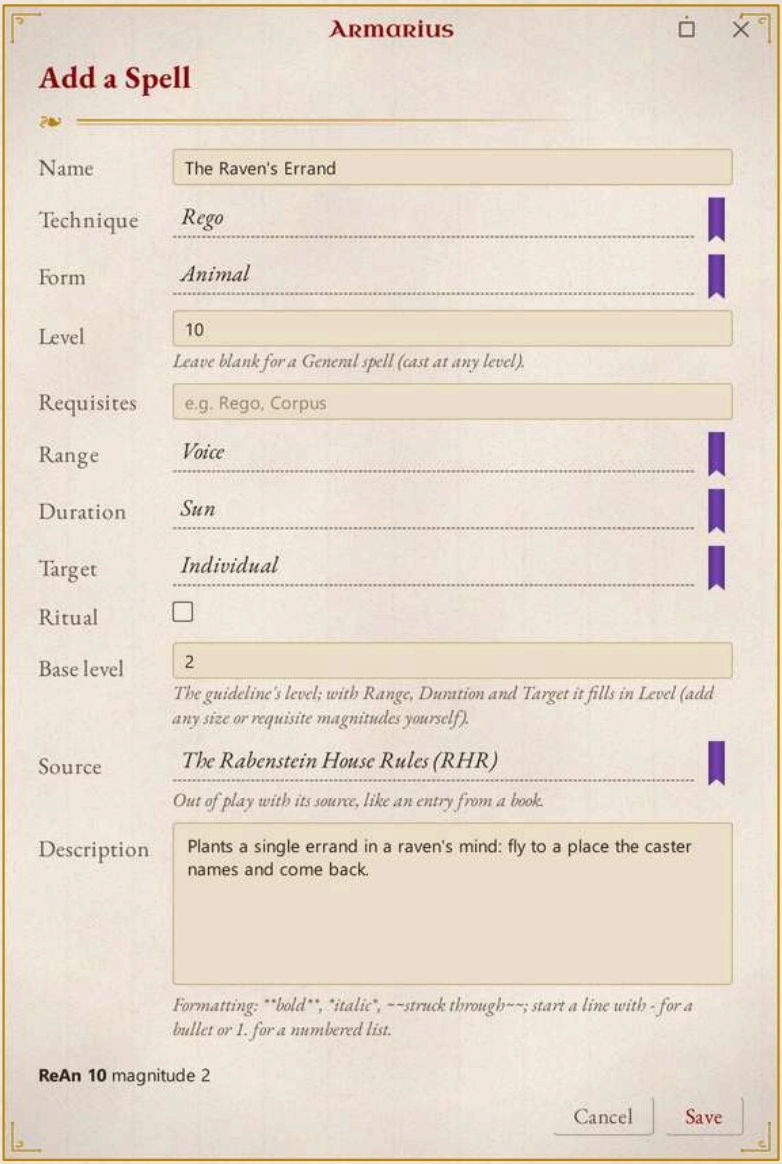
8. A spell of your own

Spells aren't made on the House Rules chapter but on Saga Content's **Spells** chapter, which lists every spell the saga knows. **Add** makes one of the saga's own. Leandro writes up the spell he uses to send the ravens on errands:

> **The book · DE p. 319**
>
> Rego Animal, level 2: plant a single suggestion in the mind of an animal.

Fill in **Name** "The Raven's Errand", Rego, Animal, Range **Voice**, Duration **Sun**, Target **Individual** and **Base level** 2. The app works the level out from the base and the Range, Duration and Target: ReAn 10 (Base 2, +2 Voice, +2 Sun).

Choose **Source** from the same drop-down as the House Rules: The Rabenstein House Rules (RHR).



Add a Spell: The Raven's Errand, Rego Animal, Voice, Sun, Individual, Base level 2, Source The Rabenstein House Rules (RHR); the foot reads "ReAn 10 magnitude 2".



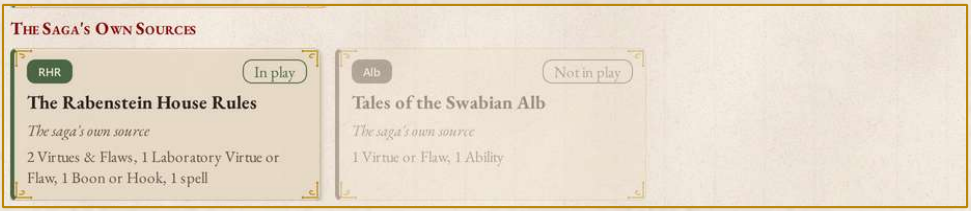
The Spells chapter searched for "Raven": 5 of 1318 spells, among them The Raven's Errand, ReAn 10, Voice/Sun/Ind, Source RHR.

The **Source** column shows each spell's source, the saga's own included, and the drop-down beside the search box narrows the list to one source.

The saga's own goods (on the **Goods** chapter) and Mystery Cults (on **Mystery Cults**) have the same Source drop-down, and go out of play with their source in the same way.

9. Putting a source out of play

When the troupe leaves the Alb behind, the storyguide's faerie notes can go out of play. A saga source goes in and out of play just as a supplement does: on the Books chapter, click the **In play** chip on *Tales of the Swabian Alb*'s card. It turns to **Not in play**, and the card fades.



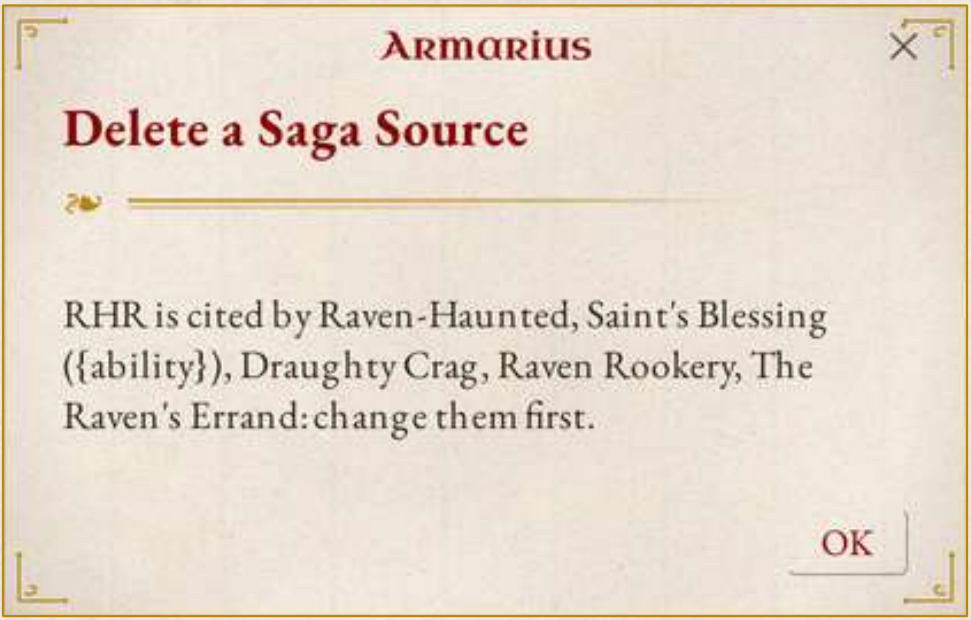
The Saga's Own Sources: The Rabenstein House Rules in play, bringing 2 Virtues & Flaws, 1 Laboratory Virtue or Flaw, 1 Boon or Hook and 1 spell, and Tales of the Swabian Alb faded, Not in play, bringing 1 Virtue or Flaw and 1 Ability.

> **What happened.** Hare-Speech and its Virtue drop out of the pickers, as a book's entries do; **Show everything** in the Add a Virtue picker still lists the Virtue, marked as not in play. A spell citing the source would leave the spell lists, a good would be marked "(not in play)", and a cult's Scripts would leave Initiation.
> A character who already has Hare-Speech keeps it. Click the chip again and they're back.

10. Renaming and deleting a source

Edit under Saga Sources changes a source's title or abbreviation. A new abbreviation is carried to everything that cites the source: its House Rules, spells, goods and Mystery Cults.

Delete removes a source, but not while anything still cites it: the app names those entries, so you can move them to another source, or to none, first. **Move to Source** does the House Rules in one go; a spell, good or cult is changed on its own form.



Delete a Saga Source: "RHR is cited by Raven-Haunted, Saint's Blessing ({ability}), Draughty Crag, Raven Rookery, The Raven's Errand: change them first."

What you do by hand

- **What a house rule does.** House rules are text only: the app counts their points and offers them in the pickers, but applies no effect of their own. Saint's Blessing's +3 is rolled by hand.
- **Library books aren't in a source.** Books in the library, creatures and Lab Texts are the saga's records, not entries a picker offers, so they don't cite a source and stay where they are whatever is in play.
- **Is it a fair Flaw?** Whether a Flaw hinders or leads to stories (DE p. 61) is the troupe's call.

Where the rules come from

Ars Magica Definitive Edition: Virtue and Flaw points for companions, magi and grogs (p. 45); Virtues, Flaws and what a Flaw must do (p. 61); Boons and their cost (p. 183); the Rego Animal guidelines (p. 319). *Houses of Hermes: Societates*: designing a Supernatural Ability, and Accelerated Abilities (p. 104). *Errata*: Accelerated Abilities at creation (p. 60).



Armarius

A saga manager for Ars Magica

On the Move

A covenant on two river cogs and another on wagons: making a covenant that travels, its route, its aura and Aegis, and sending a ship off on her own.

Guide 17 of 17

Most covenants stay put, and everything in the app assumes it unless you say otherwise. But some magi live aboard ship, and some follow the trade roads with their laboratories in a wagon. The books have Hooks for that and not much else, so the rules here are short, and most of what the app does is keep track of where everybody is and what that changes.

This guide founds two of them in Spring 1224. **Schwalbenflug** is two river cogs on the Danube, *The Swallow* and *The Swift*, working from Ulm to Vienna and back round the year with **Thekla of Jerbiton** and **Wolfram of Tytalus**. **Der Karrenzug** is a string of wagons on the roads south of Augsburg with **Bruno of Mercere** and **Rosamund of Bonisagus**, moving when it suits them and wintering in town. Rabenstein stays where it is, and waves them off.

The save for this guide is **17 On the Move**. It opens in Spring 1224 with the four magi still at Rabenstein, and nothing else made yet.

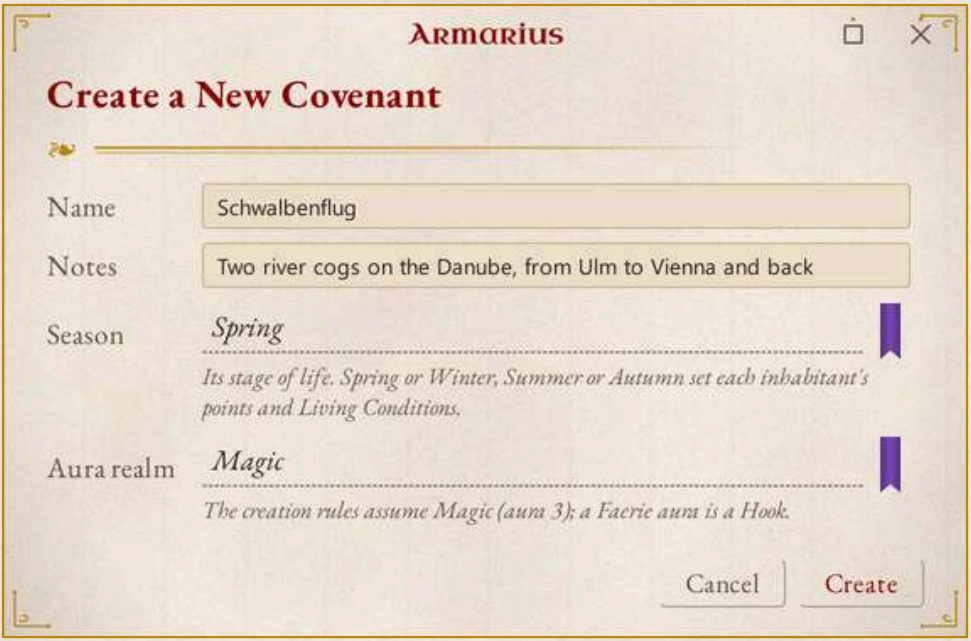
The rules are few: the Mobile Hooks and the Traveling Covenant from *Covenants* (pp. 9-10, 27), auras from the *Ars Magica Definitive Edition* (DE, p. 410), the Aegis from *Legends of Hermes* (p. 123), and *Through the Aegis* on ship covenants (pp. 11, 23, 25). The rest is how this app handles it, and the guide says where that's so.

The rule · Covenants pp. 9-10, 27

Constantly Mobile (Major Site Hook): the covenant moves all the time, and would lose its income if it stopped. Erratically Mobile (Minor): it moves often, but settles somewhere for a season between journeys. A Traveling Covenant has no stationary site and moves on a circuit to harvest its resources or keep its trade contacts.

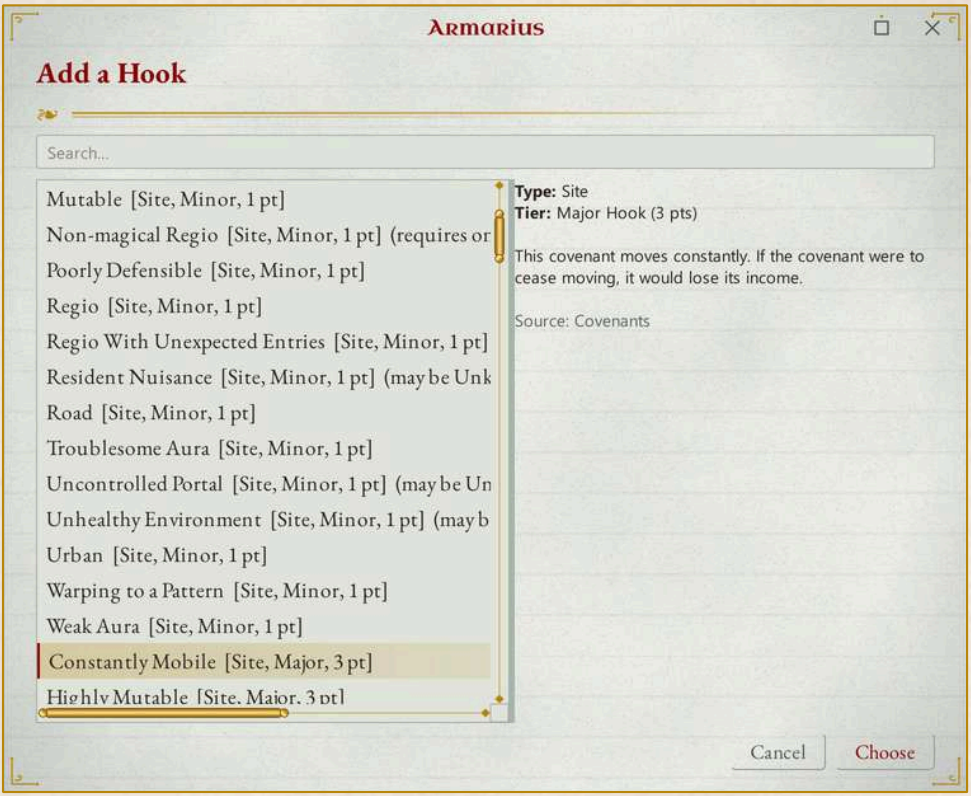
1. Two new covenants

A mobile covenant starts like any other. **New Covenant** on the saga's page asks for a name, a season and a realm, and the Creation Worksheet opens. *Founding and Keeping a Covenant* walks through that properly; here we only need enough to go on with: **Choose Power Level** and **Set starting income** on Baseline.



Create a New Covenant: Name "Schwalbenflug", Notes "Two river cogs on the Danube, from Ulm to Vienna and back", Season Spring, Aura realm Magic.

The Hook is what says it moves. On **Boons & Hooks**, **Add a Hook**: Constantly Mobile for Schwalbenflug, three points, and Erratically Mobile for Der Karrenzug, one. Neither Hook does anything on its own, but it makes the covenant show its Whereabouts. Then **Review**, and **Move to In Play**.



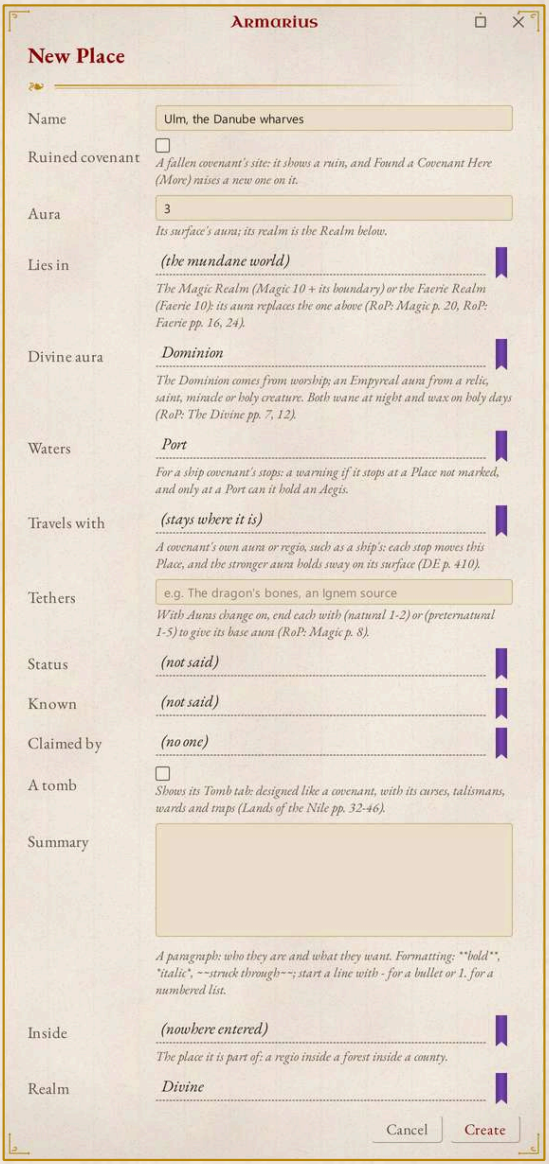
Add a Hook, with Erratically Mobile and the other Site Hooks in the list.

Now the magi. On each one's sheet, **Edit** in the header changes their **Covenant**: Thekla and Wolfram to Schwalbenflug, Bruno and Rosamund to Der Karrenzug. Each laboratory is made with the **New Laboratory** card on the covenant's Laboratories chapter, as usual: *The Swallow's Cabin*, *The Swift's Cabin* and, for Bruno, *The Long Wagon*.

2. Marking the map

Every stop is a Place in The Region, so the route has to exist before anyone can sail it. That includes the open water: a stretch of river with no aura is a Place too. On The Region, click the New card under the neighbours and choose **Place**. Give each its aura and its realm, and for the ship covenant its **Waters**: Open water, Anchorage or Port.

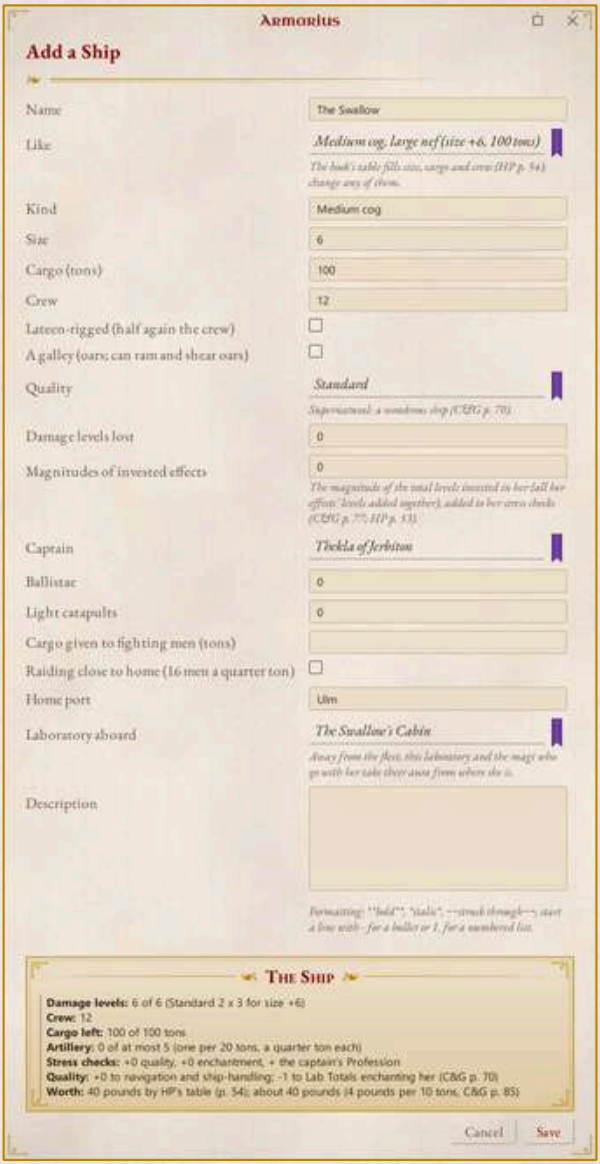
A town isn't a Place, so a harbour town gets one of its own. For Schwalbenflug: *Ulm, the Danube wharves*, *Regensburg, the Stone Bridge* and *Vienna, the Danube quays* are Ports with a Divine aura of 3; *The Inn mouth at Passau* is an Anchorage; *The Danube below Passau* is Open water. For Der Karrenzug: *Augsburg, the Perlach market* (Divine 3), *The Via Claudia at Fuessen* (no aura) and *The Fernstein spring* (Magic 2). These are this saga's places and figures, not a book's.



New Place: Ulm, the Danube wharves, Aura 3, Divine aura Dominion, Waters Port, Travels with "(stays where it is)", Realm Divine.

3. Ships

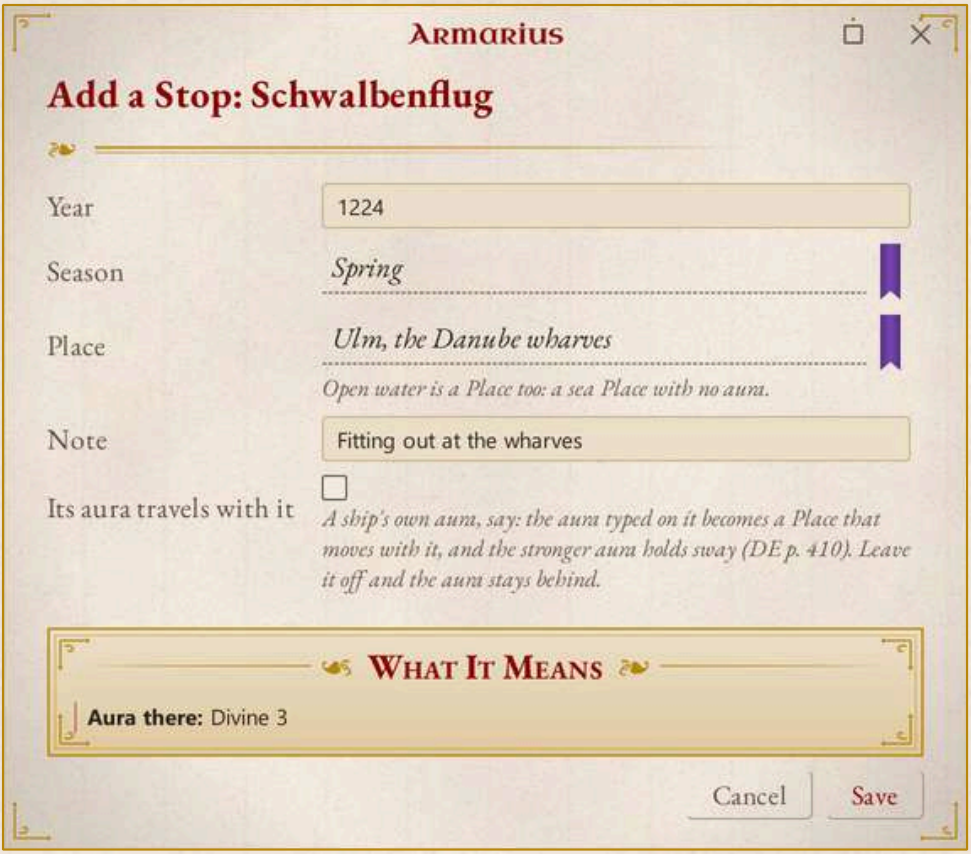
On Schwalbenflug's **Inventory** chapter, **Add** under Ships. *The Swallow* is like a medium cog, *The Swift* a small one, with Thekla and Wolfram as captains. **Laboratory aboard** names the lab she carries, so that it can leave with her later. The panel at the foot of the form works her out as you go: damage levels, crew, cargo, artillery and what she's worth. Der Karrenzug has no form like this: a wagon is just written down under Items, on Inventory.



Add a Ship: The Swallow, like a medium cog (size +6, 100 tons), Crew 12, Captain Thekla of Jerbiton, Home port Ulm, Laboratory aboard The Swallow's Cabin; The Ship panel reads Damage levels 6 of 6, Cargo left 100 of 100 tons, Worth 40 pounds.

4. The first stop

The Mobile Hook has already put a **Whereabouts** section on the covenant's Overview, above the Boons and Hooks. Its **Add** (Add a Stop) logs where the covenant is. Choose the year, the season and the Place. The foot of the form says what aura that means. With a ship afloat, Places with Waters come first in the list, and an unmarked Place gets a warning but isn't refused.

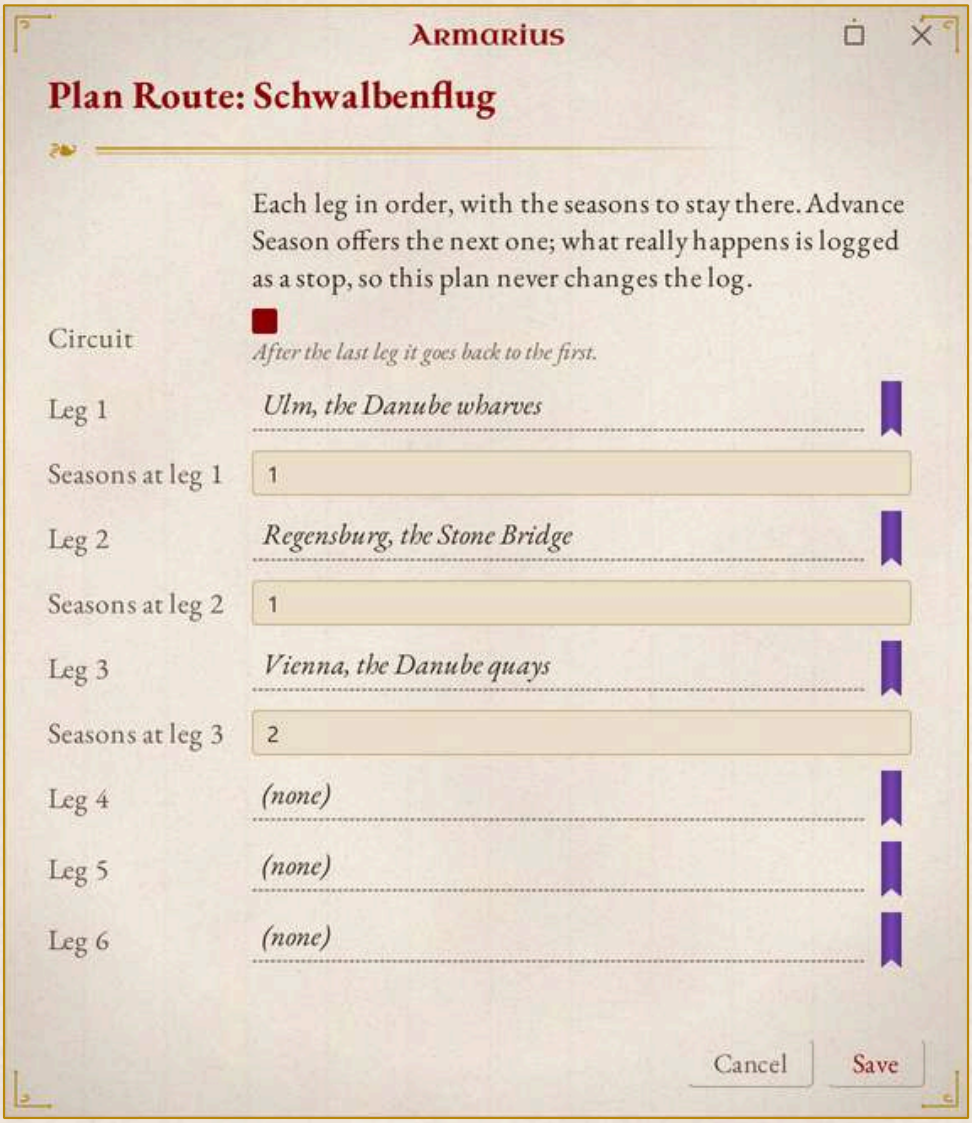


Add a Stop: Schwalbenflug, Spring 1224, Place Ulm, the Danube wharves, Note "Fitting out at the wharves". The foot reads "Aura there: Divine 3".

> **What happened.** "Schwalbenflug is logged at Ulm, the Danube wharves." Its aura is now Divine 3, and Whereabouts opens with "Here now: Ulm, the Danube wharves, Divine 3" over the log of stops. Casting, laboratories, vis study, aging and Warping all follow the stop from now on. Der Karrenzug's first stop, in the same way, is Augsburg.

5. Planning a route

On Whereabouts, **Plan Route** lists the legs in order, with the seasons to stay at each. Tick **Circuit** to go back to the first after the last. Schwalbenflug spends one season at Ulm, one at Regensburg, two at Vienna, and round again. A route can begin where the covenant already is: Whereabouts shows the route under Here now, and the leg in bold is the next place it isn't ("Route: Ulm, the Danube wharves > **Regensburg, the Stone Bridge** > Vienna, the Danube quays (2 seasons) > round again").



Plan Route: Schwalbenflug, Circuit ticked, Leg 1 Ulm for 1 season, Leg 2 Regensburg for 1, Leg 3 Vienna for 2.

A route is only a plan. It never changes the log, and what really happens is a stop. Der Karrenzug has no route: an Erratically Mobile covenant goes where the trade is, and answers the question in section 7 as it comes.

6. An aura that travels

Auras don't move. Magi can't simply take one with them, either: the Definitive Edition treats a mobile regio as something to be hunted for in hidden Mysteries (p. 518). But some covenants have one anyway. Favonius, in *Sundered Eagle* (p. 84), has ships that carry an aura and a regio of their own.

Say *The Swallow* carries a Magic aura of 2. Make a Place for it, *The Swallow's wake*, with Aura 2 and **Travels with** set to Schwalbenflug, and on **Edit Covenant** set the covenant's **Place** to it. The Place now goes inside whichever stop is in force.

The rule · DE p. 410

A place has one aura, and where two meet the stronger holds sway. The app's ruling for a travelling Place: on its surface the stronger of the two wins, with its realm, and a tie keeps its own. Inside its regio only the regio counts. A fixed Place inside another keeps its own aura as before.

Whereabouts (3) + Add | Edit | Delete | Plan Route

Here now: The Danube below Passau, Magic 2
Route: Ulm, the Danube wharves > Regensburg, the Stone Bridge > **Vienna, the Danube quays (2 seasons)** > round again

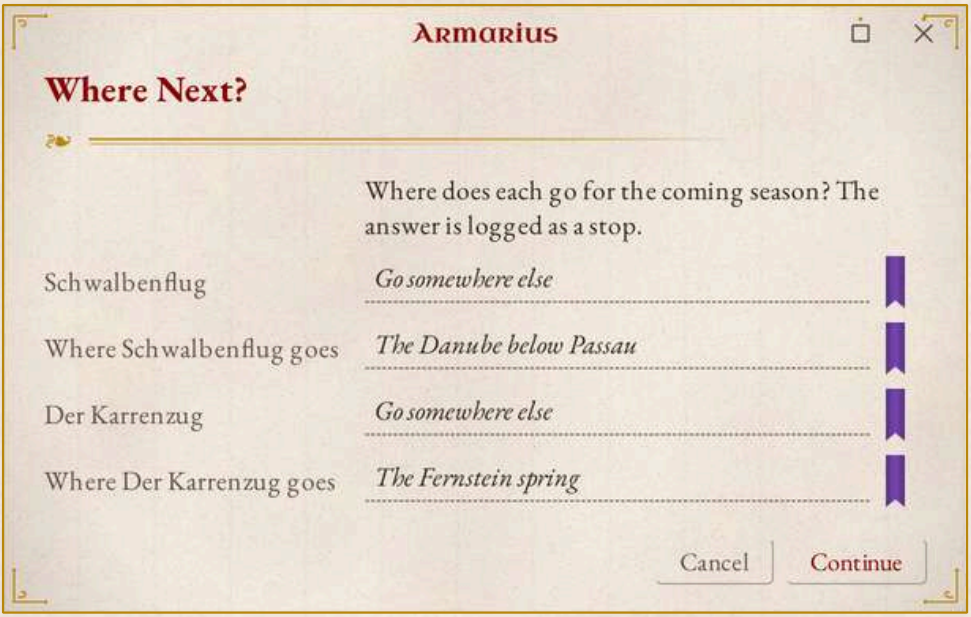
When	Where	Aura	Waters	Note
Autumn 1224	The Danube below Passau	Magic 2	Open water	Here now
Summer 1224	Regensburg, the Stone Bridge	Divine 3	Port	
Spring 1224	Ulm, the Danube wharves	Divine 3	Port	Fitting out at the wharves

Schwalbenflug's Whereabouts in Autumn 1224 on the open Danube: "Here now: The Danube below Passau, Magic 2", the route with Vienna next in bold, and the same Magic 2 in the table's Aura column, beside Open water.

> **What happened.** At Ulm, Regensburg and Vienna the Dominion's 3 still beats the ship's 2. On the open river, with no aura of its own, the covenant has its Magic 2, and that's where its magi want to be working. Whereabouts shows the aura that counts at each stop, with the travelling aura taken into account.

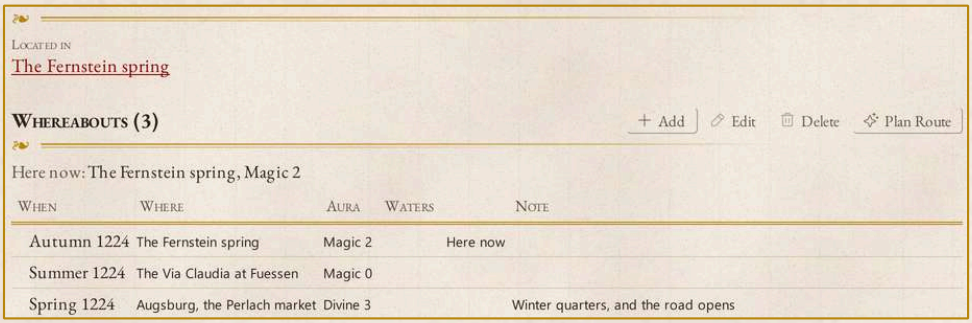
7. Advancing the season

The **Advance Season** card at the foot of the chapters now asks one more thing after its confirmation. **Where Next?** lists each covenant on the move: **Move on** to the route's next leg, **Stay**, or **Go somewhere else**, which asks where. It offers Move on when a leg's seasons are up, and you change it if the story did; a covenant with no route, like Der Karrenzug, is offered only Stay or Go somewhere else. **Continue** logs the answers.



Where Next?: Schwalbenflug "Go somewhere else", The Danube below Passau; Der Karrenzug "Go somewhere else", The Fernstein spring.

What happened. Over 1224, Schwalbenflug goes from Ulm to Regensburg in Summer, onto the open Danube in Autumn, and to Vienna in Winter. Der Karrenzug goes up the Via Claudia in Summer, spends Autumn at the Fernstein spring and is back in Augsburg for Winter, just as the book's example of an Erratically Mobile covenant does. Each answer is a stop in the log. Editing or deleting a stop later corrects the log and changes nothing else.



Der Karrenzug's Whereabouts in Autumn 1224: Here now The Fernstein spring, Magic 2, with its three stops (Augsburg, the Via Claudia at Fuessen, the Fernstein spring) and its Erratically Mobile Hook below.

8. The Aegis stays behind

The rule · Legends of Hermes p. 123

A Boundary effect isn't mobile, so an Aegis of the Hearth can't travel with a covenant. *Through the Aegis* (p. 23) only has its ship magi working at anchor; what follows for ships is this app's ruling.

Thekla casts an Aegis at Ulm: on **Edit Covenant**, Aegis of the Hearth 15. When the fleet moves on to Regensburg, it's gone: the value drops to 0, and the Diary has it under Defence & Magic. The same goes for Der Karrenzug, or any covenant that logs a move.

A ship covenant has a harder time of it. It can hold an Aegis only docked at a Port for the whole season. Edit Covenant refuses one anywhere else, even at an Anchorage ("A ship covenant holds an Aegis only docked at a Port all season."), and one still held away from a Port is lost when Advance Season keeps it there.

9. Vis on the way

Vis sources don't move either. A vis source belongs to the covenant and lies where it lies. Add it as usual under **Vis Sources**, with its **Season** and **Location**: Schwalbenflug has *The pearls under the Stone Bridge*, three pawns of Aquam each Summer at Regensburg, which is why the route starts there.

While a source's season is on, Whereabouts adds a **Vis this season** line naming it and where it lies, so that you can plan round it. The app doesn't check that you got there: the pawns arrive in the stores with the season wherever the fleet is, and if the fleet missed the pearls, that's yours to fix on Inventory.
A Constantly Mobile covenant that stops moving loses its income by the book, and that's also yours to apply.

10. Sending a ship away

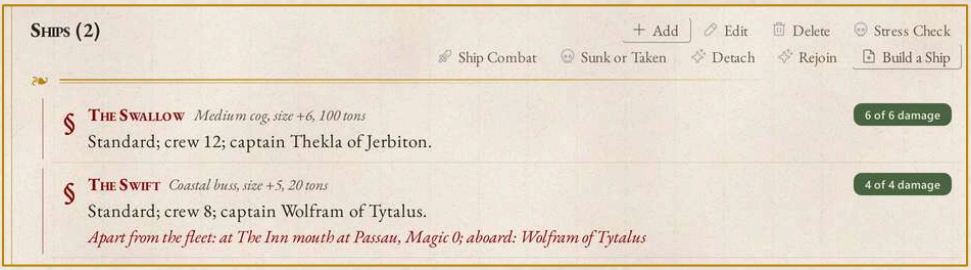
A covenant rests on its charter, not on everyone being in one place (*Through the Aegis* pp. 11, 25), so one ship can go off on her own. In Autumn 1224 Wolfram has business with the Bishop of Passau.

On Inventory, choose *The Swift* and click **Detach**, among the buttons over Ships. Say where she goes, and for each magus whose laboratory is aboard, tick whether he goes with her: the default is yes.



Detach: The Swift, She goes to The Inn mouth at Passau, Note "Wolfram has business with the Bishop", Wolfram of Tytalus travels with this ship ticked.

What happened. "The Swift left the fleet for The Inn mouth at Passau." Her entry on Inventory says so: "Apart from the fleet: at The Inn mouth at Passau, Magic 0; aboard: Wolfram of Tytalus". She keeps her own stops, and her laboratory and Wolfram take their aura from where she is. Where Next? asks about her separately each season, and she stays at the Inn mouth while the fleet goes on to Vienna.



Schwalbenflug's Ships on Inventory: The Swallow, medium cog, 6 of 6 damage, with the fleet, and The Swift, coastal buss, 4 of 4 damage, marked "Apart from the fleet: at The Inn mouth at Passau, Magic 0; aboard: Wolfram of Tytalus".

When she's back, choose her and click **Rejoin**, and say yes to "Bring The Swift back to the fleet?". Her stops end and the Diary records both. Choosing the moment is up to you: the app doesn't check that she can reach the fleet.

What you do by hand

- **The Hooks' other costs**: losing income for stopping, by the book, or missing a vis source.
- **Wagons**: a caravan's wagons are Items, with no form of their own, and no wagon can Detach as a ship can.
- **How long a journey takes**: the app logs where the covenant is each season, not whether it could get there.
- **Neighbours, Tribunal and possessions**: none of them change when a covenant moves.

Where the rules come from

Ars Magica Definitive Edition: auras (p. 410); a mobile regio as a proactive story (p. 518).

Covenants: Constantly Mobile (p. 9); Erratically Mobile (p. 10); the Traveling Covenant (p. 27).

Legends of Hermes: the Aegis isn't mobile (p. 123). *Through the Aegis*: a covenant rests on its charter (pp. 11, 25); working at anchor (p. 23). *Sundered Eagle*: Favonius (p. 84). A Dominion port beating a ship's own aura, and the Port rule for an Aegis, are this app's rulings.